DigitalResources

SIL eBook 65

SIL

Discourse Features of Godié Narrative

Inge Egner

Discourse Features of Godié Narrative

Inge Egner

SIL International®
2015

SIL e-Books
65

©2015 SIL International®

ISSN: 1934-2470

Fair-Use Policy:

Books published in the SIL e-Books (SILEB) series are intended for scholarly research and educational use. You may make copies of these publications for research or instructional purposes free of charge (within fair-use guidelines) and without further permission. Republication or commercial use of SILEB or the documents contained therein is expressly prohibited without the written consent of the copyright holder(s).

Editor-in-Chief
Mike Cahill

Volume Editor
Dirk Kievit

Managing Editor
Bonnie Brown

Compositor
Margaret González

Abstract

While most studies dealing with discourse phenomena focus on only one feature, such as information structure or participant reference, this work provides a more extensive study of the discourse features of a language. Based on the author's original fieldwork in the language for over a decade and using a selection of eighteen natural texts—sixteen narratives, a dialogue, and an exhortation—totalling roughly 2,500 clauses, the study examines seven different discourse features found in the Godié language of Côte d'Ivoire, ranging from constituent order to narrative development. Throughout the study, examples from the texts illustrate what is being argued or claimed. The complete text collection is included for reference by way of an appendix.

Contents

Abstract
Preface
Abbreviations
1 Introduction
2 Phonology and grammar of Godié
2.1 Phonology
2.2 Pronouns
2.2.1 Personal pronouns
2.2.2 The locative pronoun *-mɔɔ*
2.3 Determiners
2.3.1 Definite marker
2.3.2 Demonstratives
2.3.3 Locative adverbs
2.4 Relative clauses
2.4.1 The linguistic forms of relative clauses
2.4.2 Semantic types of relative clauses
2.5 Tenses
2.5.1 The future tense
2.5.2 The past tense
2.6 Aspects
2.6.1 The completive aspect
2.6.2 The incompletive aspect
2.6.3 The progressive aspect
2.6.4 The perfect aspect
3 Order of constituents
3.1 Default order of constituents in the clause
3.1.1 The basic clause types
3.1.2 The verb brace
3.1.3 The default position of adjuncts
3.2 Marked constituent order: Preposed constituents
3.3 Dislocated constituents
3.3.1 Left-dislocated constituents
3.3.2 Right-dislocated constituents
3.3.3 Combinations of left-dislocation and preposing
4 Information management
4.1 Information structure of the clause
4.1.1 Clauses with predicate focus
4.1.2 Clauses with argument focus
4.1.3 Clauses with global focus
4.2 Points of departure
4.2.1 Situational points of departure
4.2.2 Referential points of departure
4.2.3 Tail-head linkage
4.3 Managing prominence: Highlighting and backgrounding
4.3.1 Highlighting devices
4.3.2 Backgrounding devices
4.4 Information management in relative clauses
5 Participant reference
5.1 Introduction of participants
5.1.1 The introduction of brand new participants
5.1.2 The introduction of identifiable participants

5.1.3 The introduction of the very first participant
5.2 Tracking of participants
5.2.1 Default tracking of participants
5.2.2 Marked tracking of participants
6 Represented speech
6.1 Formal features of represented speech
6.1.1 Direct speech
6.1.2 Indirect speech
6.2 Speech margins
6.3 Functions of represented speech in narrative
7 Spacers
7.1 The spacer *nä* ‘SP1’
7.2 The spacer *nynä* ‘SP2’
8 Pragmatic connectives
8.1 Additive connectives
8.1.1 The additive connective *'nɪ* ‘ADD1’
8.1.2 The additive connective *-yä* ‘ADD2’
8.1.3 The additive connective *'sɪɪ* ‘ADD3’
8.1.4 The additive connective *-mä* ‘ADD4’
8.1.5 The additive connective *-mää* ‘ADD5’
8.2 Countering connectives
8.2.1 The connective *-bhlɛ* ‘CNT1’
8.2.2 The connective *-wv* ‘CNT2’
8.3 Conclusive connectives
8.3.1 The connective *'ɪzä* ‘CLU1’
8.3.2 The connective *ɪɪ 'ŋnö 'mnö* ‘CLU2’
8.3.3 The connective *-kä* ‘CLU3’
9 Narrative development
9.1 Moving forward within a narrative phase
9.1.1 The temporal adverb *yɪ* ‘now’
9.1.2 The *yi* clause
9.2 Marking the different stages in the narrative
9.2.1 Situational points of departure
9.2.2 The evidential marker *wlä*
9.2.3 Past tense particles
9.2.4 The perfect aspect and ideophones
9.2.5 Set expressions
9.2.6 Orientation
9.3 Theme line versus background
Appendix: Text collection
References

Preface

The present study has been on my agenda for a number of years. It was started in 1999 at a workshop with Dr. Stephen Levinsohn in Bouaké, Côte d'Ivoire, and I have been trying to continue working on it ever since. Unfortunately, because of other activities and various changes in my life situation, I had not been able to free myself up for a long enough period of time to really get back to it until almost a decade later, when, as a result of another change in external and personal circumstances, I was able to give more time to the study. At that point I had decided to write it in English rather than French, so that it would be accessible to a wider audience.

For the past few years I have finally been able to make the study a priority until its completion. The study is by no means exhaustive. However, I have attempted to analyze and describe discourse features that are relevant to translation activities but are nevertheless all too often not getting the attention they deserve. Some of the features are no doubt described inadequately and some of the analyses may turn out to be incorrect, while others may break new ground. Readers are invited to make use of what is presented here according to their interests and needs. While the study is mostly limited to the narrative genre (with the exception of two texts, all of the texts used for the study were narratives), many features are likely to apply to non-narrative genres as well.

Systematically describing the discourse features of a language is like putting in the keystone of a building. Just as a keystone can be properly placed and hold together the rest of the construction only if all the other parts of the construction are also in their proper place, so too the description of discourse features requires the proper description of the other aspects of the language structure, especially the morphology and syntax of the language. This avoids attributing features to discourse structure that are in fact part of the lower-level grammar.

For this reason and since a full grammatical description of Godié has not yet been published, the study begins with an overview of those areas of the morphology and syntax of which the reader should have a basic notion in order to understand the pragmatic effects of these grammar features on discourse.

The text collection comprising the eighteen texts from which the vernacular examples in the study have been drawn is made available to the reader at the end of the study in the appendix.

Dr. Stephen Levinsohn read an earlier version of the manuscript and made helpful comments. I thank him for accompanying me in this project from a distance over the years and for being willing to answer questions I had along the way.

I am immensely grateful to my friend and colleague Cornelia Wüsthoff, who also read the whole manuscript and made useful comments. Her encouragement along the way and her help with innumerable questions of layout and formatting have been invaluable. Without her, the study would not have seen its completion at this time, and maybe not at all.

Inge Egner

Möckmühl, Germany
July 2015

Abbreviations

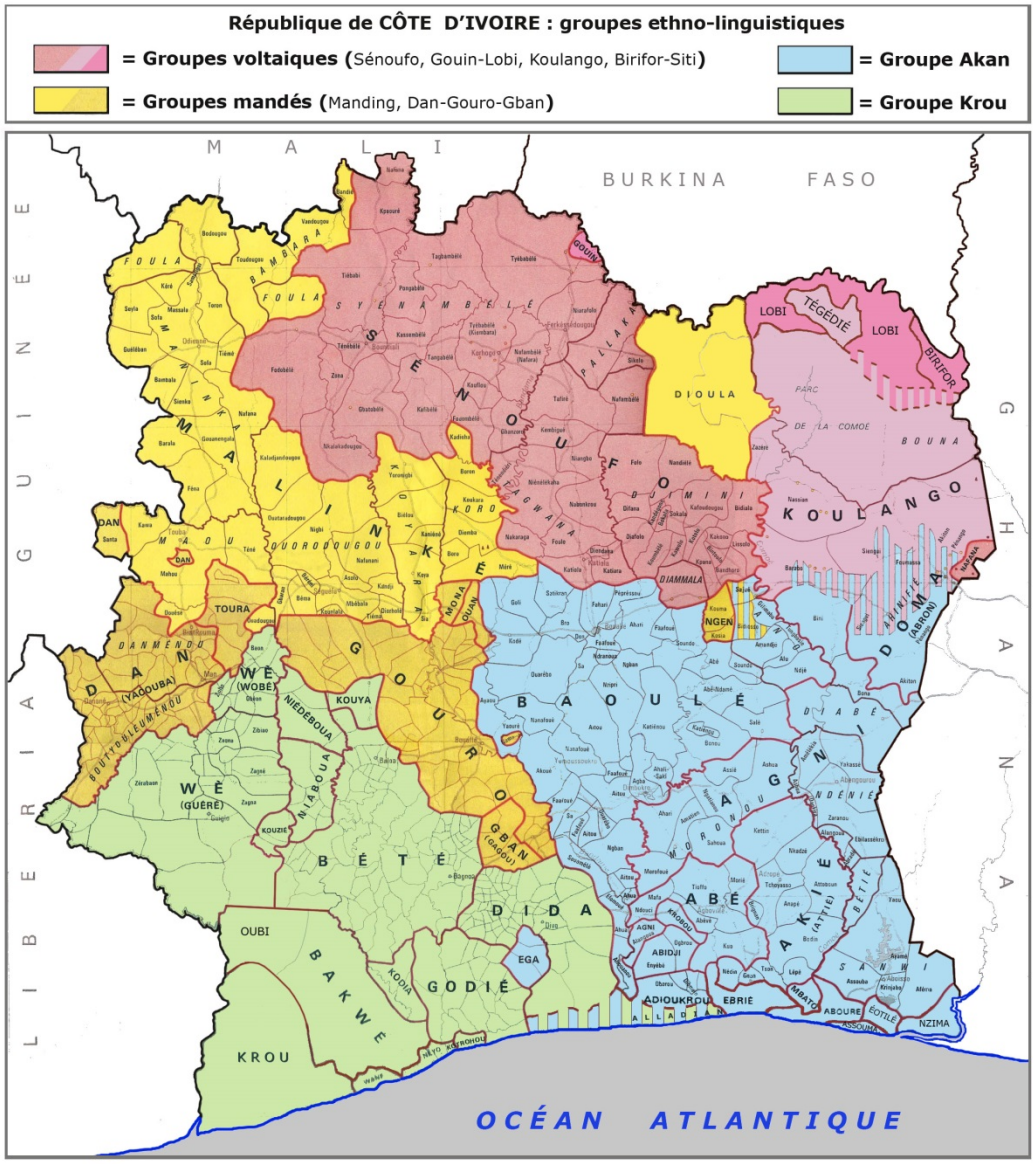
1P	first person plural pronoun, human gender: *-a*
1PO	first person plural object pronoun, human gender: *-anyɪ*
1S	first person singular pronoun, human gender: *n* (mid-tone syllabic nasal)
1SO	first person singular object pronoun, human gender: floating high-tone clitic
2P	second person plural pronoun, human gender: *a*
2PO	second person plural object pronoun, human gender: *anyɪ*
2S	second person singular pronoun, human gender: *-n* (low-tone syllabic nasal)
2SO	second person singular object pronoun, human gender: floating low tone
3P	third person plural pronoun, human gender: *wa*
3S	third person singular pronoun, human gender: *ɔ*
ADD1	additive connective: *ʻnɪ*
ADD2	additive connective: *-yä, -ya, ɪyä*
ADD3	additive connective: *ˈsɯ*
ADD4	additive connective: *-mä*
ADD5	additive connective: *-mää*
AG	agent suffix
APL	applicative suffix: *-nö* or floating low tone
ASF	assertive focus particle: *kä*
BE1	to be in a position: *-kʊ*
BE2	to be or become someone or something: *ˈplö*
BE3	to belong to a group or in a place: *-glö*
BE4	to be in a certain way, e.g., a group, number: *bhlü*
CAUS	causative suffix
CLU1	conclusive connective: *ˈɪzä* ‘therefore’
CLU2	conclusive connective: *ɯ ˈŋnö ˈmnö* ‘because of this’, ‘that is why’
CLU3	conclusive connective: *-kä*
CNT1	countering connective: *-bhlɛ*
CNT2	countering connective: -w*ʊ*
COM	comitative suffix: *-mV*
COMP	complement
COP	copula
CP	completive aspect: floating low tone
DDEM	distant demonstrative marker
DEF	definite marker
DEM	demonstrative marker
DIM	diminutive suffix
DP1	discourse particle: *sää*
DP2	discourse particle: *-lä*
DP3	discourse particle: *-zä*
DP4	discourse particle: *a* (clause-final backgrounding particle)
DPF	definite pro-form: *-lVV* ‘the…one’
EVD	evidential marker: *wlä* (from ‘they say’)
EXCL1	exclamatory particle: *ˈƆ(ɔ)!* or *O(o)!* (clause initial)
EXCL2	exclamatory particle: *o!* (clause final)
EXCL3	exclamatory particle: *a(a)!* (clause final)
GEN	genitive marker: floating high tone
ICP	incompletive aspect: floating mid tone
ID	ideophone
IO	indirect object
IPF	indefinite pro-form: *-lVV* ‘one’
LOC	locative pronoun: *-m ɔ ɔ*
LOC. COMP	locative complement
LOP	lower prominence particle: *lä*
NCOMP	noun complement
NH1	pronoun, non-human gender 1: *a*
NH2	pronoun, non-human gender 2: *ɛ*
NH3	pronoun, non-human gender 3: *ʊ*
NHP	plural pronoun, non-human gender: *ɪ*
NOM	nominalizing suffix
NUPT	narrative uptake element: *sese* or *-kpazebhleku*
O	object

OBL	oblique case marker: *'mʋ/'mö* (or its reduced form, a high-tone clitic)
PL	plural suffix
POST	postposition
PRC	process suffix *mä*
PST1	past particle: *bhä* (and its variant forms)
PST2	past particle: *a*
PST3	past particle: *wä/wɛ*
PST4	past particle: *bhɛ*
PST5	past particle: *bhst*
PSV	passive suffix *-ɔ/-o*
PUR	purpose particle: *-kä*
Q	question marker for yes-no questions
QW	question marker for WH-questions: *bhä*
REL	relative marker: floating low tone
S	subject
sg.	singular
SG	singularizing suffix: *ye*
sp.	species
SP1	default spacer: *nä*
SP2	spacer: *nynä*
TH	thematic marker for pronouns
UPT	uptake element: *-a, -aa, aa, nn*
V	verb
VC	verbal complement (i.e., noun being part of a verbal expression)
VOC	vocative suffix: *nyc* (low tone)
VPC	verbal particle (often a postposition)
XCND	conditional auxiliary: *kä*
XFUT	future auxiliary: *yi*
XNEG	negative auxiliary: *'nö* or floating high-tone clitic
XPER	perfect auxiliary: *yä*
XPOT	potential auxiliary: *'kä*

1 Introduction

According to the sixteenth edition of the *Ethnologue*, Godié [god] is an Eastern Kru language just like the Bakwé, Dida, and Bété languages.[1] More specifically, it belongs to the western branch of the Bété language complex. All these languages are traditionally spoken in the southwestern part of Côte d'Ivoire (see map 1 below).[2]

Map 1. Map of Côte d'Ivoire



Source: Spiridon Ion Cepleanu, Wikipedia (unaltered). http://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:IvoryCoastEthno.jpg (accessed December 14, 2015). Permission granted under the Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Unported license.

[1]In this study, lesser-known languages are identified by their ISO language code (if they have one), such as [god] for Godié. No code is given here for Bakwé, Dida, and Bété because they represent groups of languages, each of which has its own code.

[2]Pioneering work on the classification of the Kru languages was carried out by Marchese (see Marchese 1983a and 1989).

The estimated one hundred Godié villages are located in the Department (Préfecture) of Sassandra. According to the general census of the Ivorian population carried out in 1998, there are around 30,000 Godié speakers.[3] As is the case with other ethnic groups, a significant part of the population lives outside the group's original territory, especially in the larger towns and cities throughout the country.

The Godié language is certainly not an endangered language, as it is still spoken by the young generation in all Godié villages. Godié has around ten mutually intelligible dialects (see map 2 below). The present study is based on the Kagbo (or Kagboué) dialect spoken in a dozen villages along the middle part of the 130 kilometer-road from Lakota to Sassandra in the centre of the Godié area.

Map 2. Godié dialect areas



Names of languages on this map have other equivalents. In this text, I refer to the Kagboué of the map as "Kagbo." Source: Carte « Groupes culturels ethniques », Atlas de Côte d'Ivoire (1971), Institut de géographie tropicale (IGT), Abidjan ; realized in 2014 by Centre de cartographie et de télédétection (CCT), Abidjan (2014). Used with permission.

The linguistic analysis of the Godié language was started in 1972 by Carol Gratrix and Lynell Marchese. All their work on the phonology, grammar, and discourse of the language is based on the Jluko (or Djirokouya) dialect spoken in the villages along the southern part of the 150 kilometer-road from Gueyo to Sassandra in the western part of the Godié area.

It goes without saying that our study of the language draws heavily on the excellent groundwork laid by our predecessors in all areas of language study. The credit we owe them is huge. Their publications appear in the references at the end of this study.[4]

The present work is based on personal research carried out during a ten-year involvement in the Godié language development and Bible translation project under the auspices of SIL International. The

[3]This figure was kindly provided by the Institut national de la statistique in Abidjan.
[4]They can also be found online in the SIL bibliography at http://silorg.devcloud.acquia-sites.com/resources/search/language/god (accessed December 14, 2015) and in the OLAC resources on Godié at http://www.language-archives.org/language/god (accessed December 14, 2015).

SIL project which had been started in 1972 was discontinued in 1978 and remained inactive for some fifteen years. Our own contact with the Godié language and people started in 1993 with a prolonged stay in the Kagbo language area in order to learn the language and then help develop it. The alphabet and orthography established by our predecessors were revised and a team of native speakers was trained to help develop a small body of literacy material comprising a primer, an orthography guide, and some post-primer reading material. A program for translating Bible texts was also initiated and is still ongoing.

This discourse study is an attempt to provide a more extensive study of Godié narrative discourse, though Gratrix and Marchese have both studied discourse, too. However, since discourse analysis has developed a great deal over the past four decades, our theoretical stance is somewhat different from theirs. In particular, while their discourse work was carried out mainly in the discourse grammar perspective predominant in SIL at the time, we adopt more of a discourse-pragmatic position. We have thus tried to apply cognitive approaches such as Lambrecht's in dealing with information structure, and used insights from Relevance Theory in our description of connectives. Overall we have drawn most heavily on Stephen Levinsohn's eclectic approach.

More specifically, in presenting our analysis of Godié connectives, we have proposed some scenarios of historical development involving their reanalysis, giving evidence for it from present language use as documented in our data corpus. Despite the shortcomings that these proposed scenarios may have, we found them worth presenting to fellow linguists, especially those working in Kru languages, while experts of historical linguistics may also find them stimulating and worth considering.

The study is divided into nine chapters. Following this introductory chapter, chapter two presents an overview of the phonology of Godié as well as of key areas of the grammar that are particularly relevant for discourse analysis: pronouns, determiners, the relative clause, and the tense-aspect system.

Chapter three deals with the order of constituents in the clause as the basis for discourse analysis. It first describes the default order of constituents in each of the basis clause types (§3.1.1), the so-called verb brace characteristic of Kru languages (§3.1.2), and the default position of adjuncts in the clause (§3.1.3). Then follows a small section discussing preposed constituents as the only case of marked constituent order in Godié (§3.2). Finally, transcending the strict clause level, a section on dislocated constituents (§3.3) is included, discussing left dislocation (§3.3.1), right dislocation (§3.3.2), as well as the combination of left-dislocation and preposing (§3.3.3).

The remaining chapters deal with specific areas of discourse analysis. Chapter four considers the vast area of information management, including information structure of the clause (§4.1), Points of Departure or frames of reference (§4.2), as well as devices for managing prominence (§4.3), and a small section on information management in relative clauses (§4.4). Chapter five deals with the introduction and tracking of participants (§5.1 and §5.2 respectively). Chapter six looks at reported speech, both at its formal features (§6.1) and its functions (§6.2) in Godié narrative, while chapter seven presents the two most common spacer elements in Godié, *nä* 'SP1' (§7.1) and *nynä* 'SP2' (§7.2). The final two chapters are the longest and most original ones: chapter eight discusses pragmatic connectives—distinguishing between additive (§8.1), countering (§8.2), and conclusive (§8.3) connectives—and chapter nine discusses various devices for marking narrative development. The appendix contains the collection of eighteen texts on which the study is based.

A number of examples occur several times in the study, each time illustrating a different discourse feature. In such cases, rather than referring back to the example when it was first used, we have reprinted the example with a new number for the reader's convenience.

The Leipzig Glossing Rules for Interlinear Morpheme-by-Morpheme Glosses have only partially been followed in the interlinearization of the examples used in this study. As the Godié vernacular is represented in practical orthography, where the hyphen is used to represent low tone, the hyphen has been avoided altogether in the interlinearization, which is at odds with Leipzig Rule 2. Thus in the vernacular line no morpheme separation is indicated, while in the gloss line the colon is used throughout to separate morphemes (Leipzig Rule 4C), no matter whether these morphemes are segmental or non-segmental, i.e. tonal. As for one-to-many correspondences between a Godié morpheme and its English gloss, the understroke is used in the gloss (Leipzig Rule 4A), e.g., *'pilo* 'fishing_net'.

2 Phonology and grammar of Godié

This chapter provides a brief overview of Godié phonology (§2.1), as well as those aspects of the grammar that are particularly relevant for discourse (§2.2-§2.6). Among these are the pronouns (§2.2), including personal pronouns (§2.2.1) and the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* 'LOC' (§2.2.2); the determiners (§2.3), including the definite marker (§2.3.1), the demonstratives (§2.3.2), and the locative adverbs (§2.3.3); the relative clause (§2.4); the future and past tenses (§2.5.1 and §2.5.2 respectively); and finally the aspect system (§2.6), including the completive aspect (§2.6.1), the incompletive aspect (§2.6.2), the progressive aspect (§2.6.3), and the perfect aspect (§2.6.4).[1]

2.1 Phonology

Only the most basic rules of Godié orthography are given here, but they should be sufficient for the reader to understand the glosses of the examples.[2]

Godié is a tonal language with three level tones: high, mid, and low. High tone is represented in the orthography by a straight apostrophe <'> and low tone by a hyphen <-> while mid tone is left unmarked. Lexical tones are written at the beginning of a word in Godié, as shown in example (1).

(1) 'yi (high tone) 'eyes'
yi (mid tone) 'come'
-yi (low tone) 'know'

Tone plays an important role in Godié grammar (see Gratrix 1975). In Godié orthography, grammatical tones—unlike lexical tones illustrated in example (1) above—are generally written at the end of the word. For example, the oblique marker 'OBL' and the negative auxiliary 'XNEG' are both realized by a floating high tone. This results in the lengthening of the preceding vowel represented by duplication, as shown in example (2a). In the case of the syllabic pronouns *n* 'I' and *-n* 'you (sg.)', the addition of the high tone of the negative auxiliary results in the lengthening of the syllabic nasal, indicated by the reduplication of the letter *n,* as shown in (2b) and (2c). [3]

(2) a. 'klää'
field:OBL
'to/in the field'

b. nn' -lä tee -yi
1S:XNEG/DP2/yet/come:CP
'I haven't come yet.'

c. -nn' -lä tee -yi
2S:XNEG/DP2/yet/come:CP
'You haven't come yet.'

[1]For a more detailed description of the grammar of Godié the reader is referred to Marchese 1986b. This practical grammar was written in French and exists only in manuscript form.
[2]It may be surprising for some readers that the Godié orthography is used in the present study, rather than a phonological transcription. However, for the purpose of describing discourse features of Godié, the orthography was deemed sufficient for the reader. This orthography is used in Godié pedagogical and other literature. Where remarks concerning the phonological structure are pertinent, these have been added in a footnote.
[3]To avoid confusion with the low tone marker, morpheme breaks are not indicated by hyphens in the vernacular line of the examples. In the gloss line, they are indicated by colons.

The only exception to the general rule of writing grammatical tones at the end of the word is the low-tone sign representing completive aspect, which is written at the beginning of monosyllabic mid-tone verbs. Thus the verb *yi* 'come' is written *-yi* in the completive aspect. On the other hand, with low-tone monosyllabic verbs such as the verb *-sä* 'take away', the completive floating low tone is not represented.

For words longer than one syllable (including compound words), the tone of the following syllable or syllables is predictable for a native speaker. Thus there is no need to indicate these tones in the orthography.

Tables 2.1 and 2.2 show the orthographic representation of the 13 vowel phonemes and the 24 consonant phonemes of the Godié phonological system.

Table 2.1. Orthographic representation of Godié vowels

		+ FRONT*	- FRONT	
			– ROUNDED	+ROUNDED
+ CLOSED	+ATR	i	ü	u
	– ATR	ɪ	ö	ʊ
– CLOSED	+ATR	e	ë	o
– OPEN	– ATR	ɛ	ä	ɔ
+ OPEN			a	

*Note that all front vowels are unrounded in Godié. Thus the feature [-ROUNDED] is redundant for FRONT vowels.

Table 2.2. Orthographic representation of Godié consonants

		Labial	Alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Labio-velar	Labialized velar
Plosives	voiceless	p	t	c	k		kw
	voiced	b	d	j	g		gw
Fricatives	voiceless	f	s				
	voiced	v	z				
Sonorants	nasal	m	n	ny	ŋ		nw
	oral	bh	l / n*	y	gh	w	

*The representation of the phoneme /l/ by *n* in the orthography occurs only in the syllable structure C_1C_2V, where C_1 is a nasal consonant and C_2 is the phoneme /l/, phonetically realized as [n], e.g., *'mnö* 'inside'.

2.2 Pronouns

This section describes the Godié personal pronouns and the locative pronoun. Other pro-forms, such as the definite pro-form *-lVV* 'DPF' and the indefinite pro-form *lVV* 'IPF', will not be described here. (See Marchese 1986c for a description of the Godie pronominal system, including the use of pronouns in discourse.)

2.2.1 Personal pronouns

According to Schachter (1985:25), a pronoun is a "word used as a substitute for a noun or noun phrase." Within the system of personal pronouns, this is actually true only for those commonly called third person pronouns, but not for first and second person pronouns. Even though the latter do refer respectively to

the speaker(s) and the addressee(s), they are not a substitute for a noun phrase such as “the speaker” or “the hearer” in the way that a third person pronoun such as “he” is a substitute for a noun like “John”. This needs to be kept in mind when talking about pronouns of first and second person, which are also referred to as “speech pronouns.”

In table 2.3 the Godié personal pronouns are presented in two sets: simple and thematic. Simple pronouns cannot occur alone and can therefore also be referred to as dependent pronouns. Thematic pronouns, on the other hand, can occur alone and are therefore independent forms. They carry the thematic marker ‘TH’, which takes different forms depending on the pronoun with which the marker occurs. In the first and second person singular pronouns, the marker amalgamates with the syllabic nasal *n.* In addition, as table 2.3 shows, there is a distinction among the third person pronouns between human and non-human gender in Godié. Three non-human genders are distinguished in the singular.

Table 2.3. Godié pronouns

		Simple pronoun		Thematic pronoun	
		Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
1st person	human	n ‘1S’	-a ‘1P’	-amʊ/-mö ‘1S:TH’	-anyɪ ‘1P:TH
2nd person	human	-n ‘2S’	a ‘2P’	-mɔɔ ‘2S:TH’	anyɪ ‘2P:TH’
3rd person	human	ɔ ‘3S’	wa ‘3P’	ɔmɔ ‘3S:TH’	wamä ‘3P:TH’
	non-human	a ‘NH1’	ɪ ‘NHP’	amä ‘NH1:TH’	ɯmɪ ‘NHP:TH’
		ɛ ‘NH2’		ɛmɛ ‘NH2:TH’	
		ʊ ‘NH3’		ʊmʊ ‘NH3:TH’	

As already indicated, the form of the thematic pronouns is complex, being made up of the simple pronoun and the thematic marker. As can be seen from table 2.3 above, the marker ‘TH’ has the form *nyɪ* in first and second person plural and *'mV* in third person singular and plural. The vowel V of the third person is identical to the vowel of the corresponding simple pronoun, except for the first non-human gender *a* ‘NH1’, where the vowel is *ä.* That vowel is also found with the third person human plural.[4]

As shown in table 2.4 below, the type of non-human gender of a pronoun appears to be phonologically conditioned by the last vowel of the noun it stands for.[5] The pronoun *a* is used for nouns ending in an unrounded non-front vowel; the pronoun *ɛ* for nouns ending in an unrounded non-open vowel; the pronoun *ʊ* for nouns ending in a rounded vowel; and the pronoun *ɪ* for non-human plural nouns (which all have an underlying high-vowel plural suffix).

[4]For more details on the pronominal system of Godié, see Marchese 1986c.

[5]The last vowel of a noun represents in many cases an old gender suffix, but noun class suffixes are no longer productive in Godié. However, a tendency to orient to the phonological features of the last vowel of the noun can be observed with non-human nouns ending in the vowel ɔ. Such nouns can be found to be represented by the human pronoun ɔ (see example (168b)). Orientation to a phonological feature has thus overridden orientation to gender in the choice of the pronoun standing for a noun of non-human gender ending in the vowel ɔ.

Table 2.4. Examples of non-human nouns and their corresponding pronouns

Noun		Simple pronoun	Thematic pronoun
tlä -zlë	‘hedgehog’ ‘spirit’	a ‘NH1’	amä ‘NH1:TH’
'gwɛ zlü	‘chimpanzee’ ‘fish’	ɛ ‘NH2’	ɛmɛ ‘NH2:TH’
-bhutu sukpɔ	‘house’ ‘ants’ (sp.)	ʊ ‘NH3’	ʊmʊ ‘NH3:TH’
-bhiti ‘süü	‘houses’ ‘shoes’	ɪ ‘NHP’[6]	ɪmɪ ‘NHP:TH’

For third person simple pronouns, the forms are identical in subject and object positions. However, even though in both positions the forms are subject to ATR vowel harmony, the resulting forms are represented differently in the orthography for subject and object position.[7] In subject position, pronouns with a [–ATR] vowel *(ɛ, ɪ, ɔ, ʊ*) tend to be pronounced with their corresponding [+ATR] vowel (*e, i, o, u*) before a verb or an auxiliary with a [+ATR] vowel, such as e, *i, o, u,* or *ë*. However, the Godié orthography does not reflect these changes. Thus in the written clause *ɔ yi* ‘3S/come.ICP’ translated ‘he comes’, the pronoun ɔ is pronounced [o].

On the other hand, in object position the pronouns, attached as pronoun clitics to the preceding verb or auxiliary, undergo the same changes as the subject pronouns. However, unlike the changes in subject position, these changes *are* reflected in the orthography, as shown by the examples in table 2.5.

Table 2.5. Orthographic representation of object pronouns

Verb + pronoun clitic	Resulting forms
yi + ɪ /ɛ /ɔ/ ʊ	yii / yie / yio / yiu
su + ɪ / ɛ /ɔ/ ʊ	sui / sue / suo/ suu

Unlike the third person pronouns, simple pronouns in first and second person have different forms for subject and object position in the clause. The first person pronoun singular in subject position is the mid-tone morpheme *n* ‘1S’, as in example (3a), while the first person singular pronoun morpheme for object position (‘1SO’) is only a floating high tone. In writing, the floating high tone is represented by a reduplication of the preceding vowel to which an apostrophe is attached, as shown in example (3b). The second person singular pronoun, on the other hand, is the low tone morpheme *-n* ‘2S’ in subject position, while the pronoun morpheme for object position (‘2SO’) is a floating low tone. It is represented in writing by a reduplication of the preceding vowel with a hyphen attached to it, as shown in example (3a).[8]

(3) a. ɔ lä **-n** ni sä **n** sonö-**ö** bhlä
3S say **2S** see since **1S** speak:APL:2SO:ICP PST1:LOP
‘He said, “You see, since I had said to you

[6]The non-human plural pronoun is also used for abstract nouns, such as *wälɪ* ‘affair, matter’ or *'ŋnö* ‘name’.
[7]ATR (Advanced Tongue Root) vowel harmony in Godié applies to the phonological word.
[8]For examples taken from the text collection in the appendix, the text reference is given after the free translation. Thus, example (3a) is taken from the text titled ‘sigo’, clauses 399 and 400.

nynä kä **n** 'kää- lä göglä nä
SP2 ASF 1S XPOT:2SO LOP prepare SP1
that I would really give you a good situation.…"' [sigo 399–400]

b. nyıkpɔ -bhlogbe yi**i'** lä soo nynä…
person one_single XFUT:1SO LOP speak SP2
'somebody said to me that…' [greve 65–66]

If a verb has two objects and both are third person pronouns, they are separated by the palatal nasal consonant *ny*, as illustrated by examples (4a) and (4b).[9] (Note that in (b) the second pronoun is the third person singular simple pronoun, non-human class 2; see table 2.3.)

(4) a. Laagɔ 'mɔ -ɔ cii nynä n **'pɔnyı** nä
God TH 3S:REL speak SP2 1S throw:3S:NHP SP1
'It was God who said that I am to give it (=the name John) to him,

ıı-zä **n** **pɔɔnyı**
CLU1 1S throw:CP:3S:NHP
that is why I gave it to him!' [elisabet 94–96]

b. 'nı ɔ **yionyɛ** 'nyɛ
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S:NH2 give
'then he gave it to him' [sigo 129]

If one of the two pronominal verb objects is a third person pronoun and the other a first or second person pronoun, both pronouns are thematic pronouns, as in example (5).[10]

(5) a po yı 'nyukwli -yä n 'k**anyımı** yı soo
2P listen now VC (ears) ADD2 1S XPOT:2PO:NHP:TH now speak
'Listen now and I shall speak to you about them [i.e. the matters to be discussed in the radio program].' [radio 19]

2.2.2 The locative pronoun **-mɔɔ**

Godié has one locative pronoun, which is *-mɔɔ* 'LOC'. It normally stands for a local noun or noun phrase, as illustrated in example (6a). The locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* may be fronted for focus, as in (6b).

(6) a. nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä 'kuŋnʊklä -kʊ **-mɔɔ**
river-DEF BE1:CP:REL LOP there SP1 ghost:old_woman BE1:CP LOC
'That river (lit. the river that was there), an old woman's ghost was in there.' [kazo 7–8]

[9]This consonant could also be analysed as the onset of a contextual variant form *nyV* of the thematic third person pronoun that occurs only in object position after a human third person pronoun. Also see the form *nyı* of the thematic marker in the first and second person thematic pronouns in table 2.3.

[10]Whether it is the first pronoun that loses its last vowel in the word *'kanyımı* or the second pronoun that loses its first vowel cannot be determined on the basis of this pronoun combination. A third person pronoun with a different vowel than *ı* would be needed here, but unfortunately it cannot be provided from our database. However, given that a third person thematic pronoun can also occur without its first syllable in certain contexts—for example, in structures with argument focus (see end of §4.1.2)—it seems more likely that *mı* constitutes the third person pronoun in this context. Third person singular thematic pronouns would then have two contextual variants: *mV* and *nyV*.

b. jiee' -zɔɔ **-mɔɔ** ʋ cie lä 'kʋ
ocean-GEN under LOC NH3 begin:ICP LOP VPC
'Down south (lit. under the ocean), that's where it (=the world) begins.' [creation 133]

The locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* may also be followed by the noun or noun phrase it stands for, as in example (7).[11]

(7) a. 'döö' -wʋ **-mɔɔ** Gbɔglɛ -kʋ
news:XNEG CNT2 LOC Sassandra BE1:CP
'There are no news there in Sassandra.' [neyo 1]

b. ɔ -kʋ yı **-mɔɔ** ɔɔ' cɔkʋʋ 'wlu [-kpazebhleku]
3S BE1:CP now LOC 3S:GEN rock:DEF on_top NUPT
'… he was now there on top of his rock.' [sigo 417]

Just as postpositional phrases and nouns with the oblique marker can appear in subject position in Godié, the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* can also function as clause subject, as in example (8).

(8) -sikaacıı ʋ ŋʋʋ- lä -blıı' [-kpazebhleku]
gold:chain NH3 put:CP LOP neck:OBL NUPT
'It is a gold chain that he (=Worm) has put round his neck,

ıı' -zä **-mɔɔ** lele lä 'mʋ [-aao]
CLU1 LOC shine:ICP LOP VPC UPT
that's why it (lit. there) is shining.' [kokoleko 8–9]

The locative pronoun also occurs as the noun complement in a genitival construction, as in example (9). A high floating tone, represented by the apostrophe, is then attached to it.

(9) a mʋ -yä a -lä **-mɔɔ**' -sikaakpätlʋweyee
2P go ADD2 2P bring LOC:GEN gold:ring
'Go and bring the golden ring that is there!' [filsprod 151–152]

2.3 Determiners

This section describes some of the Godié determiners. The definite marker and the demonstrative markers are noun suffixes and thus dependent forms. The locative adverbs are independent forms but are frequently used as determiners for spatial nouns and for that reason have been included here.

Except for the definite marker, all the determiners described in this section are deictic elements. In other words, they specify the location of a person or an object relative to the location of the speaker and hearer. A noun in its root form without any determiners has a non-specific referent in Godié. It either has generic meaning, as in example (10), or is unidentifiable.

[11]The word *-kpazebhleku* at the end of (7b) has no lexical meaning but is a feedback signal from the audience, uttered by the person chosen to represent the audience before the narrator begins with his story. It occurs after the narrator has uttered an intonational unit and/or given some relevant piece of information. It is thus an uptake element, the purpose of which is to let the narrator know that the audience is attentive and eagerly awaiting what follows. Such feedback signals are placed in square brackets in the example data. Compare *sese* in (15a) and footnote 14. The use of one or the other of these two uptake elements seems to be due to personal preference of the audience representative.

(10) a. klälebhe sıä nyıkpɔ
bush:work make_tired:ICP person
'Work in the bush is tiring (lit. makes a person tired).' [fabricated example]

b. ka sä **-mɔɔ** nʊkpʊ
ASF:NH1 take:ICP LOC feather
'…he (=Dacligo) takes a feather from him (lit. from there).' [dacligo 45]

2.3.1 Definite marker

The definite marker (DEF) in Godié is a noun suffix. Depending on the final vowel of the noun, its form varies between *-a* after the unrounded back vowel *ë,* as in *zlëa (*fish:DEF) 'the fish'; *o* after *i,* as in *ŋwadio* (male:DEF) 'the man'; or a floating tone lengthening the final vowel of the noun, as in *-bhutuu* (house:DEF) 'the house'.

The referent of a noun carrying the definite marker is established information (see introduction to chapter 4). It may be an active referent, as in example (11a), where the river is mentioned in the previous clause. Alternatively, the referent may be accessible through inference, as in (11b), where the morgue is inferable from the script since *'kwie* 'death' is mentioned at the beginning of the text. Or the referent may simply be common knowledge, as in (11c), where the reference is to a woodworker, which every vilage is expected to have.

(11) a. nyibhlë -kʊ -lɔɔ nyibhlë**a** -kʊ lä lɔɔ nä…
river BE1:CP there river:def BE1:CP LOP there SP1
'… there was a river. That river (lit. the river that was there),' [kazo 7]

b. wa wlää- -mɔɔ kubhutu**u** 'mlö
3P gather:CP LOC dead:house:DEF inside
'they gathered there in the morgue' [decesrad 13]

c. n 'kä kplikonyɔ**ɔ** 'yi 'ni
I XPOT woodworker:DEF VC (eyes) see
'I am going to see the woodworker' [cacao 42]

Certain referents are accessible without the definite marker and consequently do not occur with the definite marker. They are unique referents in the speaker's universe, such as the sun and the moon, the world, the Creator-God, the market place, as well as someone's home village, compound, or field.

In possessive constructions with the genitive marker, a difference in meaning has been observed according to whether the definite marker is absent or present on the head noun.[12] The presence of the definite marker implies that the referent is fully specified by the noun complement. If the definite marker is absent, however, only a subset of referents is specified.

Thus the referent of ɔɔ *-bhutuu* (3S-GEN/house-DEF) 'his/her house' is fully specified, and the meaning is that the person in question owns only one house. In contrast, the genitive construction ɔɔ *-bhutu* (3S-GEN/house), where the head noun lacks the definite marker, implies that only one unit from a subset of the houses the person owns is referred to. The meaning of the construction is therefore 'one of his houses'. In example (12) the definite marker thus implies that the person has only one washcloth.

[12]In associative constructions without an associative marker, this choice of meaning does not exist. However, the nouns entering into an associative construction without an associative marker are mainly kinship terms for ascending kinship relationships such as one's father, mother, grandparent, and ancestor, or for one's spouse (husband or wife). In most of these cases the referent is unique and thus identifiable without a definite marker. An associative construction like *-n nyoto* 'your husband' is fully identifiable.

(12) ɔ bhɛɛ ɔɔ kazɔɔ
3S hold:ICP 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth:DEF
'he had with him (lit. was holding) his raffia washcloth' [kazo 17]

In contrast to the genitive phrase with the definite marker in example (12), the genitive phrase may also occur without the definite marker, as in example (13), where the speaker implies that he has told just one of the set of tales he has in store.

(13) n paa- 'naa 'nünë o
1S show:CP 1S:GEN folk tale EXCL2
'There I have told one of my tales!' [dacligo 62]

2.3.2 Demonstratives

Godié has two demonstrative markers, one for referents that are close to the speaker and hearer and the other for referents that are at a distance from them.

The demonstrative marker (DEM) for close referents is the more frequent one of the two markers. It has the form of a noun clitic whose vowel agrees in number and gender with the noun it is attached to. It has the five forms *nɔ, nä, nɛ, nʊ, nɪ,* in accordance with the five noun genders in Godié. Table 2.6 compares these markers with the third person simple personal pronouns (cf. table 2.3).

Table 2.6. Godié demonstratives for close referents

Gender	Personal pronoun	Demonstrative
Human singular	ɔ	nɔ
Human plural	wa	nʊa [nwa]
Non-human singular 1	a	nä
Non-human singular 2	ɛ	nɛ
Non-human singular 3	ʊ	nʊ
Non-human plural	ɪ	nɪ

The noun with a demonstrative marker is often followed by a recapitulative relative clause (see §4.4), as in example (14).

(14) tʊ**nʊ** ɪ vë lä nä
war:DEM NHP fight:ICP LOP SP1
'This war they were fighting …' [dacligo 8]

The demonstrative marker for referents that are at some distance from both speaker and hearer is the invariable element *'yɪ,* which is glossed as 'DDEM' (for 'distant demonstrative').[13] Unlike the demonstrative marker for close referents, which is written as one word with the noun, the distant demonstrative is written as a separate element from the noun in Godié orthography, as shown in example (15a).[14] However, following the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* 'LOC' and the locative adverb *-lɔɔ* 'there',

[13]The distant demonstrative is fairly rare, possibly due to its resemblance to the temporal adverb *yɪ* 'now' (see §9.1.1), from which it differs only by its high tone.

[14]The word *sese* at the end of (15a) is an uptake element used by the audience representative when a narrator is telling a folk tale. It does not have any lexical meaning. Compare *-kpazebhleku* in (7b) and footnote 11. The use of one or the other of these two uptake elements seems to be mainly due to personal preference of the audience representative.

it is written as one word with these elements, since they lose their second vowel in the process, as shown in example (15b).

(15) a. -lɔɔ gwädä **'yı** -a -kʊ lä -lɔ**yı** nä
there kapok_tree DDEM NH1:REL BE1:CP LOP there:DDEM SP1
'… the tree over there, which is way over there,

a bhla [sese]
2P hit:NH1 NUPT
cut it down!' [sigo 223–224]

b. -n ni gɔlʊ -lıɔ -ɔ -kʊ lä -mɔ**yı** nä
2S find canoe DIM 3S:REL BE1:CP LOP LOC:DDEM SP1
'… there is a small canoe over there (lit. which is over there) …' [greve 76–77]

2.3.3 Locative adverbs

2.3.3.1 The locative adverb -lɔɔ

The locative adverb *-lɔɔ* is the default form among the locative adverbs. It can be used on its own for an unspecified though implicit location, as in example (16a), or it may be followed by the specified location in question, as in (16b).

(16) a. zëplünöö' n -kʊ lä **-lɔɔ**
morning:DEM:OBL 1S BE1:CP LOP there
'This morning I am there.' [cacao 6]

b. **-lɔɔ** 'klää' mnɛ -kʊ -mɔɔ [sese]
there forest:OBL animal BE1:CP LOC NUPT
'There in the forest there is an animal,

ɛɛ' -wʊ 'ghlü [sese]
NH2:XNEG CNT2 be_big NUPT
it is not big.' [creation 27]

The location may also have been mentioned just before, as in example (17).[15]

(17) ɔ lä ɔ wlo jlu 'kʊ nä nyıkpɔ -kʊ **-lɔɔ**
3S say 3S go_out outside SP1 person BE1:CP there
'… he wanted to go outside, then someone was there.' [devinet 81–82]

The locative adverb *-lɔɔ* is also used in a temporal sense, as illustrated in example (18).

(18) a. dä n yi lä duu'
place 1S come:ICP LOP village:OBL
'When I am coming to the village,

[15]It could therefore be argued that *-lɔɔ* functions here like a pronoun. However, it is unlikely that the speaker is referring back to the location mentioned in the preceding clause. Rather than specifying the location of the person, the speaker asserts the existence of the person outside.

-lɔɔ n 'kä lä nyıkpɔ në slä
there 1S XPOT LOP person VC (mouth) speak_to
then I may speak to someone.' [medicament 20–21]

b. **-lɔɔ'** 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ ɔ -nyoto -goo duu'
there-GEN day-DEF on 3S husband stay_overnight:CP village-OBL
'… that day her husband spent the night in the village …' [lueuzi 36]

As illustrated in example (19), *-lɔɔ* can occur as a noun complement in a genitival construction, as well as with the distant demonstrative marker *'yı*.[16]

(19) geyuënyı **-lɔɔ'** gwädä 'yı -a -kʊ lä [sese]
slave:PL:VOC there:GEN kapok_tree DDEM NH1:REL BE1:CP LOP NUPT
'Hey, slaves, the kapok tree over there, that is

-lɔyı nä a bhla
there:DDEM SP1 2P hit:NH1
way over there, cut it down!' [sigo 222–224]

2.3.3.2 The locative adverbs -lää *and* -mää

The locative adverbs *-lää* and *-mää* have deictic meaning. The place they refer to is within the speaker's and/or hearer's sight. Both can be translated 'here'. However, *-mää* seems to be the marked member of the pair in that it is used only for a location very close to the speaker ('right here') such as on his body, as in example (20a), whereas *-lää* is used elsewhere, as in (20b). Note further from these examples that in contrast to the locative adverb *-lɔɔ* and the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ*, which can occur on their own, *-lää* and *-mää* are followed by the noun specifying the place that is being referred to.

(20) a. n kʊ **-mää** 'naa kätänää'
2S BE1 here 1S-GEN back-DEM-OBL
'Sit (lit. be) right here on my back!' [kokoleko 142]

b. **-lää** duu' -a -kʊ lä
here village-OBL we BE1:CP LOP
'We are here in the village.' [sigo 15]

2.3.3.3 The locative adverbs -länömö *and* -mänömö

Unlike the adverbs *-lää* and *-mää* discussed above (see §2.3.3.2), the adverbs *-länömö* (or *-länʋmʋ*) and *-mänömö* (or *-mänʋmʋ*), glossed as 'at this place', can occur alone and can even be the head of a genitive construction, as in example (21).[17] Just as *-mää* is the marked member of the adverbs *-lää* and *-mää,* so *-mänömö* is the marked member of the adverbs *-länömö* and *-mänömö,* occurring only for a location very close to the speaker (translated 'right here').

[16]Note the threefold marking of the left-dislocated noun *gwädä* 'kapok tree' by three different expressions: the locative adverb *-lɔɔ* as noun complement, the distant demonstrative marker *'yı 'DDEM',* and the recapitulative relative clause *-a -kʊ lä -lɔyı* 'that is way over there'.

[17]Also note the two occurrences of the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* in example (21a). The first of these refers back to a referent in the preceding text, whereas the second one refers back to the referent of the point of departure ('our place here') in the second clause.

(21) a. kä -mɔɔ nää- -mä -aa **-mänömö** naa […] -nyu lä
ASF LOC be_good:CP ADD4 1P:GEN at_this_place SP1 be_bad LOP
'That place (lit. there) is good, but this place where we are […] is bad (lit. at this our place is bad).' [creation 134, 138]

b. -naa dää- -kʊ lä **-länʊmʊ** [sese]
2S:GEN place:REL BE1:CP LOP at_this_place NUPT
'It is your home that is in this place.' [sigo 174]

The locative adverbs in Godié seem to be grouped in phonological minimal pairs, with one group having an *l* as initial consonant, while the other group has an *m* in that position. All of them start out on a low tone and have a rising tone curve. Apart from the basic forms *-lɔɔ* and *-mɔɔ*, all the elements have deictic meaning. Table 2.7 shows the pairs.

Table 2.7. Godié locative adverbs and the locative pronoun

-lɔɔ 'there'	-mɔɔ 'LOC'
-lɔyɪ 'over there'	-mɔyɪ 'over there'
-lää + noun 'here'	-mää + noun 'right here'
-länömö /-länömʊ 'this place'	-mänömö /-mänömʊ 'this place right here'

*Only *-mɔɔ* is a pronoun. All the others are adverbs.

2.4 Relative clauses

This section describes relative clauses, first their linguistic forms and then their semantic types.

2.4.1 The linguistic forms of relative clauses

There are two forms of relative clauses in Godié depending on the grammatical function of the antecedent within the relative clause. If the antecedent's grammatical function in the relative clause is that of subject, as in example (22a), or that of noun complement within a nominal phrase, as in (22b), the relative marker (REL) is present. In all other cases the marker is absent. Thus in example (22c), where the antecedent is the object in the relative clause, there is no relative marker.[18]

(22) a. Jübënyëbluo -ɔ -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä
Neyo:lad:DEF 3S:REL leave:CP LOP there mouth-OBL SP1
'The Neyo lad who had escaped,

kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsɪ soo -kä
ASF:3S go:CP 3S father:PL speak PUR
he went to tell his elders …' [neyo 37.1–2]

[18]The spacer particle *nä* 'SP1' (see §7.1) marks the end of a relative clause or of a series of them.

b. wälıı -ınözä -a bhluu- lä 'kʊ nä
affair:DEF NHP:REL:GEN:reason 1P take:NH3:CP LOP VPC SP1
'The reason why we have taken it (=your fishing net) (lit. the problem because of which we have taken it) …' [neyo 11.2]

c. ʊ -zi 'gokpü -a plä bhlä -zä nä 'kʊ
NH3 outstrip:CP boat:PL 1P enter PST:LOP DP3 SP1 VPC
'…it (=the boat) outstripped the canoes we had usually taken' [greve 28–29]

The relative marker is a floating low tone. It attaches either to the personal pronoun taking up the antecedent at the beginning of the relative clause, as in examples (22a) and (22b) above, or to the antecedent itself, as in example (23). (In fact, the latter seems to be the rule if the antecedent is a pronoun, as shown in example (28) below.)

(23) a. 'nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä 'kuŋnʊklä -kʊ -mɔɔ
river:DEF:REL BE1:CP LOP there SP1 ghost:old_woman BE1 LOC
'That river (lit. the river that was there), an old woman's ghost was in there.' [kazo 7–8]

b. -anyıı- -kä lä gwɔlı tıkılıa nä
1P:REL have LOP boat:PL small:NHP:DEF SP1
'… we, who have small canoes, …' [neyo 12.6]

The definite pro-form *-lVV* 'DPF' can also be the antecedent of the relative clause, as in example (24).

(24) -mɔ -bhlogbe 'co -mɔ plöö- lä -anyıa 'yu
2S:TH one_single ID 2S:TH BE2:CP LOP 1P:GEN child
'You alone, you are our child,

-lɔɔ Laagɔ nyı-anyı lä nä
DPF God give:1PO LOP SP1
the one that God has given us.' [elisabet 102–103]

In relative clauses that have no expressed antecedent the relative marker attaches to the pronoun corresponding to the implied antecedent, as in example (25).

(25) -ɔ plöö- lä bʊkʊ -lɔɔ nä
3S:REL BE2:CP LOP yet DPF SP1
'The one (=son) who was the younger one …' [filsprod 8]

Adverbial clauses in Godié are syntactically construed as relative clauses, as in example (26), with antecedents such as *dä* 'place' (spatial or temporal); *'tɛnyı* 'time'; and *sä* 'manner'. Such adverbial clauses are mostly left-dislocated as situational points of departure (see §4.3).

(26) a. **dä** ɛ bhloo- 'nı dä wa -kʊ lä nä [sese]
place NH2 stop:CP ADD1 place 3P BE1:CP LOP SP1 NUPT
'… where it (= the ocean) ends and where they (= people) live …' [creation 47–48]

b. **dä** n yi lä duu'
place 1S come LOP village:OBL
'When I come to the village…' [medic 20]

c. -M**ä** **'tɛnyɪɪ'** ɔ pa ylä -mɔɔ -gbʊgbaa
ADD4 time 3S push:ICP now:LOP LOC bamboo_door
'Now, when he was then pushing the door

'nɪ ɔ wlʊ ylä -zɔɔ nä
ADD1 3S go_out:ICP now:LOP VPC SP1
and was about to go out…' [devinet 79–80]

d. **sä** -n 'gä lä nʊ -yä -n 'gɔ lä büda nä [sese]
way 2S XPOT LOP do ADD2 2S XPOT:3S LOP wash SP1 NUPT
'…the way you are going to proceed in order to wash him…' [lueuzi 72–73]

2.4.2 Semantic types of relative clauses

Two semantic types of relative clauses are traditionally distinguished: identifying (or restrictive) relative clauses and descriptive (or non-restrictive) relative clauses.

Identifying relative clauses give information that allows the hearer to identify a referent. This type is illustrated by all the examples in the preceding section and by example (27), where a certain group of boats is identified by the relative clause.

(27) 'gokpüü -ɪ tʊ-anyɪ bhlä nä
boat:PL NHP:REL cross:ICP:1P PST1:LOP SP1
'… the boats that used to take us across …' [greve 18]

In contrast, descriptive relative clauses give information about an already identified referent. Their antecedent is either a speech pronoun (first or second person), as in (28a), or a noun phrase with a demonstrative marker, as in (28b).[19]

(28) a. anyɪɪ- -kä lä 'jekpigwɔlɪ nä […]
2P:REL have LOP white_people:boat:PL SP1
'… you, who have boats like the white people, […]

-anyɪɪ- -kä lä gwɔlɪ tɪkɪlɪa nä …
1P:REL have LOP boat:PL small:NHP:DEF SP1
we, who have small canoes…' [neyo 12.2, 12.6]

b. -Kɔkwɛɛnɔ -ɔɔ bhɛ lä monii nii- nä …
Rooster:DEM REL:XNEG PST4 LOP money find:CP SP1
'That rooster, who had not gained any money …

[19]The demonstrative marker in (28b) has human gender. In other words, Rooster is treated like a human person and referred to accordingly. Otherwise the demonstrative marker would have to be *-nɛ* (see §2.3.2, table 2.6).

2.5 Tenses

The systems of tense, aspect, and modality (TAM) in human language are three ways of representing events in their relationship to time or, as Givón (1984:272) puts it, they are "three different points of departure in our experience of time." Although it may be convenient and indeed necessary to separate them for analytical purposes, it must be kept in mind when studying them that they are interconnected conceptual categories.

This section presents only a very sketchy view of the tense system of Godié. Its purpose is to give the reader a glimpse of the devices the Godié language provides to represent events in relation to time.

Tenses represent events as happening at a certain point in time. This is done in reference to a time axis, which is usually the moment of speaking, though other points of reference can also be taken by the speaker. In other words, tense tells us something about whether an event happened in the past or will happen in the future, or is happening right at the moment of speaking. Godié has formal features for future tense and several different past tenses. There is no present tense in Godié. Rather, an event represented by the incompletive aspect can get a present reading in the right context.

The following sub-sections present only the inherent semantic meaning of the tenses in conversation, as their discourse meaning in narrative is discussed elsewhere in the study.

2.5.1 The future tense

The future tense in Godié conversation is used for future events that will unavoidably happen; otherwise, the "potential mode" is used. From this it is clear that future tense in Godié has a modal component (see chapter 4). No distinction is made between a close and a distant future.

Future tense in Godié is marked by the verb *yi* 'come' used as an auxiliary, as shown in example (29). This is the so-called 'come-future'. Related languages, such as Wobé [wob], have a 'go-future', which uses the verb 'go' to express future tense. In this use the word is glossed as 'XFUT'. Unlike the full verb *yi,* the auxiliary *yi* (like the other auxiliaries in Godié) is not conjugated.

(29) ɔ cii- lä nynä -a yi ˈyu gä
3S speak:CP LOP SP2 1P XFUT child beget
'… he (= the angel) said that we will get a child.' [elisabet 21–22]

To talk about an event that will certainly *not* happen, the negative auxiliary ('XNEG') is used, together with the discourse particle *-lä* 'DP2', as shown in example (30).

(30) -nn -lä yɪɔ -zɪkä ˈmʊ -sää
2S:XNEG DP2 anymore today VPC be_able_to_speak
'As of today you will no longer be able to speak.' [elisabet 40]

In narrative, the future auxiliary occurs with events that were to be expected from the preceding event (see §9.1.2).

2.5.2 The past tense

Past tense in Godié is expressed by different tense particles. Their position in the clause is either after the main verb or after the auxiliary.

A past tense particle indicates that the event or state expressed by the verb has happened or existed since some time before the current temporal reference point. This reference point is the moment of speaking for some particles, but a point in the past for other particles. Events of the past are thus presented as being distant from the time of speaking.

An analysis of the Godié tense system is not attempted here. Instead, the attested tense particles will simply be listed and their basic function described.

Five different past tense particles can be distinguished in Godié narrative, as listed in table 2.8.

Table 2.8. Tense particles

Particle	Gloss
bhä	‘PST1’
a	‘PST2’
wä	‘PST3’
bhS	‘PST4’
bhɔɔ	‘PST5’

2.5.2.1 The past tense particle bhä *‘PST1’*

The most frequent tense particle in Godié is *bhä* ‘PST1’. It appears to be in the process of replacing all the other tense particles, especially in the speech of younger speakers, who have gone through school in French and are not immersed in the Godié language like older speakers.

The particle *bhä* often combines with the low-prominence particle *lä* ‘LOP’ (discussed in §4.3.2.1), which results in the form *bhlä* ‘PST1:LOP’, as shown in example (31).

(31) a. nä ʋmʊ gɔlʊnʊ ʊ pio kpänyı
SP1 NH3:TH canoe:DEM NH3 hurry:ICP much
‘So that same canoe, it was very fast

'nı ʊ -zi 'gokpüü -a plä **bhlä** -zä nä 'kʊ
ADD1 NH3 outstrip:CP boat:PL:DEF 1P enter:ICP PST1:LOP usually SP1 VPC
and it outstripped the boats we usually took.’ [greve 27–29]

b. -zëküü' 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- **bhlä** nä
adjacent_day:GEN day:DEF NH3:REL pass:CP PST1:LOP SP1
‘Now on the day of yesterday (lit. the one day from now that passed),

ʋmʊ 'kʊ nä wälıklë -bhlogbe -bhlü bhä
NH3:TH on SP matter_part one_single fall:CP PST
that day (lit. on it) something happened.’ [greve 15–17]

Note that the main clause in (31a) acts like a title for the following narrative, thus placing the whole subsequent narrative in the past. It sets the time for the subsequent events at a certain point in the past, as opposed to the preceding section which talks about the usual daily routine.

The element *bhlä* also frequently occurs with the incompletive aspect (ICP) in relative clauses (see §2.6.2). In this context, it signals a habit that existed before the time of the narrative, as in example (32).

(32) -mɔɔ 'nyiee 'klʊʊ'
LOC lagoon:DEF surface:OBL
‘There on the lagoon

'gokpüü -ı tʊ-anyı **bhlä** nä […] kı bʊä
boat:PL:DEF NHP REL:cross:ICP:1PO PST1:LOP SP1 ASF:NHP be_slow:ICP
the boats that used to take us across, […] they are really slow.’ [greve 18, 21]

In a tail-head linkage construction (discussed in §4.2.3) the element *bhlä* only occurs in the tail clause, but not in the head clause, as shown in example (33).

(33) -Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ' -za -a -mö **bhlä** -a -mö lä nä
Christmas:GEN because:of we go:CP PST1:LOP we go:CP LOP SP1
'It was because of Christmas that we had gone. When we had gone …' [neyo 2–3.1]

2.5.2.2 The past tense particle a *'PST2'*

The tense particle *a* 'PST2' instructs the hearer to locate the state or event expressed by the verb in a past stretch of time or at a specific point in time situated before the time of another state or event in the past.[20] In other words, the time axis, or reference time, for such a state or event is not the moment of speaking but another past state or event, as illustrated by example (34).

(34) a. n nä 'naa käkäwoobhü n -sä **a** nä
1S say 1S:GEN cocoa:pod:PL 1S take_away:CP PST2 SP1
'My cocoa pods that I had picked,

wa 'kä mʊ wa kä'ä klää -a 'gɪ wlä
3P XPOT go 3P XPOT help 1P XPOT:NHP break
they should go to help me break them (lit. they should go, they should help me, we would break them)…' [cacao 13–18]

b. -mä ɔmɔ nyɪkpɔɔ nä ɔ plöö- **a** nyikpa 'kädɔ
ADD4 3S:TH person:DEF SP1 3S BE2:CP PST2 person big
'Now that same man, he was an important man.

ɔ -kä **a** lɪ 'nɪ ɔ -kä **a** -gänʊnyʊä
3S have:CP PST2 thing:PL ADD1 3S have:CP PST2 slavery:do:AG:PL
He had riches and he had slaves.' [filsprod 3–6]

2.5.2.3 The past tense particle wä *'PST3'*

The past tense particle *wä* 'PST3' is used for a state of affairs that existed (or did not exist) in the distant past, or for an event that happened (or did not happen) in the distant past. It has a variant form *wɛ*, which has been found only in negative clauses, as shown in example (35).

(35) tëbhii' **wɛ** -kʊ
towel:PL:XNEG PST3 BE1:CP
'Towels didn't exist back then.' [kazo 21]

With action verbs in the incompletive aspect, *wä* is used to indicate past habitual actions, often ancient customs, as shown in example (36).

(36) a. tɛɛtɛɛ -a bäsɪ -yä -a tɪtɪä
formerly 1P father:PL ADD2 1P grandfather:PL
'In former times, our fathers and grandfathers,

[20]Marchese (1978b:63) describes it as indicating recent time in the Jluko dialect of Godié spoken in the area of the town of Dakpadou.

'kazɪɪ' wa budo **wä**
raffia_washcloth:PL:OBL 3P wash:ICP PST3
it was with raffia washcloths that they used to wash themselves.' [kazo 18–19]

b. ylɪɪ wa nʊ **wä** [sese]
torch:PL 3P make:ICP PST3 NUPT
'It was torches people used to make.' [lueuzi 40]

As already mentioned (in §2.5.2.1), in the speech of younger speakers the particle *bhä* seems to be used in contexts where *a* and *wä* are likely to be used by older speakers. This is illustrated in example (37) produced by a young-adult speaker. (Contrast (37a) with examples (34a) and (34b) produced by a middle-aged speaker; and (37b) with (36a) and (36b) produced by an older speaker.)

(37) a. ɔ plöö- **bhlä** 'släkäsänyɔ
3S BE2:CP PST1:LOP sacrifice:take:AG
'He was a priest …' [elisabet 16]

b. -bhɔɔdä nä kä 'gwɛ -yä nyɪkpɔ 'sɔ -kʊʊ **bhä** 'kʊ
beginning SP1 ASF chimpanzee ADD2 person two live_together:CP PST1 VPC
'… in the beginning the chimpanzee and man actually lived together.' [gwebhutu 12]

2.5.2.4 The past tense particle bhɛ *'PST4'*

In nominal clauses the tense particle *bhɛ* 'PST4' takes the place of the predicator particle *lä* to indicate a past state of affairs (see §4.2), as in example (38).

(38) -mɔɔ 'titi -naa 'yu **bhɛ**
2S:TH self 2S:GEN child PST4
'… it was your own child …' [lueuzi 71]

In verbal clauses, this particle is used for anterior events and states—that is, events and states that happened or existed before another event or state in the past—as in example (39). With the perfect auxiliary, it combines with the discourse particle *-zä* to express the idea of 'already', as in example (39c).

(39) a. -Kɔkwɛɛnɔ, -ɔɔ **bhɛ** lä monii nii- nä [-kpazebhleku]
Rooster:DEM 3S:NEG PST4 LOP money get:CP SP1 NUPT
'That Rooster, who had not gotten money,

'nɪ ɔ yi monie 'kʊ 'bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S XFUT money:DEF VPC take NUPT
he then took the money …' [kokoleko 173–174]

b. -zlëa -a -kʊ **bhɛ** lä -lɔɔ nä
spirit:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP PST4 LOP there SP1
'The spirit that had been there

ɔ yä yɪ -lɔɔ -zlëa -sä
3S XPER now there spirit take_away
he has now taken that spirit away from there.' [kazo 58–59]

c. -a yä 'anyı **bhɛ** soo
1P XPER 2P PST4 speak
'We had told you…' [neyo 13.1]

The particle *bhɛ* 'PST4' is also used for posterior events and states—that is, events that happened (or could have happened) and states that existed (or could have existed) after other event(s) or states in the past—as illustrated in example (40).

(40) kä -a bhobho nynä -aa' -lä **bhɛ** 'yu gä
ASF 1P think:ICP SP2 1P:GEN DP2 PST4 child beget
'… we really thought we would not get a child.' [elisabet 26–27]

Unlike the particle *bhä,* the particle *bhɛ* does not amalgamate with the low-prominence particle *lä* 'LOP', as shown by example (41).

(41) lmı n yä **bhɛ** **lä** -zä ci
NHP:TH 1S XPER PST4 LOP DP3 speak
'… "That's what I had already said."' [gwebhutu 40]

The particle *bhɛ* has the variant form *wɛ.* It seems to be phonologically conditioned, which is not surprising since phonetically the consonants [bh] and [w] are very close. The form *wɛ* has been found whenever a long vowel caused by a floating high tone precedes the particle, as illustrated in example (42).

(42) a. 'ëbhii' **wɛ** -kʊ
towel:PL:XNEG PST4 BE1:CP
'Towels didn't exist back then.' [kazo 21]

b. -n 'bä, ɔ yä'ä **wɛ** -zä -naa 'ŋnöö paa-
2S father 3S XPER:1SO PST4 DP3 2S:GEN name:DEF show:APL
'… your father, he had already told (lit. shown) me your name.' [elisabet 77]

As with the particles *wä* and *a,* younger speakers tend to replace the particle *bhɛ* with the default past particle *bhä.* Thus, in example (43), *bhä* is used by the speaker for both anterior and posterior events.

(43) ɔɔ' -lä **bhä** tee 'wlie nöö
3S:XNEG DP2 PST1 yet husband marry
'… she hadn't married a man (lit. a husband) yet.

'nı -Laagɔzuzu -sonöɔ **bhä** 'sıı
ADD1 God:spirit speak:APL:3S:CP PST1 ADD3
Then an angel from God had told her, too,

nynä ɔ yi **bhä** 'sıı 'yu gää
SP2 3S XFUT PST1 also child give_birth
saying that she would also give birth to a child.' [elisabet 54–56]

2.5.2.5 The past tense particle bhɔɔ *'PST5'*

The past particle *bhɔɔ* is limited to negative clauses, as shown in example (44). It may originally have been a morphologically complex form, consisting of the past particle *bhä* 'PST1' and the countering connective *-wʊ* 'CNT2' (see §8.2.2). In the course of time, the two elements may have amalgamated, yielding the present form *bhɔɔ* 'PST5'.

(44) a. waa' budo **bhɔɔ** 'tobhoo'
3P:XNEG wash PST5 towel:OBL
'They didn't use a towel to wash themselves.' [kazo 20]

b. -mä ɔmɔ ɔɔ -sää **bhɔɔ** lä 'mʊ nä
ADD1 3S:TH 3S:XNEG speak:ICP PST5 LOP VPC SP1
'But as for him, since he was not speaking … [elisabet 80]

2.6 Aspects

Unlike the tenses of a language, which inform the hearer primarily about the time of an event in reference to a time axis (see preceding section), the aspects of a language primarily construe an event in relation to whether it is bounded or unbounded in time.[21] A bounded event is seen as compact, that is, as a global fact, while an unbounded event is seen as ongoing in its duration in time.

All four aspects found in the other languages of the Kru language family can be distinguished in Godié. [22] These are (1) the completive or perfective aspect; (2) the incompletive or imperfective aspect; (3) the progressive aspect; and (4) the perfect aspect.

The completive and incompletive aspects are the two basic and most frequently occurring aspects in Godié, as is the case also in the other Kru languages (see Marchese 1986a:29–71 and Marchese 1989).

2.6.1 The completive aspect

The completive aspect in Godié gets a past compact reading with action verbs and a present or undefined time reading with stative verbs.[23]

The completive aspect is signalled by a floating low tone added to the verb root. It replaces the mid tone of a monosyllabic verb root, but it doesn't show with a monosyllabic low tone verb root. It spreads to the right to suffixes without an inherent tone, such as third person pronoun suffixes. Table 2.9 illustrates these changes as they are represented in the Godié practical orthography.

Table 2.9. Tone changes of Godié verb roots in the completive aspect

Verb tone	Example of verb root	Completive aspect	Completive aspect + pronoun
Mid	yi 'come'	-yi	-yiwa
Low	-kʊ 'BE1'	-kʊ	-kʊɔ
High	'su 'push'	'suu-	'suwa-
High-mid	'kwlie 'bring down'	'kwlie-	'kwlienöɔ-

[21]See Givón 1984:269ff., chapter 8: "Tense-Aspect Modality."
[22]See Marchese 1986a:29ff., chapter 2: "Basic Aspectual Categories in Kru."
[23]Marchese (1986a:30ff) therefore proposes the term *factative* for this aspectual category, a term first used by Welmers (1973:311).

2.6.2 The incompletive aspect

The incompletive aspect in Godié indicates ongoing non-terminated action, including customary and habitual actions. However, even though it may get a present reading, it should not be considered a present tense. Indeed, it can also occur with past tense markers (see §2.5.2.1 and §2.5.2.3 above).

The incompletive aspect is signalled by a floating mid tone added to the verb root. It replaces the tone of monosyllabic high and low tone roots, but it does not show with a mid tone root or with a high-mid root. It spreads to the right to suffixes without an inherent tone, such as third person pronoun suffixes. Table 2.10 illustrates these changes, as they are represented in the Godié practical orthography.

Table 2.10. Tone changes of Godié verb roots in the incompletive aspect

Verb tone	Example of verb root	Incompletive aspect	Incompletive aspect + pronoun
Mid	yi ‘come’	yi	yiwa
Low	-sä ‘take away’	sä	säwa
High	ˈsu ‘push’	su	suo
High-mid	ˈkwlie ‘bring down’	ˈkwlie	ˈkwlienöɔ

2.6.3 The progressive aspect

According to Marchese (1986a:29), “progressives are very close semantically to imperfectives in that they too express ongoing actions.” In Godié, the progressive aspect is a periphrastic construction consisting of the verb *-kʋ* ‘BE1’ (‘to be at a place’) with completive aspect followed by a locative complement. The complement consists of a compound noun whose first term is the verb of the action in progress and the second term is the noun *dä* ‘place’, as shown in example (45).[24]

(45) ɔ -kʋ paadä -aaa
3S BE1:CP run:place until
‘He was running until …’ [kokoleko 154]

Whereas progressive aspect is very frequent in English, it seems to occur rarely in Godié. Only three times does it occur in the text database for this study of almost 2,500 clauses, and, furthermore, what may be significant is the fact that all three clauses were uttered by older speakers.

2.6.4 The perfect aspect

As Givón (1984:278) points out, the perfect aspect is the most complex component of the tense-aspect-mode system in human languages, displaying “a large degree of intra-language complexity, as well as subtle but real cross-language variability.” This complexity is due to the fact that “it spans the entire functional range, from narrow scope semantics to discourse-pragmatics” (ibid.). Its various features are usually found to conflate in the perfect aspect attested in a given language (ibid., 283).

The perfect aspect in Godié is expressed by the perfect auxiliary *yä* ‘XPER’. In conversation, whether live or represented, speakers normally use it to indicate the current relevance of the past event expressed by the verb. That current relevance is often expressed in the immediate context, as in example (46).

[24]This type of construction to express the progressive aspect is universally attested in languages as different as Welsh, Quechua, Yoruba, Japanese, and even English, where the progressive also derives from a locative construction: he is hunting < he is ahunting < he is on hunting (see Marchese 1986a:67).

(46) a. -amʊ Zakalii n **yä** 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä
1S:TH Zachariah 1S XPER old_age enter SP1
'I, Zachariah, I have become old,

nn -lä yɪɔ yu gää
1S:XNEG yet anymore child beget
I can no longer beget a child,

'nɪ 'naa 'ŋnɔ yä 'sɪ 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä
ADD1 my wife XPER ADD3 old_age enter SP1
and my wife has also become old, so

-aa -lä yɪɔ 'yu gää
1P:XNEG yet anymore child beget
we will no longer have a child.' [elisabet 29–32]

b. wlä -Dacligoo lä tʊʊ **yä** yɪ bhɪä [nn]
EVD Dacligo say war:DEF XPER now be_finished UPT
'Well, then Dacligo said, "The war is now over,

nä a 'bhlü yɪ aa' -gʊgwaa 'kʊ [aa]
SP1 2P take now 2P:GEN war_fetish VPC UPT
so take back your war fetish!"' [dacligo 36–37]

The semantic meaning of the perfect aspect as an indicator of the current relevance of a past event is the basis for its discourse-pragmatic role in narrative development (see §9.2.4).

3 Order of constituents

Constituent order is of primary importance for analyzing discourse features in any language. For this reason, before beginning the study of Godié discourse proper, the topic of constituent order needs to be dealt with. After presenting the normal, or default, order of constituents in the clause in §3.1, this chapter will consider variations of that order, or marked constituent order, in §3.2, before looking at dislocated constituents in §3.3.

3.1 Default order of constituents in the clause

This section will examine the default order of constituents within the basic Godié clause types. This is necessary in order to identify any marked orders of constituents.

3.1.1 The basic clause types

The basic clause types in Godié have the following default constituent orders.

3.1.1.1 Transitive clause: S-V-O

The transitive clause has a subject, a transitive verb as the predicate, and a direct object, as shown in example (47).

(47)	-a	nʊ	lä	lebhe
	1P	do:ICP	LOP	work
	S	V		O

'… we work (lit. we do work).' [greve 11]

A number of transitive verbs are associated to a verbal particle (VPC), as in example (48), where the postposition *'kʊ* 'on' occurs as a verbal particle.[1]

(48)	n	bhlü	lä	-kosu	'kʊ
	1S	take:ICP	LOP	fire	VPC
	S	V		O	POST

'…I take fire …' [medic 11]

3.1.1.2 Semi-transitive clause: S-V-LOC.COMP

The semi-transitive clause has a subject followed by a motion verb. A small number of these verbs, such as *-bha* 'to leave somewhere' and *ghlä* 'to pass somewhere', must take a locative complement (LOC.COMP) as object, as shown in example (49a). Others, such as 'go' and 'come', may or may not take the complement, as shown respectively in examples (49b) and (49c). Note that whenever the locative complement is present, as in (49b), its object carries the oblique marker (OBL), which consists of a lengthened vowel with a high tone.

[1]For Schachter (1985:45), verbal particles are one of the two classes of "verbal adjuncts," the other one being auxiliaries. Like auxiliaries, verbal particles are a closed set of uninflected words. Some of them are postpositions and thus have locative or directional meanings. In most cases the verbal particle does not have a clearly separable semantic meaning but forms a lexical unit with the verb. Examples from English are "to pick up," "to carry out," and "to look after."

(49) a. nyɪkpɔɔ bha 'klää'
person:DEF leave:ICP field:OBL
'… the person was leaving the field …' [devinet 18]

b. n yi lä Ghliviɛlaa'
1S come:ICP LOP Riviera:OBL
'… and I come to Riviera …' [greve 10]

c. -Mä ʊ mʊ nä ʊ yi
ADD4 NH3 go:ICP SP1 NH3 come:ICP
'But it (=the canoe) goes and comes …' [greve 42]

3.1.1.3 Ditransitive clause

In a ditransitive clause, the verb calls for a direct object and a second constituent, which is either an indirect object or a locative complement. Two types of ditransitive clauses can thus be distinguished, which are here referred to as the 'give'-type and the 'put'-type. The 'give'-type has an indirect object followed by a direct object, while the latter has an object and a locative complement.

a. 'give'-type: S-V-IO-O

In the 'give' type, the indirect object typically has the semantic role of the beneficiary of the action. It always precedes the direct object, whether it is realized by a noun or by a pronoun, as shown in examples (50a–c).

(50) a. ʊ nyɪɔ gwieyi taa
NH3 give:3S palm_nut:grain:PL three
S V:IO O
'He (=God) gave him three palm nuts.' [sigo 38]

b. ɔ -zla ɔ 'nagɔ -bhlo gɔlʊ
3S ask:CP 3S friend one canoe
S V IO O
'… he asked one of his friends for a canoe.' [greve 58]

c. 'nɪ ɔ yionyɛ 'nyɛ
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S:NH2 give
S V IO O
'… he gave it to him.' [sigo 129]

b. 'put'-type: S-V-O-LOC.COMP or S-V-LOC.COMP(pron)-O

In the 'put' type, the locative complement typically has the semantic role of the goal of the action. When realized by a noun phrase, as in (51a), it follows the direct object, whereas when realized by the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* (see §2.2.2), it precedes the direct object, as in (51b).

(51) a. Fädɪnyʊä pää- waa 'pilo jiee'
Fanti_people throw:CP 3P:GEN fishing_net ocean:OBL
S V O LOC.COMP
'Fanti people had thrown their net into the ocean.' [neyo 6.3]

b. n ŋʊ -mɔɔ -nyakpɪ
1S put:ICP LOC leaf:PL
S V LOC.COMP O
'… I put leaves there …' [medic 28]

3.1.1.4 Intransitive clause: S-V

The intransitive clause has a subject followed by an intransitive verb as the predicate, as shown in example (52).

(52) ɔ tuu-
3S weep:CP
S V
'… he wept' [neyo 63.2]

3.1.1.5 Copula clause: S-COP-NCOMP

In copula clauses a subject is linked to a noun complement (NCOMP) by a copula. Copula clauses in Godié have one of four copulas. Only one of them, *-glö* 'BE3', is used exclusively in copula clauses, as in example (53). It expresses a relation of equality between the subject and the complement.

(53) ɔmɔ Pɛlɪɔ nä ɔ -glö Guduyu
3S:TH priest:DEF SP1 3S BE3 Gudu_child
'That priest, he is a member of the Gudu clan (lit. a Gudu child).' [neyo 52]

The other three copulas are intransitive verbs that can also be used as copulas. Of these, *-kv* literally means 'to be in a place or position'. It is glossed 'BE1' both in locative and in copula clauses. Its use in a copula clause is illustrated in example (54).

(54) ɪɪ -zä -n -kʊ -plɪɪ -a
NHP:GEN cause 2S BE1:CP silent Q
'Is it because of that that you keep silent?' [devinet 38]

The other two copulas are *'plö* 'to pass' and *bhlü* 'to fall', which are glossed respectively as 'BE2' and 'BE4' in their use as copulas. They are illustrated in example (55).

(55) a. ɪ plöö- gämalɪ
NHP BE2:CP play:NOM
'It is fun.' [creation 145]

b. a yi nyɪkpa gwlɪ taa bhlü
2P XFUT people twenty three BE4
'You will be sixty people.' [lueuzi 8]

3.1.1.6 Nominal clause

The nominal clause in Godié consists of a noun phrase followed by either the past tense particle *bha* 'PST4' (see §2.5.2.4 above) or the low-prominence particle *lä* 'LOP' (see §4.3.2.1 below), as in example (56a). These particles act as predicator particles and thus allow the noun phrase to function as a nominal predicate.[2] Note that a nominal predicate does not have a negative form in Godié. To express the non-existence of something, a negative copula clause with the verb *'plö* 'BE2' is used with the non-human plural pronoun as a dummy subject, as in example (56b).

(56) a. kpläkplödö lä
lie:news LOP
'It's a lie …' [lueuzi 6]

b. ɪɪ' -wʊ kpläkplödö plöö-
NHP:XNEG CNT2 lie:news BE2:CP
'That's not a lie.' (fabricated example)

3.1.2 The verb brace

If an auxiliary is present in the clause, the main verb or the copula is moved to the end of the clause, a syntactic feature common to all Kru languages.[3] The auxiliary and the main verb thus form a brace around the material included between them (marked in bold). In example (57a) the verb brace includes the countering connective *-wʊ* (see §8.2) as well as the manner adverb sisio 'quickly'. In (57b) it includes the direct object and two adverbs, and in (57c) it just includes the verbal particle *'kʊ*.[4] As for the position of the constituents within the verb brace, modal particles come first, followed by adjuncts, local complements, noun objects, and verbal particles (in that order).

(57) a. nn' **-wʊ** **sisio** -yi
1S:XNEG CNT2 quickly come:CP
'I haven't come quickly …' [devinet 40]

b. 'nn n 'kä **yɪ** **fɪa** **-ngbüna** **nünëa** 'pä
no 1S XPOT now at_first five:DEM tale:DEF throw
'No, I am now going to tell the fifth story first …' [creation 11]

c. 'nɪ ɔ yi **'kʊ** bha 'nɪ ɔ yi mʊ
ADD1 3S XFUT VPC leave ADD1 3S XFUT go
'Then he got up and went.' [devinet 22]

---

[2]For the term *predicator particle,* see, for example, Schachter 1985:55.
[3]However, Kru languages differ as to what kind of constituents can occur inside the verb brace. While some, like the three Wɛɛ varieties, allow only objects of the verb, others, like Godié, also allow adjuncts. See Marchese 1986a:218–226 for more detail.
[4]Some verbal particles are homonymous with postpositions and have locative or directional meanings, such as *'kʊ* in (57c), which means 'on' or 'upward'. In most cases the verbal particle does not have a clearly separable semantic meaning but forms a lexical unit with the verb. Examples of verbal particles in English are *up* and *out,* as in "to pick up" and "to carry out".

3.1.3 The default position of adjuncts

Adjuncts are not among the core constituents of a clause. Rather, they indicate the spatial, temporal, and other circumstances of the event talked about in the clause. In clauses without a verb brace, the default position of adjuncts in Godié is at the end of the clause, as shown in example (58).

(58) a. 'gokpüü' mʊ -wʊ -zɪkä
boat:PL:XNEG go:ICP CNT2 today
'There are no boats going today.' [greve 67]

b. -n titonöɛ -yä -n 'mëë -lɪ ɪ 'kɔɔkɔ
2S go_alongside:APL:NH2 ADD2 in spread_out thing:PL:DEF always
'… walk alongside it (=ocean) and spread out the things all the time!' [creation 49–50]

c. nä -n ni wälɪ ɪ' -lɪ ɪ -ɪ -ŋënöö lä
SP1 2S find matter:GEN DPF:PL NHP:REL arrive:APL:1SO LOP
'So these are the kind of things that happened to me

-mɔɔ -blɔ 'kʊ **zëplüünöö'** **nä**
LOC way on morning:DEM:OBL SP1
there on my way this morning.' [greve 91–92]

In clauses with a verb brace the default position of adjuncts seems to be different for noun phrases and adverbs, possibly because of word length. Noun phrases, which are usually postpositional phrases, stay in the clause-final position outside the verb brace, as in examples (59a) and (59b). Adverbial adjuncts, on the other hand, occur within the verb brace, as in (59c). This last example also shows that if there is an object, the adverbial adjunct precedes that object.

(59) a. wa 'kä zlü tää Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ' -za
3P XPOT fish:PL look_for Christmas:GEN because_of
'… in order to look for fish because of Christmas.' [neyo 5.3]

b. 'nɪ n yi lä 'nyie 'tɔɔ -zëplünöö'
ADD1 1S XFUT LOP lagoon cross morning:DEM:OBL
'… and I crossed the lagoon this morning.' [greve 85]

c. a kä lä -zɪkä 'gwɛ 'yi 'ni
2P XCND LOP today chimpanzee VPC see
'Whenever you see a chimpanzee today …' [gwebhutu 6]

3.2 Marked constituent order: Preposed constituents

The only choice for marked constituent order in Godié consists in preposing a nominal constituent. A constituent is preposed if it occupies a position earlier in the clause than in the default clause structure. Preposed constituents are frequent in Godié clauses. Indeed, any nominal constituent after the verb can be preposed.

Postposing of clause constituents (in the sense that a constituent occurs later in the clause than in the default clause structure) does not seem to exist in Godié and has not been found to occur in the data for this study. As for afterthoughts and self-corrections, which may come to mind, they will be treated as right-dislocated constituents in §3.3.2.

A preposed core constituent can be an object, as in example (60a), a locative complement, as in (60b), or a noun complement, as in (60c). (Preposed indirect objects are certainly possible but seem rare and have not been found in the corpus.) Note that the preposed noun complement in (60c) occurs in a conditional or subordinate clause.[5]

(60) a. -sikaaye ʊ ŋʊʊ- lä -blɪɪ'
gold:SNG NH3 put:CP LOP neck:OBL
'He had put something golden around his neck (lit. it was something golden that he had put around his neck).' [kokoleko 7]

b. M'Putoo' n ghlä lä
M'Puto:OBL 1S pass:ICP LOP
'I pass through *M'Puto*.' [greve 3]

c. nyɪkpa 'sɔ a kä bhä -bhlü nä
people two 2P XCND PST1 BE4 SP1
'… in case you were *two people*…' [kazo 12]

Adjuncts can be preposed in two ways. One way is to prepose them in clause-initial position. The information of the adjunct is then salient and often, but not necessarily, conveys non-established information. In this case the constituent order violates the principle of natural information flow from established to non-established information (see the introduction to chapter 4). This is shown in example (61) with adverbs, as in (61a) and (61b), and with a noun phrase, as in (61c).[6]

(61) a. **'kpokposä** ɔ 'nɪ bhɛ -nʊ
deliberately 3S XNEG:NHP PST4 do:CP
'…it wasn't *deliberately* that she had done it' [lueuzi 127]

b. Nä ɪɪ 'ŋnö 'mnö nä **-zɪkä** waa -wʊ lebhe nʊ
SP1 NHP:GEN name inside SP1 today 3P:XNEG CNT2 work do
'So, because of that, it is *today* they did not work.' [greve 48–49]

c. **-Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ'** -za -a -mö bhlä
Christmas:OBL because:of 1P go:CP PST1:LOP
'It was because of *Christmas* that we had gone.' [neyo 2]

The other way to prepose an adjunct is to move it before the object, as in (62a), and even within the verb brace, as in (62b), where the verb brace extends from the main verb *gëë-* 'light' to the verbal particle *'yi* at the end of the clause. This happens in order to observe the principle of natural information flow, according to which established information is presented before non-established information. (In examples (62a) and (62b) the context reveals that the information conveyed by the adjuncts is established information.)

(62) a. n nʊ **'kɔɔkɔ** ɔɔ lebhe
1S do always 3S:GEN work
'… and I always worked for him …' [filsprod 215]

[5]As the most salient information in a clause is marked by high pitch in English, italics reflect this fact in the free translation, rather than preposing, which has contrastive function in English.
[6]Compare example (61b) with examples (58a) and (59c) above, where *-zɪkä* 'today' occurs in final and medial position respectively. Compare also example (61c) with example (59a) above, where *Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ' -za* 'because of Christmas' is in final position.

b. wa gëë- **-mɔɔ** **-bhutuu'** -kadlükpɔ taa 'yi
3P light:CP LOC house:OBL piece_of_wood three VPC
'There in the house three pieces of wood had been lit (lit. they had lit).' [devinet 28]

3.3 Dislocated constituents

Dislocated constituents are nominal elements preceding or following a complete clause. They are therefore syntactically separated from that clause. This means that dislocation of constituents is not a clause-level process like preposing discussed in the previous section but a sentence-level process (see Keenan 1985:246).

3.3.1 Left-dislocated constituents

Left-dislocation is extremely frequent in Godié. No restrictions on the type of nominal constituents that can be left-dislocated have been found.[7]

If the left-dislocated constituent is coreferential with a core constituent of the subsequent clause—that is, a subject, object, or locative complement—it must have a pronominal trace in that clause. In example (63a) the left-dislocated constituent is coreferential with the subject of the following clause, in example (63b) with its direct object, and in (63c) with its locative complement. Quite often, the left-dislocated constituent contains a relative clause, as in example (63c).

(63) a. **waa ducifio 'titi, ɔ** lä ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ
their village:chief self 3S say 3S XPOT lagoon cross
'Their village chief himself, he said he wanted to cross the lagoon.' [greve 50–51]

b. **nyɪkpaa**, kä plɛ 'kʊ si**wa**
people:DEF ASF liver on burn:3P
'… "The people, they are really angry (lit. liver surface burns them)."' [greve 70]

c. **'nyibhlëa -kʊ lä -lɔɔ** nä kuŋnʊklä -kʊ **-mɔɔ**
river:DEF BE1:CP LOP there SP1 ghost:old_woman BE1:CP LOC
'That river (lit. the river that was there), an old woman's ghost was in there.' [kazo 7–8]

Many sentences in Godié have two left-dislocated constituents, which may be coreferential, as in examples (64a) and (64b).

(64) a. 'nɪ ɔ yi lä bʊkʊ -lɔɔ' dä 'nyɛ
ADD1 3S XFUT LOP afterwards DPF:GEN share give
'Then he gave the younger one his part.

'yikʊgä-lɔɔ ɔmɔ kɔ -kʊɔ a yëku
before:beget:DPF 3S:TH ASF:3S BE1:3S:CP PST2 beside
As for the elder one, he, he stayed with him …' [filsprod 21–22]

b. **-zëküü' 'ylʊʊ** -ʊ plöö- bhlä nä
adjacent_day:GEN day:DEF NH3:REL BE2:CP PST1:LOP SP1
'Now yesterday (lit. the one day from now that passed),

[7]Marchese (1976) calls a left-dislocated constituent the topic and the following clause the comment of a sentence. This view is not supported in this study. For the notion of topic and comment used in this study, see §4.1 and §4.1.1.

ʊmʊ	'kʊ	nä	wälɪklë	-bhlogbe	-bhlü	bhä
NH3:TH	on	SP1	matter:part	one_single	fall:CP	PST1

that day (lit. on it) something happened.' [greve 15–17]

If they are not coreferential, the first dislocated constituent has a spatial, temporal, or other circumstantial reference (with no trace in the following clause), while the second dislocated constituent is coreferential with a core constituent of the subsequent clause and a pronominal trace in that clause. This situation is illustrated in example (65). Note in this example that the first dislocated constituent has a spatial reference ('on the lagoon') while the second ('the canoes that used to transport us') is coreferential with the non-human pronoun *ɪ* 'they' in the main clause.

(65)

-mɔɔ	'nyiee	'klʊʊ'	'gokpüü	
LOC	lagoon:DEF	surface:OBL	boat:PL:DEF	

'There on the lagoon, the boats

-ɪ	tʊ-anyɪ	bhlä	nä	[…]	kɪ	bʊä
NHP:REL	cross:ICP:1PO	PST1:LOP	SP1		ASF:NHP	be_slow:ICP

that used to take us across, […] they are really slow.' [greve 18, 21]

In terms of information processing, the dislocation helps to package the information in such a way that the core structure of the clause has less linguistic material and is thus easier to process. Note that in the above example, the spacer *nä* marks the end of the relative clause and the main clause consists of only two words.

3.3.2 Right-dislocated constituents

Right-dislocated constituents are rare in Godié. The only occurrences that have been found in the data are coreferential with the clause subject. Thus they are not what Lambrecht (1994:181) calls a (right-dislocated) anti-topic, which is the only subject constituent of the clause. They either give more precise information about the subject referent, as in (66a), or express an afterthought or a self-correction, such as adding more referents to the subject referent, as in (66b).

(66) a.

'nɪ	wa	yi	yi	**'ŋwnɪä**	**-yä**	**'yuë**	
ADD1	they	XFUT	come	woman:PL	ADD2	child:PL	

'… and they came, women and children.' [elisabet 72]

b.

ɔ	-kʊ	ylä	-lɔɔ	**ɔ**	**-yä**	**ɔ**	**'ŋwnɪä**	**'sɔ**	
3S	BE1	now:LOP	there	3S	ADD2	3S	wife:PL	two	

'… he was there, he and his wives' [sigo 185]

3.3.3 Combinations of left-dislocation and preposing

Combinations of left-dislocation and preposing are very frequent in Godié, with the left-dislocated constituent(s) preceding the preposed one, as in examples (67a) and (67b). In example (67a), the subject 'that same beer' is left-dislocated and the adjective 'much' is preposed. In example (67b), the subject 'our fathers and grandfathers' is left-dislocated and *'kazɪɪ'* 'raffia washcloths' is preposed.

(67) a.

ɛmɛ	biee	nä	kpänyɪ	ɛɛ'	'kpä	'tɛ	yɪ	-pɛɛ
NH2:TH	beer	SP1	much	NH2:GEN	price	be_strong	now	hence

'… that same beer, its price is very high at present.' [radio 85]

b. tɛɛtɛɛ -a bäsı -yä -a tıtıä
formerly 1P father:PL ADD2 1P grandfather:PL
‘In former times, our fathers and grandfathers,

'kazıı' wa budo wä
raffia_washcloth:PL:OBL 3P wash:ICP PST3
it was with raffia washcloths that they used to wash themselves.’ [kazo 18–19]

Example (68) has two left-dislocated constituents (‘second ones’ and ‘their group’) and one preposed one (the locative pronoun *-mɔɔ*). The referent of the first dislocated constituent has its pronominal trace in the second left-dislocated constituent, and the preposed locative pronoun *-mɔɔ* is the pronominal trace of the second left-dislocated constituent in the clause.

(68) 'sɔna -lʋä nä waa kpaa 'mnö -mɔɔ n -kʋmʋ bhlä
second DPF:PL SP1 3P:GEN group:DEF inside LOC 1S BE1:CP:COM PST1:LOP
‘The second group (lit. the second ones, in their group), it was there that I was also …’ [greve 82–84]

4 Information management

The need for speakers to manage information arises out of several constraints that the construction and interpretation of a discourse impose on both the speaker and the hearer.[1] All speakers in any language have the same tasks in the management of information. It is only in the strategies they use to carry out these tasks that they differ according to the language they speak.

One fundamental constraint on the speaker is what Brown and Yule (1983) call the linearisation problem. Simply put, it consists "first of all in the constraint on the speaker that he can produce only one word at a time" (Brown and Yule 1983:125). A speaker who wants to produce a text therefore "has to choose a beginning point" and "this point will influence the hearer/reader's interpretation of everything that follows in the discourse" (ibid.).

After choosing the beginning point, the speaker who is about to produce a narrative text must decide on how he will bring into sequence the events he intends to talk about. In doing so he needs to take into account the inferences the hearer will draw from the sequence in which the events are presented. One of these inferences consists in assuming, unless the speaker gives a cue to do otherwise, that the first-mentioned event also happened first. Similarly, the hearer will make the assumption, again unless told otherwise, that the second-mentioned event is related to the first.

Information is not primarily processed by analysing word meanings but by constructing mental representations, or models, of entities and referents (see Brown and Yule 1983:125ff and Lambrecht 1994). It is these mental representations that are stored in the mind. As a discourse progresses, existing mental representations are activated, and possibly changed, in the hearer's mind and new mental representations are added. In order to enable the hearer to draw the desired inferences and to construct a coherent mental representation of the information he is given to process, the speaker needs to comply with the strategies for information management that are provided by the speaker and hearer's common language.

The purpose of any discourse is to give information. Most clauses in a discourse are a combination of old and new, or established and non-established, information. This guarantees a balanced information rate, where the "established information provides the grounding and the framework within which we process and store the newly asserted information" (Runge 2010:188).

Established information is information that the hearer knows and of which he has a mental representation. It includes information that was previously established in the same discourse, information that the hearer inferred from what was previously said, and information that is part of the hearer's general knowledge about the world. Non-established information, on the other hand, is information that is newly established in the clause. What is non-established information in one clause in a discourse will be established information in the following clause and so forth through the whole discourse. It is therefore crucial for the study of information management to determine for each clause the knowledge state of the information conveyed by the constituents of that clause.

One typical cross-linguistic strategy to manage established and non-established information in a text is the "principle of natural information flow" (Comrie 1989:127–128). It stipulates that speakers generally move from what is most known to their hearers to what is least known. In other words, the normal, or unmarked, way of managing information is for speakers to present established information before non-established information.

The knowledge state of information (whether it is established or non-established) needs to be distinguished from its activation state, which concerns its consciousness in the hearer's mind or the availability of a given piece of information at a given time. Indeed, while huge amounts of knowledge are stored in a person's mind, only a very small portion of this knowledge can be focused on at any one time and is therefore available, or active, in the person's consciousness.

On the basis of this fact, Chafe (1987:22ff) distinguishes between three different activation states, or degrees of accessibility of information in the hearer's consciousness at a given time and in a given

[1]These observations also apply to the writer and the reader but for the sake of simplicity we will refer only to the speaker and the hearer.

context: active, semi-active, and inactive. Active information is information that is "currently lit up" in the hearer's consciousness. Inactive information is information that is in the person's long-term memory and not active. At the time the utterance is processed, inactive information either has not been activated at all yet in the course of the discourse or, if it was activated earlier on in the discourse, it has been de-activated and fallen out of a person's consciousness. Finally, semi-active information is information that automatically enters the hearer's consciousness together with other information, because it is associated to that information in the hearer's mind. This last category is therefore also referred to as coactivated or accessible information.

Finally, from the speaker's point of view, not all information given to the hearer is of equal importance or weight in the narrative. Indeed, in order to enable the hearer to construct for himself the mental representation of the narrative that the speaker intends, the speaker gives him cues about which information has more weight than other information. As Carozzi (2010:246) rightly states, "Writers (and speakers) have more than one strategy at their disposal to enable the audience to appreciate the relative weight of information in the discourse they are producing, and in fact they may manipulate a variety of linguistic items to this end." Like probably all languages, Godié has linguistic means to show that some entities (events, participants, etc.) have more relative importance than others at the current point in the narrative (see §s 4.1.2 and 4.3.1 below). However, as will be shown in §4.3.2, a Godié speaker also has means to let the hearer know which information is of lesser importance at the current point in the narrative.

Information management in language has mostly been studied at the clause level and is often referred to as information structure. Chafe (1976) referred to it as "information packaging" and Prince (1981:224) as "the tailoring of an utterance by a sender to meet the particular assumed needs of the intended hearer" (also see Marchese 1976). For Lambrecht (1994:1) information structure is "concerned with the relationship between linguistic form and the mental states of speakers and hearers."

Information management in this study deals with the management of established versus non-established information and of gaps in the progress of narrative discourse, as well as with different degrees of prominence of the presented information. Specifically, this chapter looks at the strategies that Godié employs for information management. First, it describes these strategies at the clause level, distinguishing various focus structures or discourse-pragmatic articulations (§4.1). Then it looks beyond the clause level, describing different types of points of departure (§4.2). Following that, it deals with the management of prominence at the clause level and beyond, describing devices for highlighting and backgrounding information (§4.3) and, finally, it considers information management in relative clauses (§4.4).

4.1 Information structure of the clause

Widely used terminology for information structure at the clause level includes the terms topic, comment, and focus. Some remarks about these terms are therefore in order. Lambrecht (1994:127f) distinguishes between the topic and the topic expression. The former is a referent, that is, a cognitive entity, while the latter is the linguistic form referring to that entity. Note that Comrie (1989:64) does not make this distinction in his "classical" definition of topic as "what the sentence is about." This distinction is nevertheless an important one because it is possible for a clause to be about a certain referent without any linguistic expression referring to that referent in the clause. Lambrecht states:

> A referent is interpreted as the topic of a proposition if in a given situation the proposition is construed as being *about this referent,* i.e., as expressing information which is relevant to and which increases the addressee's knowledge of this referent (Lambrecht 1994:131; emphasis mine).

According to Lambrecht, the topic of a clause must be an accessible referent. This is one that either has already been established in the text or is readily associable with an established referent. He further argues in his topic acceptability scale that active referents are the best candidates for propositional topic because they require only a "low cost" cognitive processing effort (ibid., 165). Across languages, the preferred topic expression to refer to an active referent is a pronoun.

The topic of a clause is frequently expressed in the grammatical subject of the clause. However, the notions of topic and grammatical subject must remain distinct for "topics are not necessarily grammatical subjects, and grammatical subjects are not necessarily topics" (ibid., 118).

The information given about the topic referent is called the comment. However, in many cases, not all information in the comment is of equal importance to the speaker. Rather, the speaker will intend one part of that information—generally the new, or non-established, information—to be more salient. According to the principle of natural information flow (see the introduction to this chapter), the expected place of this information within the clause will be towards the end of the comment, after the established information has been presented.

As for the term *focus,* Lambrecht understands it as "the semantic component of a pragmatically structured proposition whereby the assertion differs from the presupposition" (1994:213). In other words, focus is what is left of a pragmatic proposition once the presupposed information is taken away. Put even more simply, focal information will typically be newly established information.

In analogy to the distinction between topic and topic expression, Lambrecht distinguishes between focus as a semantico-pragmatic category and focus domain as the linguistic expression of the focal information. There are different types of focus structures, depending on which component of the semantic proposition is asserted and which thus carries the relatively most important (that is, the focal or salient) information. This leads to the distinction of three pragmatic clause types on the basis of their focus structure.[2]

The first type of clausal information structure has predicate focus. It corresponds to what is commonly called a topic-comment structure. The second type has argument focus, meaning that the focal information is carried by an argument of the verb.[3] The third type does not have any presupposed information, which means that all information that is expressed is asserted and thus focal information. A clause expressing only asserted information may be said to have global focus.[4]

It is important to note that focus cannot be conflated with new, or non-established, information, any more than presupposition can be with old information. According to Dooley and Levinsohn (2001:62), the focus of a clause is the information that "the speaker intends as the most important … change to be made in the hearer's mental representation." Even though the focal domain of a structure often expresses non-established information while the presupposed material often refers to old information, one must distinguish the pragmatic function of the focus from its pragmatic properties. The function of the focus is to identify the most salient piece of information in the clause while the properties of the focus refer to its knowledge state (established versus non-established), its degree of accessibility, or its activation state (active, semi-active, non-active).

4.1.1 Clauses with predicate focus

Clauses with predicate focus—also known as topic-comment structures—answer questions such as "What did X do?" or "What happened to X?". In Godié, X must be an established and active referent. Typically it is the grammatical subject of the clause. The default topic expression is the simple anaphoric pronoun. This is illustrated by example (69), where the referent, after having been activated in the first clause, is then referred to by the simple pronoun in the second clause.

---

[2]Lambrecht's three types of focus structure correlate with what Andrews (1985:77ff) calls the three pragmatic articulations, namely presentational articulation, topic-comment articulation, and identificational articulation, or focus-presupposition. The articulation of information in a sentence is the way in which semantic content, that is, information, is presented in it.

[3]For Lambrecht this includes information expressed by adjunct phrases. Indeed, if such phrases express focal information, they are promoted to argument status within the semantic proposition. See Egner 2005 for a description of this mechanism in Kru languages.

[4]Lambrecht talks about sentence focus here. However, given that sentence is a grammatical unit beyond the clause, the term sentence focus will not be used here.

(69) ŋwadi mʊ ylä ɔ bhɛɛ ɔɔ 'kazɔɔ
lad go:ICP now:LOP 3S hold:ICP 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth:DEF
'… a lad was coming along, he was holding his raffia washcloth.' [kazo 16–17]

If a referent was not mentioned in the previous clause, it is considered as being no longer active. It must then be reactivated through a left-dislocated noun phrase (see §3.3.1) before anything can be said about it. In example (70), even all of the previously established information about the referent is recapitulated before more information is given about it.

(70) 'Kuŋnʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ nyibhlëa 'mʊ
ghost_old_woman:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP now:LOP LOC river:DEF OBL
'The old woman's ghost that was there in the river

'nɪ -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä
ADD1 NH1:REL BE2:CP now:LOP LOC:GEN spirit:DEF SP1
and that was its spirit (lit. the spirit of there),

a yä 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü
NH1 XPER raffia_washcloth:DEF VPC take
it has taken the raffia washcloth.' [kazo 29–31]

The same requirement holds for semi-active referents, that is, referents that can be established through inference, as in example (71). Here the referent for "village chief" can be inferred because the boatmen are villagers and hence have a village-chief.

(71) waa ducifio 'titi ɔ lä ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ
3P:GEN village:chief self 3S say 3S XPOT lagoon cross
'Their village chief, he said he wanted to cross the lagoon' [greve 50–51]

It appears that the Godié language imposes a rather strong constraint on the speaker as to the choice of a clause topic. In terms of an instruction for topic choice the constraint can be formulated as follows:

- Only choose an active referent as clause topic.

It follows from this constraint that previously introduced referents that are no longer active must be reactivated before they can function as clause topic. This is achieved by means of a left-dislocated noun phrase. Thus the following additional instructional can be formulated:

- In order to reactivate a referent that is no longer active, use a left-dislocated noun phrase.

4.1.2 Clauses with argument focus

In clauses with argument focus one of the nominal constituents expresses the most important information, that is, the information by which the speaker intends to make a change in the hearer's mental representation. For Lambrecht (1994:122) these structures serve "to identify a referent as the missing argument in an open proposition." Hence he uses the term *identificational* referent.[5] In Godié, the nominal constituent expressing the focal information is always preposed. Two types of clauses with argument focus can be distinguished: those in which non-established information is in focus and those in which established information is in focus.

[5]Andrews (1985:79) talks about such structures as having focus-presupposition articulation.

Type 1: Non-established information in focus

In the first type, the information in focus is non-established information. Example (72) illustrates the preposing of different clause constituents: the direct object (72a), the locative complement (72b), the instrumental adjunct (72c), and the noun complement (72d).

(72) a. **'nünü -ŋgbü** n zɛɛ bhlä
tale:PL five 1S recount PST1:LOP
'… I was going to tell *five tales*.' [creation 5]

b. n kä Kumasii' -bha nä
1S XCND Kumasi:OBL leave:CP SP1
'When I have left Kumasi,

'nɪ n kä yi nä **M'Putoo'** n ghlä lä
ADD1 1S XCND come SP1 M'Puto:OBL 1S pass LOP
and when I come (here), I pass through *M'Puto*.' [greve 1–3]

c. tɛɛtɛɛ -a bäsɪ -yä a tɪtɪä
formerly 1P father:PL ADD2 1P grandfather:PL
'In former times, our fathers and grandfathers,

'kazɪɪ' wa budo wä
raffia_washcloth:PL:OBL 3P wash:ICP PST3
they used to wash themselves with *raffia washcloths*.' [kazo 18–19]

d. **nyɪkpa 'sɔ** a kä bhä -bhlü nä
people two 2P XCND PST1 BE4:CP SP1
'… in case you were *two people* …' [kazo 12–13]

If the constituent in focus is the clause subject, it is followed by the low tone relative pronoun corresponding to the referent's gender and number, as illustrated in example (73). The relative pronoun thus acts as a spacer between the syntactic constituent expressing the focal information and the rest of the clause expressing the presupposed information. The role of spacers is to separate information pertaining to different syntactic or pragmatic levels (see §8.2).

(73) **Jübëyëkpü 'sɔɔ-** -mʊ lä jie 'klʊʊ'
Neyo_people two:REL go:CP LOP ocean surface:OBL
'… it was two Neyo that went out (to fish) in the ocean.' [neyo 5.1]

Type 2: Established information in focus

In the second clause type with argument focus, the focal information is established information and expressed by a thematic pronoun (see §2.2.1). It stands for an active referent (see §4.1.1), which may have been mentioned in the preceding clause, as is the case with the focal information expressed by the thematic pronoun at the beginning of the third and fourth clauses of example (74a). Or the active referent may have been mentioned in an immediately preceding left-dislocated noun phrase, as in example (74b) and (74c).[6]

[6]Example (74a) incidentally illustrates the interplay of all three focus types in the introduction of a major participant. The first clause has global focus, the second has predicate focus, and the last two have argument focus, one with the object preposed and the other with the subject preposed. It seems unusual that the name of a referent is

(74) a. -lɔɔ 'klää' mnɛ -kʊ -mɔɔ Ɛɛ' -wʊ 'ghlü
there forest:OBL animal BE1 LOC NH2:XNEG CNT2 be_big
'There in the forest, there is an animal. It is not big.

ɛmɛ wa la 'Nɛmʊ[7]
NH2:TH 3P call Red_Deer
It is called Red Deer (lit. her they call Red Deer).

ɛmɛɛ- -mʊ lä -a 'Bä yëku
NH2:TH:REL go:CP LOP 1P Father beside
She was the one who went to our Father …' [creation 27–30]

b. ɔ lä 'naa 'kazɔɔ **ʊmʊ** n budo 'mʊ
3S say 1S:GEN raffia_washcloth:DEF NH3:TH 1S wash:ICP OBL
'He said, "My raffia washcloth, *that's what* I wash with …"' [kazo 35]

c. -n kä gää [sese] […] 'ŋnɔɔ **'mɔ** wa 'kä lä
you XCND beget NUPT female:DEF 3S:TH 3P XPOT LOP
'If you have children, […] it is the *girl* that they will

wlie 'nyɛ ıyä -n 'gä lä ŋwadio 'kʊ 'bhlü
husband:DEF give ADD2 2S XPOT LOP male VPC take
marry off (lit. give a husband) and you will *keep* (lit. take) the boy.' [siamoi 6, 11–12]

If the pronoun is the subject of the clause, as in the last clause of (74a) above, the low tone relative pronoun that is added to it is often reduced to a floating low tone (cf. example (73) above). The initial vowel of the thematic pronoun tends to be dropped when the left-dislocated noun phrase ends in the same vowel as that of the pronoun, as is the case in (74c), where the pronoun *ɔmɔ* is reduced to *'mɔ* following *'ŋnɔɔ* 'the female'.

Unlike the first clause type with non-established information in focus, the type with established information in focus conveys contrastive meaning. It is also the structure used in the first clause of a sequence of two clauses expressing a double contrast, as in (74c), where the two constituents 'girl' and 'marry off' in the first clause are in contrast to 'boy' and 'keep' in the second clause. Note that the latter clause has the pragmatic structure of predicate focus.

4.1.3 Clauses with global focus

Clauses with global focus express only non-established information. They typically introduce a new entity into the discourse, affirming or negating its existence, but without saying anything further about it. The new entity can be a participant that is brought on stage or a whole event in which all entities are new. Four subtypes of global focus structures can be distinguished in Godié on the basis of their linguistic form: (1) a nominal clause; (2) the verb *-k*ʊ 'BE1' followed by a dummy locative complement; (3) an imperative clause with *ni* 'find'; and (4) an event-reporting clause.

---

introduced contrastively. However, it does make sense to say that referent X (and not a different referent) is called Y.

[7] *'Nɛmʊ* is the vernacular name for a small species of mazama deer, probably *mazama rufina.*

Type 1: Nominal clause

The first type of global focus structure is expressed by a nominal clause. It consists of a noun phrase and a predicator element that allows the nominal phrase to function as a nominal predicate (see §3.1.1). The predicator element can be realized either by the low prominence particle *lä* 'LOP', as in example (75a), or by the past tense particles *bhɛ* 'PST4', as in (75b), or *wä* 'PST3, as in (75c). Note in (75c) that the past particle *wä* may amalgamate with the low prominence particle *lä,* yielding the form *wlä.* In the same example, *wɛ* seems to be a variant form of *wä* in negative clauses (see §2.5.2).

(75) a. kpläkplödö **lä**
lie:news LOP
'It's a lie …' [lueuzi 6]

b. ɔ 'nagɔ **bhɛ**
3S friend PST4
'He was her friend …' [devinet 30]

c. -dʋdʋʋ' wɛ -kʋ -mä jie -bhlobhlo w**lä**
earth:XNEG PST3 BE1 ADD4 ocean one_ only PST3:LOP
'… there was no firm ground, but only the ocean existed.' [creation 18–19]

In order to affirm the non-existence of a referent, a negative verbal clause with the intransitive verb *-kʋ* 'BE1' is used, as shown in the first clause of (75c) and in example (76).[8]

(76) tëbhii' wɛ -kʋ
towel:PL:XNEG PST3 BE1:CP
'Towels didn't exist back then.' [kazo 21]

Type 2: -kʋ *'BE1' and dummy locative complement*

The second type of global focus structures contains the intransitive verb *-kʋ* 'BE1' and the locative adverb *-lɔɔ* 'there' acting as a dummy locative complement, as in (77a) and (77b).

(77) a. 'nyibhlë' **-kʋ** **-lɔɔ**
river BE1:CP there
'There was a river.' [kazo 6]

b. nyɪkpaa' -wʋ **-lɔɔ** 'nyie yëku **-kʋ**
people:DEF:XNEG CNT2 there lagoon beside BE1:CP
'… the (usual) people were not around on the shore of the lagoon,

-mä bhlooblo 'lʋä **-kʋ** **-lɔɔ**
ADD4 a_few IPF:PL BE1:CP there
though a few were around.' [greve 64–65]

[8]Other Kru languages use a negative predicator particle to affirm the non-existence of a referent, such as the particle *ko-* in Wobé (see Egner 1989:150).

Type 3: Imperative clause with ni *'find'*

The third subtype of global focus structures is a set imperative clause with the verb *ni* 'find'. In conversation it is used to present someone or something to someone, as in example (78). If the person or object is presented to one person, second singular pronouns are used, as in (78a); if the person or object is presented to more than one person, second plural pronouns areused, as in (78b).

(78) a. -n ni -naa dä
2S find 2S:GEN share
'Here is your (*sg.*) share!' [fabricated example]

b. a 'ni anyɪn dä
2P find 2P:TH:GEN share
'Here is your (*pl*) share!' [fabricated example]

Type 4: Event-reporting clause

The fourth type of global focus structures is the so-called event-reporting clause (see Lambrecht 1994:137ff.). In Godié such a clause is syntactically constructed in subject-predicate form but at the pragmatic level, it is a global focus structure. This type of clause—which answers the question "What happened?"—is a structure with a non-topical subject. Typically, it occurs with certain verbs of movement (such as *come* and *go*) and takes incompletive aspect. It is used to bring participants on stage, as is the case in example (79). (See also §5.1.1.)

(79) zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ nä ŋwadi mʊ ylä
today:GEN day:DEF on SP1 lad go:ICP now:LOP
'Now one day (lit. on the day of today) a lad was coming along …' [kazo 15–17]

4.2 Points of departure

Points of departure (hereafter PoDs) may be left-dislocated noun phrases (discussed in §3.3.1 above). They may also be preposed temporal or locative adverbs or subordinate clauses.[9] A PoD's basic, or default, function in information management is to establish "an explicit frame of reference, providing the reader with the primary basis for connecting what follows with what precedes" (Runge 2010:194). The need for an explicit frame of reference naturally arises at transition points within the narrative, when the narrative shifts from one point in time to another, from one place to another, or from one participant to another. At these points, the hearer needs what Dooley and Levinsohn (2001:68) call "a contextual anchor" for the information presented in the subsequent clause. The information conveyed by a PoD is thus not brand new, or unidentifiable, information for the hearer. Rather, it is information that is either active or accessible from the context.[10]

[9]Subordinate clauses have sometimes been called topics, as by Marchese (1976). However, this terminology is incompatible with the notion of topic adopted in this study, which is what Comrie (1989) and Lambrecht (1994) describe in terms of "aboutness". Indeed, a sentence introduced by a temporal clause is not "about" the time of the event. Rather, such a clause sets the time frame for the event.

[10]The term *brand new information* was introduced by Prince (1981) in an atttempt to establish a taxonomy of information types on a scale from given to new. As Lambrecht (1994:105) points out, this term has to do with the identifiability of a referent, that is, the existence or non-existence of its mental representation in the mind of the hearer. Accessiblity, on the other hand, has to do with the activation status of information already stored in the mind. Such information can be active (if it is used in the immediate context); inactive (if it has not yet been used in the current discourse); semi-active; or accessible.

Transitions in discourse, termed discontinuities by Dooley and Levinsohn (2001), can be classified with respect to three textual dimensions: (1) situation (such as time and space); (2) referents (participants and props); and (3) type of action (speech versus non-speech; event versus non-event).

Of these, the third type (type of action) has not been found to occur in Godié. Thus only two main types of PoDs may be distinguished for Godié, namely situational PoDs (including temporal, spatial, and causal PoDs) and referential PoDs, referring to participants. While participants are the agents in the narrative and thus normally animate, props are mostly inanimate objects.

Another function of PoDs has to do with information processing. When established and complex information is left-dislocated and then referred to in the clause with a pronoun, the amount of linguistic material within the clause is reduced and thus easier for the hearer to process. Examples (80a) and (80b) below illustrate this function of a PoD. In both cases, the main clause (bolded) is very short, consisting of two and three words respectively.

(80) a. -mɔɔ 'nyiee 'klʊʊ' 'gokpüü
LOC lagoon:DEF surface:OBL bateau:PL:DEF
'There on the lagoon, the canoes

-ɩ tʊ-anyɩ bhlä nä […] **kɩ** **bʋä**
NHP:REL cross:ICP–1PO PST1:LOP SP1 ASF:NHP be_slow:ICP
that used to take us across … they are really slow.' [greve 18, 21]

b. 'sɔna -lʋä nä waa kpaa 'mnö
second DPF:PL SP1 3P:GEN group:DEF inside
''The second group (lit. the second ones, in their group),

-mɔɔ **n** **-kʋmʊ** **bhlä**
LOC 1S BE1:COM:CP PST1:LOP
it was there that I was also …' [greve 82–84]

Another advantage of packaging the information in this way is that it allows the speaker to give the old information before the new information, which is in accordance with the principle of natural information flow.

In certain cases the spacer *nä* 'SP1' is inserted between the PoD and the subsequent clause, as in example (81) (see also example (80a) above). Spacers will be discussed in chapter 7. For the spacer *nä,* see §7.1.

(81) zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ nä ŋwadi mʊ ylä
today:GEN day:DEF on SP1 lad go:ICP now:LOP
'Now one day (lit. on the day of today) a lad was coming along …' [kazo 15–16]

4.2.1 Situational points of departure

The default use of situational PoDs is to set a new temporal, spatial, or other frame of reference. A situational PoD can be an adverb, as in example (82a); a temporal clause, as in (82b); or a postpositional phrase, as in (82c). Note that the temporal PoD in (82b) is a noun phrase with a relative clause that has the noun *dä* 'place' as an antecedent and ends with the spacer *nä.*

(82) a. 'kɔɔkɔ sɔɔ ɔ nʊ ylä
always thus she do now:LOP
'All the time, that's how she now acted.' [siamoi 52]

b. dä Jübëyua 'ylıbhä ylä waa gɔlʊʊ nä
when Neyo:child:PL:DEF return:ICP now:LOP 3P:GEN canoe:DEF SP1
'When the Neyo children were turning round their canoe,

kʊ bhuo-
ASF:NH3 turn_over:CP
it turned over.' [neyo 19.1–2]

c. 'sɔna -lʊä nä waa kpaa 'mnö
second DPF:PL SP1 3P:GEN group:DEF inside
'The second group (lit. the second ones, in their group),

-mɔɔ n -kʊmʊ bhlä
LOC 1S BE1:COM:CP PST1:LOP
it was there that I was also.' [greve 82–84]

If the left-dislocated constituents in example (82) were in their normal place after the verb, as shown in example (83), the information structure of the clause would not follow the principle of natural information flow, since established information (namely, that there were two groups of people) would be placed at the end of the clause instead of being given first.

(83) n -kʊmʊ bhlä 'sɔna lʊää' kpaa 'mnö
1S BE1:CP:COM PST1:LOP second DPF:GEN group:DEF inside
'I was also in the group of the second ones.' [fabricated example]

4.2.2 Referential points of departure

The default function of a referential PoD is to introduce a participant as the new frame of reference for the information given in the following clause or clauses. In example (84a) the referential PoD introduces a brand new referent, "a certain man"; in (84b) it reactivates a de-activated referent, "the canoe"; and in (84c) it activates a semi-active referent, "their village chief himself." In all three cases, the referent thus becomes a candidate for playing the pragmatic role of topic.

(84) a. nyıkpɔ -bhlogbe ɔ -nʊ sää ɔɔ gɔlʊlɛɛ
person one_single 3S make:CP DP1 3S:GEN canoe:DIM:DEF
'… a certain man, he took his small canoe

'nı ɔ ŋʊɔ- masii
ADD1 3S put:NH3:CP motor
and he put a motor on it.' [greve 25–26]

b. gɔlʊʊ 'nı ɔ yiu yı pıa
canoe:DEF ADD1 3S XFUT:NH3 now pull_ashore
'The canoe, he now pulled it ashore…' [kazo 32]

c. waa ducifio 'titi ɔ lä ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ
3P:GEN village:chief:DEF self 3S say 3S XPOT lagoon cross
'Their village chief himself, he said he wanted to cross the lagoon.' [greve 50–51]

Example (85) has three referential PoDs: *nyëbluo* ‘the young lad’, ɔ *'nɔ* ‘his mother’, and *Mali* ‘Mary’, the second and third ones being coreferential. The repetition of the referent has the effect of highlighting that referent.

(85) 'nɪ nyëbluo wa laa lä Zozi nä
ADD1 lad:DEF 3P call LOP Jesus SP1
‘Then the young boy they called Jesus,

ɔ 'nɔ Mali ɔmɔ -mä Laagɔzuzu yio bhlä
3S mother Mary 3S:TH ADD4 God_spirit XFUT:3SO PST1:LOP
his mother Mary, on her an angel from God

'sɪɪ -mɔɔ 'kʊ kwlii 'nɪ ʊ yio soo
also LOC VPC come_down ADD1 NH3 XFUT:3SO speak
also came down there and spoke to her.’ [elisabet 48–51]

4.2.3 Tail-head linkage

Tail-head linkage is an important cohesive device within a text. It consists of the repetition of the information of the last clause (the tail) of one sentence at the beginning (the head) of the following sentence. The tail clause is a clausal form of the situational point of departure (see §4.2.1 above). The two clauses are separated either by the spacer *nä* ‘SP1’ added to the end of the tail clause or by the additive connective *'nɪ* ‘ADD1’ at the beginning of the head clause. This is represented in table 4.1.

Table 4.1. Tail-head linkage

Sentence 1	Sentence 2
tail clause + *nä*	head clause
tail clause	*'nɪ* + head clause

The two structures are illustrated in example (86a) and (86b) respectively.[11] The spacer *nä* is further discussed in §7.1 and the additive connective in §8.1.

(86) a. Goplë yie lü [sese]
Gopleu XFUT:NH2 eat NUPT
‘… and Gopleu ate it (= the palm nut).

Ɔ -lü ylä gwieyee nä ɔ lä
3S eat:CP now:LOP palm_nut:grain:DEF SP1 3S say
When he had now eaten the palm nut, he said …’ [sigo 73–75]

b. ‘nɪ n ŋëë lä M'Puto n kä yɪ M'Puto -ŋëë
ADD1 1S arrive:ICP LOP M'Puto 1S XCND now M'Puto arrive:CP
‘Then I arrive in M’Puto. When I have arrived in M’Puto,

'nɪ n bhlü lä 'wlɔwlɔ 'kʊ 'nɪ n yi lä Ghliviɛlaa'
ADD1 1S take:ICP LOP five_five VPC ADD1 1S come:ICP LOP Riviera:OBL
I take a pickup taxi and I come to Riviera …’ [greve 7–8]

[11]In (86b) the word *'wlɔwlɔ* is taken from the trade language Jula [dyula], where it means ‘25CFA’, the price for a taxi ride.

The frequency and function of tail-head constructions vary according to the type of discourse sequence. In descriptive sequences, describing places or actions, such as an itinerary or a procedure, tail-head linkage serves to link together the different stages of the description, as illustrated in example (86b) above. In narrative sequences, besides its function in managing transitions, tail-head linkage is also found as a highlighting device for events or participants (see §4.3.1.3 below).

4.3 Managing prominence: Highlighting and backgrounding

Highlighting and backgrounding are part of an author's strategies of information management at the clause level and beyond. Indeed, just as the pieces of information within a clause or a sentence are not all of equal prominence, in the same way the clauses within the sentences of a text have varying degrees of prominence.

Highlighting consists of giving additional prominence to a piece of information, while backgrounding decreases the prominence of a piece of information. In a narrative, events that take the narrative forward to its climax and dénouement are by nature more important for the narrative than background information. They are commonly referred to as theme line or foreground information. In contrast, background information consists mostly of so-called non-events, such as comments, explanations or evaluative statements, but it can also provide information about previous or secondary events. This kind of information provides background for the hearer, helping the hearer to better understand the events on the theme line of the narrative. Certain types of background information, such as comments and explanations, also reveal something about the relationship between the speaker and the hearer.

Besides information that is inherently of a background nature, a continuous backgrounding process takes place as the narrative, or any discourse for that matter, moves forward. The device of tail-head linkage (see §4.2.3 above) is linguistic evidence of this process: the information that is theme line information in one sentence is taken up as backgrounded information at the beginning of the next sentence. Cognitively speaking, it is as new material comes into view that older material loses its importance and becomes background information.

The following sections will consider the more frequent highlighting and backgrounding devices in Godié narrative.

4.3.1 Highlighting devices

Devices for highlighting are means of allowing the author to give special prominence to information. One purpose of highlighting certain pieces of information rather than others in a narrative is to attract the hearer's special attention to that information because he will need to keep it in mind for what follows. Another purpose is rhetorical, perhaps to make the narrative more lively and dramatic. In other words, by choosing to highlight certain pieces of background information, the author alerts the hearer to the fact that this information is of special importance for the unfolding of the narrative plot.

In Godié the same devices are used for highlighting background information and theme line information.[12] The following sections will discuss five highlighting devices in Godié. For others see §5.2.2.2, §6.2, and chapter 9.

[12]Giving special prominence to background information could also be referred to as foregrounding and distinguished from highlighting, which is a device to give additional prominence to foreground information. However, this distinction is not necessary in Godié, where the same devices are used to increase the prominence of both background and theme-line information.

4.3.1.1 The assertive focus particle kä *'ASF'*

The assertive focus particle *kä* 'ASF'[13]occurs in declarative utterances with predicate focus (see §4.1.1 above). It strengthens the statement made by the speaker. Its position is at the beginning of the clause.

In conversation, the speaker uses the particle *kä* to strengthen his statement regarding a state or an action that are relevant at the time of the conversation, as in example (87).[14]

(87) **kä** nyämʊ loo- lä 'kʊ [sese]
ASF breath satiate:2SO:CP LOP VPC NUPT
'… you really *are* out of breath (lit. breath has satiated you),

nä n 'kää- fää [sese]
SP1 1S XPOT:2SO accompany NUPT
so I will accompany you.' [creation 101–102]

In narrative, the narrator uses the particle *kä* to highlight information that is particularly relevant for the course of the narrative. Such information can be event information, as in example (88) or background information, as in example (89).

(88) a. Jübënyëbluo -ɔ -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä
Neyo:lad:DEF 3S:REL leave:CP LOP there mouth:OBL SP1
'The Neyo lad who had escaped,

kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsɪ soo -kä
ASF:3S go:CP 3S father:PL speak PUR
he went to tell his elders …' [neyo 37.1–2]

In example (89) the information highlighted by the particle *kä* turns out to be important for the unfortunate event that will be told in the narrative, so the narrator must make sure the hearer will keep it in mind.[15]

(89) -kaflɪnɪɛ ɔɔ' 'ŋwnɪa 'sɔ -kä 'yuë 'sɔ
Excuse me! 3S:GEN woman:PL:DEF two have:CP child:PL two
'Excuse me! His two wives had two children.

[sese] **kä** wa këpë lä [sese]
NUPT ASF HP crawl:ICP LOP NUPT
They were at the age of crawling …' [lueuzi 21–22]

In many cases, the clause introduced by *kä* in a narrative is preceded by one or several points of departure, which left-dislocate nominal constituents from the clause. These constituents are then referred to by a simple pronoun in the clause, so that the action expressed there is all the more highlighted.

---

[13]Marchese (1978:67f) gives a list of the syntactic contexts of what she names the "current relevance marker." In discourse, she sees its special function in "drawing attention to the speed of action in a narrative" (ibid., 72). See also her practical grammar (Marchese 1986b:179) for a discussion of this particle.

[14]Also, after a visitor has signalled his presence at the door, a speaker coming to the door will say *Kä n yi* 'I'm **coming**'.

[15]Note that the expression *-Kaflɪnɪɛ!* in this example is used before talking about something that is considered as negative, such as some bad news. It is also used when one arrives at a meeting and interrupts in order to greet the people.

Examples (90a) and (90b) illustrate this. (Note from these examples and also (88) above that the particle *kä* often coalesces with the subject pronoun, losing its vowel in the process.)

(90) a. -mɔɔ 'nyiee 'klʊʊ' 'gokpüü
LOC lagoon:DEF surface:OBL boat:PL:DEF
'There on the lagoon the boats

-ɪ tʊ-anyɪ bhlä nä […] **kɪ** bʊä
NHP:REL cross:ICP:1PO PST1:LOP SP1 ASF:NHP be_slow:ICP
that used to take us across […] they are really slow.' [greve 18, 21]

b. -lɔɔ' 'sɔnä lɔɔ -mä dä ɔ nii- lä
there:GEN second "one" ADD4 when 3S see:CP LOP
'That second one, when he saw

nʊnʊgbɪ 'yi nä **kɔ** 'fike
do:do:affair:PL VC (eyes) SP1 ASF:3S act_smartly
what was going on, he really acted smartly

-mä 'nɪ ɔ mɛɛ- gɔlʊʊ -zɔɔ
ADD4 ADD1 3S dive:CP canoe:DEF under
because he then dived under the canoe.' [neyo 24.1–3]

4.3.1.2 Ideophones

Ideophones, also named expressives, convey sensory perceptions in relation to a specific action or state, like English hippety-hoppety 'in a limping and hobbling manner'.[16] Their sound structure does not necessarily comply with the phonological rules of a language. They are characterized by "their sound symbolic character, displaying likeness or other non-arbitrary relations between form and meaning" (Tufvesson (2007:53).

Ideophones are a common highlighting device for events in narrative. Key actions, as in (91a) and (91b), or the climax, as in (91c), are frequently marked in this way. As the semantics of Godié ideophones has not been studied, they are invariably glossed as 'ID' in the examples and not translated in the free translation.

(91) a. **gblikisi** gɔlʊ yä bhuo
ID canoe XPER overturn
'The canoe overturns (lit. has overturned).'
[kazo 24–25]

b. **kokloko** 'ŋnʊkla yi 'kʊ ji
ID old_woman:DEF XFUT VPC appear
'The old woman appeared.' [kazo 54]

c. **wuë** -sʊmabolu yä -zɔɔ bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ID Worm XPER (VPC) fall_down NUPT
'Worm falls down!' [kokoleko 157]

[16]Ideophones are marked words that depict sensory events. There are ideophones for visual, auditory, olfactory, gustatory, and haptic perceptions. This example is taken from Dingemanse 2010:24.

4.3.1.3 Tail-head linkage

Another way of highlighting information in a narrative is by tail-head linkage (discussed in §4.2.3 above). The repetition of the information that has been established in the preceding clause (the tail) allows the speaker to delay the new information for a little longer, thereby highlighting the new information. The information of the preceding clause can be repeated in clausal form, as in example (92a), or by way of a nominal point of departure containing a relative clause, as in (92b). The highlighted information in the following clause can be a key event of the narrative, as in (92a), or a key participant, as in (92b).[17]

(92) a. ɔ nyima lä monie ɔ 'bä nyiɔ- lä nä
3S waste:ICP LOP money:DEF 3S father give:3S:CP LOP SP1
'… he was wasting the money his father had given him.

-mä ɔ -nyima monie -aan
ADD4 3S waste:CP money:DEF until
Now he wasted the money until

' nɪ monie, ɛ yio 'mʊ -bhɪa
ADD1 money:DEF NH2 XFUT:3S VPC go_away
the money, it was gone…' [filsprod 33–37]

b. 'nyibhlë -kʊ -lɔɔ
river BE1:CP there
'There was a river.

'nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä 'kuŋnʊklä -kʊ -mɔɔ
river:DEF:REL BE1:CP LOP there SP1 ghost_old_woman BE1:CP LOC
In the river that was there, an old woman's ghost was in there.' [kazo 6–8]

4.3.1.4 Marked points of departure

As explained in §4.2 above, the default function of points of departure is to provide an explicit frame of reference at points of discontinuity in the narrative. However, instead of introducing a new frame of reference, some left-dislocated noun phrases are found to explicitly renew the existing frame. These noun phrases may be considered marked PoDs. Their pragmatic function is to highlight the information that follows.

Example (93) is taken from the introductory section of the narrative in question. It illustrates the marked use of a referential frame, highlighting key information about the participants.

(93) nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe ɔmɔ wa laa lä 'Lulu
person one_single 3S:TH they call LOP Lulu
'There was a certain man called (lit. it is him they call) Lulu.

ɔmɔ -ɔ -gää lä ɔɔ ŋnʊgbɛnyʊä 'sɔ [ɔmɔ -ɔ -gää lä ɔ'ɔ ŋlʊgbɛnyʊä 'sɔ]
3S:TH 3S:REL beget:CP LOP 3S:GEN girl:PL two
He (lit. it was he who) had two girls (lit. procreated his two girls).

[17]In (92a), note the change from incompletive aspect (ICP) in the tail clause to completive aspect (CP) in the head clause.

-mä ŋnʊgbɛnyʊänä 'sɔ ɔ -gää lä naa
ADD4 girl:PL:DEM two 3S beget:CP LOP SP1
Now these two girls that he had,

kä wa 'mɛmɛ
ASF 3P be_stuck_together
they were stuck to each other.' [siamoi 13–16]

In example (94) the very elaborate PoD recapitulates in two relative clauses all the information given so far about a participant. It occurs just before the clause expressing the major complication of the plot caused by that very participant.

(94) 'kuŋnʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ 'nyibhlëa 'mʊ
ghost_old_woman:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP now:LOP LOC river:DEF OBL
'The old woman's ghost that was there in the river

'nɪ -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä
ADD1 NH1:REL BE2:CP now:LOP LOC:GEN spirit:DEF SP1
and that was its spirit (lit. the spirit of there),

a yä 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü
NH1 XPER washcloth:DEF VPC take
it has taken the raffia washcloth.' [kazo 29–31]

4.3.1.5 Clauses and set expressions

The imperative clause *-n ni* ('2S/find') 'Find!' occurs as a highlighting device in narrative. At the discourse-pragmatic level, it functions as a clause with global focus (see §4.1.3 above). It brings on stage something or someone unexpected at a key point in the narrative, as illustrated in example (95) (also see §9.2.5). In this function the clause is a set phrase and is used only with the second person singular. As these examples further illustrate, the clause is preceded by another set clause showing the participant(s) as being about to realize a new fact. That clause is introduced by the assertive focus particle *kä* 'ASF' (discussed in §4.3.1.1 above).

(95) a. wlä **kä wa wlo yɪ** nä [-kpazebhleku]
EVD ASF 3P look:ICP now SP1 NUPT
'Then all of a sudden (lit. as they are now looking)

-n ni 'nyikpotütë [-kpazebhleku]
2S find black_ants:swarm NUPT
there was/is a swarm of black ants (lit. find a swarm of black ants)!' [kokoleko 126–127]

b. du ɔ yä 'yuo 'bhlä [sese] ɔ lä
ID 3S XPER child:DEF kill NUPT 3S say
'She kills (lit. has killed) her child!

kɔ wlo yɪ -n ni yɪ ɔɔ' 'yu mɔ [sese)
ASF:3S look:ICP now 2S find now 3S:GEN child TH NUPT
As she was now looking, there is her child!' [lueuzi 53–55]

4.3.2 Backgrounding devices

In contrast to highlighting devices, devices for backgrounding are means of allowing an author to give *lower* prominence to information that would normally qualify for being foreground information. The purpose of backgrounding certain pieces of information in a narrative is to let the hearer know that those pieces of information are not—or are no longer—the most relevant pieces of information. The hearer is thus instructed to look for the currently relevant information and is helped in keeping abreast of the progress of the story towards its goal.

This section will discuss the following three backgrounding devices in Godié narrative: the low-prominence particle *lä* 'LOP'; the past tense particles *bhlä* 'PST1:LOP' and *wä* 'PST3'; and the progressive aspect. (For the backgrounding function of the spacer *nä*, see §7.1.)

4.3.2.1 The particle lä

The particle *lä* is pervasive in all genres of Godié discourse. The vast majority of its occurrences is in verbal clauses, though it also occurs in nominal utterances, where it acts as a predicator particle (see §4.1.3 above).

This section will discuss first the types of clauses where the particle is normally present, as well as those contexts where it is normally absent. Then it will consider contexts where the author has a choice whether to use the particle or not, as well as contexts where the author can override the normal use. It is from these two types of context that a hypothesis for the meaning of *lä* can be formulated as an instruction for the use of the particle in discourse.

Table 4.2 compares the types of clauses where the particle *lä* is normally present with those where it is normally absent.

Table 4.2. Clause types with and without the particle *lä*

Normally present in…	Normally absent in…
• relative clauses • adverbial clauses • the tail clause of tail-head linkage structures (see §4.2.3 and §4.3.1.3) • clauses with argument focus (see §4.1.2)	• imperative clauses • interrogative clauses • negative clauses • clauses containing ideophones (see §4.3.1.2) • exclamatory clauses • completive clauses

1. Clauses where lä *is normally present*

The hypothesis for the function of *lä* argued for here arises from the following observation. As shown in table 4.2, *lä* normally occurs in clauses where the event talked about appears to have relatively less prominence than some other information at the current point in the discourse. On the other hand, in contexts where the presence of the particle is due to the narrator's choice, the information given in the clause constitutes the contextual frame for some other information that has currently more prominence relative to the author's purpose.

This is illustrated in example (96), where the first clause, which contains *lä*, talks about the Chimpanzee's climbing on the roof. This event is not background information of itself; rather, it is *backgrounded* in this context as a secondary event relative to the following primary event, for which it constitutes the contextual frame. Indeed, undoing the fastening of the main beam of the house is the more prominent event at this point in the story but this event presupposes the Chimpanzee's climbing on the roof. Note also the presence of the spacer *nä* 'SP1' (see §7.1) at the end of the first clause,

underlining the lower prominence of the information in the first clause, as well as the presence of the assertive focus particle *kä* 'ASF' at the beginning of the second clause, reinforcing the prominence of the information in that clause (see §4.3.1.1).

(96) ɛ gblää- **lä** -bhutupapɪɪ nä
NH2 climb_up:CP LOP house:wall:PL SP1
'Having climbed up the walls of the house

kɛ döö- -bhutugbäglöyee' 'kpɔ
AF:NH2 cut:CP house:beam:GEN fastening
he (=the chimpanzee) actually cut the fastening of the beam.' [gwebhutu 27–28]

A clause containing *lä* thus contains information with lower prominence relative to some other, more prominent information in the context. If this information has not yet been given, the hearer awaits it shortly. As an instruction to the hearer, the particle *lä* in verbal utterances appears to mean the following: attribute lower prominence to the information given in the clause containing *lä* and wait for information in the context that has higher prominence at the current point in the discourse.

The presence of *lä* in relative clauses, adverbial clauses, and linkage clauses can be considered as an instance of grammaticalization where the particle has become part of the syntax of these structures. However, the presence of *lä* in these contexts is also perfectly compatible with the hypothesis of *lä* indicating lower prominence. Relative clauses must contain established information (see §4.4 below), which is recapitulated at certain points in the discourse and thus has lower prominence. The same is true for adverbial clauses, which are syntacically construed like relative clauses in Godié (see §2.4). In the case of linkage clauses, they repeat the information established in the previous clause (see §4.2.3 and §4.3.1.3 above) and thus have lower prominence than the event to be talked about next. It is thus not surprising that they normally contain the particle *lä*. Example (97) illustrates a linkage clause repeating the information given earlier.[18]

(97) Jübëyëkpü 'sɔɔ- -mʊ lä jie 'klʊʊ' […]
Neyo_people two:REL go:CP LOP ocean surface:OBL
'… two Neyo went out (to fish) in the ocean. […]

wlä wa -mʊ **lä** nä
EVD 3P go:CP LOP SP1
'It is reported that as they (=the two Neyo men) went,

Fädɪnyʊä pää- waa 'pilo jiee'
Fanti:people throw:CP 3P:GEN fishing_net ocean:OBL
Fanti people had thrown their net into the ocean.

wa niu- **lä** 'yi nä
3P see:NH3:CP LOP VC (eyes) SP1
When they (=the two Neyo men) saw it,

kwa -sʊʊ 'nyiee'
ASF:3P take_away:NH3 water:OBL
they took it out of the water.' [neyo 5.1, 6.1.–6.4]

[18]The occurrence of *lä* in the earlier clause is due to the information structure with argument focus, here with the focal information expressed by the clause subject (see §4.1.2). In this particular example, the structure with argument focus is used to bring the first participants on stage (see §5.1.3).

In structures with argument focus (see §4.1.2), as in the first clause of example (97) above, a nominal constituent expresses the focal information, while the rest of the clause is out of focus, that is, it has a lower degree of prominence. However, the particle *lä* can be absent in clauses with argument focus that give the name of a person, as in example (98). Such structures have a double coreferential object, the first of which is a preposed thematic pronoun, while the second at the end of the clause is the proper noun giving the name. Obviously, that name is the purpose of the clause and cannot be said to have low prominence.

(98) a. ɔmɔ wa la Albɛlö Bayi Taglɔ
3S:TH 3P name:ICP Albert Bayi Tagro
'He (lit. it is him that) is called Albert Bailly Tagro.' [decesrad 20]

b. ɛmɛ wa la 'Nɛmʊ [sese]
NH2:TH 3P name:ICP Red_Deer NUPT
'It (lit. it is it that) is called Red Deer.' [creation 29]

Interestingly, the particle *lä* is absent in these structures only if the name given is that of the protagonist, as is the case in examples (98a) and (98b) above. On the other hand, the particle is present if the person whose name is given is a minor character in the narrative, as in example (99).

(99) nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe ɔmɔ wa la **lä** 'Lulu
person one_single 3S:TH 3P say LOP Lulu
'There was a certain man called (lit. it is him they call) Lulu.' [siamoi 13]

In example (100) the particle *lä* is also absent. It is the last clause of the text, so there is no reason for the speaker to show it as less prominent in relation to other information that precedes or follows.

(100) -lɔɔ n bhloo -bhlɛ
there 1S stop:ICP for_now
'It is there that I stop for now.' [elisabeth 110]

2. Clauses where lä *is normally absent*

In the clause types where *lä* is normally absent, the information given is naturally prominent: imperative clauses, interrogative clauses, negative clauses, clauses containing ideophones, exclamatory clauses, and completive clauses (see table 4.1 above). However, examples (98) and (100) above, where *lä* is absent in syntactic structures that normally have it and which therefore look at first sight like exceptions, are cases in point that show that the presence of *lä* does not ultimately depend on a syntactic structure, but rather on the pragmatic factor of prominent information. That factor overrides syntax in certain cases, such as these examples.

Another case in point is example (101) below, where the particle *lä* does appear in a negative clause. From the context, however, it is obvious that the negative clause here has lower prominence than the following clause, for which it forms the contextual frame. Indeed, in this case the negative clause with *lä* is the background information which explains why Worm arrives slowly in the village.

(101) ʊmʊ -mä ʊʊ' pio **lä** nä
NH3:TH ADD4 NH3:XNEG hurry LOP SP1
'As for him (= Worm), he wasn't fast,

dɪgasä 'nɪ ʊ yi ŋë [-kpazebhleku]
slowly ADD1 NH3 XFUT arrive NUPT
it was slowly that he arrived.' [kokoleko 36–37]

4.3.2.2 Past-tense particles

The past-tense particles *bhä* 'PST1', *a* 'PST2', and *wä* 'PST3' (see §2.5.2) are also used for backgrounding events. The particle *bhä* frequently combines with the particle *lä* (see §4.3.2.1 above), losing its vowel in the process to yield the amalgamated form *bhlä* 'PST1:LOP'.

In combination with the completive aspect ('CP') of an action verb, the particle *bhlä* signals a flashback, that is, an event that happened before the time of the theme line events of the narrative, as illustrated in example (102).[19] Such events are naturally part of the background of a story.

(102) -Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ' -za -a -mö bhlä
Christmas:GEN because_of we go:CP PST1:LOP
'It was because of Christmas that we had gone.' [neyo 2]

With the completive aspect of a stative verb, *bhlä* signals a state of affairs as background to an event on the theme line, as in example (103).[20]

(103) 'sɔna -lʊä nä waa' 'kpaa 'mnö
second DPF SP1 3P:GEN group:DEF inside
'The second group (lit. the second ones, in their group),

-mɔɔ n -kʊmʊ **bhlä**
LOC 1S BE1:COM:CP PST1:LOP
it was there that I was also

'nɪ n yi lä 'nyie 'tɔɔ -zëplünöö'
ADD1 1S XFUT LOP lagoon cross morning:DEM:OBL
and I crossed the lagoon this morning.' [greve 82–85]

The past tense particle *wä,* which is normally used for background states (see §2.6.2), is also used as a backgrounding device for events on the theme line. It marks such events as being secondary in relation to a subsequent primary event.[21] This happens before an important turn in the narrative, as in example (104). Note that the two verbs with which the past tense marker *wä* occurs in this example are in the incompletive aspect, which has the effect of slowing down the action and increasing the suspense.

(104) wlä 'ŋnɔnɔ yi **wä** a [sese]
EVD woman:DEM come:ICP PST3 DP4 NUPT
'And that woman was coming

'nɪ ɔ ŋʊ **wä** 'yunɔ sä a [sese]
ADD1 3S put:ICP PST3 child:DEM VPC DP4 NUPT
and she was putting that child down.

zeli yä yɪ ze [sese]
daylight XPER now light_up NUPT
When day broke the next morning …' [lueuzi 68–70]

---

[19]The particles *bhä* and *bhlä* are thus the converse of the particles *yɪ* and *ylä* 'now', which signal that the narrative is moving forward (see §9.2).

[20]Interestingly enough, in an edited version of the text, the author and transcriber simplified the structure of this sentence as follows, taking out the material in brackets: *'Sɔna lvä (nä, waa' 'kpaa) 'mnö, -mɔɔ n -kʊmʊ bhlä.* The revised sentence thus has only one point of departure instead of two as in the original spoken version.

[21]Given that the inherent meaning of the past tense particle *wä* seems to be distant past, the pragmatic effect of this use could be seen as an iconic way of distinguishing a secondary event from a primary event in the narrative.

The tense particle *a* ‘PST2’, which is otherwise used for events or states previous to another past state or event (see §2.5.2), has also been found to be used for backgrounding minor events before a major event. In example (105) the backgrounded minor event is the meeting of the people at the morgue, whereas the major event is taking the deceased person to burial.

(105) wa wlää- **a** -mɔɔ 'wlu 'nɪ wa -kʊ a -lɔɔ
3P meet_together:CP PST2 LOC VC (head) ADD1 3P BE1:CP PST2 there
‘They met together there and they were there (in the morgue)

'nɪ wa yio -kä wä -mɔɔ -sä a
ADD1 3P XFUT CLU3 PST3 LOC take_away DP4
and so they took him out of there, then.’ [decesrad 15–17]

Note the presence of the discourse particle *a* ‘DP4’ in both examples (104) and (105). In fact these are the only occurrences of the particle in the whole data corpus for this study, so it seems that it is rather rare, which is why it hasn’t been discussed in a separate section. It is interesting, however, that in both examples, the particle occurs with events that are backgrounded in view of an upcoming, major event. Moreover, the events in question are expected events, as shown in example (104) by the presence of a *yi* clause, which is used for such events (see §9.1.2).

4.3.2.3 The progressive aspect

The progressive aspect is at present only rarely used in Godié narrative. In fact, in the narratives on which this study is based only the two instances in example (106) have been found, both of them in narratives produced by older speakers. The progressive aspect zooms in as it were on the action as a process, thus slowing the story down and increasing suspense. As it turns out, a major complication of the story comes up right away.

(106) a. ɔ lä, 'nɔɔ 'yua 'sɔ **-kʊ** **gämadä** nä [sese]
3S say my_friend child:PL:DEF two BE1:CP play:place SP1 NUPT
‘He said, “My friend, as the two children were playing together,

'naa -lɔɔ yä -naa 'yuo 'bhlä [sese]
1S:GEN DPF XPER 2S:GEN child:DEF kill NUPT
my child (lit. mine) killed your child.”’ [sigo 317–318]

b. ɔ **-kʊ** **paadä** -aaa
3S BE1:ICP run:place until
‘He (=Rooster) was running until

ɔ mʊ 'nyikpotütëa' nëëdë ŋë -kää nä [-kpazebhleku]
3S go black_ants:swarm:DEF:GEN middle arrive PUR SP1 NUPT
he arrived in the middle of the swarm of black ants

'nɪ ɔ yii gbɔtɔ
ADD1 3S XFUT:NHP shake
then he shook them (=his wings).’ [kokoleko 154–155]

4.4 Information management in relative clauses

In Godié the semantic distinction between identifying and descriptive relative clauses (see §2.4.2) appears to be of little relevance from a discourse-pragmatic point of view. Rather, both semantic types of

relative clauses have the same pragmatic function in Godié, namely to recapitulate information already given earlier about their antecedents.[22] The term *recapitulative relative clause* is therefore suggested as a more appropriate term.

The recapitulative relative clause in Godié narrative frequently occurs within a marked point of departure (see §4.3.1.4).[23] This type of PoD does not bridge some gap in the narrative, nor does it remind the hearer of already established information that he now needs for a better understanding. Rather, it slows down the narrative, thus building up suspense and eventually giving more prominence either to the event that is about to happen or to the new participant that is about to come on stage. In other words, PoDs with relative clauses play a special discourse-pragmatic role in the area of highlighting.

Recapitulative relative clauses sometimes have little semantic meaning, as illustrated by example (107). In (107a) the relative clause merely recapitulates the existence of the river introduced in the preceding clause while in (107b) the relative clause recapitulates the fact that the spirit lived in the river.

(107) a. 'nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä 'kuŋnʊklä -kʊ -mɔɔ
river:DEF:REL BE1:CP LOP there SP1 ghost_old_woman BE1 LOC
'That river (lit. the river that was there), an old woman's ghost was in there.' [kazo 7–8]

b. 'kuŋnʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ nyibhlëa 'mʊ
ghost_old_woman:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP now:LOP LOC river:DEF OBL
'The old woman's ghost that was there in the river

'nɪ -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä
ADD1 NH1:REL BE2:CP now:LOP LOC:GEN spirit:DEF SP1
and that was its spirit (lit. the spirit of there),

a yä 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü
NH1 XPER raffia_washcloth:DEF VPC take
it has taken the raffia washcloth.' [kazo 29–31]

In the tracking of an activated participant by way of a full noun phrase (see §5.2.2.1), a relative clause recapitulates significant information about the participant, thereby alerting the hearer that a significant event will happen next or that the climax of the narrative is imminent. Thus the relative clause in example (108) is not necessary to identify the referent unambiguously; rather, its presence indicates to the hearer that a key action will follow.

(108) Jübënyëbluo -ɔ -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä
Neyo:lad:DEF 3S:REL leave:CP LOP there mouth:OBL SP1
'The Neyo lad who had escaped,

kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsɪ soo -kä
ASF:3S go:CP 3S father:PL speak PUR
he went to tell his elders …' [neyo 37.1–2]

[22]This is a more widely spread characteristic of relative clauses in African languages. Pope (1993) points out that relative clauses in the Waama [wwa] language of Benin show discourse-pragmatic restrictions. Levinsohn (1997) makes the same observation for African languages in general. Pope further claims that descriptive relative clauses are not natural in Waama. Translated as such from French into Waama, they are likely to cause misunderstandings. She further observes that in folk tales identifying relative clauses are fairly infrequent.
[23]See Marchese 1976 and 1987 for a first description of this phenomenon in Godié.

5 Participant reference

Participant reference in narrative, or in any discourse for that matter, is concerned with the linguistic means by which participants—characters and inanimate objects—are brought on stage and then tracked in a text. It is of crucial importance that the hearer knows at every point in the text who or what is being talked about. Otherwise the hearer will not be able to follow what the speaker is saying or will have difficulty in making sense of it. The way in which languages manage participant reference in a text depends on various factors, some of which are (more or less) universal, while others are specific to a language family or even a single language.

This chapter consists of two major sections. Section 5.1 deals with the introduction of participants in a Godié narrative. Section 5.2 describes how participants, once introduced, are tracked in a narrative.

5.1 Introduction of participants

Two relevant pragmatic factors determine the linguistic form in which a participant is introduced into a Godié narrative. The first factor is whether or not the hearer already has a representation of the participant in his mind. If he does, the participant is identifiable for him; if he does not, it is brand new (see Lambrecht 1994:105ff). The second factor is the role the narrator attributes to that participant in the story. This role can be minor or major, local or global. A participant with a major global role is generally the protagonist, or one of the protagonists, of the story.

5.1.1 The introduction of brand new participants

To bring brand new participants on stage, the narrator uses generic nouns, such as *nyɪkpɔ* 'human person', *'ŋnɔ* 'woman', and *mnɛ* 'animal'.

(109) wlä **nyɪkpɔ** ɔmɔɔ-[1] nöö- lä ɔɔ ŋwnɪä 'sɔ
EVD person 3S:TH:REL marry:CP LOP 3S:GEN woman:PL two
'They say a man had (married) two wives.' [lueuzi 20–21]

The noun *nyɪkpɔ* 'person' introduces only male participants. Example (109) above is taken from a narrative where even though the women are the major characters in the story, they are introduced in relation to their husband.[2] More frequently than just the generic noun *nyɪkpɔ* 'human person', the noun phrase *nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe* 'a certain person' is found to bring a brand new participant on stage, as in example (110).[3]

(110) 'nɪ **nyɪkpɔ** **-bhlogbe** yii' lä soo nynä
ADD1 person one_single XFUT:1SO LOP speak SP2
'Then somebody said to me …' [greve 65–66]

The participant's relative importance in the subsequent narrative is reflected in the amount and the type of linguistic material used to bring that participant on stage. In terms of amount, more linguistic material means greater importance, illustrating Givón's principle of iconicity. In terms of linguistic type, the information structure (see §4.1.1) of the clause in which the participant is introduced appears to give a cue as to the role of the particpant in the story.

[1]The presence of the thematic pronoun here is due to the fact that the participant is the first to be brought on stage (see §5.1.3).
[2]It appears that female participants are preferably introduced in relation to a man, that is, as daughters, wives, etc. An exception to this rule seems to be old women, who can be introduced in their own right.
[3]For the use of the future auxiliary in narrative found in this example, see §9.1.2.

1. Clause with predicate focus

A clause with predicate focus is used to introduce a brand new participant with only a local minor role in the narrative, as in example (110) above.

2. PoD followed by a clause with predicate focus

A point of departure, followed by a clause with predicate focus is used to introduce a brand new participant playing a local key role in the narrative, as in example (111).

(111) **nyɪkpɔ** **-bhlogbe** ɔ -nʊ sää ɔɔ gɔlʊlɛɛ
person one_single 3S make:CP DP1 3S:GEN canoe:DIM:DEF
'… a certain man, he took (lit. made) his small canoe …' [greve 25]

3. PoD followed by a clause with global focus

A point of departure followed by a clause with global focus is used to introduce a brand new participant who will be the protagonist, as in examples (112a) and (112b).

(112) a. -lɔɔ 'klää' **mnɛ** **-kʊ** **-mɔɔ** ɛɛ' -wʊ ghlü
there forest:OBL animal BE1:CP LOC NH2:XNEG CNT2 be_big
'There in the forest, there is an animal. It is not big.' [creation 27–28]

b. 'nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä **'kuŋnʊklä** **-kʊ** **-mɔɔ**
river:DEF:REL BE1:CP LOP there SP1 ghost_old_woman BE1 LOC
'That river (lit. the river that was there), an old woman's ghost was in there.

amä plöö- lä 'nyibhlëa 'mnö -zlëë
NH1:TH BE2:CP LOP river:DEF inside spirit
She (lit. it was her who) was the river spirit.' [kazo 7–8]

4. An event-reporting clause

An event-reporting clause—that is, a clause with grammatical subject-predicate structure and a pragmatic global focus structure (see §4.1.3)—is also typically used to bring a brand new major participant on stage, as in example (113). The verb of the clause is then generally some verb of movement, such as *go, come, appear,* or *pass*. The incompletive aspect of the verb seems to be characteristic of the event-reporting clause in this particular function.

(113) -zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ nä **ŋwadi** **mʊ** **ylä**
today:GEN day:DEF on SP1 lad go:ICP now:LOP
'Now one day (lit. on the day of today) a lad was coming along,

ɔ bhɛɛ ɔɔ kazɔ
3S hold:ICP 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth
he had with him (lit. was holding) his raffia washcloth.' [kazo 15–17]

5.1.2 The introduction of identifiable participants

If the narrator assumes that the hearer already has a mental representation of the participant, this participant is considered an identifiable referent for the hearer. Similarly to the introduction of brand

new participants (see §5.1.1), the information structure of the clause in which identifiable referents are introduced gives the hearer a cue as to their role in the narrative as either the major participant (the protagonist) or a minor particpant with a local role.

5.1.2.1 The introduction of identifiable major participants

Identifiable major participants, especially if they are referred to by a proper name, are brought on stage by a clause with global focus of the event-reporting type, preceded by a point of departure. (This structure is also one of the structures used to introduce a brand new participant, as shown in the preceding section.) Compare the first clause of the sentence in example (114) with example (113) above to that effect.

(114) -zɪkä **Goplë** plö -aaa 'nɪ a yi -mɔɔ jinëëdë mʊ
today Gopleu pass:ICP until ADD1 NH1 XFUT LOC sea:middle go
'One day, Gopleu was flying until he (lit. it) came to the middle of the sea.' [sigo 43–44]

5.1.2.2 Introducing identifiable minor participants

Identifiable minor participants are brought on stage in a clause with predicate focus. As for the noun phrase that introduces them, the following structures have been found to occur:

5. Simple indefinite noun phrase

An identifiable minor participant, especially an inanimate one, is introduced with a simple indefinite noun phrase, as shown with "things" and "slaves" in example (115).

(115) ɔ -kä a **lɪ** 'nɪ ɔ -kä a **-gänʊnyʊä**
3S have PST2 thing:PL ADD1 3S have PST2 slavery_do:AF:PL
'He had riches and he had slaves.' [filsprod 5–6]

6. Definite noun phrase

If the identifiable minor participant is accessible through other information—whether given earlier in the narrative, through inference, or through encyclopedic knowledge—it is introduced with a definite noun phrase, sometimes also accompanied by a relative clause, as in (116c).

(116) a. **dunyʊa** lä ɔ
village_people:DEF say EXCL2
'The village people said, "Oh! …"' [lueuzi 64]

b. ɔɔ' -wʊ -bʊä -mä kɔ -mö komisäliaa'
3S:XNEG CNT2 be_slow:CP ADD4 ASF:3S go:CP police_station:OBL
'he wasn't slow (to act) but went to the police station

'nɪ ɔ yi **'sʊjaa** soo
ADD1 3S XFUT police:DEF speak
and told the police' [neyo 32.2–32.3]

c. **minislöɔ wa laa lä Bonbee** nä ɔ -yi -mɔɔ
minister:DEF 3P call:ICP LOP Bombet SP1 3S come:CP LOC
'The minister called Bombet, he came there,

'nɪ	**Ganaa'**	**abasadɛlɪɔ**	-yi	'sɪɪ
ADD1	Ghana:GEN	ambassador:DEF	come:CP	ADD3

and the ambassador of Ghana came, too.' [neyo 71.1–3]

7. Left-dislocated definite noun phrase, followed by a clause with global focus

An identifiable minor participant may also be introduced with a left-dislocated definite noun phrase as a point of departure, preceding a clause with global focus, as in example (117). This encoding appears to convey that even though the participant is a minor participant, he plays a local key role.

(117)

pɛlɪɔ	-mä	ɔ	-kʊ	bhä	'sɪɪ	lɔɔ	
priest:DEF	ADD4	3S	BE1:CP	PST1	ADD3	there	

'Now the priest, he was also there.' [neyo 51]

5.1.3 The introduction of the very first participant

The very first participant mentioned in a Godié narrative is typically introduced as a point of departure, with the thematic pronoun referring to it in the following clause with argument focus.[4] This structure occurs independently of the role played by the participant in the subsequent narrative and also of its cognitive status as identifiable or unidentifiable (that is, brand new). It is thus used for major participants, as in example (118a), and for minor participants, as in (118b), (118c), and (118d). In the last three examples the first participant introduced soon disappears again from the scene and does not reappear in the rest of the narrative. In example (118c) the first participant is identifiable, while the other examples illustrate the introduction of a brand new participant.

(118) a.

nyɪkpɔ	**-bhlogbe**	**ɔmɔ**	mii-	lä
person	one_single	3S:TH	be_able:CP	LOP

'A certain man, he had come (lit. been able)

'nɪ	-ɔ	-gää	lä	ɔɔ	'yuë
ADD1	3S:REL	beget:CP	LOP	3S:GEN	child:PL

to have children.' [filsprod 1–2]

b.

nyɪkpɔ	**-bhlogbe**	**ɔmɔ**	wa	la	lä	'Lulu	
man	one_single	3S:TH	3P	call	LOP	Lulu	

'There was a certain man called (lit. it is him they call) Lulu.' [siamoi 13]

c.

Laagɔ	**'mʊʊ-**	kwlie-	lä	nyɪkpɔ
God	(NH3)TH:REL	bring:down:CP	LOP	person

'God created man (lit. God, it was he who brought down man).' [sigo 28]

d.

wlaa	**nyɪkpa**	**'mä**	slää-	lä	waa	'du
EVD	people	TH	build:CP	LOP	3P:GEN	village

'It is reported that people had built a village for themselves (lit. they say that people, it was they who built their village).' [kazo 1–2]

Table 5.1 summarizes the linguistic structures used for the introduction of brand new and identifiable participants.

[4]Marchese (1986c:242f) notes this structure and its function in introducing participants, though she does not point out that it occurs only with the first participant in a narrative.

Table 5.1. Linguistic forms used for the introduction of participants

Cognitive status / Role in narrative	Brand new participant (*nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe* 'a certain person')	Identifiable participant (nominal phrase or proper name)
Local minor role	clause with predicate focus—example (110)	clause with predicate focus—examples (115) and (116)
Local key role	left-dislocated as PoD, followed by a clause with predicate focus—example (111)	left-dislocated as PoD, followed by a clause with global focus—example (117)
Global major role (protagonist)	event-reporting clause—example (115)	event-reporting clause—examples (112) and (114)
Very first participant	left-dislocated as PoD, followed by a clause with marked argument focus structure—examples (118a), (118b), and (118d)	left-dislocated as PoD, followed by a clause with marked argument focus structure—example (118c)

5.2 Tracking of participants

Dooley and Levinsohn (2001:112) name three different tasks of the linguistic forms for participant tracking in a given language:

- at the semantic level, they need to identify the referents unambiguously, distinguishing them from other possible referents
- at the pragmatic level, they need to signal the activation status and prominence of the referents or of their actions
- at the text-processing level, they need to help overcome disruptions in the flow of information.

Givón's iconicity principle provides a way to predict the forms which will be used to refer to the participants in a narrative. The principle states that "the more disruptive, surprising, discontinuous or hard to process a topic is, the more coding material must be assigned to it" (Givón 1983:18). In the description below of the different ways that are used for participant tracking, a distinction will be made between default forms and marked forms. For marked forms, an attempt will be made to explain the motivation for their use. As will be shown, in order to determine whether a given form is a marked reference or an unmarked one, the activation status of the participant concerned—whether active, inactive, or semi-active—needs to be taken into account (see the introduction to chapter 4 above).

In contrast to the ways of introducing identifiable participants (see §5.1.2), the role of participants in the narrative as a whole, whether major or minor, does not appear to determine the forms used for tracking them. Rather, it is the role of the participant at a certain point in the narrative that matters. The important consideration is whether it is a thematic participant at that point or not.

5.2.1 Default tracking of participants

The default, or unmarked, form for tracking a participant is the basic form of reference in a given context. According to Runge (2010:185) it is "the option used when the writer chooses not to signal the presence of some qualitative feature." For the analyst, the presence of a default form thus requires no explanation of the motivation for its use.

5.2.1.1 Active participants

For tracking an active participant, the default form is the simple pronoun. The active participant may be one that was mentioned in the preceding clause (see §5.1.2.2), as in example (119a), or in a preceding point of departure, as in (119b).[5]

(119) a. zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ nä ŋwadi mʊ ylä
today:GEN day:DEF on SP1 lad go:ICP now:LOP
'Now one day (lit. on the day of today) a lad was coming along,

ɔ bhɛɛ ɔɔ kazɔ
3S hold:ICP 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth
he had with him (lit. was holding) his raffia washcloth.' [kazo 15–17]

b. tɛɛtɛɛ -a bäsɪ -yä -a tɪtɪä
first 1P father:PL ADD2 1P forefathers
'In former times, our fathers and forefathers,

'kazɪɪ' **wa** budo wä
raffia_washcloth:PL:OBL 3P wash:ICP PST3
it was with raffia washcloths that they used to wash themselves.' [kazo 18–19]

5.2.1.2 Reactivation of participants: The definite noun phrase

If a participant has already been introduced but hasn't been mentioned in the immediate context, it is no longer in active status according to Godié information management (see end of §4.1.1). In order to reactivate such a participant, a full noun phrase with the definite marker is used. This is illustrated in example (120), where the "Fanti people" were last referred to four clauses earlier.

(120) wa yiu waa gɔlʊʊ 'mö 'ŋʊ ɪɪ' yɪɔ
3P XFUT:NH3 3P:GEN canoe:DEF inside put NHP:XNEG no:longer
'… they (= the two Neyo men) put it (= the fishing net) into their canoe.

'mö -tlʊmö 'nɪ **Fädönyʊa** yi yi
VPC be_far:CP ADD1 Fanti_people:DEF XFUT come
Before long the Fanti came (lit. it was not far anymore, then the Fanti people came).'
[neyo 6.5–7.2]

5.2.2 Marked tracking of participants

Unlike unmarked forms, by which an author does not signal anything special beyond the fact of referring unambiguosly to a referent, marked forms of participant tracking have an additional discourse function or pragmatic effect.

Most cases of marked tracking of participants in Godié concern active referents. On the basis of the linguistic elements used by the narrator, three types of marked tracking can be distinguished: marked tracking by a full noun phrase (§5.2.2.1), marked tracking by the thematic pronoun (§5.2.2.2), and marked tracking by the simple pronoun (§5.2.2.3).

[5]As Marchese (1986b:166) points out, this applies only to human participants. Objects, especially ones of minor importance in the context, are not pronominalized, even if they have active status.

5.2.2.1 Marked tracking of active participants by a full noun phrase

Given that the default, or unmarked, reference for tracking an active participant is the simple pronoun, a full noun phrase is a marked way of referring to an active participant. Such a noun phrase carries either the definite marker (DEF), as in (121a), or the demonstrative marker (DEM), as in (121b) (see §2.3). Note that the noun phrase with the demonstrative marker is left-dislocated as a point of departure.

(121) a.

ˈnɪ	**ɔ**	yie	ˈyi	ˈkpɔtɔ	**nyëbluo**
ADD1	3S	XFUT:NH2	VPC	tear_out	lad:DEF

'… he (=the young man) tore it (=the fish-hook) out. The young man

ˈtlänyɪ	-aaa	ˈnɪ	ɔ	yi	ˈnyügbë	ˈkʊ	ŋëë
try:ICP	until	ADD1	3S	XFUT	beach	on	arrive

succeeded in reaching (lit. tried until he reached) the beach.' [neyo 30.2–31.2]

b.

gɔlʊnʊ	ʊmʊʊ-	tʊɔ-	lä
canoe:DEM	NH3:TH:REL	cross:3S:CP	LOP

'That canoe was the one that took him across

ˈnɪ	ɔ	yi	lä	mʊ	-amʊ	-mä
ADD1	3S	XFUT	LOP	go	1S:TH	ADD4

and he went. As for me…' [greve 59–61]

A noun phrase with a demonstrative marker may also include a recapitulative relative clause (see §4.4), as in example (122).

(122)

tʊnʊ	ɪ	vë	lä	nä
war:DEM	3P	fight:ICP	LOP	SP1

'This war they were fighting…' [dacligo 8]

When a full noun phrase is used to track active participants, this alerts the hearer to the fact that the narrative is entering a new phase.[6] For example, in (121a) above, the narrator has just finished telling how one of the young Neyo fishers managed to escape the attempts of the Fanti fishers to kill him in the water. The second clause with the full noun phrase talks about the fact that he succeeded in reaching the beach, after which he went to the police to report the incident. This clause marks the transition between two episodes of the narrative.

Likewise, the sentence in (121b) constitutes the dénouement and final situation of a short embedded narrative that is not part of the theme line but provides a convincing argument supporting the main purpose of the narrative. The following sentence returns to the theme line of the narrative. Finally, the full noun phrase in example (122) opens a paragraph that gives background information about the active referent *tʊ* 'war'. In example (122) the full noun phrase begins a paragraph that gives background information about the active referent *tʊ* 'war'.

Full noun phrases thus occur at transition points in the narrative and they typically co-occur with other structuring devices (see §9.2) For example, in (167b) the noun phrase co-occurs with a connective and tail-head linkage.

[6]Any narrative has an underlying coherence structure with different phases (the optional ones are in brackets): (introduction), initial situation, complication, (reaction), (climax), dénouement, final situation, and (moral). See table 9.1 in chapter 9.

5.2.2.2 Marked tracking of active participants by a thematic pronoun

Whenever active participants are referred to by something other than a simple pronoun, this is a marked way of tracking them. The shortest form of marked tracking is the thematic pronoun alone, as in example (123a). However, there are also heavier types of referencing, using more linguistic material. In examples (123b) to (123d) a definite noun phrase is added to the thematic pronoun while in (123e) a demonstrative noun phrase is added.

(123) a. **wamä** -mä, waa' -wʊ -bʊä
HP:TH ADD4 3P:XNEG CNT2 be_slow:CP
'Now as for them, they were not slow (to act).' [neyo 45.1]

b. -mä **ɔmɔ nyɪkpɔɔ** nä ɔ plöö- a nyɪkpa 'kädɔ
SP2 3S:TH person:DEF SP1 3S BE2:CP PST2 person big
'Now that same man, he was an important man.' [filsprod 3–4]

c. **ɔmɔ Pɛlɪɔ** nä ɔ -glö Guduyu
3S:TH priest:DEF SP1 3S BE3 Gudu:child
'That priest, he is a member of the Gudu clan (lit. a Gudu child).' [neyo 52]

d. **ʊmʊ -kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ,** ʊmʊʊ- -gää lä 'kɔɔkɔ 'yikʊ
NH3:TH Rooster 3:TH go_ahead:CP LOP always ahead
'That same Rooster, it was he who always walked ahead.' [kokoleko 87]

e. nä **ʊmʊ gɔlʊnʊ,** **ʊ** pio kpänyɪ 'nɪ **ʊ** -zi 'ko
SP1 NH3:TH canoe:DEM NH3 hurry:ICP much ADD1 NH3 overtake:CP VPC
'So that same canoe, it was very fast and it outstripped

'gokpüü -a plä bhlä -zä nä
boat:PL:DEF 1P enter:ICP PST1:LOP usually SP1
the boats we usually took.' [greve 27–29]

All these structures for marked tracking are examples of a left-dislocated referential point of departure—which itself is a marked use of this type of point of departure (see §4.2.2). Their pragmatic effect is to highlight the background information of the subsequent clause. Other devices for highlighting key information in the narrative often co-occur with these structures, as illustrated in example (124). Here the marked participant tracking is preceded by an elaborate situational point of departure (see §4.2.1). The information highlighted by the two preceding PoDs constitutes the climax of the narrative.

(124) ɪɪ 'ŋnö 'mnö nä 'gokpünyɪkpaa' 'mnö
NHP:GEN name inside SP1 boat_people:DEF:GEN inside
'That is why the boat people

'nöwa -wʊ mɛmä-
XNEG:3P CNT2 be_sweet:PRC:CP
were not happy.

nä -zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- lä 'sɔylʊnʊ 'kʊ nä
SP1 today:DEM day:DEF NH3:REL BE2:CP LOP Tuesday:DEM on SP1
So today, which is this Tuesday,

wamä	**'gokpütienyɒa**,	wlä	waa	nʊ	-wʊ	lebhe
3P:TH	boat:lead:AG:PL:DEF	3P:say	3P:XNEG	do:ICP	CNT2	work

those boatmen, they say they are not working.' [greve 30–34]

This example again illustrates Givón's iconicity principle, according to which features of linguistic form reflect features of meaning. In this case the huge amount of linguistic material preceding the highlighted information in the last clause reflects the importance of that information, being the climax of the narrative.

5.2.2.3 Marked tracking of reactivated participants by a simple pronoun

The simple pronoun is by default used to refer to an active participant (see §4.2.2.3). Therefore, if a simple pronoun is used to reactivate a participant that is no longer active, the reference is marked, meaning that the author is signalling to the hearer to look for additional meaning. The pragmatic effect of this type of marked tracking is to indicate the major role in the narrative of the participant(s) in question.

Example (125) follows an author's comment of three sentences, where the major participant was not mentioned. The participant is reactivated with the simple pronoun.

(125)

ɔ	mʊ	yɪ	'nyibhlëa	'kʊ	ŋëë	-kä	nä	ɔ	bhɛɛ-	'boo
3S	go:ICP	now	river:DEF	on	arrive	PUR	SP1	3S	carry:CP	basin

'As he was now heading towards the river (lit. he was now going in order to arrive at the river), he was carrying a wash basin.' [kazo 22–23]

In terms of text-processing, example (126) is a little more complicated than example (125), since the reference by the plural pronoun *wa* is by default first interpreted as referring to the "Fanti people" as the active referents. As the following information about the action of the referents is processed, however, the default interpretation of the pronoun *wa* must be abandoned by the hearer, because it doesn't make sense. The hearer then picks as referents the Neyo men, whom he already knows as the major participants of the narrative.

(126)

wlä	**wa**	-mö	lä	nä	Fädɪnyʊä	pää-
EVD	3P	go:CP	LOP	SP1	Fanti:people	throw:CP

'It is reported that as they (=the two Neyo men) went, Fanti people had thrown

waa	'pilo	jiee'	wa	niu-	lä	'yi	nä
3P:GEN	net	ocean:OBL	3P	see:NH3:CP	LOP	VC (eyes)	SP1

their net into the ocean. When they (=the two Neyo men) saw it,

kwa	-sʊʊ	'nyiee'
ASF:3P	take_away:NH3:CP	water:OBL

they took it out of the water …' [neyo 6.1–6.4]

6 Represented speech

This chapter looks at the subject of represented speech in Godié. Rather than the traditional term *reported speech,* the term *represented speech* is preferred in this study. There are several reasons for this. First, unlike the term *reported speech,* the term *represented speech* does not suggest that the speech referrred to has already taken place and is therefore "reported." Indeed, in many languages, speech that has not yet been produced but that the speaker anticipates will be, or might be, produced is expressed in the same way as speech that has been produced, as is the speaker's own or someone else's unexpressed thought (e.g., '"Isn't that smart?" he/I thought').

Second, the term *represented speech* is a constant reminder of the fact that the speech referred to is not a reproduction but rather a representation of an actual or potential utterance, most frequently by someone other than the speaker.[1]

Third, emphasizing the fact that represented speech is of an interpretive (rather than a descriptive) nature also allows us to account better for the different types of represented speech. Indeed, the different speech types can now be viewed as the fact that the speaker is claiming different degrees of resemblance with the original speech, "direct" speech claiming a higher degree of resemblance than "indirect" speech.

Fourth, the notion of represented speech can accommodate phenomena that do not normally fit in the category of reported speech. For example, many languages express mental states (such as belief, desire, intention, and volition) as representations of speech. For example, a thought like "he wants to go" is expressed as something like "he says he will go." Such states may even be ascribed to inanimate objects, as is the case in Godié, where the idea that a tree is about to fall can be encoded as "the tree says it will fall."

Finally, the notion of represented speech also includes instances where the speech is not formulated but where only the illocutionary force of the speech event is given, such as when the verb *accuse, reproach,* or *refuse* is mentioned. Indeed, even though only the speech event is referred to in these instances, these are clearly ways of representing speech.[2]

6.1 Formal features of represented speech

The two ususal types of represented speech or thought, namely direct and indirect speech, are found in Godié.

6.1.1 Direct speech

With direct speech all deictic elements of the original speech are retained, namely the so-called speech pronouns (I, we, you) as well as all deictic elements, including determiners (e.g., this, that); spatial adverbs (e.g., here, over there); and time adverbs relating to the moment of speech (e.g., yesterday, tomorrow).

Direct speech in Godié is often introduced by an address term, such as "my friend", as in example (127a); by an exlamation, as in (127b); or by the uptake element *-aa* 'UPT', as in (127c).[3]

(127) a.	a	lä	**'nɔɔ**	[sese]	'bhlı	'kʊ	n	bha	nä	[sese]
	NH1	say	**my_friend**	NUPT	region	on	1S	leave:ICP	SP1	NUPT
	'He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, it is from afar that I am coming,									

[1]It is thus a case of what is called "interpretive use" in Relevance Theory (see Sperber and Wilson 1995; Blass 1990; and Blakemore 1992).

[2]This study will not deal further with these non-formulated types of represented speech, although something about their function will be said in §6.3.

[3]Note that in writing, direct speech begins with a capital letter following the comma that separates the speech margin (see §6.2) from the represented speech. Quotation marks are not used in Godié because of the tone signs.

n yä sıä [sese]
1S XPER be:tired NUPT
I am tired.’” [sigo 54–55]

b. dunyʋa lä **ɔ** a po -wʊ 'nyukwli
village:people say EXCL1 2P listen CNT2 VC (ears)
‘The villagers said, “Oh, listen!”’ [lueuzi 64]

c. Dacligoo lä **-aa** n yi wälıı 'kʊ 'bhlü
Dacligo say UPT 1S XFUT matter:DEF VPC take
Dacligo said, “Alright, I'll take the matter upon me.”’ [dacligo 18]

Direct speech can also occur within direct speech in Godié, as in example (128).[4]

(128) ɔ lä […] -amʊ 'naa 'yii ŋwɛɛ -kä 'kʊ
3S say 1S:TH 1S:GEN eyes:DEF be_closed:CP CLU3 VPC
‘He said, “[…] As for me, (you know that) my eyes are closed

'nı nn' nii- -kä sä [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 1S:XNEG see:CP CLU3 VPC NUPT
and I cannot see,

'nı -n sonö'ö -mä -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 2S speak:APL:1SO:ICP ADD4 2S close eyes VPC NUPT
and you are saying to me, ‘Close your eyes!’”’ [sigo 137–140]

6.1.2 Indirect speech

With indirect speech the speech pronouns (I, you, we) are absent, as the speaker and hearer of the represented speech are referred to by third person pronouns. Deictic time and space adverbs (today, here) are not found either but are replaced by non-deictic elements, such as ‘that day’ in example (129).

(129) pɛlıɔ lä[5] ɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ -aaa […]
priest:DEF say 3S BE1:CP there a_long_time
‘The priest said he was around a long time.…

-lɔɔ' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ, ɔɔ -wʊ dëdü -lü
there:GEN day:DEF on 3S:XNEG CNT2 lunch eat:CP
That day (he said) he hadn’t eaten lunch.’ [neyo 64.1–64.3]

As for represented open questions, they have the same linguistic form in indirect speech and in direct speech, as the question particle *bhä* is present in both. Therefore, unless the stretch of represented speech contains deictic elements, it is impossible to determine on a formal basis whether the represented question is direct or indirect, as illustrated in example (130).

[4]There may be restrictions on which utterances can occur as direct speech within another direct speech but this needs more study.
[5]In written form indirect speech begins after the speech margin without a comma and without a capital letter.

(130) wa ylɔɔ lä 'yuoo' 'ŋnö bhää nä
3P ask:3S:CP LOP child:GEN name QW SP1
'… when they asked what the name of the child was (or: they asked, "What is the child's name?"),

ɔ lä wa -lɔ kplupä
3S say 3P bring:3S tablet
he said to bring him a tablet.' [elisabet 82–85]

In Godié, indirect speech seems to be the default format for representing speech that expresses a desire, as in example (131a), or an answer to a request, especially a negative answer, as in examples (131b) and (131c). The marked form would be direct speech in those cases. Compare (131) with (127c) where the acceptance of a request is expressed with direct speech. Other than this example, such marked examples of direct speech have not been found in the database for this study.

(131) a. waa ducifio 'titi, ɔ lä ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ
3P:GEN village:chief:DEF self 3S say 3S XPOT lagoon cross
'Their village chief himself, he wanted to cross the lagoon (lit. he said he was going to cross the lagoon).' [grève 50–51]

b. wamä gokpütienyʊa, wlä waa' nʊ -wʊ lebhe
HP:TH boat:lead:AG:PL:DEF 3P:say 3P:GEN do CNT2 work
'… those same boatmen, they said they are not working …' [grève 33–34]

c. nümnüü -lefɪɪn, wlä waa' ylä -wʊ
bird:PL:DEF totality 3P:say 3P:XNEG want CNT2
'All the birds, they said they were not willing (lit. they said they didn't want).' [dacligo 17]

6.2 Speech margins

A speech margin is a linguistic element indicating that represented speech follows. Speech margins are obligatory in Godié and are the same for both direct and indirect speech.[6] Since they always precede the represented speech, they can also be called speech introducers. Whenever a speech margin also indicates who speaks to whom, it is not only a speech introducer but also a speech orienter (see Dooley and Levinsohn 2001:50).

Godié speech margins may be more or less elaborate. The normal and most simple speech margin is the invariable verb *lä* 'say', spelled *nä* after the nasal pronouns *n* '1S' and *-n* '2S', and amalgamated with the third person plural *wä* into the form *wlä.*

The speech margin *lä* may introduce only one represented speech element, such as an exclamation or an uptake element, as in example (132a), or it may be preceded by a verb specifying the verbal expression, as in (132b).

(132) a. n nä -aa
1S say UPT
'I said, "I see."' [greve 71]

b. ɔ woo ɔ lä 'naa 'yuo
3S cry 3S say 1S:GEN child
'He screamed saying, "My child…"' [filsprod 117–119]

[6]Marchese (pers.comm.) claims there is a lot of Godié represented speech without speech margin. However, this is not confirmed by the data for this study.

The speech margin *lä* followed by a clause containing the potential auxiliary *'kä* expresses will or intention, as in example (133).

(133) waa ducifio 'titi, ɔ lä ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ
3P:GEN village:chief:DEF self 3S say 3S XPOT lagoon cross
'Their village chief himself, he wanted to cross the lagoon (lit. he said he was going to cross the lagoon).' [greve 50–51]

The default speech margin *lä* is a speech introducer but not a speech orienter. Whenever the speaker wants to indicate who speaks to whom, he needs to use the verb *soo* 'to speak to', followed by the spacer *nynä* 'SP2' (see §7.2), as in example (134).

(134) kä -Laagɔzuzuu -sonöɔ lä nynä
ASF God:spirit:DEF speak:APL:3S:CP LOP SP2
'God's angel said to him,

-nn -lä yɪɔ -zɪkä 'mʊ -sää
2S:XNEG DP2 anymore today VPC have_speech
"As of today you will no longer be able to speak."' [elisabet 39–40]

Given that in most contexts it is clear who speaks to whom, a speech margin different from, or in addition to, the default element *lä* can be considered a means of drawing special attention to and thus highlighting the following speech. Such more complex speech introducers in Godié are therefore considered marked speech margins.

The default speech margin *lä* is the normal link between the turns of the different speakers in a represented conversation, as shown in example (135).

(135) a lä -amʊ Goplë [sese]
NH1 say 1S:TH Gopleu NUPT
'He (=Gopleu) said, "It's me, Gopleu."

ɔ lä -a 'nɔɔ -ayiokä [sese]
3S say UPT my_friend thank_you NUPT
He (=Sigo) said, "Oh, my friend, hello."

a lä 'nɔɔ [sese] 'bhlɪ 'kʊ n bha nä [sese]
NH1 say my_friend NUPT region on 1S leave:ICP SP1 NUPT
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, I have come a long way …"' [sigo 52–54]

6.3 Functions of represented speech in narrative

Direct speech is the default type of represented speech in Godié narrative. It is found with all represented speech along the main event line of the narrative, produced by main and minor characters alike.

Direct speech is used in initial speech, such as questions and orders, as well as in brief response moves, such as a brief uptake (UPT) in agreement or acceptance, as with the second sentence in example (136a). Indirect speech is preferred for negative responses in dialogue, as illustrated by the first sentence in (136a), as well as by (136b).

(136) a. nümnüü -lefɪɪn wlä waa' ylä -wʊ
bird:PL:DEF totality 3P:say 3P:XNEG want CNT2
'All the birds, they refused (lit. they said they were not willing).

Dacligoo lä -aa n yi wälɪɪ 'kʊ 'bhlü
Dacligo say UPT 1S XFUT matter:DEF VPC take
Dacligo said, “Alright, I’ll take the matter upon me.”’ [dacligo 17–18]

b. kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsɪ soo -kä
ASF:3S go:CP 3S father:PL speak PUR
‘… he went to tell his elders,

-mä wa 'nɪɪ -wʊ -nʊawlɛ laa-
ADD4 3P XNEG:NHP CNT2 truth call:CP
but they did not believe it (lit. they did not call it truth).’ [neyo 37.2–3]

7 Spacers

Spacers signal that the information expressed by the material that follows is to be distinguished from the information that precedes.[1] In terms of an instruction for the hearer, the function of spacers is primarily an instruction for segmentation of the speech flow, rather than an instruction for interpretation, as is the case with connectives (discussed in chapter 8).

Two linguistic elements in Godié function exclusively as spacers: *nä* 'SP1' and *nynä* 'SP2'. Other elements may act as spacers in addition to their intrinsic function. This is the case, for example, with the relative pronoun when it is attached to a subject constituent in focus (see §4.1.2), and especially with the additive connective *-mä* 'ADD4' (see §8.1.4).[2]

7.1 The spacer *nä* 'SP1'

The spacer *nä* is the default spacer in Godié. Within a given string of speech, *nä* signals a distinction between speech material at three different levels: (1) between different syntactic levels; (2) between different sentence-pragmatic levels; and (3) between different levels of information.

First, the spacer *nä* signals a distinction between different syntactic levels, such as between the clause and phrase level. This is true for instance in its position at the end of a relative clause, as is the case in example (137). Here the spacer *nä* occurs within the verb brace (see §3.1.2) between the two elements of the complex verb *-zi ˈkʊ* 'exceed'. Coming at the end of the relative clause, it indicates the distinction between the verb phrase and the clause levels. This use of the spacer is practically grammaticalized.

(137) ʊ -zi ˈgokpü -a plä bhlä -zä **nä** ˈkʊ
NH3 exceed boat:PL 1P enter:ICP PST1:LOP DP3 SP1 VPC
'… it (=the canoe) outstripped the boats we usually took (lit. entered).' [greve 28–29]

Second, the spacer *nä* signals a distinction between different sentence-pragmatic levels, such as between a point of departure and the following clause, as is the case in example (138).

(138) ɔmɔ pɛlɪɔ **nä** ɔ -glö Guduyu
3S:TH priest:DEF SP1 3S BE3 Gudu:child
'That priest, he is a member of the Gudu clan (lit. a Gudu child).' [neyo 52]

Third, the spacer *nä* signals a distinction between different levels of information, such as between background and foreground information, as in example (139a) or between a condition and the result, as in example (139b). With a series of subordinate clauses the spacer *nä* normally occurs only after the last one, before the syntactic level changes from subordinate to main level, as shown in example (139b).[3]

---

[1]They thus play a role in the management of information and could therefore also have been discussed in chapter 4 above. However, as they also take functions of pragmatic connectives, we have preferred to deal with them in a separate chapter following the chapter on connectives.

[2]Connectives that are placed between connected linguistic material could also be said to act as spacers, which would make the distinction between connectives and spacers meaningless. It would then seem better to reunite them all under the traditional heading of conjunctions. Incidentally, especially the connectives *-mä* and *-mää,* could be treated either as spacers or as additive connectives. However, as it seemed possible to attribute a specific instruction for interpretation to them, it was decided to treat them as connectives rather than as spacers. It is quite plausible that they started out as spacers and then became additives as a specific instruction for interpretation became attached to them. This could be argued to be presently happening to the spacer *nynä,* which appears to have an instruction to treat the following material as the content of the preceding verb. It could then be considered as an additive connective for the specific context of represented speech.

[3]The presence of *nä* after a clause in the middle of the series would probably imply special insistence.

(139) a. ɔ -nyoto -nʊ -gbɔtʊ **nä**
3S husband make:CP bamboo_bed SP1
'Her husband had built a bed out of bamboo,

-gbɔtʊʊ 'kʊ wa pu sä [sese]
bamboo_bed:DEF on 3P lie:ICP VPC NUPT
so it was on the bed out of bamboo that they were lying down.' [lueuzi 34–35]

b. -mä a kä 'pɐpɛlıä -gäma 'nı a kä
ADD4 2P XCND a_little have_fun ADD1 2P XCND
'But if you have a little fun and then you go to lie down,

sä pu -kä -mʊ **nä** [kpazebhleku] -n yä ŋɔɔ
VPC lie_down PUR go:CP SP1 NUPT 2S XPER sleep
you sleep (lit. have slept).' [siamoi 73–75]

While in the first two uses mentioned above the spacer *nä* is followed by a pause, reflected in writing by a comma, in the third use it can be preceded by a pause, especially if the background information takes more than one clause, as in example (140).[4] In this use, the spacer also receives more voice volume. In writing, this is reflected by the position of *nä* at the beginning of a new sentence that gives the foreground information.[5]

(140) a. ıı 'ŋnö 'mnö **nä** 'gokpünyıkpaa' 'mnö 'nöwa -wʊ mɛmä-
CLU2 SP1 boat_people:GEN inside XNEG:3P CNT2 be_sweet:PRC:CP
'It was because of that that the boat people were not happy (lit. their inside didn't make them sweet).

nä -zıkää' 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- lä 'sɔylʊnʊ 'kʊ **nä**
SP1 today:GEN day:DEF NH3:REL BE2:CP LOP Tuesday:DEM on SP1
So today, which is this Tuesday,

wamä 'gokpütienyʊa wlä waa' nʊ -wʊ lebhe
3P:TH boat_lead:AG:PL:DEF 3P:say 3P:XNEG do CNT2 work
those same boat captains said they are not working.' [greve 30–34]

b. wlä 'ylʊbä kä cii- a 'kä yi nä
EVD (new)year XCND speak:CP NH1 XPOT come SP1
'It is reported that when New Year is going to (lit. says it will) come up,

kä Fädınyʊa bhlä nyıkpɔ 'nı wa bʊbɔ jiee
ASF Fanti_people:DEF kill:ICP person ADD1 3P sacrifice ocean:DEF
the Fanti kill someone and they make a sacrifice to the ocean.

nä Jübua kä jie 'klʊ -mö nä kä wa too -mɔɔ
SP1 Neyo:DEF XCND ocean surface go:CP SP1 ASF 3P stay LOC
So when Neyo people go out on the ocean (to fish), they don't come back (lit. they stay there).' [neyo 33.1–6]

[4]The pause is absent if the spacer occurs within the verb brace, as in example (140).
[5]This is a choice that the transcriber made spontaneously and which has now been adopted in writing the language. Also see clauses 24, 27, and 32 in the text "greve" in the text collection.

The spacer *nä* seems to have no semantic content and is therefore never translated, except in the third use, where it tends to be rendered by “thus” or “so,” as illustrated in the preceding examples.[6] However, it is homophonous with the non-human singular *nä* of the demonstrative (see §2.2). Indeed, nominals provided with a demonstrative marker normally refer to established referents. Likewise, information separated from what follows by the spacer *nä* is invariably established information. This is true even for its occurrence at the end of the relative clause, as relative clauses in Godié can only convey established information (see §4.4). It seems therefore plausible that the spacer *nä* in Godié has derived from the non-human demonstrative *nä*.[7]

In example (141) there are two occurrences of the spacer *nä* side by side. Interstingly enough, the second instance was glossed by the transcriber as “therefore.”[8]

(141) -mä -nɪnɪ -ɪ -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ nä
ADD4 these_things NHP:REL BE1:CP LOP at_this_place SP1
‘Since these things that are in this place, they are rotten,

yä 'zɛ **nä** yä 'zɛ **nä** n 'kää- 'yigäda dä 'ŋʊ
XPER be_rotten SP1 XPER be_rotten SP1 1S XPOT:2SO other place put
therefore I shall put you in a better place.’ [sigo 365–367]

Example (142) illustrates all three uses of the spacer *nä*: the sentence-pragmatic use, the discourse-pragmatic use, and the grammaticalized use, in that order. Moreover, this example shows the use of the additive connective *-mä* ‘ADD4’ as a spacer.

(142) pɛlɪɔ -mä ɔ -kʊ bhä 'sɪɪ -lɔɔ
priest:DEF ADD4 3S BE1:CP PST1 ADD3 there
‘Now the priest, he was also there.

ɔmɔ pɛlɪɔ **nä** ɔ -glö Guduyu
3S:TH priest:DEF SP1 3S BE3 Gudu:child
That priest, he is a member of the Gudu clan (lit. he is a Gudu child).

nä dä ŋwnɪa nii- lä gboyloo 'yi **nä**
SP1 when woman:PL:DEF see LOP smoke:DEF VC (eyes) SP1
So when the women saw the smoke,

kä waa nëëdëë' lɔɔ -bhlo -möɔ soo -kä
ASF 3P:GEN midst:OBL IPF one go:3S:CP speak PUR
one from among them went to tell him …’ [neyo 51–53.2]

[6]These translations do not mean, however, that in this context *nä* is a conclusive connective (see §8.3). Rather, the causal meaning is only a contextual effect, which is produced by the interpretation as a causal relationship between the two chunks of information given in the clause(s) preceding and following the spacer.
[7]In German, the demonstrative neuter definite article and demonstrative pronoun *das* and the spacer *dass* are also homophonous and are related in the same way, as Lambrecht (1994:78) points out, reminding us of the well known fact “that in many languages the morpheme used as an identifiability marker, e.g., the definite article or a demonstrative determiner, is the same as, or is at least historically related to, the subordinating morpheme used to introduce a nominalized sentence”.
[8]The original gloss in French is the conclusive connective *donc*.

7.2 The spacer *nynä* ‘SP2’

The spacer *nynä* occurs between a verb of saying, thinking, feeling, desire, knowledge, or evaluation and a completive clause.[9] It instructs the hearer to interpret what follows as the content of a thought, as in example (143a), an evaluation, as in (143b), or a represented speech, as in (143c) and (143d), depending on the lexical meaning of the preceding verb.

(143) a. n -luë bhlä **nynä** ɔ kuu- bhlä
1S think_falsely:CP PST1:LOP SP2 3S die:CP PST1:LOP
‘I had thought that he had died.’ [filsprod 122–123]

b. ı -ŋwa 'kʊ **nynä** n 'pä yı -a 'bhunünü
NHP be_suitable:CP CV SP2 1S throw now 1P home:stories
‘… it is a good thing that I now tell our own stories …’ [sigo 21]

c. kä -Laagɔzuzuu -sonöɔ lä
ASF God:spirit:DEF speak:APL:3S:CP LOP
‘God's angel said to him,

nynä -nn -lä yıɔ -zıkä 'mʊ -sää
SP2 2S:XNEG DP2 anymore today VPC speak
“As of today you will no longer be able to speak.”’ [elisabet 39–40]

d. 'nı -Laagɔzuzuu -sonöɔ bhä 'sıı
ADD1 God:spirit:DEF speak:APL:3S:CP PST ADD3
‘Then an angel from God had spoken to her, too, saying

nynä ɔ yi bhä 'sıı 'yu gää
SP2 3S XFUT PST ADD3 child procreate:AP
that she also would give birth to a child.’ [elisabet 55–56]

The spacer *nynä* can be combined with the additive *-mä* ‘ADD4’ (see §8.1.4), as in example (144).

(144) -aa -wʊ cii- **nynä** **-mä** -a 'gʊ nyima
1P:XNEG CNT2 say:CP SP2 ADD4 1P XPOT:NH3 ruin
‘We did not want to (lit. we did not say we would) destroy it,

-mä -a 'gʊ -anyıa 'cifio yëku fä
ADD4 1P XPOT:NH3 1P:GEN chief:DEF beside send
rather we are going to send it to your chief.’ [neyo 14.2–14.4]

In example (145) the speech verb is implied.

(145) -n yä'ä 'ylʊ -bhlogbe mnɛ 'nyɛ
2S XPER:1SO day one_single animal give
‘Have you ever given me an animal

nynä n -yä 'naa nagwıä 'kä lü -a
SP2 1S ADD2 1S:GEN friend:PL XPOT eat Q
(telling me) I could eat with my friends?’ [filsprod 256–257]

[9]It could therefore also be considered as a complementizer (see Schachter 1985:50). As for its form, it seems plausible to consider it as a coalescence of the connective *‘nı* ‘ADD1’ (see §8.1.1) and the speech margin *lä* (see §6.2).

8 Pragmatic connectives

The world's languages can be divided into two groups, as far as connectives are concerned. In one group, clauses are normally conjoined *without* a connective and in the other group they are normally conjoined *with* a connective. In the latter group, the connective that occurs most frequently may be called the default connective.

Godié belongs to the former group of languages where clauses are normally conjoined without a connective. This means that the presence of a connective is significant and needs to be seen as the marked way of conjoining discourse units in Godié.

A pragmatic connective is a linguistic marker whose function is to specify the way in which information expressed in clauses or sentences—and sometimes in larger groupings—is to be connected. The category of pragmatic connectives according to this definition, therefore, not only comprises the elements that have traditionally been called coordinating or subordinating conjunctions, but it also includes a variety of other grammatical categories, such as adverbs (e.g., 'also', 'even', 'indeed' in English), adverbial expressions (e.g., 'after all'), and particles.

Pragmatic connectives do not contribute to the semantic content of the connected items; rather, they facilitate the interpretation process for the hearer by helping to economise on processing effort and thus decreasing the risk of misunderstanding.[1]

Some connectives explicitly refer to the discourse context by some anaphoric item such as 'that' (e.g., 'after that' or 'because of that'), thus specifying in their conceptual meaning in which way what follows is to be connected to what precedes. Their function is similar to that of situational points of departure (see §4.3). It is therefore not surprising that some connectives in fact derive from points of departure and can still be analysed as such. Most connectives, however, do not encode any kind of conceptual meaning. Rather, their lexical meaning is of a procedural nature in that it consists of a single and general instruction or constraint for interpretation. Connectives are therefore most adequately described by making this instruction explicit.

What Levinsohn (2000:69) says about conjunctions is certainly true for all pragmatic connectives:

> When a reader encounters a conjunction in a text, the conjunction always constrains him or her to relate what follows to the context in the *same* way. The different senses that grammarians identify are produced by the same constraint being applied in different contexts. [*emphasis in original*]

Different possible translations of a connective in different contexts thus reflect these different contexts, rather than different "meanings" of the connective in question.

The claim that the meaning of a connective can be expressed in one single general instruction for interpretation is a fairly strong one to make, especially given that the description of a conjunction, for instance, has traditionally aimed at describing the different "meanings" of the element in different contexts. In this study, however, such "meanings" are considered contextual effects, being constructed by the hearer in the various contexts on the basis of the general instruction for interpretation given by the connective.

The instruction for interpretation given by a connective applies to its occurrence in both narrative and non-narrative material. The description of Godié connectives in this chapter will therefore not only draw on narrative texts for the examples, as in the other chapters, but also use examples drawn from non-narrative material. On the basis of the type of instruction given by a connective, the following three types of connectives will be distinguished here: additive connectives, countering connectives, and conclusive connectives. The following three major sections describe these three types of connectives in Godié.

[1]In terms of Relevance Theory, connectives thus guide the hearer's search for optimal relevance (see Blass 1990:126f.).

8.1 Additive connectives

The procedural meaning of additive connectives consists in inviting the hearer to treat the information of an utterance as an addition to other information.

The following five additives can be distinguished in Godié:

- *ˈnɪ* 'ADD1', normally translated into English as 'and' or 'then'
- *-yä* 'ADD2' with its variants *-ya* and *ɪyä*, all of which are translated as 'and' but may also be translated as 'so that'
- *ˈsɪ* 'ADD3', which is commonly translated as 'also'
- *-mä* 'ADD4', often translated as 'but', 'however', 'now'
- *-mää* 'ADD5', also translated as 'but', 'however', 'now'

The general instruction for interpretation that is common to all additives can be formulated as follows:

- Treat the information added in the clause after the additive connective as an addition to already established information.

The instruction for each of the different additive connectives specifies in which way exactly the information is to be added to the context. The five additive connectives are described in more detail below.

8.1.1 The additive connective ˈnɪ 'ADD1'

The additive connective *ˈnɪ* is the most frequent connective in Godié. Information connected by way of the additive *ˈnɪ* is to be seen as very closely related. That is certainly why among the five additive connectives *ˈnɪ* is the one with the shortest scope inasmuch as it connects only the information of noun phrases and clauses, not of larger discourse units such as sentences or paragraphs. The instruction for interpretation given by the additive *ˈnɪ* can be formulated as follows:

- Consider the two pieces of information connected by ˈnɪ as very closely related.

The connective *'nɪ* is used for connecting event information, as in examples (146a) and (146b), as well as non-event information, as in (146c-e). The events can be successive, as in (146a), or simultaneous, as in (146b).[2]

(146) a. ɔ -mʊ **ˈnɪ** ɔ -zla ɔ ˈnagɔ -bhlo gɔlʊ
3S go:CP ADD1 3S ask:CP 3S friend one canoe
'… he went to ask (lit. and he asked) one of his friends for a canoe.' [greve 57–58]

b. -mɔɔ gwäda ˈwlu ɔ -kʊ **'nɪ** ɔ tu
LOC kapok:DEF on_top 3S BE1 ADD1 3S cry:ICP
'there he was sitting on top of the kapok tree crying (lit. and he was crying).' [sigo 193–194]

c. ɔmɔ -mä ɔ plöö- ylä ŋwadi
3S:TH ADD4 3S BE2:CP now:LOP man
'Now he, he was a man

[2]The English translation in (147a) by an infinitive construction shows the close relationship of the actions 'go' and 'ask'. Likewise, in (147b) the English translation of the second event as a participle signals its close connection to the first event.

'nɪ ɔ -yi ylä 'ŋie nä
ADD1 3S know now:LOP swim SP1
and he knew how to swim …' [kazo 26–27]

d. 'kuŋnʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ 'nyibhlëa
ghost_old_woman:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP now:LOP LOC river:DEF
'The old woman's ghost that was there in the river

'mʊ 'nɪ -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä
OBL ADD1 NH1:REL BE2:CP now:LOP LOC:GEN spirit:DEF SP1
and that was its spirit (lit. the spirit of there),

a yä 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü
NH1 XPER raffia_washcloth:DEF VPC take
it has taken the raffia washcloth.' [kazo 29–31]

The close connection between two pieces of information as constrained by '*nɪ* may in addition be expressed by parallel syntax, as in example (147).

(147) ɔ -kä a lɪ **'nɪ** ɔ -kä a -gänʊnyʊä
3S have PST2 thing:PL ADD1 3S have PST2 slavery_people
'He had riches and he had slaves.' [filsprod 5–6]

If '*nɪ* is followed by a *yi* clause (see §9.1.2), as in example (148), the actions referred to happened in temporal sequence.

(148) -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ 'mʊʊ- pio lä nä **'nɪ** ʊ yi
Rooster NH3:TH:REL hurry LOP SP1 ADD1 NH3 XFUT
'It was Rooster that hurried and he arrived

'Clikpëkʊ ŋë **'nɪ** wa yiu 'dö 'ylä
Tripoko arrive ADD1 3P XFUT:3SO news ask
at Tripoko, and they asked him the news.' [kokoleko 19–21]

This also applies to an action that follows upon reported speech material and is the confirmation or execution of what was said in the speech, as in example (149).

(149) nä -a 'gä ye -yä -lɔɔ -ɔ -yi lä
SP1 1P XPOT dance ADD2 DPF REL know LOP
'We'll dance, then, and the one who knows

yesä nä [kpazebhleku] -a 'gɔ 'ni [aao]
dance:manner SP1 NUPT 1P XPOT:3S find okay
how to dance, we are going to find him.

'nɪ -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ yi -jlëë' slo [kpazebhleku]
ADD1 Rooster XFUT crowd:OBL meet NUPT
And Rooster came out before the crowd,

'nɪ wa yi -mɔɔ plüü 'ŋʊ
ADD1 3P XFUT LOC drum:PL:DEF put
and they started beating the drums there.' [kokoleko 23–27]

The additive *'nɪ* may introduce direct speech in a reported conversation, with the implication that the speaker doesn't change but that the same speaker adds an utterance to his speech, as in example (150).

(150) ɔ lä -ɛɛ ɔ lä **'nɪ** 'yua -wa gäma bhlä nä
3S said yes 3S said ADD1 child:DEF:PL REL:3P play:ICP PST1:LOP SP1
'He said, "Yes." Then he added, "And the children who used to play together,

-naa -lɔɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ -a
2S:GEN DPF BE1:CP there Q
is yours there?"' [sigo 356–357]

The connective *'nɪ* is also used in contexts where the material connected is semantically in contrast, as in examples (151a) and (151b). Note, however, that the contrastive interpretation is not due to the connective *'nɪ* but due to the semantic contrast between the two clauses.

(151) a. n luënöɔ a kwiee'
1S think:falsely:APL:3S PST2 death:OBL
'I thought he was dead

'nɪ ɔɔ -wʊ lä kuu-
ADD1 3S:XNEG CNT2 LOP die:CP
and he wasn't (lit. I thought him in death and he hadn't died) …' [filsprod 267–268]

b. nɔnɔ -yä 'nɪ -nɔnɔ kuu-
DEMPR live:CP ADD! DEMPR die:CP
'One (lit. that one) lived and one (lit. that one) was dead.' [siamoi 26]

8.1.2 The additive connective -yä *'ADD2'*

The element *-yä* is used both for conjoining noun phrases and for conjoining clauses.

8.1.2.1 Conjoining noun phrases

Conjoined noun phrases have *-yä* 'and' placed between them, as in example (152).

(152) tɛɛtɛɛ -a 'bäsɪ **-yä** -a tɪtɪä
first 1P father:PL ADD2 1P forefather:PL
'In former times, our fathers and forefathers…' [kazo 18]

If the numeral *'sɔ* 'two' is placed after the second noun phrase, as in (153a) and (153b), the meaning is that the action referred to in the clause is carried out by or happened to the referents of the conjoined noun phrases at the same time. The semantic meaning is then 'together with'. Note that a noun phrase with an animate referent can be conjoined with a noun phrase that has an inanimate referent, as in the second clause of example (153c), where the conjoined noun phrases refer to Chicken and the money.[3]

(153) a. sä -bhɔɔdä nä kä 'gwɛ **-yä** nyɪkpɔ **'sɔ**
because beginning SP1 ASF chimpanzee ADD2 person two
'… because in the beginning, the chimpanzee and man actually

[3]For example (156), the only possible explanation for the form *-nyɛ* is that it contains an intrusive nasal.

-kʊʊ bhä 'kʊ
BE1:APL PST1 VPC
lived together.' [gwebhutu 12]

b. ʊ paa- lä -mää 'küküü **-yä** cɛkwɪɪ **'sɔ**
NH3 put:CP LOP here hill:PL ADD2 rock:PL two
'… it put (lit. threw) here hills and rocks.' [creation 137]

c. 'nɪ ɔ yi monie 'kʊ 'bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S XFUT money:DEF VPC take NUPT
'… he then took the money

'nɪ ɔ -nyɛ **'sɔ** yi bhä yi aa [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S ADD2:NH2 two XFUT PST1 come EXCL3 NUPT
and went away with it (lit. he and it came).' [kokoleko 174–175]

The additive *-yä* has the variant form *-ya*. However, *-ya* does not occur alone; rather, it alternates with *-yä,* as in example (154). This is true especially when more than two noun phrases are conjoined, as in example (157b). Moreover, the form *-ya* occurs not only between noun phrases but also, like the numeral *'sɔ* 'two', after the second of two noun phrases, as in (157a), and even after the last one of a series of conjoined noun phrases, as in (157b) (cf. example (155)). Again, the emphasis seems to be on the simultaneity of the actions happening to or being carried out by the referents.

(154) a. -bhutupapɪɪ **-yä** papoo **-ya** -vlu
house_wall:PL:DEF ADD2 straw ADD2 ID
'The walls and the straw crash to the ground!' [gwebhutu 38]

b. papoo **-yä** -cɛcɛcɪɪ **-ya** -gbäpɪɪ **-ya**
straw:DEF ADD2 beam:PL:DEF ADD2 pillar:PL:DEF ADD2
'It was on the straw and the beams and the pillars

ɪmɪ 'kʊ 'gwɛ -goo
NHP:TH on chimpanzee spend_the_night
that the chimpanzee spent the night.' [gwebhutu 44]

Example (155) is particularly interesting in that *-ya* was added in brackets by the transcriber of the recorded text. He obviously felt that it should occur there. The narrator had first conjoined two noun phrases and then as an afterthought added the third one but without using the additive *-ya*.

(155) ɔ 'bä **-yä** ɔ 'nɔ 'sɔ, dunyʊa **-ya** wa tu yɪ
3S father ADD2 3S mother two village_people:DEF ADD2 3P weep now
'Her father and her mother, together with the village people, they now wept.' [siamoi 27–29]

8.1.2.2 Conjoining clauses

The clauses connected by *-yä* refer to events that take place alongside each other or parallel to each other. The second clause typically receives a purposive interpretation. This meaning extension can be

explained by a cognitive path where the action referred to in the first clause is seen as being accompanied by its purpose. In example (156a) both meanings are still clearly present.[4]

(156) a. -n titonöɛ **-yä** -n 'mëë -lɪɪ 'kɔɔkɔ
2S go_alongside:APL:NH2 ADD2 2S spread thing:PL:DEF always
'… walk alongside it (= the sea shore) while spreading the things all the time!' [creation 49]

b. n soonö-ö **-yä** -n 'gä sɔɔ yibhë
1S speak:APL:2SO ADD2 2S XPOT thus know
'… I talk to you so that you know about it.' [neyo 79.5–6]

c. 'na 'ŋnɔnɔ -n kʊ -kä -lɔɔ
1S:GEN woman:DEM 2S BE1 CLU3 there
'… my dear woman, so do stay around

-yä n 'kä duu' 'dö fä
ADD2 1S XPOT village:OBL news send
so that I can take the news to the village,

-yä -n -nyoto kä -kɛ -yi nä
ADD2 2S husband XCND CLU3 come:CP SP1
so that when your husband will have come,

-a 'gä -kɛ -naa wälɪɪ bhobho
1P XPOT CLU3 2S:GEN matter:PL think
we may deal with your problem.' [devinet 72–75]

Similarly to the form *-ya*, which is a variant of *-yä* for conjoining noun phrases, the connective *ɪyä* is a variant of *-yä* for conjoining clauses. It carries an explicit reference to the discourse context (the preceding clause) by its first part *ɪ,* which is the non-human plural pronoun also used for abstract things.[5] The form *ɪyä* receives more stress than *-yä* alone and can be preceded and followed by a pause. When recording texts, transcribers therefore tend to spontaneously put a comma before it.

Conjoining clauses by *ɪyä* thus appears as a marked way of conjoining clauses. The presence of *ɪyä* confers special significance on, or highlights, the event referred to by the clause, for reasons that the hearer infers from the context. The additive can be translated into English as 'actually', 'even', or 'and also', as illustrated in example (157).

(157) a. suu 'mʊ wa bhlä ylä **ɪyä** ʊ 'kä -zɔɔ bhlü
tree:DEF (NH3)TH 3P fell:ICP now:LOP ADD2 NH3 XPOT (VPC) fall_down
'They now went about felling the tree, so that it would actually fall

-yä wa 'kä 'yuo 'kʊ 'bhlü
ADD2 3P XPOT child:DEF VPC take
and they could take the child (= the baby bird).' [sigo 226–228]

b. ɪ -ŋwa 'kʊ nynä n 'pä yɪ -a 'bhunünü
NHP be_right VPC SP2 1S throw now 1P home:tale:PL
'… it is a good thing that I now tell our own stories,

[4]In (159c), the variant *-kɛ* of the connective *-kä* seems to be due to a need for dissimilation from the immediately preceding conditional auxiliary *kä.*

[5]Marchese (1986c:239f) calls this pronoun the "catch-all" of the pronoun system, as it is used to refer to "anything abstract, in particular words, actions, whole phrases, or discussions".

-yä wa ˈkɪ ˈsɪɪ ˈnumʊ
ADD2 3P XPOT:NHP ADD3 hear:COM
so that they may also hear them,

-mä **ɪyä** wa ˈkɪ ˈsɪɪ wa ˈbhlɪ fä
ADD4 ADD2 3P XPOT:NHP ADD3 3P country send
and so that they can even take them to their home country.' [sigo 21–23]

In example (158), a sequence of three clauses is conjoined by *ɪyä*. The different actions of a ritual for the dead are explained to the person who is to carry them all out, each action having its own special significance. It is not the order of the actions that is in view here; rather, what is in view is the fact that they are all to be performed.

(158) ˈkɔɔn ˈnylipë lesie ˈkʊ **ɪyä** ˈŋʊ -lɔɔ ˈtɪtɔ
always sweep tomb on ADD2 put there ashes
'… always sweep the tomb on top and put ashes there,

ɪyä ˈŋʊ -lɔɔ -bhʊbhlä -ya wätɪä
ADD2 put there leaves (sp.) ADD2 leaves (sp.)
and put Bubla and Wateea leaves there!

-n pi -läbʊ **ɪyä** -n ˈŋʊ -lɔɔ
2S cook mashed_banana ADD2 2S put there
Cook mashed banana and put it there!' [siamoi 41–46]

8.1.3 The additive connective ˈsɪɪ *'ADD3'*

The additive *ˈsɪɪ* invites the hearer to find information in the context which is strengthened by adding the information of the clause containing *ˈsɪɪ*. The meaning of *ˈsɪɪ* can thus be formulated by the following instruction for interpretation:

- Look in the context for information that is strengthened by the information given in the clause containing *ˈsɪɪ*.

The strengthening of information can happen in several ways, which the hearer is able to derive in a given context and which will be referred to as the different contextual effects of *ˈsɪɪ*.[6] Depending on which contextual effect is aimed at by the author, the connective may be translated into English as 'also', 'too', 'even', 'after all', 'indeed', or 'furthermore'.

The position of the connective *ˈsɪɪ* is always after the verb, or after the auxiliary if there is a verb brace. However, elements that are semantically close to the predicate precede *ˈsɪɪ*, such as the low prominence particle *lä,* as in example (159a), or a tense particle, as in example (159b).

(159) a. -n yää' puë -amʊ -mä kä n puë- lä **ˈsɪɪ**
2S XPER:1SO save 1S:TH ADD4 ASF 1S save:2SO LOP ADD3
'You saved me, now I am saving you, too.' [sigo 168–169]

b. ɔ yä bhɛ ˈkɔgwlɛ plä ˈnɪ -amʊ -mä
3S XPER PST2 old_age enter ADD1 1S:TH ADD4
'… he had become old and, as for me,

[6]See Blass (1990:134-160) for her groundbreaking treatment of a similar particle in the Sissala [sld] language of Burkina Faso.

n yä **bhɛ** **'sɪɪ** 'kɔgwlɛ plä
1S XPER PST2 ADD3 old_age enter
I had also become old …' [elisabet 24–25]

8.1.3.1 The connective 'sɪɪ *and parallel strengthening*

As Blass (1990:144) points out, parallel strengthening means that the hearer is required to draw the same conclusion from the two parallel utterances. The conclusion that is strengthened by the utterance containing *'sɪɪ* often remains implicit but can be provided by the hearer through the discourse context. However, it can also be made explicit by the speaker, as in example (160a), taken from a Bible story freely told back by the speaker.

(160) a. -amʊ Zakalii n yä 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä
1S:TH Zachariah 1S XPER old_age enter SP1
'As I, Zachariah, I have become old,

nn -lä yɪɔ yu gää
1S:XNEG yet anymore child beget
I will no longer beget a child,

'nɪ 'naa 'ŋnɔ yä **'sɪɪ** 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä
ADD1 my wife XPER ADD3 old_age enter SP1
and my wife has also become old,

aa -lä yɪɔ 'yu gää
1P:XNEG yet anymore child beget
we will no longer beget a child.' [elisabet 29–31]

b. -n yää' puë -amʊ -mä kä n puë- lä **'sɪɪ**
2S XPER:1SO save 1S:TH ADD4 ASF 1S save:2SO LOP ADD3
'You saved me, now I am saving you, too.' [sigo 168]

c. ɔ yä bhɛ 'kɔgwlɛ plä 'nɪ -amʊ -mä
3S XPER PST2 old_age enter ADD1 1S:TH ADD4
'He had become old and, as for me,

n yä bhɛ **'sɪɪ** 'kɔgwlɛ plä
1S XPER PST2 ADD3 old_age enter
I had **also** become old.' [elisabet 24–25]

8.1.3.2 The connective 'sɪɪ *and backwards confirmation*

Backwards confirmation (see Blass 1990:145ff.) is the second major contextual effect of the additive connective *'sɪɪ*. In this case *'sɪɪ* provides additional evidence for a conclusion already established in the context, rather than giving a parallel premise for a conclusion that needs to be drawn yet, as happens in parallel strengthening discussed above.[7]

[7]It could be argued that parallel strengthening is only a special case of backwards strengthening, as the parallel premise is also evidence towards the same conclusion.

In the context of backwards confirmation, the translations of *'sɪɪ* into English are ‘also’, ‘too’, ‘indeed’, ‘furthermore’, and ‘after all’, as illustrated in example (161).[8]

(161) a. ɪ plöö- gämalɪ
NHP BE2:CP play:NOM
‘It’s about having fun.

'ɪzä n pä lä **'sɪɪ** -lɔɔ 'nünë 'yɪ
CLU1 1S throw:ICP LOP ADD3 there tale DDEM
That’s why I am telling that story, after all.’ [creation 145–146]

b. -mɔ -bhlogbe 'co -mɔ plöö- lä -anyɪa 'yu
2S:TH one_single ID 2S:TH BE2:CP LOP 1P:GEN child
‘You alone, you are our child,

-lɔɔ Laagɔ nyɪ -anyɪ lä nä 'ɪzä n mii-
DPF God give 1PO LOP SP CLU1 1S be_able:CP
the one God has given us. That is why I seize the opportunity

'nɪ n sonö-ö lä **'sɪɪ** 'sɔɔ
ADD1 1S speak:APL:2SO:ICP LOP ADD3 thus
to **also** tell you about that.’ [elisabet 102–105]

8.1.3.3 The connective 'sɪɪ and pseudo-relatives

Utterances that are introduced by the pseudo-relatives *whoever, whenever,* and *whatever* in English are expressed with *'sɪɪ* in Godié, as in example (162).[9]

(162) a kä lä **'sɪɪ** 'gwɛ 'ni 'nɪ ɛ
2P XCND LOP ADD3 chimpanzee find ADD1 NH2
‘So whenever you see a chimpanzee

kä lä ɛɛ numnuu 'plöplönyʊä tlaa nä
XCND LOP NH2:GEN lip pass:pass_people show SP1
and it shows its lips to all who pass…’ [gwebhutu 53–54]

8.1.4 The additive connective **-mä** *‘ADD4’*

The connective *-mä* constrains an interpretation of the following material as an addition. It instructs the hearer to consider the following material as setting off in a different direction than the preceding material. The function of *-mä* could in fact be compared with a cut on a film strip, which generally involves some change of perspective of the camera.

In a narrative context, the occurrence of *-mä* means that the information to be added does not advance the narrative along its event line. Rather, it instructs the hearer to interpret the following information as being of a non-event, background nature. That information can be descriptive. It may be about a state that by normal standards should be the case but isn’t, or it may be about an event that should have happened but did not happen.[10]

[8]The German translation would have a so-called modal *auch* where English has ‘after all’.
[9]The term ‘pseudo-relative’ is used by Blass (1990:151). The Godié connective *'sɪɪ* behaves quite similarly to the particle *má* in the Sissala language analysed by Blass, with the sense of an English pseudo-relative.
[10]Such information is also called collateral information by Grimes (1975:64) and Levinsohn (2007:68).

The instruction for interpretation given by *-mä* can be formulated as follows:

- Add the information expressed after *-mä,* but consider narrative progress as stalled until further notice.

Even though the connective *-mä* can often be translated into English as 'but' or 'however', *-mä* is to be considered an additive and not a countering connective. The countering senses (such as contrast, counterexpectation, and concession) that are quite frequent with this connective are pragmatic effects of *-mä* that occur in certain contexts but they are not part of the instructional meaning of *-mä.* Examples (163a) and (163b) illustrate the pragmatic effect of counterexpectation of the connective *-mä.*

(163) a. Jübënyebluoo- -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä kɔ -mö
Neyo_lad:DEF:REL leave:CP LOP there mouth:OBL SP1 ASF:3S go:CP
'The Neyo lad who had escaped,

ɔ 'bäsɪ soo -kä **-mä** wa 'nɪ -wʊ -nʊawlɛ laa
3S father:PL speak PUR ADD4 3P XNEG:NHP CNT2 truth call
he went to tell his elders, and/but they did not believe it.' [neyo 37:1–3]

b. -a bhibhie- Laagɔ -a 'gä 'yu gää
1P pray:CP God 1P XPOT child beget
'We prayed to God that we might have a child

-mä -aa 'kɔɔkɔ 'yu gää
ADD4 1P:XNEG ever child beget
but we had never had one.' [elisabet 8–10]

The negative clause can also come first, as in examples (164a-c).

(164) a. -dʊdʊʊ' wɛ -kʊ **-mä** jie -bhlobhlo wlä
earth:XNEG PST3 BE1 ADD4 ocean alone PST3:LOP
'the earth didn't exist, but (or: though/however) the ocean was there.' [creation 18–19]

b. Fädɪnyʊa **-mä** wa 'nɪ yɪɔ 'mö 'nuu
Fanti_people:DEF ADD4 3P XNEG:NHP anymore VPC understand
'Now as for the Fanti, they did not want to listen to reason anymore;

-mä 'yizlɛ wa -kʊ ylä
ADD4 anger 3P BE1:CP now:LOP
rather, they were now angry.' [neyo 17.1–2]

c. nyɪkpaa' -wʊ -lɔɔ 'nyie yëku -kʊ
people:XNEG CNT2 there lagoon beside BE1:CP
'… there were no people there by the lagoon,

-mä bhloobhlo lʊä -kʊ -lɔɔ
ADD4 a_few IPF BE1:CP there
though a few were around' [greve 64–65]

If there is tail-head linkage (see §4.2.3), *-mä* occurs at the beginning of the subordinate head clause, as in example (165).

(165) nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe ɔmɔ wa laa lä 'Lulu
person one_single 3S:TH they call LOP Lulu
'There was a certain man called (lit. it is him they call) Lulu.

ɔmɔ -ɔ -gää lä ɔɔ ŋnʊgbɛnyʊä 'sɔ
3S:TH REL:3S beget:CP LOP 3S:GEN girl:PL two
He (lit. it was he who) had two girls (lit. procreated his two girls).

-mä ŋnʊgbɛnyʊänä 'sɔ ɔ -gä lä naa kä wa 'mɛmɛ
ADD4 girl:PL:DEM two 3S beget:CP LOP SP1 ASF 3P be_stuck_together
Now, these two girls that he had they were stuck to each other.' [siamoi 13–16]

On the other hand, where there is a point of departure, *-mä* is placed after it. It then acts as a spacer (see introduction to chapter 9), as in examples (166a) and (166b) (also see example (164b) above). Note that in example (166a) there is no contrast involved. Rather, the attention shifts to other participants. In example (166b), the clause introduced by *-mä* gives known background information about the participant, before the action continues.[11]

(166) a. ɔ -soo ɔ 'bäsɪ
3S speak:CP 3S elders
'He spoke to his elders.

wamä **-mä** waa' -wʊ -bʊä
3P:TH ADD4 3P:XNEG CNT2 be_slow:CP
Now as for them, they weren't slow to act,

kwa bhlüü- tëvëlɪɪ 'kʊ
ASF:3P take:CP weapon:PL VPC
they actually took weapons …' [neyo 44.4–45.2]

b. 'nɪ -Sʊmabolu yi yi. Ʊmʊ **-mä** ʊʊ pio lä nä
ADD1 Worm XFUT come NH3:TH ADD4 NH3:XNEG hurry LOP SP1
'… and Worm came. Now as for him, he wasn't fast

dɪgasä 'nɪ ʊ yi ŋë
slowly ADD1 NH3 XFUT arrive
it was slowly that he arrived.' [kokoleko 35–37]

8.1.5 The additive connective -mää *'ADD5'*

The additive connective *-mää* and its variant form *-maa* signal the transition to a new phase of the underlying mental scheme of the narrative (see chapter 9). The procedural meaning of *-mää* can thus be formulated by the following instruction for interpretation:

- Consider the information following *-mää* as belonging to a new major section in the narrative.

[11]Note in example (169) that 'nɪ acts as a spacer, like *mä* before.

Thus the connective occurs at the transition point between the introduction of the narrative and the beginning of the story, as in example (167a), or at the transition point to the complication phase, as in (167b). The scope of this connective is thus much larger than that of the other connectives.[12]

(167) a. **-mää** -zëküü' 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- bhlä nä
ADD5 adjacent_day:GEN day:DEF NH3:REL pass:CP PST1:LOP SP1
'Now **yesterday** (lit. the one day from now that passed),

ʊmʊ 'kʊ nä wälɪklë -bhlogbe -bhlü bhä
NH3:TH on SP1 matter:part one_single fall PST1
that day (lit. on it) a certain thing happened.' [greve 15–17]

b. 'nɪ ɛ yi -mɔɔ 'plöö 'nɪ ɛ yi sä pu o
ADD1 NH2 XFUT LOC pass:APL ADD1 NH2 XFUT VPC lie:down EXCL2
'then he went inside and lay down!

-maa, 'gwɛ puu- sä
ADD5 chimpanzee lie_down:CP VPC
However, when the chimpanzee had lain down,

-mä plɛɛ' bhlüe- -wʊ
ADD4 liver:XNEG be_quiet:CP CNT2
his heart wasn't at peace.' [gwebhutu 19–22]

8.2 Countering connectives

As discussed in §8.1.1 and §8.1.4 above, the additive connectives *'nɪ* and *-mä* can have countering or adversative readings in certain contexts. In other words, they may yield countering or adversative contextual effects. By contrast, a true countering connective always constrains a countering interpretation, as Levinsohn (2007:191) points out: "If a particular connective constrains a countering or adversative interpretation, then it will *always* introduce material that counters some event or expectation." The only connectives in Godié that have been found to correspond to this description are *-bhlɛ* and *-w*ʊ.

8.2.1 The connective -bhlɛ *'CNT1'*

The word *-bhlɛ* in Godié occurs not only as a countering connective but also as a time adverb with the meaning 'for the time being', 'for now', or 'at this point'.[13] The countering connective *-bhlɛ* results from the reanalysis of this adverb. A few examples of *-bhlɛ* as an adverb will be given before discussing *-bhlɛ* as a countering connective.[14]

(168) a. -lɔɔ n bhloo **-bhlɛ**
there 1S stop:ICP for_now
'There I stop for now.' [elisabet 110]

[12]Its increased phonetic substance can be seen as a case of iconicity, inasmuch as it correlates with a larger scope.
[13]Gratrix (1978:314) and Marchese (1978:70) mention a low tone particle *bɛɛ* in the Jluko dialect of Godié used for connecting two clauses that express simultaneous events. This particle appears to be the equivalent of *-bhlɛ* in the Kagbo dialect described in this study.
[14]In example (171) the form of the pronoun ɔɔ orients to the phonological form of the referent *'pɛpɛlɪɔ*, rather than to its gender, which is non-human plural (see §2.2).

b. säsä -a 'gä bhä nʊ -yä 'pɛpɛlɪɔ -a -yi lä **-bhlɛ** nä
how? 1P XPOT QW do ADD2 little 1P know LOP for_now SP
'… what can we do (lit. how can we act) so that the little that we know at this point,

ɔɔ 'kä -kä bhä 'kʊ büoo
NHP:XNEG XPOT CLU3 QW VPC forget:PSV:Q
it will not be forgotten?' [soutien 49–51]

In narrative texts, the adverb *-bhlɛ* is used with durative events that are set off against another event, generally one that is more salient. The narrative is then put on hold as it were, while attention is directed to the process during which the next event of the narrative takes place. The presence of *-bhlɛ* in the first clause anticipates that next event referred to in the second clause, as shown in examples (169a) and (169b). This use of *-bhlɛ* thus already shows characteristics of a connective, even though it does not link the information of the clause to information already given but rather to upcoming information. The adverb *sää*, translated 'in this way', frequently occurs in the first clause describing the process, as illustrated in (169b). The two clauses are linked by the connective *'nɪ*.[15]

(169) a. a 'kä **-bhlɛ** bhlü 'nɪ Goplëa yi yi
NH1 XPOT CNT1 fall ADD1 Gopleu:DEF XFUT come
'It (the tree) was about to fall when Gopleu came …' / 'As it (the tree) was about to fall, Gopleu came …' [sigo 274–275]

b. ɛ cie **-bhlɛ** sää -dʊdʊ ŋëlɪ
NH2 begin:ICP CNT1 in_this_way ground arrive:NOM
'He (= the chimpanzee) was about to reach the ground

'nɪ -gbäpʊʊ 'kpɔtɔ- lä -mɔɔ ŋɔkʊ
ADD1 ridge_beam break:CP LOP LOC above
when the ridge beam broke there above (him) …' / 'As he (= chimpanzee) was about to reach the ground, the central pillar broke there above him …' [gwebhutu 33–34]

Examples like the preceding ones provide the basis for the reanalysis of the adverb *-bhlɛ* as a countering connective. Indeed, an event in process and a punctiliar event that happens during this process can easily be seen to be in contrast, in the same way as two simultaneous events do.[16] By further generalization of the idea of contrast, *-bhlɛ* is then gradually reanalyzed as a countering connective.

The process of reanalysis is likely to have been favoured by syntactic contexts where the verb has no object and *-bhlɛ* thus ends the clause expressing the process. This position makes it possible to reanalyse *-bhlɛ* as introducing the second clause. Such reanalysis has likely taken place in example (170) where the transcriber of the recorded text treats *-bhlɛ* as a connective and even has it begin a new sentence.[17] Moreover, in this example the two clauses connected by *-bhlɛ* are clearly in contrast, which favours the reanalysis of *-bhlɛ* as a countering connective.[18]

[15]The second English translation in these examples better reflects the fact that the Godié connective looks forward.
[16]Compare conjunctions like *as* in the sense of *while* in English, *während* in German, and *tandis que* in French, which can all be used in a temporal sense for connecting simultaneous events, as well as for non-temporal contrast.
[17]The recording still needs to be rechecked to see whether *-bhlɛ* is pronounced with more voice volume than the preceding element. If so, that would confirm its renanalysis as introducing the following clause.
[18]Interestingly enough, Gratrix (1978:314) also mentions a use of the *bɛɛ* particle in the Jluko dialect of Godié where it acts as what she calls a "rhetorical connective not limited to simple clauses."

(170) ʋ mʋ nä ʋ yi
NH3 go:ICP SP1 NH3 come:ICP
'… it (his boat) comes and goes (fast).

-bhlɛ waa -lʋʋ, kʋ bʋä
CNT1 3P:GEN DPF:NH3 ASF:NH3 be_slow:ICP
However, as for theirs, it is slow …' [greve 43–45]

The instruction for interpretation for the countering connective *-bhlɛ* can thus be formulated as follows:

- Look for a way in which the information in the clauses before and after *-bhlɛ* can be seen to be in contrast.

Example (171) illustrates how the idea of simultaneity is still present in the use of *-bhlɛ* as a countering connective.

(171) 'klaa 'mnö sukpɔ -kʋ -mɔɔ
field:DEF inside ants BE1:CP LOC
'In the field there were ants (sp.),

-bhlɛ sukpɔnʋ suwa 'nɪ ʋʋ wälɪɪ
CNT1 ants:DEM sting:3P:ICP ADD1 NH3:GEN matter:DEF
(but) even though these ants were stinging them

wa 'nɪ -wʋ 'mänyɪ
3P XNEG:NHP CNT2 mind
they didn't care about it.' [cacao 69–71]

8.2.2 The connective **-wʋ** *'CNT2'*

The vast majority of occurrences of the countering connective *-wʋ* are found in negative clauses, as illustrated in example (172).

(172) nyɪkpaa' **-wʋ** -lɔɔ 'nyie yëku -kʋ
people:XNEG CNT2 there lagoon beside BE1:CP
'… there were no people around on the shore of the lagoon …' [greve 64]

Occurrences in affirmative clauses have been found only in imperatives within represented speech, as in examples (173a-c). The reason for the imperative is some unexpected situation, which the speaker signals by *-wʋ*. In examples (173a) and (173b) that situation is described subsequently in the represented speech itself, while in example (173c) it was mentioned previously by the narrator.[19]

(173) a. dunyʋa lä ɔ a po **-wʋ** 'nyukwli
village_people:DEF say EXCL1 2P listen CNT2 VC (ears)
'The villagers said, "Oh, listen!"

[19]It is not clear why in example (178c) the connective *-wʋ* is repeated. The word *-zɪkä* does not have its usual meaning 'today' here but rather something like 'presently' or 'shortly'. In fact, the latter meaning may well be the basic meaning of this word, with the translation 'today' just rendering one of its contextual meanings.

-mä -awlii' klaa' -blɔɔ 'kʊ [sese]
ADD4 our_friend:GEN field:DEF:GEN road on NUPT
The path to our friend's field,

'nʊgbʊwälı ghlä -kä -mɔɔ
mourning_words pass CLU3 LOC
wailing is (unexpectedly) coming from there!"' [lueuzi 64–65]

b. duu' 'kɔgwlɛnyʊa […] wlä a yi **-wʊ** -zıkä
village:GEN world:last-long:AG:PL:DEF 3P:say 2P come CNT2 at_present
'The village elders […], they said, "Let's get together shortly,

[sese] -mä 'ŋnɔɔ' 'wugä -bhɔɔ lä 'wlu [sese]
NUPT ADD4 woman:DEF:GEN soul leave:3S LOP head NUPT
as the woman has had a rough time (lit. the woman's soul left from her head)."'
[lueuzi 92–94]

c. ɔ lä -n yi **-wʊ** -zıkä -wʊ
3S say 2S come CNT2 at_present CNT2
'… saying, "Come here!"' [filsprod 188]

The procedural meaning of *-wʊ* can thus be described by the following instruction for interpretation:

- Look for a situation in the context that is contrary to expectation.

This instruction is also valid in negative clauses, where *-wʊ* has practically been generalized. Indeed, each negative clause contains the 'voice' of a different enunciator who is the author of the corresponding affirmative clause.[20] The negative clause typically expresses a counter-expectation. In example (174) the narrator tells the audience that the story he is about to tell will not contain a song. This is contrary to their expectation, since Godié stories normally do contain songs.

(174) -nanä n pä ylä nä [sese] aa' -wʊ ' 'lʊ' -kä
DEMPR 1S throw:ICP now:LOP SP1 NUPT NH1:XNEG CNT2 song have
'This one (= story) that I am telling here, it doesn't have a song.' (creation 66–67)

Concerning the numerous instances where the element *-wʊ* occurs in negative utterances, the question arises as to whether the preceding instruction for interpretation can be applied to those utterances or whether *-wʊ* in negative utterances is grammaticalized and part of the negative construction requiring the negative auxiliary and *-wʊ*.[21] The following facts do not seem to support the view that *-wʊ* is grammaticalized. First, *-wʊ* occurs neither in negative imperatives (to negate possible future events or states) nor in negative conditional clauses. Moreover, in conditional clauses, the negative auxiliary *'nö* alone expresses negation, as shown in example (175).

(175) a 'nö gäma nä
2P XNEG play SP1
'… and if you are not having fun…' [lueuzi 9]

[20]This is argued in the polyphonic approach to negation, as described by Roulet (1996).
[21]This would then be a situation similar to French, where negation is regularly expressed by a pair of negative elements, such as in the utterance *Cela ne me concerne pas* 'That does not concern me', where the elements *ne* and *pas* are both grammatically necessary.

Finally, in negative imperatives and future negation, the particle *-lä* replaces *-wv*.

(176) a. plɛ 'kʊ'ʊ sii- -lä
liver on:XNEG burn:2SO DP2
'… don't be angry (lit. your liver surface may not burn you) …' [filsprod 277]

b. n 'nöö- -lä të [-kpazebhleku]
1S XNEG:2SO DP2 leave_behind NUPT
'… I will not leave you behind.' [kokoleko 134]

8.3 Conclusive connectives

A conclusive connective is a linguistic element inviting the hearer to interpret the information of the utterance that contains the connective or that is introduced by the connective as the conclusion drawn from some information the hearer already has. Its presence conveys an argumentative tenor to the text, which is most certainly the reason why conclusive connectives are rare in narrative, except in represented speech. Rather than being constrained by a conclusive connective, a logical relationship between two pieces of information in narrative is typically left to the hearer to infer on the basis of contextual information and the presence of an additive connective (see §8.1).

Three conclusive connectives have been identified in Godié narratives. They are the phrases *'ɪzä* 'CLU1' and ɪɪ *'ŋnö 'mnö* 'CLU2', and the particle *-kä* 'CLU3'. One difference between them seems to be the strength of the causal link between the connected pieces of information. This can also be rendered in their translation into English. The expression '(it was) because of that' as a translation of *ɯ 'ŋnö 'mnö* CLU2 constrains a stronger link than 'for that reason' for *'ɪzä* CLU1, and a translation by 'so' of *-kä* CLU3 reflects the fact that CLU3 constrains the weakest link of the three connectives.[22]

Another difference between the three connectives appears to be whether the causal link is established at the time of speaking, which applies to the connectives *'ɪzä* 'CLU1'and ɪɪ *'ŋnö 'mnö* 'CLU2', or whether it is assumed to be already part of the hearer's contextual assumptions and thus only called back to mind, as seems to be the case with *-kä* 'CLU3'.

8.3.1 The connective 'ɪzä *'CLU1'*

Unlike the connectives dealt with in the preceding sections, *'ɪzä* is still analysable, in a similar way to its suggested English translation 'that is why'. It is actually a genitival nominal phrase and could therefore also be spelled ɪɪ *-zä* (NHP:GEN/reason). The latter spelling shows that the connective is composed of the plural form of the non-human simple pronoun (NHP) and the nominal element *-zä*. The exact meaning of *-zä is* difficult to determine but the word is probably best translated as 'reason'.[23]

The pronoun of the connective refers back to preceding material, which can be just the preceding utterance or several preceding utterances, or even a whole narrative, as in example (177). The scope of the connective is thus left to the hearer to establish.[24]

(177) a. Laagɔ 'mɔ -ɔ cii- nynä n 'pɔnyɪ nä
God TH REL speak SP2 1S throw:3S:NHP SP1
'It was God who said that I am to give it (=name) to him,

[22]This is again an illustration of the iconocity principle, where more linguistic material in an expression corresponds to the additional weight and importance given to the information, in this case the causal link between two pieces of information.

[23]It could be compared to the English word *sake*, incidentally semantically close to Godié *-zä,* which is also clearly a nominal element but occurs only within a genitival construction that is part of a prepositional phrase, e.g., 'for my sake'.

[24]In example (182), the plural form of the pronoun on *'pɔnyɪ* refers to the word *'ŋnö* 'name', which is treated as a plural. For the nasal consonant /ny/ inserted between the two object pronouns, see §2.2.

'ɪzä n -pɔɔnyɪ
CLU1 1S throw:CP:3S:NHP
that is why I gave it to him.' [elisabeth 94–96]

b. -a yä bhɛ anyɪ soo nynä a 'nö pää -lä 'sɪɪ
1P XPER PST4 2PO speak SP2 2P XNEG throw DP2 ADD3
'We had told you that you were not to throw the fishing net either,

'piloo 'kʊ **'ɪzä** -a bhlüü- lä anyɪa 'piloo 'kʊ
fishing_net:DEF VPC CLU1 1P take:CP LOP 2P:GEN fishing_net:DEF VPC
that is why we took your fishing net.' [neyo 13.1–3]

c. **ɪɪ -zä** n pä lä 'naa 'nünë o
CLU1 1S throw LOP 1S:GEN tale EXCL2
'**That is why** I was telling my story!' [kazo 70]

The procedural meaning of the connective *'ɪzä* can thus be described by the following instruction for interpretation:

- Look for the information which is the reason for or which explains the action or state expressed in the clause introduced by *'ɪzä*.

8.3.2 The connective ɪɪ 'ŋnö 'mnö *'CLU2'*

The connective ɪɪ *'ŋnö 'mnö* (NHP:GEN/name/inside) 'CLU2' seems to invite the hearer to construct a stronger logical link between the connected pieces of information than ɪɪ *-zä* 'CLU1'. Like CLU1, CLU2 is a phrase, though not a nominal but a postpositional one. The literal meaning is 'in its name'. It is best translated into English by the expression 'because of that'.

(178) ɪ -ŋwa 'kʊ nynä -a 'bä Fʊfʊɛ 'titi nii- a -lɔɔ
NHP be_suitable VPC SP2 1P father Houphouet self see:NHP PST2 there
'It is suitable that our father Houphouet himself would see these things,

ɪyä wa 'kɔ -mɔɔ 'kubhutuu' -sä
ADD2 3P XPOT:3S LOC dead:house:OBL take_away
so they could take him (=the body) there out of the morgue.

ɪɪ 'ŋnö 'mnö ɔ -yä ɔɔ lebhenʊnyʊa 'sɔ […]
CLU2 3S ADD2 3S:GEN work:do:AG:PL:DEF two
Because of that he and his ministers (lit. workers) […],

wa wlää- -mɔɔ 'kubhutu 'mnö 'wlu
3P get_together:CP LOC dead_house inside VC (head)
they gathered there inside the morgue.' [decesrad 11–13]

The causal link between the connected pieces of information seems to be even stronger when the spacer *nä* 'SP1' separates the connective from the rest of the utterance, as in example (179).[25] A possible rendering in English would be the cleft structure 'it was because of that'.

[25]The connective then functions as a point of departure (see §4.2).

(179) **ɯ 'ŋnö 'mnö** nä 'gokpünyıkpaa' 'mnö 'nöwa -wʊ mɛmä-
CLU2 SP1 boat_people:DEF:GEN inside XNEG:3P CNT2 be_sweet:PRC:CP
'It was because of that that the boat people were not happy.' [greve 30–31]

The hearer is instructed to establish an even stronger causal relation between the connected pieces of information when the spacer *nä* not only follows but also precedes the conclusive phrase ɪɪ *'ŋnö 'mnö* 'CLU2', as in example (180). Indeed, in initial position the spacer *nä* takes an inferential sense (see §7.1).[26]

(180) 'nɪ ɪ mɪa nyıkpa -bhutukpä 'tänyı 'kʊ
ADD1 NHP overflow:ICP people many time VPC
'… and they (=the boats) are wasting a lot of people's time.

nä **ɯ 'ŋnö 'mnö** nä nyıkpɔ -bhlogbe ɔ -nʊ sää
SP1 CLU2 SP1 person one_single 3S make:CP DP1
So it was because of that that a certain man, he took

ɔɔ gɔlʊlɛɛ 'nɪ ɔ ŋʊɔ- masii
3S:GEN canoe:DIM ADD1 3S put:NH3:CP motor
his small canoe and put a motor on it.' [greve 23–26]

Another variant of the connective CLU2 is the clause ɪ *-kä 'ŋnöö* (NHP/have.CP/name:DEF), literally translated as 'it has the name'.[27] The precise nuance of meaning cannot be established on the basis of the present data, but in example (181), the connective seems to have the sense of 'this even led to the fact that' or 'this even meant that'.[28]

(181) **ɪ -kä 'ŋnöö** waa ducifio ɔ -mʊ
CLU2 3P:GEN village:chief:DEF 3S go:CP
'This even meant that their village chief, he went

'nɪ ɔ -zla ɔ 'nagɔ -bhlo gɔlʊ
ADD1 3S ask 3S friend one canoe
to ask one of his friends for a canoe.' [greve 57]

8.3.3 The connective -kä *'CLU3'*

The conclusive connective *-kä* 'CLU3' mostly occurs in represented speech in Godié narratives and also in their coda. The causal link between the connected pieces of information is not asserted by the speaker at the time of speaking but rather assumed to be already part of the hearer's contextual assumptions.[29] The connective *-kä* occurs after the verb or the auxiliary.

---

[26]This pronoun clitic ɔ is actually the human singular pronoun (see §2.2) and thus does not agree in gender with the noun *gɔlʊlɛɛ* it stands for, which would call for the non-human pronoun *ʊ*. The resulting form would be ŋʊʊ-, where the pronoun clitic would no longer be distinct from the verb root. Thus the form ɔ of the pronoun clitic seems to be motivated by the will to distinguish the two—in other words, from a process of dissimilation.
[27]Further study may well lead to the conclusion that *ɪ -kä 'ŋnöö* should be treated as a distinct connective and not just as a variant of *ɯ 'ŋnö 'mnö* 'CLU2'.
[28]The absence of the definite marker on the noun *'nagɔ* in this example implies that the friend is a member of a set of friends. For this meaning (see §2.3.1).
[29]The French connective *puisque* (see Ducrot 1983) and the German connective *ja* (Weydt et al. 1983) also have this characteristic.

It will be argued here the connective *-kä* 'CLU3' has developed from the purpose particle *-kä* 'PUR', which is also placed after the verb and indicates the purpose of someone's going somewhere or coming from somewhere, as illustrated in example (182).

(182) Jübënyëbluo -ɔ -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä
Neyo:lad:DEF 3S:REL leave:CP LOP there mouth:OBL SP1
'The Neyo lad who had escaped,

kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsɪ soo **-kä**
ASF:3S go:CP 3S father:PL speak PUR
he went to tell his elders …' [neyo 37.1–2]

The shift from the purpose particle *-kä* 'PUR' to the conclusive connective *-kä* 'CLU3' can be explained by an extension of the idea of purpose to a more general idea of result and conclusion. This may have happened along the following cognitive path.

A purposeful action aims at a result. That result is thus related to the action that motivated it. The purpose particle *-kä* 'PUR' indicates the link between a person's movement and the action it aims at. The particle *-kä* 'PUR' therefore connects information about two actions, namely an action of moving to a different place and an action that is the purpose of that movement. In that sense *-kä* 'PUR' already has characteristics of a connective, even though it connects information between a main clause and an embedded clause rather than information between two clauses at the same syntactic level.

It may be argued that this function of indicating that two actions are in a purpose relation is still the basic function of the connective *-kä* 'CLU3' except that it is no longer required that the first action be a movement, as is the case with the purpose particle *-kä* 'PUR'. Instead, any two actions or situations in a purpose relation can be connected by *-kä* 'CLU3'. Thus by using *-kä* 'CLU3'*,* the speaker invites the hearer to discover a purposeful relation between the utterance and another piece of information, generally an action or a situation. This type of relation can be translated into English by quite a range of inferential connectives, such as 'so', 'then', and 'thus', but also 'however' or 'but', depending on which aspect of the relation is in focus in a given context. In other words, then, *-kä* 'CLU3' invites the hearer to make an inference.[30]

The presence of *-kä* 'CLU3' conveys a nuance of insistence to the utterance in which it occurs. This appears to be precisely due to the speaker's inviting the hearer to become aware of the purposeful relation between information given in the current utterance and information in the context.[31] (The notion of context here includes information given in the immediate discourse context, information established earlier in the same discourse or in a previous discourse, information that is part of common knowledge between the speakers or within their social groups, and finally also information that is part of the knowledge about the world and the universe.)

The procedural meaning of the connective *-kä* 'CLU3' can thus be formulated by the following instruction for interpretation:

- Find the information in the context to which the information in the current utterance can be connected by inference.

In many cases, the contextual information the hearer is invited to access by way of the connective *-kä* 'CLU3' is a piece of information established in the immediate discourse context, or co-text, as in

[30]The connective *sɪɛ* in the Sissala language of Burkina Faso, a Gur language, seems to share several properties with Godié *-kä* 'CLU3'. Blass (1990:130ff) translates it into English by 'so', 'after all', and 'well', all of which also invite the hearer to make an inference.

[31]For this reason our initial analysis of *-kä* treated it as an attitudinal (modal) particle, rather than a connective. However, the fact that it clearly establishes a link between information given in the utterance where it occurs and information given in the context led to a reanalysis of *-kä* as a connective.

examples (183a) and (183b), both of which are protests to the preceding utterance in a represented conversation.[32]

(183) a. wlä 'ɔɔ -naa 'lɔlʊkpa 'mlö nyɪkpɔɔ' **-kä** Zan plöö-
3P:say EXCL1 2S:GEN family inside person:XNEG CLU3 John BE2:CP
'They said, "Well, in your family no one is called John, though, …"' [elisabet 91]

b. -mä -ɔ -kä bhlä wälɪɪ nä
ADD4 3S:RE have PST1:LOP matter:DEF SP1
'But the one who was responsible for the matter,

ɔmɔɔ- plöö- **-kä** bhlä 'Nɛmʊ
3S:TH:REL BE2:CP CLU3 PST1:LOP Red_Deer
that one was Red Deer, wasn't it?' [creation 122–123]

In example (184), the blind protagonist Sigo protests against the bird Gopleu's order to open his eyes. The connective *-kä* occurs in each clause. by the first *-kä* Sigo reminds Gopleu of his blindness, which makes it impossible to carry out the bird's order, while the second *-kä* establishes the common sense relation between blindness and not being able to see.

(184) -amʊ 'naa 'yii ŋwɛɛ- **-kä** 'kʊ
1S:TH 1P:GEN eyes:DEF be_closed:CP CLU3 VPC
'Well, as for me, (you know that) my eyes are shut

'nɪ nn' 'ni **-kä** sä [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 1S:XNEG see CLU3 VPC NUPT
and so I cannot see…' [sigo 137–138]

In example (185) *-kä* invites the heares to make an inference from what was just said.[33]

(185) -mä ɔ -kʊ klë [-kpazebhleku]
ADD4 3S BE1 behind NUPT
'… he (= Rooster) is behind

-mä kɔ yi **-kä** [-kpazebhleku]
ADD4 ASF:3S come CLU3 NUPT
but/so he is coming … [given that we are doing this dance competition together, as I just said].' [kokoleko 94–95]

In expressive utterances, such as expressions of thanks or sympathy, pleas and supplications, the context to be accessed by way of *-kä* is a previous action carried out either in or before the speech situation, as in (186a) and (186b), or a possible future action, as in (186c).

(186) a. lebhe a yɛ nʊ ayayo **-kä**
work:DEF 2P XPER do thanks:PL CLU3
'… the work, you have done it, thank you!' [cacao 75]

[32]If there is an auxiliary, the position of *-kä* is within the verb brace, as in (188) (see §3.1), where the verb brace is formed by the floating high tone clitic of the negative auxiliary 'XNEG' and the verb *'plö* 'BE2'.
[33]The expression *-kpazebhleku* in this example is one of the feedback words from the audience. It is uttered by the intermediary between the narrator and the audience.

b. ayayo **-kä** Gbaklı kläälı -ya
thanks:PL CLU3 Gbakle help:NOM for
‘Thank you for helping Gbakle!

ayayo **-kä** käkäwo -wlälı -ya
thanks:PL CLU3 cocoa break:NOM for
Thank you for breaking cocoa!’ [cacao 99–100]

c. bheeje -nn 'bhlää -lä **-kä**
please 2S:XNEG hit DP2 CLU3
‘… so please forgive me (lit. don’t hit me)!’ [devinet 52]

In example (187) the inference which *-kä* invites the hearer to draw involves knowledge about the taboo linked to the war fetish in question.

(187) -mä -tëbhukänyɔɔ nä
ADD4 responsibilty:have:AG:DEF SP1
‘However, the one who is responsible for the war fetish,

ɔɔ' lü **-kä** gwi
3S:XNEG eat CLU3 palm_nuts
he must not eat palm nuts, as you know.’ [dacligo 16]

In example (188) the connection is based on common knowledge of the world about the fact that normally people build their houses on dry ground.

(188) -zägbä yä yi nyıkpaa wa 'kä **-kä** 'slä [sese]
beach XPER come people:DEF 3P XPOT CLU3 build NUPT
‘… dry ground comes (lit. has come) out, so that the people can build,

wa 'kä -kä sä kʊ wa 'kä **-kä** loo [sese]
3P XPOT CLU3 VPC sit 3P XPOT CLU3 debrush NUPT
so that that they can settle, so that they can clear ground to make fields,

wa 'kä **-kä** lülülʊʊ lü
3P XPOT CLU3 eat:eat:thing:DEF eat
so that they have food to eat.’ [creation 55–59]

In some contexts involving backwards confirmation (see §8.1.3.2), the meaning of the conclusive connective *-kä* ‘CLU3’ appears to be very close to that of the additive *'sıı* ‘ADD3’, to the point that they are even interchangeable in some contexts. Such is the case in example (188) above, where the last three occurrences of *-kä* ‘CLU3’ could be replaced with the additive connective *'sıı* ‘ADD3’.

However, the difference between an utterance containing the additive *'sıı* and one containing the conclusive *-kä* is the following: whereas *'sıı* merely strengthens the preceding assertion, without indicating a logical relation between the current utterance and that assertion, *-kä* instructs the hearer to make an inference and establish a logical connection. In other words, while *'sıı* leaves it up to the hearer to notice a logical connection, *-kä* constrains the reader to do so; hence the nuance of insistence, which is absent when additive *'sıı* is used.[34]

[34]For other examples in the database, see devinet 4, gwebhutu 53, sigo 22–23, greve 45, creation 86–87 in the text collection.

A similar comparison can be made between *-kä* and the countering connective *-wʋ* ‘CNT2’ (see §8.2.2) in imperative utterances, again illustrating the inferential meaning of *-kä.* A particularly telling instance of this was found in one of the folk tales in the database for this study. Two similar situations were described, in each of which a woman comes back from the bush before daybreak carrying her dead child and wailing loudly. In the first clause, the imperative representing the villagers’ speech has the countering connective *-wʋ* ‘CNT2’, as shown in example (189). This connective establishes a link between the current utterance and a situation that is contrary to the speaker’s expectation. Then in the last clause, the conclusive connective *-kä* is present, inviting the hearers to look for a connection between the wailing and something that must have happened to the woman.

(189) dunyʋa lä ɔ a po **-wʋ** 'nyukwli
village_people:DEF say EXCL1 2P listen CNT2 VC (ears)
‘The villagers said, “Oh, listen,

-mä -aawlii' klaa' -blɔɔ 'kʋ [sese]
ADD4 our_friend:GEN field:DEF:GEN road on NUPT
(because) from the road to our friend’s field

'nʋgbʋwälɪ ghlä **-kä** -mɔɔ
mourning_words pass CLU3 LOC
wailing is coming from there (lit. wailing passes there!”’ [lueuzi 64–65a]

Later in the narrative, when another woman, who turns out to be the first woman’s co-wife, comes to the village from the same direction of the bush, carrying her dead child and wailing in the same way, the utterance representing the villagers’ speech already has the conclusive connective *-kä* in the imperative clause. This shows that the speaker is making a connection to the first event. This inference is conveyed in the free translation into English by the connective *again.*

(190) wlä 'o a po **-kä** 'nyukwli -mä -aawlii' 'klänä 'mnö
3P:say EXCL1 2P listen CLU3 VC (ears) ADD4 our_friend:GEN field:DEM inside
‘They said, “Oh listen again, because in that field of our friend’s

gbʋ -bhlobhlo ghlä lä -mɔɔ
problem a_few pass LOP LOC
there are a few problems!”’ [lueuzi 109–110]

Examples (191a) and (191b) illustrate how each of the three occurrences of *-kä* invites the hearer to draw a specific inference, given in brackets in the free translation.[35]

(191) a. ɔ -yi nä kɔ so lä 'kukuŋnɔɔ nynä
3S come:CP SP1 ASF:3S speak LOP be_dead:be_dead:woman:DEM SP2
‘When he came, he spoke to the dead woman, saying

-n nyotoo' -wʋ -lɔɔ -kʋ nä 'naa 'ŋnɔnɔ
2S husband:XNEG CNT2 there BE1:CP SP1 1S:GEN woman:DEM
“As your husband is not here, so my dear woman,

[35]In (196b) *-kɛ* is a variant form of *-kä*. It seems to be used by some older speakers, possibly for purposes of vowel dissimilation. It has been found only after an auxiliary containing the schwa vowel, written in the orthography as *<ä>*. See also the third clause of example (191b) below.

-n kʊ **-kä** -lɔɔ -yä n 'kä duu' 'dö fä
2S BE1 CLU3 there ADD2 1S XPOT village:OBL news send
stay here (given that you are dead) and I'll take the news to the village

-yä -n -nyoto kä **-kɛ** yi nä
ADD2 2S husband XCND CLU3 come:CP SP1
so that when your husband will have come (as a result of the news)

-a 'gä **-kɛ** -naa wälɪɪ bhobho
1P XPOT CLU3 2S:GEN matter:DEF think
we can (then) think about your problem."' [devinet 70–75]

b. -bhlɛ waa -lʊʊ, kʊ bʊä
CNT1 3P:GEN DPF ASF:NH3 be_slow:ICP
'However, as for theirs (= their boat), it is slow, so they won't

'nɪ waa' -lä **-kä** nyɪkpä 'ni 'nɪ
ADD1 3P:XNEG DP2 CLU3 people find ADD1
get customers (as a result)

waa' -lä **-kä** monii 'ni
3P:XNEG DP2 CLU3 money find
and (thus) make no money.' [greve 44–46]

In conditional sentences the conclusive connective *-kä* 'CLU3' may occur both in the conditional clause and in the main clause.[36] The expressed condition then results from a previous conversation. Example (192) shows *-kä* in three different syntactic environments: the conditional clause, the negative imperative of the main clause, and the declarative clause.[37]

(192) -mä 'yua 'sɔ kä **-kä** gäma nä [sese]
ADD4 child:PL:DEF two XCND CLU3 play SP1 NUPT
'but when the two children will play together,

waa' 'bhläbhlä -lä **-kää**, [sese]
3P:XNEG hit:hit DP2 CLU3 NUPT
they must not hit each other!

-mä -amʊ n yä **-kɛ** mʊ a
ADD4 1S:TH 1S XPER CLU3 go EXCL3
As for me, I am gone, then!' [sigo 289–291]

[36]Note that in Godié, as in other African languages, a conditional clause where the condition is still fulfillable (e.g., 'if he comes') has exactly the same structure as a temporal clause that refers to the future ('when he will come'). The hearer decides in the context which interpretation is the relevant one.
[37]The lengthening of the vowel in *-kää* could be due to the pause during which the representative of the audience pronounces the narrative uptake element *sese*.

9 Narrative development

This chapter presents an overview of the linguistic means that are used by a Godié narrator to construct a well-formed story. In doing so the narrator will comply with the quasi-universal mental scheme underlying any kind of narrative. Table 9.1 shows the parts or phases of this scheme, only three of which (those in bold) are mandatory. The latter are found even in so-called minimal narratives.[1]

Table 9.1. The mental scheme of a narrative

Phases of the narrative	Fictive example
Introduction	I'm going to tell you a story.
Initial situation	There was a man who had two sons.
Complication	One day, one of them came to him and asked for his part of the inheritance.
Reaction(s)/attempt(s) to solve the problem	The father refused and the son made plans to kill him.
Peak/climax	The plan was discovered just before the son went to carry it out.
Resolution/dénouement	The father forgave the son.
Final situation	The son left the father.
Coda/moral	This is what it all means…

Note that the complication and reaction phases can be recursive. In other words, a story can contain several complications and reactions before coming to its resolution.[2] Moreover, the peak is not an obligatory part of the story.

The traditional Godié narrator employs a variety of devices that function as linguistic cues to the audience, guiding them through the different stages of the narrative. Younger narrators no longer use some of these cues, as they have had less exposure to the language and the tradition of telling stories. The cues that guide the audience through the narrative are taken from different parts of the language system such as the tense and aspect system, certain syntactic structures and connectives, as well as special markers and set expressions that occur only in a narrative.

Three types of cues for narrative development can be distinguished. These will be discussed in turn below. The first type concerns devices that show that the narrative is moving along within a narrative phase (§9.1). The second type includes devices that mark (the transition to) a new phase in the scheme of the narrative (§9.2). The third type are the cues that mark the status of the information: theme line events versus secondary or background(ed) events (§9.3). These latter cues help the reader to concentrate on the theme line when processing the information provided. Authors often use cues of more than one type in their narratives. This ensures that the hearer keeps abreast with the development of the story.

Traditional Godié stories also include songs that the narrator sings together with the hearers. These songs, which are sung by the narrator and to which the audience responds in a well-defined way, seem to be made up of special formulas and words whose meaning is not always analysable. These songs occur at transition points between the different stages of the narrative. In the database for this study only two of the older narrators made use of this device, which will not be studied any further here.

[1]A minimal narrative might run as follows: "I was on the bus to school [initial stage], when a car hit the bus [complication]. We were all scared to death, but no one was injured and the police came right away. [resolution]." Minimal narratives are extremely frequent in daily conversation and small newspaper reports or as embedded narratives in larger narratives.

[2]See Roulet et al. 2001:317f.

9.1 Moving forward within a narrative phase

The two most important cues showing that the narrative is moving forward are the temporal adverb *yı* 'now' (§9.1.1) and the *yi* clause (§9.1.2). In many cases these two cues occur together with the connective *'nı* and sometimes even with each other.

9.1.1 The temporal adverb **yı** *'now'*

The temporal adverb *yı* has the semantic meaning of 'now' both in the sense of 'at this moment' and in the sense of 'from now on', as in examples (193a) and (193b). This meaning naturally predisposes it to the function of indicating narrative development, since a narrative reports successive events or states of affairs.

(193) a. -n 'gä yı bhlı -a
2S XPOT now sing Q
'Will you sing now?' [creation 10]

b. a po yı 'nyukwli -yä n 'kanyımı yı soo
2P listen now VC (ears) ADD2 1S XPOT:2PO:NHP now speak
'… listen now and I shall speak to you about them.' [radio 19]

The adverb *yı* frequently combines with the particle *lä* (see §4.3.2.1). Losing its vowel in the process, it results in the amalgamated form *ylä* 'now:LOP'. It is frequently found in the tail clause of a tail-head linkage construction (see §4.2.3), as in example (194).

(194) 'nı ɔ yio zizie [sese]
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S bury NUPT
'And she buried him (her child).

-mä ɔ -zizio **ylä** naa [sese]
ADD4 3S bury:CP now:LOP SP1 NUPT
When she had now buried him,…' [lueuzi 90–91]

The function of *ylä* might appear to be contradictory inasmuch as the *yı* element in it points forward towards the next event while the *lä* element backgrounds the event expressed in the current clause. However, this is precisely what happens in a narrative, as the current event becomes part of the background as soon as the next event is presented. In the building up of the narrative plot towards the peak, the adverb *yı* or the form *ylä* can be found in each clause leading up to the peak event, as in examples (195a) and (195b).

(195) a. 'kɔɔkɔ sɔɔ ɔ nʊ **ylä**
always thus 3S do now:LOP
'All the time, that's how she now acted.

'ŋnɔɔ -mʊ **ylä** -zıkä nä [sese]
woman:DEF go:CP now:LOP today SP1 NUPT
When the woman now went one day,

nyikpotütë yä 'kʊ ghlä
black_ants:swarm XPER VPC appear
a swarm of black ants appeared.' [siamoi 52–54]

b. 'yuo puu- **yɪ** -gbɔtʊʊ 'kʊ ɔ yä ŋɔ [sese]
child:DEF lie:CP now bamboo_bed on 3S XPER sleep NUPT
'Now the child lay on the bamboo bed, he is asleep (lit. has slept).

'klaa 'mnö ɔ mʊ **ylä** bi -kä [sese]
field:DEF inside 3S go now:LOP stroll PUR NUPT
She (=the mother) then goes for a stroll into the (rice) field.

'yuo -glɔ **ylä** nä [sese]
child:DEF wake_up:CP now:LOP SP1 NUPT
Now when the child has woken up,

kɔ mʊ **ylä** -mɔɔ 'klaa 'mnö
ASF:3S go:ICP now:LOP LOC field inside
he then goes into the (rice) field.

'säkaa -bɔlɪɪ' wa saa wä [sese]
rice:DEF path:OBL 3P take_away:DSTP2 PST3 NUPT
Formerly they used to make paths into the rice fields.

ʊmʊ ɔ bhlü **ylä** [sese]
NH3:TH 3S take now:LOP NUPT
It was such a path that he (=the child) then took.

Laagɔ nʊ **ylä** wälɪ nä [sese]
God do:ICP now:LOP things SP1 NUPT
Now as God does things,

'ŋnɔɔ mʊ **yɪ** 'wlu ylɪbha -kä nä [sese]
woman:DEF go:ICP now head turn PUR SP1 NUPT
as the woman was now turning her head,

ɔɔ' plɛ nynä mnɛɛ -ɛ yi [sese]
3S:GEN liver SP2 animal NH:REL come:ICP NUPT
she thought it was an animal that was coming.

du ɔ yä 'yuo 'bhlä [sese] ɔ lä
ID 3S XPER child:DEF hit NUPT 3S say
She kills (lit. has killed) her child!

kɔ **wlo** **yɪ**, **-n** **ni** yɪ ɔɔ' 'yu mɔ [sese]
ASF:3S look now 2S find now 3S:GEN child ? NUPT
As she was now looking, there's now her child!' [lueuzi 43–55]

9.1.2 The yi *clause*

In contrast with the temporal adverb *yɪ* 'now', which merely shows that the narrative is moving forward, the presence of the verb *yi* 'come', which is actually the future auxiliary (see §2.5.1), indicates that the action is moving along in the expected way, as shown in example (196a) and b.[3]

(196) a. -mä ɔ nyima monie -aan ʻnɪ monie
ADD4 3S waste:ICP money:DEF a_long_time ADD1 money:DEF
'Now he wasted the money until (lit. for a long time and then), the money,

ɛ **yi**o 'mʊ -bha ɛ **yi**o wlɪɪ' -bhɪä
NH2 XFUT:3S VCP leave NH2 XFUT:3S fingers:OBL be_finished
it was gone, it was finished (lit. it was finished in his fingers).' [filsprod 36–37]

b. ʊʊ' 'mnö -yɛɛ ylä nä
NH3:GEN inside be_dry:CP now:LOP SP1
'When its (=the house) inside had now dried,

ʻnɪ ɛ **yi** -mɔɔ 'plöö
ADD1 NH2 XFUT LOC pass:APL
he (= the chimpanzee) then went in

'nɪ ɛ yi sä pu o
ADD1 NH2 XFUT VPC lie_down EXCL2
and lay down!' [gwebhutu 18–20]

A *yi* clause is typically introduced by the additive connective *'nɪ* 'ADD1'. This is not surprising, given that *'nɪ* establishes a close pragmatic relationship between two pieces of information (see §7.1). A *yi* clause is therefore always part of the same thematic grouping as the preceding clause.

A frequent context for *yi* clauses is after represented speech (see chapter 6). Such *yi* clauses talk about the carrying out of the action that was ordered, recommended, agreed upon, or decided in the represented speech. The action "comes about", so to speak, after having been commanded, etc.

There may also be several *yi* clauses in a row, talking about successive events resulting from a represented speech, as in example (197). Given that events expressed by a *yi* clause are all part of the same thematic grouping, the *yi* clause thus also acts as a cohesive device within a thematic grouping. The last *yi* clause of the series is typically taken up as a linkage clause at the beginning of the next thematic grouping, as shown in examples (197a) and (197b). Note the presence of the element *ylä* 'now:LOP' in the linkage clause in both of these examples.

(197) a. wlä -n büdüo yɪ [sese]
3P:say 2S wash:CAUS:3S now! NUPT
'They said, "Wash him now!"

'nɪ ɔ **yi**o 'kʊ 'bhlü
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S VPC take
Then she took him'

[3]Marchese (1986a) calls the *yi* clauses 'sequential clauses' and the *yi* auxiliary a 'sequential auxiliary'. She gives a fairly complete description of the *yi* clause, its grammar and its distribution in narrative. However, in the discourse grammar point of view that she argues from she cannot find a truly unified function for it. Indeed, in her conclusion she states that speakers use *yi* clauses "to combine events together when they want to focus in on punctiliar events […], to wind down the paragraph […], to set up expectations for the story climax […], to point to significant conclusions at story-end, and they use them to signal macro-level divisions" (ibid. 266).

'nɪ ɔ **yi**o büda 'fɪɪn [sese]
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S wash:CAUS all NUPT
and washed him completely.

'nɪ wa **yi**o lɪɪlılɪɪ 'kʊ 'ŋʊ [sese]
ADD1 3P XFUT:3S riches VPC add NUPT
Then they put ornaments on him.' [lueuzi 85–88]

b. 'bhlü gwieyee 'kʊ [sese]
take palm_nut:grain:DEF VP NUPT
'Take the palm nut!

'nɪ ɔ **yi**o gwieyee 'nyɛ [sese]
ADD1 3S XFUT:3S palm_nut: grain:DEF give NUPT
So he gave him the palm nut

'nɪ Goplë **yi**e lü [sese]
ADD1 Gopleu XFUT:NH2 eat NUPT
and Gopleu ate it,

ɔ -lü ylä gwieyee nä
3S eat:CP now:LOP palm_nut: grain:DEF SP1
When he had now eaten the palm nut, …' [sigo 71–74]

c. ɔɔ' 'slënɔɔ [sese] ɔ laa
3S:GEN first_wife NUPT 3S say
'His first wife, she said,

n 'kä -zɪkä -mɔɔ' 'klää' mʊ [sese]
1S XPOT today LOC:GEN field:OBL go NUPT
"I am going to go to the field there today."

'nɪ ɔ **yi** ylä 'yuo 'kʊ bhlü [sese]
ADD1 3S XFUT now:LOP child:DEF VPC take NUPT
Then she took the child

'nɪ ɔ **yi** ylä -mɔɔ mʊ
ADD1 3S XFUT now:LOP LOC go
and she now went there.

ɔ -mʊ ylä […] nä
3S go:CP now:LOP SP1
When she had now gone…' [lueuzi 28–31]

Apart from contexts after represented speech, *yi* clauses are also used for actions that the hearer can expect from the preceding actions on the basis of encyclopaedic knowledge, as is the case in example (198).

(198) 'nɪ ɔ -loo lä 'säkäzize [sese]
ADD1 3S clear_land:CP LOP rice_field NUPT
'then he cleared land for a rice field

'nɪ 'ŋwnɪa **yi** 'säkaa go [sese]
ADD1 woman:PL XFUT rice:DEF plant NUPT
and the women planted the rice.

'Säkänä futo ylä nä [sese]
rice:DEM bear_fruit now:LOP SP1 NUPT
When that rice was now bearing fruit…' [lueuzi 23–25]

The choice of the verb *yi* 'come' is certainly not accidental. Rather, it seems motivated by the deictic component in its meaning. Indeed, just as the movement of 'come' is towards the speaker as the centre of orientation, so a sequence of actions within a thematic grouping is oriented to an outcome within one stage of the development of the narrative. This implies that in sequences of actions that may not seem quite as predictable for the hearer, the narrator conveys to the hearer that the sequence of actions is oriented towards a particular outcome.[4]

In example (199) the *yi* clauses occur in the resolution part of the narrative. The theme of the narrative is that the narrator made it to his work place across the lagoon in spite of a strike of the people operating the ferry. The example shows the first five of these clauses.[5]

(199) 'nɪ -amʊ -mä n **yi** lä mʊ
ADD1 1S:TH ADD4 1S XFUT LOP go
'Then I, I went

'nɪ -a **yi** lä gbɔlʊ pää
ADD1 1P XFUT LOP row throw:APL
then we got into a queue,

'nɪ ɔmɔ nyɪkpɔɔ ɔ **yi** lä tɛtɛ 'lʊä fä
ADD1 3S:TH person:DEF 3S XFUT LOP first IPF:PL send
then that man, he took (lit. he sent) a first group (across),

'nɪ ɔ **yi** lä 'sɔna lʊä -gʊʊ yi
ADD1 3S XFUT LOP second IPF fetch come
then he came to fetch a second group.

'sɔna -lʊä nä waa 'kpaa 'mlö, -mɔɔ n -kʊmʊ bhlä
second DPF SP1 3P:GEN group inside LOC 1S BE1:COM:CP PST1:LOP
The second ones, in their group, it was there that I was also,

'nɪ n **yi** lä 'nyie 'tɔ zëplünöö'
ADD1 1S XFUT LOP lagoon cross morning:DEM:OBL
and I crossed the lagoon this morning.' [greve 78–85]

In example (200) the *yi* clauses in the narrative are found all the way from pre-peak to peak until the dénouement, which is where the protagonist gets his washcloth back. That last event is the expected outcome and goal of the story.

[4]Note the different analysis of Marchese (1978:66f.), who views *yi* as a potential auxiliary that may have "a future oriented meaning" that "carries over in a sequential sense" in a series of actions in discourse.
[5]Note that in this example the connective *-mä* acts as a spacer (see chapter 7).

(200) wlä nyɪkpɔ -kʊ wä sɔɔ -aaa
EVD person BE1:CP PST3 thus until
'It is said that the chap (lit. someone) had stayed like that until

'nɪ 'nyibhlëa' -lefɪɪn ɔ **yi**a waa 'fɪɪn
ADD1 river:DEF:GEN totality 3S XFUT:NH1 empty_out altogether
the whole river, he had completely emptied it out

'nɪ a **yi** -mɔɔ bhɪä
ADD1 NH1 XFUT LOC be_finished
and it was empty (lit. finished there).

kokloko ŋnʊkla **yi** 'kʊ yi
ID old_woman:DEF XFUT VPC appear
The old woman appeared!

ɔ -kä a ɔɔ 'kazɔɔ
3S have PST2 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth:DEF
She had his raffia washcloth.

'nɪ wlä ɔ **yi** 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü [sese]
ADD1 EVD 3S XFUT raffia_washcloth:DEF VPC take NUPT
Then (it is said that) he took his raffia washcloth.' [kazo 50–56]

As noted above, the verb *yi* 'come' is actually the future auxiliary in Godié (see §2.5.1). It could be argued that its use in narrative sequences is just an extension of its use as a future auxiliary, inasmuch as the outcome of the narrative is the future point towards which the narrative moves in the narrative process.

On the other hand, the use of the *yi* auxiliary in narrative could also be seen as a separate use of the verb, limited to narrative, indeed as a kind of narrative tense. However, *yi* is not used for just any kind of development in the narrative, as is the case with the temporal adverb *yɪ* 'now' (see §9.1.1 above). Rather, it seems to occur specifically with the meaning of outcome of a narrative sequence within a thematic grouping. It therefore does not seem adequate to consider it a narrative tense such as can be found in some other African languages.

9.2 Marking the different stages in the narrative

Apart from the connective *-mää* 'ADD5' (see §8.1.5), the tail-head linkage construction (see §4.2.3), and the reference by a full noun phrase to an active particpant (see §5.2.2.1), there are other devices signalling the transition to a new phase in the underlying mental scheme of the narrative.[6] The following devices will be discussed in this section: points of departure, the evidential marker *wlä*, the past tense particles *bhä* and *wä*, the perfect aspect, ideophones, some set expresssions occurring before a key event, and orientation to a deictic centre by way of the verbs 'come' and 'go'. For the general role of the progressive aspect in narrative development see §2.6.3).

[6]The connective *-mää* appears to be the only connective acting at the macro-level of a narrative. All the others occur within a narrative phase (see the introduction to this chapter for this term).

9.2.1 Situational points of departure

The main function of points of departure is to establish an explicit frame of reference (see §4.2.1). This is especially important at points where the frame of reference changes. The transition to a different phase in the mental scheme of a narrative generally implies a change in the frame of reference. So it is to be expected that a point of departure should appear at such a transition point. In Godié narrative, a situational point of departure is typically found there. Indeed, a temporal or spatial point of departure is used at the transition point to the the initial phase of the narrative, as in example (201a), and to the complication phase, as in (201b). The presence of the spacer *nä* 'SP1', as in (201b), seems to emphasize the fact that the narrative advances to a new phase in its mental scheme.

(201) a. **-lɔɔ** **'klää'** mnɛ -kʊ -mɔɔ [sese]
there bush:OBL animal BE1:CP LOC NUPT
'There in the forest, there is an animal,

ɛɛ' -wʊ 'ghlü [sese]
NH2:XNEG CNT2 be_big NUPT
it is not big.' [creation 27–28]

b. **zɪkää'** **'ylʊʊ** **'kʊ** nä ŋwadi mʊ ylä
today:GEN day:DEF on SP1 lad go:ICP now:LOP
'Now one day (lit. on the day of today) a lad was coming along.' [kazo 15–16]

9.2.2 The evidential marker **wlä**

The evidential marker *wlä* 'EVD' is a way to indicate that the speaker is not to be held accountable for the truth of the information that follows, as in example (202). It is a contraction of the third person plural pronoun *wa* (see §2.2.1), used non-referentially, and the speech introducer *lä* (see §6.2).[7]

(202) **wlä** 'ylʊbä kä cii- a 'kä yi nä
EVD year XCND speak:CP NH1 XPOT come SP1
'It is reported that when New Year is going to (lit. says it will) come up,

kä Fädɪnyʊa bhlä nyɪkpɔ 'nɪ wa bʊbɔ jiee
ASF Fanti_people:DEF kill:ICP person ADD1 3P sacrifice ocean:DEF
the Fanti kill someone and they make a sacrifice to the ocean.' [neyo 33.1–4]

In fictional narrative, or folk tales, the evidential marker has been found to occur at transition points to a new phase in the story. Thus at the transition to the initial stage of the story, possibly after some kind of an introduction, the narrator can use the evidential marker *wlä* 'EVD' to make the audience aware that the story begins, as in example (203a). The speaker thus indicates that what follows is not his own personal narrative but a folk tale that has come to him by tradition. In the latter use the marker can also have the form *wlaa,* as in example (203b).[8]

(203) a. **wlä** nyɪkpɔ ɔmɔɔ- nöö- lä ɔɔ ŋwnɪä 'sɔ
EVD person 3S:TH:REL marry:CP LOP 3S:GEN woman:PL two
'They say that there was once a man who had married two wives.' [lueuzi 20–21]

[7]The pronoun *wa* with non-referential meaning also occurs elsewhere in the language.
[8]The presence of the thematic pronoun in these examples is due to the fact that the participant is the first to be brought on stage (see §5.1.3)

b. **wlaa** nyɪkpa 'mä slää lä waa 'du
EVD people TH build:CP LOP 3P:GEN village
'It is reported that people had built a village for themselves (lit. they say that people, it was they who built their village).' [kazo 1]

Occurrences of *wlä* at transition points within the story can be seen as reminders that a fictional story is being told, or as cues given to the hearer that the story is moving to a new phase in its mental scheme. Indeed, apart from the peak of the story, where other devices are used (see §9.2.3 and §9.2.4 below), the evidential marker can be found at any transition point to a new phase within a story.

However, narrators do not use the marker each time they could. Rather, it is their choice and they seem to use it preferably in anticipation of an unexpected turn in the story. The speech or action expressed in the clause following *wlä* will thus attract the heightened attention of the audience.

The evidential marker *wlä* in narrative thus has a procedural meaning, which can be formulated in the following terms:

- Be aware that the story is about to move to a new phase with unexpected events.

In example (204) the narrator of the folk tale about the chimpanzee uses *wlä* at the transition to the unexpected resolution following the peak: the chimpanzee's contentment after his house has fallen apart and on top of him.

(204) **wlä** 'gwɛ lä lmɪ n yä bhɛ lä -zä ci
EVD chimpanzee say NHP:TH 1S XPER PST LOP DP3 speak
'The chimpanzee said, "That's what I had already said."' [gwebhutu 40]

In example (205) the same narrator uses the marker *wlä* to introduce the final stage of the story, namely the scars the chimpanzee still carries today from the events told in the story.

(205) **wlä** -n gä lä -zɪkä 'gwɛ 'yi 'ni
EVD 2S XPOT LOP today chimpanzee VC (eyes) see
'Now whenever you see a chimpanzee nowadays…' [gwebhutu 47]

In example (206) the narrator of the story about the bird Dacligo uses *wlä* at the transition point to a further complication in the story: after winning the war against the animals thanks to Dacligo's willingness to carry the war fetish, Dacligo wants to give the fetish back and be freed from the ban linked to it, which is not to eat palm nuts.

(206) **wlä** -Dacligoo lä tʊʊ yä yɪ bhɪä (nn)
EVD Dacligo say war:DEF XPER now end UPT
'Well, then Dacligo said, "The war is now over,

nä a 'bhlü yɪ aa' -gʊgwaa 'kʊ (aa)
SP1 2P take now 2P:GEN war_fetish:DEF VPC UPT
so take back your war fetish."' [dacligo 36–37]

Example (207) which is taken from the story about the lost washcloth, shows two occurrences of *wlä*. The first one occurs at the transition point to the protagonists's unexpected reaction, while the second one occurs at the transition point to the resolution of the story.

(207) **wlä** nyɪkpɔ -kʊ wä sɔɔ -aaa
EVD person BE1:CP PST3 thus until
'It is said that the chap (lit. person) had stayed like that until

‘nɪ 'nyibhlëa' -lefɪɪn ɔ yia waa 'fɪɪn
ADD1 river:DEF:GEN totality 3S XFUT:NH1 empty_out altogether
the whole river, he had emptied it out entirely

‘nɪ a yi -mɔɔ bhɪä
ADD1 NH1 XFUT LOC be_finished
and it (=the water in) was finished (lit. it ended there).

kokloko ŋnʊkla **yi** 'kʊ yi
ID old_woman:DEF XFUT VPC appear
The old woman appeared!

ɔ -kä a ɔɔ 'kazɔɔ
3S have PST2 3S:GEN raffia_washcloth:DEF
She had his raffia washcloth.

‘nɪ **wlä** ɔ yi 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü [sese]
ADD1 EVD 3S XFUT raffia_washcloth:DEF VPC take NUPT
Then (it is said that) he took his raffia washcloth.’ [kazo 50–56]

9.2.3 Past tense particles

The past tense particles *bhä* ‘PST1’ and *wä* ‘PST3’ are also used at transition points between different phases of the mental scheme of a Godié narrative.[9]

The past tense particle *bhä* ‘PST1’ is found both at the beginning of the narrative and at its end. In example (208a) *bhä* is present in the clause describing the initial phase of the story, and in (208b) it appears in the transition clause to the complication phase. Example (208c) illustrates the use of *bhä* in the dénouement and (208)d in the final phase of the narrative.[10]

(208) a. -bhɔɔdä nä kä 'gwɛ -yä nyɪkpɔ 'sɔ -kʊʊ **bhä** 'kʊ
beginning SP1 ASF chimpanzee ADD2 person two BE1:APL PST1 VPC
‘… in the beginning the chimpanzee and man lived together.’ [gwebhutu 12]

b. -zëküü' 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- bhlä nä
adjacent_day:GEN day:DEF which BE2:CP PST1:LOP SP
‘Now yesterday (lit. the one day from now that passed),

ʊmʊ 'kʊ nä wälɪklë -bhlogbe -bhlü **bhä**
it:TH on SP matter_part one_single fall:CP PST1
that day (lit. on it) something happened.’ [greve 15–17]

c. 'nɪ ɔ yi monie 'kʊ 'bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S XFUT money:DEF VPC take NUPT
‘… he then took the money

‘nɪ ɔ -nyɛ 'sɔ yi **bhä** yi aa [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S ADD2:NH2 two XFUT PST1 come EXCL3 NUPT
and went away (lit. came) with it.’ [kokoleko 174–175]

[9]See Marchese 1978 for these uses of the tense particles.
[10]Note the *yi* clauses (see §9.1.2) in examples (213) and (213), which both express the outcome of the story.

d. 'nɪ wlä Goplë yi **bhä** 'kʊ -bha [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 EVD Gopleu XFUT PST1 VPC leave NUPT
'Then Gopleu got up

'nɪ ɔ yi **bhä** mʊ a [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S XFUT PST1 go EXCL3 NUPT
and he went away.' [sigo 436–437]

In the coda of a narrative the past tense particle *wä* 'PST3' occurs with the completive aspect, as in example (209).

(209) 'nünëa sä Sigo -nʊ **wä** nä ɔ -nʊ Goplë [-kpazebhleku]
folk_tale:DEF way Sigo do:CP PST3 SP1 3S do:CP Gopleu NUPT
'The story (about) how Sigo acted towards Gopleu

'nɪ Goplë -mä a -nʊɔ **wä** nä [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 Gopleu ADD4 NH1 do:3s:cp PST3 SP1 NUPT
and Gopleu, how he had dealt with him …' [sigo 438–440]

In example (210) the tense particle *wä* is used in the last clause of the complication phase of the narrative. What follows is the reaction of the villagers to the woman's unintentional killing of her child in the bush. Note the temporal point of departure (see §9.2.1) at the transition point to the reaction phase of the story.

(210) 'nɪ wlä 'ŋnɔnɔ yi wä a [sese]
ADD1 EVD woman:DEM come PST3 DP4 NUPT
'And that woman was coming

'nɪ ɔ ŋʊ wä 'yunɔ sä a [sese]
ADD1 3S PUT PST3 child:DEM VPC DP4 NUPT
and she put that child down.

zeli yä yɪ ze [sese]
daylight XPER now light_up NUPT
When day broke the next morning…' [lueuzi 68–70]

9.2.4 The perfect aspect and ideophones

The inherent semantic meaning of the perfect aspect occurring in dialogue is to indicate the current relevance of a past event (see §2.6.3). In other words, the result of the past event is still valid in the speech situation and often also in the future, as illustrated in example (211).

(211) 'naa -lɔɔ yä -naa 'yuo 'bhlä
1S:GEN DPF XPER 2S:GEN child:DEF kill
'… my child (lit. mine) hit your child' [sigo 318]

In a narrative sequence the perfect aspect in Godié takes on a pragmatic or discourse meaning, which gives a somewhat different instruction for interpretation to the hearer than the perfect aspect in dialogue. Givón (1984:280) has described the use of the perfect aspect in narrative as a marked use, inasmuch as the perfect clause is out of sequence with the rest of a narrative sequence, which normally reports successive events. Givón formulates this meaning of the perfect within a narrative as a pragmatic

inference: “If an event occurs *counter-sequentially* in narrative report, it must then be *relevant* to a later point in time—later than its original time point in the natural sequence” (ibid. 284; *emphasis in original)*).

This seems to be exactly the case in Godié narrative. Events that have special significance for the way the narrative subsequently develops are expressed in perfect aspect, that is, by way of the perfect auxiliary *yä* ‘XPER’, as illustrated in example (212). In this use the free translation into English by present tense is supposed to reflect the counter-sequential nature of the perfect aspect.

(212) Fädınyʊa wlä wa wlo klë nä
Fanti:people:DEF 3P:say 3P look:ICP behind SP1
‘As the Fanti people were looking behind,

ɔ **yä** kpänyı 'yikʊ mö
3S XPER much ahead go
he had advanced a lot.’ [neyo 28.1–2]

Evidence of the counter-sequential nature of the perfect aspect in a Godié narrative is the fact that a *yä* clause is never introduced with the additive connective *'nı* ‘then’, which in its temporal sense can express only sequentiality.[11] This is in contrast to *yi* clauses (see §9.1.2), which are used to express sequentiality and are hence typically introduced by the connective *'nı* ‘ADD1’.

The instruction for interpretation of perfect aspect, that is, a *yä* clause within a Godié narrative, can thus be formulated as follows:

- Attribute relevance beyond the current point in the narrative to the event expressed by a *yä* clause.

Quite often, *yä* clauses are preceded or followed by an ideophone (‘ID’), which highlights the event and thus underlines its relevance for the narrative (as in example (213b) and (213c) below).

Except for the initial and final phases, a *yä* clause can occur in any phase within the story: in the phase of complication, as in example (213a); at the peak, as in (213b) and (213c); or in the phase of resolution, as in example (213)d.[12]

(213) a. kä wa mʊ ylä [-kpazebhleku]
ASF 3P go now:LOP NUPT
‘They were now leaving.

wa **yä** -blɔɔ bhlü -aaa [-kpazebhleku]
3P XPER road pound until NUPT
They go on the road until

wa **yä** -blɔɔ 'mʊ mimi- [-kpazebhleku]
3P XPER road VPC do_half_of NUPT
they reach half way.

Wlä kä wa wlo yı nä [-kpazebhleku]
EVD ASF 3P look now SP1 NUPT
Then all of a sudden (lit. as they were now looking)

[11]Marchese (1978:73) also reports this feature of what she calls the “perfective” aspect by relating it to “background events that do not coincide with the regular event line but have taken place at some previous time.”
[12]In (218) the clause translated “when they were now looking” contains two cues concerning narrative development: the marker *wlä* and the set expression *kä wa wlo yı* (see §9.2.5). The set expression *-n ni* occurs in the following clause.

-n ni 'nyikpotütë [-kpazebhleku]
2S find black_ants:swarm NUPT
there was a swarm of black ants!' [kokoleko 123–127]

b. **wuë** -sʊmabolu **yä** -zɔɔ bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ID Worm XPER (VPC) fall_down NUPT
'Worm fell down!

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ **yä** -bluu **ʊ** **yä** mʊ [-kpazebhleku]
Rooster XPER fly NH3 XPER go NUPT
Rooster flew, he went away.' [kokoleko 157–159]

c. 'mnëa -yä nimnii 'sɔ **yä** zamä- **gblätätä**
nose:DEF ADD1 lip:PL:DEF two XPER be_red:CP ID
'The nose and the lips have become/become all red,

dolu -bhlobhlo -bhutupapɪɪ -yä papoo -ya
blood only house:wall:PL:DEF ADD2 palm_branches:DEF ADD2
full of blood! The walls of the house together with the roof,

vlu ɪ **yä** 'gwɛ 'wlu bhlüü-
ID NHP XPER chimpanzee head fall:APL
wum! they fell/fall on the chimpanzee's head.' [gwebhutu 38–39]

d. 'ŋnɔɔ -mʊ ylä zɪkä nä
woman:DEF go:CP now:LOP today SP1
'Now when the woman went one day,

'nyikpo-titë **yä** 'kʊ ghlä
black_ants-swarm XPER VPC appear
a swarm of army ants had appeared/appear.' [siamoi 53–54]

A meaning component that is frequently present with a *yä* clause in Godié narrative is the unexpected nature of the expressed event. This is again in contrast to the *yi* clause, which typically expresses an expected event (see §9.1.2). In examples (214a) and (214b), the clauses expressed in the perfect aspect are unexpected events that constitute a complication in the narrative.[13]

(214) a. **'gblikisi** gɔlʊ **yä** bhuo […] 'kazɔɔ **yä** mʊ
ID canoe XPER overturn raffia_washcloth:DEF XPER go
'The canoe overturns! […] The raffia washcloth is gone.

'kuŋnʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ 'nyibhlëa 'mʊ
ghost_old_woman:DEF NH1:REL BE1:CP now:LOP LOC river:DEF OBL
The old woman's ghost that was there in the river

'nɪ -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä
ADD1 NH1:REL BE2:CP now:LOP LOC:GEN spirit:DEF SP1
and that was its spirit,

[13]Instead of the invariable verb *lä* which is the default speech margin for represented speech (see §6.2), the spacer *nynä* (see §6.2) here acts as the speech margin for the woman's represented thought. Remember that *nynä* likely contains the element *lä* (see footnote 150).

a **yä** 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü
NH1 XPER washcloth:DEF VPC take
it has taken/takes the raffia washcloth.' [kazo 24–31]

b. ɔɔ' plɛ nynä mnɛɛ -ɛ yi [sese]
3S:GEN liver SP2 animal NH2:REL come:ICP NUPT
'… she thought that it was an animal that was coming.

du ɔ **yä** 'yuo 'bhlä [sese]
ID 3S XPER child:DEF kill NUPT
She kills (lit. has killed) the child!' [lueuzi 52–53]

Later in the same narrative, when the co-wife of the woman who had killed her own child by accident in her field saw all the gifts that the villagers gave to the bereaved woman to comfort her, she decided to also kill her child in the field, in order to get gifts, too. The narrator describes the killing of that child in a *yi* clause, as for him it is an expected event (see §9.1.2). Interestingly enough, however, the representative of the audience, who had just before given feedback on behalf of the audience, uses a *yä* clause, as shown in example (215), thus anticipating the event of the child's murder and expressing that it will have relevance for the way the narrative will turn out.[14]

(215) ɔɔ' sä ɔ -yä ɔɔ' -lɔɔ 'sɔ -mʊ ylä 'klä nä
3S:GEN method 3S ADD2 3S:GEN DPF two go:CP now:LOP field SP1
'When she and her child (lit. hers) went to the field

'gboo- [ɔ **yɔ** 'bhlä] 'nɪ ɔ yio 'bhlä
ID 3S XPER:3S kill ADD1 3S XFUT:3S kill
with a blow [audience representative: 'She kills (lit. has killed) him] she kills (lit. has killed) him.' [lueuzi 106–107]

9.2.5 Set expressions

Another device used by Godié narrators is a complex two-part set expression. It alerts the audience to the fact that an event of special significance is about to be described. The first part of the expression is the clause *kä ɔ wlo* yɪ (ASF/3S look.ICP/now) 'when he/she was looking now' or *kä wa wlo* yɪ (ASF/3P look.ICP/now) 'when they were looking now'. This clause slows down the action of the character and thus increases suspense. The second part of the expression is the imperative clause *-n ni* (2S/find), 'here is' (see §4.1.3). The set expression is used to bring on stage something or someone unexpected at the climax in the narrative, as in (216a) and (216b).[15]

(216) a. wlä **kä** **wa** **wlo** **yɪ** nä [-kpazebhleku]
3P:say ASF 3P look now SP1 NUPT
'Then all of a sudden (lit. as they were now looking)

-n **ni** 'nyikpotütë [-kpazebhleku]
2S find black_ants:swarm NUPT
there was a swarm of black ants (lit. find a swarm of black ants)!' [kokoleko 126–127]

[14]Given that the plan of the co-wife to kill her child is not explicit in the narrative, it could also be unexpected for the audience, which would explain the presence of the *yä* auxiliary.
[15]In (221) the high tone of the root of the verb *'ni* has been lowered to a mid tone after the low tone pronoun *-n*.

b. du ɔ yä 'yuo 'bhlä [sese]
ID 3S XPER child:DEF kill NUPT
'She kills (lit. has killed) her child!

ɔ lä **kɔ** **wlo** **yɪ** **-n** **ni** yɪ ɔɔ' 'yu mɔ [sese]
3S say ASF:3S look now 2S find now 3S:GEN child TH NUPT
As she was now looking, here is her child!' [lueuzi 54–55]

9.2.6 Orientation

The notion of orientation in narrative efers to the deictic centre in the discourse world, towards which linguistic elements with a deictic semantic component are oriented. Such elements are demonstratives, but also deictic verbs, such as 'go', 'come', 'take', and 'bring'. In many languages the change of orientation within a narrative indicates a new phase or a new turn in the narrative.

In Godié narrative, the *yi* clause with its 'come' auxiliary (see §9.1.2) is already such an orientation inasmuch as the moving along of the story is construed as being oriented to the outcome of the story as the overall deictic centre of the narrative. This is particularly striking in example (217), where the resolution of the story on the part of the Rooster is expressed by two *yi* clauses, the second of which even has the verb 'come' as a main verb, even though the character leaves the stage. However, his movement is construed as the 'coming' towards the goal of the story.

(217) -Kɔkwɛɛnɔ -ɔɔ bhɛ lä monii nii- nä [-kpazebhleku]
Rooster:DEM 3S:NEG PST LOP money get:CP SP1 NUPT
'That Rooster, who had not gotten any money,

'nɪ ɔ yi monie 'kʊ 'bhlü [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S XFUT money:DEF VPC take NUPT
he then took the money

'nɪ ɔ -nyɛ 'sɔ yi bhä **yi** aa [-kpazebhleku]
ADD1 3S ADD2:NH2 two XFUT PST come EXCL3 NUPT
and went away (lit. came) with it.' [kokoleko 173–175]

9.3 Theme line versus background

In order to properly follow a story, the hearer also needs cues enabling him to discern which events are theme line and therefore prominent events in the narrative, and which are secondary events or background information and thus less prominent. In Godié, the assertive focus particle *kä* is a common device for showing higher prominence of an event (see § 4.3.1.1), while the spacer *nä* 'SP1' and the particle *lä* 'LOP' are the most common devices for indicating lower prominence. They are discussed in §9.1 and §4.3.2.1 respectively. Furthermore, all past tense particles typically signal background information (see §2.5). For the use of the particles *bhlä* and *wä* as backgrounding devices, see §2.5.2.1 and §2.5.2.3 respectively.

Appendix: Text collection

Acknowledgements

Thanks are due first of all to the speakers of the texts on which this study is based, all of them speakers of the Kagbo dialect: the late Mr. Di Benoit, who was a living depository of stories, the late Mr. Gbaklé Paul, Mr. Kubeu, and Mr. Koci Jean, all from the village of Niégroubouhé; the late Mr. Beugré Atta César from the village of Gobroko; and Mr. Gbley Dada Jean from the village of Godjibouhé. All these villages are in the department (Préfecture) of Sassandra and sub-department (Sous-Préfecture) of Sago. The speaker of the radio news bulletin in Godié (text 15), the late Mrs Louboyo Marie-Claire, called Youbou Gnadro Gawanon, also had Niégroubouhé as her home village.

In addition to his role as narrator, Mr. Gbley Dada Jean also transcribed, keyboarded, and translated all the texts into French shortly after they were recorded.

Finally, thanks are due to Cornelia Wüsthoff, who compiled the texts into a text collection.

Preliminary remarks

The selection of texts presented below contains all the texts from which the examples in the discourse study are taken. Most of the examples were taken from narrative texts. However, since some of the examples in the study were drawn from two non-narrative texts—a dialogue and an exhortation—these texts have been included as well (see text 1 and 18). The texts are listed in alphabetical order by their reference line.

The name and (approximate) age of the speaker(s) at the time of the recording are given for each text, as well as the date of the recording. The recordings are still in cassette form and would have to be digitalized to be accessible in the future.

The writing system used in the transcriptions is the practical orthography developed for all written materials of the Godié language according to the principles developed in cooperation with the Institute of Applied Linguistics at the University of Abidjan. To put all the texts in phonetic transcription would have been very time-consuming and wasn't deemed necessary for the purposes of a discourse study.

Some minor changes have been made in the practical orthography over the years, especially in the writing of grammatical tone at the end of the word and the rendering of the sound [n] after a nasal syllable onset as either *l* or *n* (*mlö* or *mnö*, *nylä* or *nynä*). We have chosen to leave the texts in the orthography in which they were first transcribed, rather than updating them. However, examples taken from the texts and quoted in the discourse study have been updated in the study to represent the current state in Godié orthography.

Material in round brackets is what the transcriber heard the narrator say, while the material in curly brackets is what the transcriber thought the narrator should have said instead, either because it is correct or better to understand. We have left most of these editing remarks by the transcriber in the texts on purpose, as they are likely to show what is the norm at the level of *langue* (the language system), and what can happen at the level of *parole* (the actual speech utterances). However, in the quoted examples in the study, the transcriber's version was chosen and the curly brackets are absent.

By and large the texts are divided into clauses and numbered accordingly. The numbering of the text Neyo is different from that of the other texts in that sentences are numbered and clauses are numbered within the sentences.

Clauses that are quoted in the study are marked with an asterisk.

The text collection is not intended to be a research tool but merely a reference tool for the readers of the discourse study. In other words, the purpose of the text collection is only to allow readers to look for themselves at the wider context of the vernacular examples that are quoted in the study. For this reason the text collection does not fulfill the usual requirements of a scientific text collection. Thus it did not seem necessary to provide a morpheme-by-morpheme gloss of the texts. Rather, the free translation of the vernacular material was by and large deemed sufficient, although in a number of cases a literal

translation has been added in parentheses. The English free translation of the texts was added to the original French free translation only in 2014 by the author of the study.

Folk tales recorded in public with an audience also contain the feedback or uptake signals uttered by the representative of the audience (called an *animateur* in French), as well as the songs that the narrator sings together with his audience. Both the feedback signals and the songs have been included in the transcription. The study of their place within the narrative is likely to provide important indications for pragmatic units in Godié narrative. Two of the feedback signals, *sese* and *-kpazebhleku,* occur only in traditional folk tales. They are unanalyzable and seem to have no semantic meaning. The other signals of uptake and hearer attention are not specific to the folk tale genre.

	Text	Page
1.	Cacao	113
2.	Creation	123
3.	Dacligo	138
4.	Decesrad	145
5.	Devinet	147
6.	Elisabet	157
7.	Filsprod	168
8.	Greve	203
9.	Gwebhutu	213
10.	Kazo	219
11.	Kokoleko	226
12.	Lueuzi	246
13.	Medic	261
14.	Neyo	265
15.	Radio	288
16.	Siamoi	293
17.	Sigo	301
18.	Soutien	350

1. Cacao

Genre: Conversation
Content: Visit to give thanks */ Contenu*: Visite de remerciement
Speakers/Locuteurs: A (50, male); B (40, male)
Date: 19–12–1994

cacao 001

A: Gbaklı!

A: Gbaklé!

A: Gbaklé!

cacao 002

B: -Aao!

B: Yes!

B: Oui!

cacao 003

A: -Mɔɔ' 'dö?

A: What's the news?

A: Quelles sont les nouvelles?

cacao 004

B: -A, Degɔlʊ, -ayioo!

B: Well, De Gaulle, hello!

B: Bon, de Gaulle! Bonjour!

cacao 005

'Döö' -wʊ 'na bʊkʊ -kʊ.

There's no news with me.

Aucune nouvelle chez moi.

cacao 006*

Zëplünöö', n -kʊ lä -lɔɔ.

This morning I am there.

Ce matin, je suis là.

cacao 007

-Kugbësä n bha bhlä 'klää' nä,

When coming from the fields yesterday evening,

En venant des champs hier soir,

cacao 008

-lɔɔ n soo- bhlä 'naa bhɛŋlıa nylä

I had said to my sisters that

j'avais dit à mes sœurs que

cacao 009

n -kä a 'naa lebhe pɛ nä,

I had a little piece of work, so

J'avais un petit travail, alors

cacao 010

wa 'kä a mʊ

they could go

elles pourraient aller

cacao 011

wa kä'ä 'mɔ a klää.

help me with it.

m'aider avec cela.

cacao 012

Wlä, -Mä lebhe -sa bhä?

They said, "But what kind of work is it?"

Elles ont dit : « Mais quel travail est-ce? »

cacao 013*

'N -zä n nä,

So I said

Alors j'ai dit que

cacao 014*

'naa käkäwoobhü n -sä a nä,

my cocoa pods that I had picked,

mes cabosses de cacao que j'avais cueillies,

cacao 015*
wa 'kä mʊ
they should go,
qu'elles aillent
cacao 016*
wa kä'ä klää
they should help me,

cacao 017*
-a 'gı wlä,
break them. (lit. we would break them)
à les casser. (litt. nous allions les casser)
cacao 018
'nı wamä -mä wa yi bhlä 'kʊ ŋo.
and they, they had accepted.
alors elles, elles avaient accepté.
cacao 019
Zëlü -ze lä zëplünö 'pii nä,
When day broke, very early this morning
Quand il a fait jour, très tôt ce matin,
cacao 020
nn' -late -göglä,
I wasn't ready yet,
je n'étais pas encore prêt,
cacao 021
'nı wamä -mä wa yi lä mʊ,
then they, they came (lit. went)
alors elles, elles sont venues (litt. allées)
cacao 022
'nı wa yi'i lä soo,
to talk to me
et elles m'ont parlé
cacao 023
wlä -n -nä
saying, "You said
en disant: « Tu as dit
cacao 024
-a 'gä a 'klää' mʊ nä,
we would go to the field,
que nous devrions aller au champ, alors
cacao 025
-zëlü yä -zedä gwlɛɛ nä,
it's been a while that morning has broken,
comme cela fait un bon momment qu'il fait jour,

cacao 026
-anyı -a yä göglä nä,
as for us, we are ready now,
nous, nous nous sommes apprêtées, alors
cacao 027
-a 'gä yı 'klää mʊ.
let's go to the field now."
allons au champ maintenant! »
cacao 028
'N -zä nä, 'Ɔɔ!
I shouted, "Oh dear!
Je me suis écrié: « Oh, mon Dieu,
cacao 029
nn -lä -kä 'tee -göglä!
I am not ready yet!
je ne suis pas encore prêt!
cacao 030
-Amʊ, n nä,
As for me, I had said to myself
Moi, je me suis dit
cacao 031
kä wätlı yi nä,
that it was really cold, so
qu'il faisait vraiment froid, alors
cacao 032
wätlıı kä a doo nä,
when the cold would be over,
qund le froid finirait,
cacao 033
n -yä anyı 'sɔ, -a 'gä bhɛ …
I and you together, we would have…
moi et vous ensemble, nous serions/ aurions …
cacao 034
n 'kanyı bhɛ wälı 'pä kää' mʊ.
I would have come to call you."
je serais parti vous appeler. »
cacao 035
Wlä, -Anyı -mä kä -a -yä -mɔɔ 'sɔ lä 'kä lä mʊ.
They said, "We and you, let's go together."
Elles ont dit: « Nous, nous allons partir avec toi. »
cacao 036
'Nı wamä -mä wa yi lä sɔɔ ci.
Then they, they said that.
Alors elles, elles ont parlé ainsi.

cacao 037
(Ɔmɔ) {Acɛlı} -mä ɔ -bha ylä -lɔɔ nä,
One of them, Aceli, she now left;
Mais elle, Aceli, suite à cela (litt. elle a alors quitté là)
cacao 038
Acɛlı, kɔ -mʊ,
Aceli, she went (on)
Aceli, elle a continué
cacao 039
'nı ɔ cii yı nynä, Bon,
to say now, "Well,
en disant alors: « Bon,
cacao 040
n yä 'nu,
I have understood,
j'ai compris,
cacao 041
-mä n 'kä mʊ
but I'll go
mais je m'en vais
cacao 042*
-yä n 'kä kplikonyɔɔ 'yi 'ni,
and I am going to see the woodworker,
voir le menuisier,
cacao 043
ıyä -a -yɔ 'sɔ -kä a wälı klë nä,
and we and he had a little problem to solve, so
et nous avions quelque chose à régler avec lui, alors
cacao 044
a kä -bhlü nä,
when that is solved
quand ce sera résolu,
cacao 045
-a 'gä -kɛ -lɔɔ -adäblää' 'kʊ 'klʊ sloo,
we'll meet there in the marketplace.
nous allons nous rencontrer sur la place du marché.
cacao 046
'Mägıtı 'kʊ -a 'gä -lɔɔ 'klʊ sloo.
It is in the marketplace that we shall meet."
C'est sur laplace du marché que nous allons nous rencontrer. »
cacao 047
Ɔmɔ -mä ɔ yi lä sɔɔ ci.
That's what she said. (lit. As for her, she said that)
C'est ce qu'elle a dit. (litt. Quant à elle, elle a parlé ainsi)

cacao 048
-Amʊ -mä n bha ylä gbëë' nä,
As for me, when I now left the house,
Moi, quand j'ai maintenant quitté la maison,
cacao 049
n -yi,
I came,
je suis venu,
cacao 050
n 'nyligo -lɔɔ 'föö,
I stood there a little while,
j'attendais (litt. étais debout) un peu,
cacao 051
'nɪ wamä -mä wa yi yɪ yi.
then they, they now came.
puis elles sont venues.
cacao 052
Wa -yi ylä nä,
When they had now come,
Quand elles sont maintenant venues,
cacao 053
-a gä -mɔɔ 'klää -mʊ
(I said,) "When we go there to the field,
(j'ai dit:) « Quand nous allons au champ là-bas,
cacao 054
'lʊ -sä -a 'gä bhä lü'ü?
what will we eat?"
qu'est-ce que nous allons manger? »
cacao 055
Wlä:'A!
They said, "Well,
Elles ont dit: « En fait,
cacao 056
-Anyɪa lülülɪ -kʊ a -mɔɔ gbëë' nä,
since we have food there at home,
nous avons de la nourriture à la maison, donc
cacao 057
-a 'gä mʊ
we'll go
nous allons partir
cacao 058
-a 'gɪ -lä.
we'll take it with us."
pour la prendre avec nous. »

cacao 059

'Nı wamä -mä wa yi 'mʊ 'ylıbhɔ.
Then they, they returned home.
Puis elles se sont retournées.

cacao 060

Bhlogbe, -anʊ, Acɛlı yi lä 'mʊ 'ylıbhɔ,
One of them, what's her name, Aceli returned,
L'une d'entre elles, euh, Aceli, est retournée

cacao 061

'nı ɔ yi yi
she went (lit. came)
elle est partie (litt. venue)

cacao 062

'nı ɔ yi lülülıı 'kʊ 'bhlü,
and she picked up the food
et elle a pris la nourriture

cacao 063

'nı ɔ yii lä ɔɔ baduu' 'mlö 'ŋʊ,
and she put it into her bag,
et elle l'a mise dans son sac,

cacao 064

'nı -anyı -mä -a -yı 'sɔ yi lä 'klää mʊ.
then we, we went to the field with it (=the food).
puis nous sommes allés au champ avec.

cacao 065

Lebhenɛ -a -mʊ lä 'zaazı,
That work, we really went (to do it),
Ce travail, nous sommes allés effectivement

cacao 066

'nı -a -ŋë lä nä,
and when we arrived
et nous sommes arrivés, alors

cacao 067

Laagɔ -gbä nä,
by God's grace (lit. God made that),
par la grâce de Dieu (litt. Dieu a fait que)

cacao 068

wa -nʊɛ.
they did it (=the work).
elles l'ont fait (=le travail).

cacao 069*

'Klaa 'mlö, sukpɔ -kʊ -mɔɔ
In the field there were ants (sp.),
Dans le champ, il y avait des fourmis (esp.),

cacao 070*

-bhlɛ sukpɔnʊ suwa,
but even though these ants were stinging them
mais malgré le fait que les fourmis les piquaient,

cacao 071*

'nı ʊʊ wälıı wa 'nı -wʊ 'mänyı.
they didn't care about it.
elles ne s'en sont pas préoccupées.

cacao 072

'Nı wa yi lä käkäwoo wlä -aaa dëdügliyi 'kʊgbäsɔɔ'
And they broke the cocoa a long time until twelve o'clock,
et elles ont cassé le cacao jusqu'à douze heures

cacao 073

'nı wamä -mä wa yiu lä -zɔ bhıä.
then they, they finished it.
et elles l'ont fini.

cacao 074

-Ɔ!
(I said), "Okay now,
(J'ai dit:) « Eh bien!

cacao 075

Lebhee, a yɛ nʊ, ayayo -kä!
the work, you have done it, thank you!
le travail, vous l'avez fait, merci!

cacao 076

-Ɔ gä yı sɔɔ nä,
Given that (you have finished),
Puisqu'il en est ainsi,

cacao 077

kä a -yä 'naa bʊkʊʊ' -lɔɔ 'sɔ lä 'plö,
you will leave (lit. pass) with my younger brother
vous allez quitter avec mon frère cadet

cacao 078

ıyä a mʊ duu' ŋëë, -mä
in order to arrive in the village, whereas
pour rejoindre le village, tandis que

cacao 079

n 'kä -mɔɔ 'naa 'yikʊʊ' 'klaa 'mlö ŋë -yä
I'll go to (lit. arrive in) my field further along and
je vais arriver dans mon champ un peu plus loin

cacao 080

n 'kä 'naa 'säkäpɛlılıä -lä.
I'll get (lit. bring) a little bit of unpounded rice."
pour prendre (lit. apporter) un tout petit peu de riz non pilé. »

cacao 081

'Nı wamä -mä wa yi lä -bhlɛ 'duu' yi.

Then they returned (lit. came) to the village at that point.

Alors elles sont retournées (litt. revenus) au village à ce moment-là.

cacao 082

-Amʊ yä -mɔɔ 'klää' mʊ,

As for me, after going to the field,

Moi, après être allé dans le champ là-bas,

cacao 083

n yä 'säkäpɛlılıä 'kʊ 'bhlü,

taking a little bit of unpounded rice

après avoir pris un peu de riz non pilé,

cacao 084

n yä 'duu' yi,

coming to the village,

après être venu au village

cacao 085

ı plöö- nylä -mä n yi -länömʊ gbëë'

it is right that I come here to their house

il est normal que je vienne ici à la maison

cacao 086

-yä n 'kʊa lebhe -ya bhänöö.

in order to thank them for their work.

pour les remercier du travail.

cacao 087

Sɔɔ -amʊ -mä n -yi lä,

That's why I have come

C'est pour cela que je suis venu

cacao 088

'nı -mɔɔ -mä -n ylä'ä klä -mɔɔ' 'dö a.

and you (sg.), you asked me the news about the field there.

et toi, tu m'as demandé les nouvelles.

cacao 089

Nä, 'klä mii -kä sɔɔ 'kʊ a.

So, the field is in good shape.

Donc, le champ est en bon état.

cacao 090

'Naa bhloodä.

That's all. (lit. my ending place)

J'ai terminé.

cacao 091

A: Gbaklı -ayiokä!

A: Thank you, Gbaklé!

A: Merci, Gbaklé!

cacao 092

-Ayiokä wa'a klälı -ya!

Thank you for supporting them!

Merci de les avoir soutenues!

cacao 093

-Ayiokä!

Thank you!

Merci!

cacao 094

B: Bhänʋa 'na -za!

B: Thank them for me!

B: Remercie-les pour moi!

cacao 095

Bhänʋa 'na -za

Thank them for me!

Remercie-les pour moi,

cacao 096

-mä wa -nʋ lebhe

because they worked!

parce qu'elles ont travaillé!

cacao 097

A: Acɛlı, (aao) ayayio -kä!

A: Aceli, thank you!

A: Aceli, merci!

cacao 098

Ayayo -kä!

Thank you (to both of you)!

Merci (à vous tous les deux)!

cacao 099*

Ayayo -kä Gbaklı kläälı -ya!

Thank you for helping Gbakle!

Merci d'avoir aidé Gbaklé!

cacao 100*

Ayayio -kä käkäwo -wlälı -ya!

Thank you for breaking cocoa!

Merci pour avoir cassé le cacao!

cacao 101

Ayayio -kä!

Thank you!

Merci!

cacao 102

B: Laagɔ klä-nʋa o!

B: May God help them!

B: Que Dieu les aide!

2. Creation

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: How our world came into being / *Contenu*: L'origine de notre monde
Speaker/Locuteur: C (75, male)
Date: 16-08-1994

creation 001
N naa,
I say,
Je dis,

creation 002
'nünëä n 'kä 'ylä 'pä nä
the story I am going to tell (lit. throw),
le conte que je vais vous raconter (litt. jeter),

creation 003
kä n cii- bhɛ lä nynä
I had said that
j'avais dit que

creation 004
gämadä nää nä,
it is nice to have fun,
l'amusement était bon, donc

creation 005*
'nünü -ngbü n -zɛɛ bhlä
so it is five stories that I was going to tell.
c'est cinq contes que j'allais raconter.

creation 006
Sää 'titi kä -a gä yı 'sänyı nä,
If we are really determined now,
Si nous sommes vraiment décidés maintenant,

creation 007
bhlılı -ya -lıı ıı' lefıın, ımı -a 'gä lä 'kʊ 'bhlü,
singing and everything included, that's what we are going to do (lit. take),
y compris chansons et tout, c'est ce que nous allons faire (litt. prendre),

creation 008
ıyä wamä 'titi wa 'kıı yı -zɔ -sä
and so even they (=the white women), they will then explain them,
pour que même elles (= les femmes blanches), elles puissent maintenant les expliquer

creation 009
ıyä wa 'kä 'sıı 'cıä.
and they will also learn (about them).
et les apprendre.

creation 010*

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE) -N 'gä yı bhlı -a?

Will you sing now?

Vas-tu chanter maintenant?

creation 011*

'Nn, n 'kä yı 'fıa -ngbünanünëa 'pä,

No, I am now going to tell the fifth story first,

Non, je vais d'abord raconter le cinqième conte,

creation 012

pasıke aa' -lä yıɔ -mɔɔ too.

because it must not be left out. (litt. stay behind)

parce qu'il ne faut pas qu'il reste.

creation 013

A kä yı -mɔɔ -too nä,

If it was left out,

S'il restait,

creation 014

-amʊ 'titii- 'nyigë- ylä n yëku.

I would betray myself (=I wouldn't keep my promise to tell five stories)

c'est moi-même qui me trahirais maintenant. (= je ne tiendrais pas ma promesse)

creation 015

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE) -Ɛɛ, 'titi lä.

Yes, that's exactly it.

Oui, c'est exactement cela.

creation 016

Wlä -a 'bäsı, waa' Laagɔ wlʊʊ- lä

It is believed (lit. they say) that before our forefathers, before their God existed,

On raconte qu'avant que nos ancêtres, leur Dieu existe

creation 017

'nı 'pʊpʊ wlʊʊ- lä nä, (sese)

and the world existed,

et que le monde existe,

creation 018*

-dʊdʊʊ' wɛ -kʊ (sese)

there was no firm ground,

il n'y avait pas eu de terre ferme,

creation 019*

-mä jie -bhlobhlo wlä. (sese)

but only the ocean existed.

c'était seulement la mer.

creation 020

'Fıɔ 'nı 'kɔɔbhë, 'ŋʊʊ 'jekpiyuë 'nı -anyı nyıkpa -kpɔkpʊä (sese)

Before the world existed, including the white people and us the black people.

Avant que le monde n'existe, y compris les Blancs et nous les Noirs,

creation 021

nyıkpɔ kää- -soo nynä
if someone says to you that
si quelqu'un te dit que

creation 022

jie 'wuklë, nyıkpɔ -kʊ -mɔɔ nä,
behind the ocean there was someone,
derrière la mer il y avait quelqu'un,

creation 023

sonöɔ- nynä
tell him,
dis-lui:

creation 024

-n -kä -kpläkplä. (sese)
"That's wrong." (lit. you are lying)
« C'est faux. » (litt. tu mens)

creation 025

Nyıkpɔɔ' -wʊ -mɔɔ -kʊ.
There was no one out there.
Il n'y avait personne là-bas.

creation 026

'Lëkpënä -bhlogbe coo, amä -a -kʊ lä 'mʊ. (sese)
Only this place here, that's where we are.
Cet espace ici seulement, là où nous sommes.

creation 027*

-Lɔɔ 'klää', mnɛ -kʊ -mɔɔ, (sese)
There in the forest there is an animal,
Là-bas en brousse, il y a un animal

creation 028*

ɛɛ' -wʊ 'ghlü. (sese)
it is not big.
il n'est pas gros.

creation 029*

Ɛmɛ wa la 'Nɛmʊ.[1] (sese)
It is called Red Deer.
On l'appelle Biche Royale.

creation 030*

Ɛmɛɛ- -mʊ lä -a 'Bä yëku, (sese)
She was the one that went to our Father (= God).
C'est elle qui est partie auprès de notre Père (=Dieu)

[1]*'Nɛmʊ* is the vernacular name for a small species of mazama deer, probably *mazama rufina. / 'Nɛmʊ est le nom godié pour désigner une petite biche, probablement l'espèce mazama rufina.*

creation 031*

nynaa 'du -mä -aa' -yɛ -kä (sese)
saying, “We have no village
en disant: « Nus n’avons pas de village,

creation 032

'nɪ 'nyie -bhlobhlo lä nä, (sese)
and there is only water,
et il y a de l’eau seulement,

creation 033

bheeje, -n 'gä gbä
please, make it happen
pardon, fais

creation 034

-yä -a 'gä -dʊdʊ 'ni. (sese)
that we find firm ground (to live on)!”
que nous trouvions de la terre ferme (pour habiter)! »

creation 035

{-A 'Bä Laagɔ lä,} lɪ' -wʊ wälɪ -kä, (sese)
Our Father God said, “That’s not a big deal,
Notre Père Dieu dit: « Cela n’est rien,

creation 036

{-mä} -mɔɔ plöö- ylä 'Nɛmʊ nä, (sese)
because it is now you, Red Deer,
puisque c’est maintenant toi, Biche Royale,

creation 037

-n yä ci nä
you have spoken,
tu as parlé,

creation 038

n yä 'nu o! (sese)
I have understood!
j’ai compris!

creation 039

-Mä -n gä -mʊ nä, (sese)
Now when you leave,
Quand tu pars,

creation 040

-lɪɪ' -lɪmɪ n nyɛɛ- lä nä, (sese)
the things that I will have given you,
les choses que je t’aurai données,

creation 041

-n gä -mʊ nä
when you leave,
quand tu pars,

creation 042

-n 'bhlii 'kʊ, (sese)
take them!
prends-les!

creation 043

-N tito, -n -bha -mɔɔ jiee',
Go alongside (the ocean), start there from the ocean
Suis le bord de la mer, pars de là-bas à la mer

creation 044

dä ɛ bhloo lä nä, (sese)
where it ends
où elle finit,

creation 045

-ɔɔ -wʊ -mɔɔ ɛɛ' 'wuklëë', (sese)
it's not there behind it,
pas derrière elle

creation 046

-mä nyɪkpaa -kʊ lä nä, (sese)
because there are the people,
parce que les hommes sont là,

creation 047*

'nɪ dä ɛ bhloo-,
and where it ends,
et là où elle finit

creation 048*

'nɪ dä wa -kʊ lä nä (sese)
and where they live,
et où ils sont

creation 049*

-n titonöɛ
walk alongside it
marche là-bas

creation 050*

-yä -n 'mëë -lɪɪ 'kɔɔkɔ! (sese)
while spreading the things all the time!
et répands les choses toujours!

creation 051

Nä -n mëënɪ ylä nä, (sese)
Then as you are spreading them now
Alors (plus) tu les répandras maintenant

creation 052

sɔɔ jiee lä 'kä lä gwë -sä. (sese)
so the ocean will go back.
plus la mer reculera.

creation 053

Ɛ kä yɪ gwë -sä nä, (sese)
When it will now have gone back,
Quand elle aura reculé maintenant,

creation 054

'klä yä yi. (sese)
forest comes (lit. has come),
alors la forêt vient (litt. est venue)

creation 055*

-zägbä yä yi, (sese)
dry ground comes,
la plage vient (litt. est venue),

creation 056*

nyɪkpaa wa 'kä -kä 'slä, (sese)
so that the people can build,
pour que les hommes puissent construire,

creation 057*

Wa 'kä -kä sä kʊ, (sese)
so that they can settle,
pour qu'ils s'installent (litt. s'asseoient)

creation 058*

wa 'kä -kä loo (sese)
so that they can clear ground to make fields,
pour qu'ils défrichent

creation 059*

wa 'kä -kä lülülʊʊ lü. (sese)
so that they have food to eat."
pour qu'ils aient à manger. »

creation 060

Nɛmʊ lä, -Aa, (sese)
Red Deer said, "Okay."
Biche Royale dit: « D'accord. »

creation 061

'nı ʊmʊ -mä, 'nı ʊ yi lä -lıı 'kʊ 'bhlü. (sese)
and she took the things.
et elle, elle prit les choses.

creation 062

Ʊ 'bhää- yı -mɔɔ jiee' -zɔɔ -aaa,
She now began there in the south (lit. under the ocean) for a while
Elle a alors commencé au sud (litt. en bas de la mer) pendant un temps

creation 063

ʊ -kʊı 'mëëdä -aaa,
she kept on spreading the things until
elle a continué à répandre les choses jusqu'à ce qu'

creation 064

'nı ʊ yi lä pʊpʊʊ' 'lëkpëa 'klʊ glää-. (sese)
she had gone all around the world.
elle ait fait le tour du monde entier.

creation 065

Ʊ -glää -nöa ylä 'klʊ nä, (sese)
When it had now gone all around it, …
Quand elle en avait maintenant fait le tour, …

creation 066

-Näna n pä ylä -lää nä, (sese)
This one (=story) that I am telling here
Celui-ci (= conte) que je conte maintenant ici,

creation 067

aa' -wʊ 'lʊ -kä, (sese)
it doesn't have a song.
il n'a pas de chant.

creation 068

N yi -lätee 'sɔna 'laa 'pä.
I shall yet tell another one (=story).
Je raconterai encore un deuxième (=conte).

creation 069

N ka yı paa- nä,
When I shall have finished telling (lit. showing) it,
Quand j'aurai fini de le raconter (litt. montrer),

creation 070

ıı -lɔɔ' 'lʊʊ n nä n 'kä lä bhlı nä,
the songs that I want to sing,
les chants que je veux chanter,

creation 071

ɯ bhloodä -kʊ ylä -lɔɔ.
that is now their end.
c'est alors leur fin.

creation 072

ɬmɯ 'mnö naa, (sese)
In all this
Dans tout cela,

creation 073

'Nɛmʊ bhlüü- ylä wälɯnɯ 'kʊ naa, (sese)
Red Deer took these instructions (from God),
Biche Royale a pris ces consignes (de Dieu)

creation 074

'nɯ ʊ yii ylä nʊ -aaa
and she then carried them out
et elle les a alors suivies

creation 075

ɯ 'ylʊzɔɔ -a -kʊ ylä -zɯkä. (sese)
for the world where we now live today.
pour le monde où nous vivons aujourd'hui.

creation 076

Naa, Nɛmʊ nä, (sese) ʊmʊʊ- plöö- lä -dʊdʊ 'bä. (sese)
So Red Deer, *it is her that is the owner of the land.*
Donc, Biche Royale, *c'est elle qui est le propriétaire de la terre.*

creation 077

Ʊ 'ylɯbhɔ- ylä nä,
When Red Deer now returned,
Quand Biche Royale est maintenant retourné,

creation 078

ʊ yä yɯ lebhe nʊ,
she had then done the work,
elle avait alors fait le travail,

creation 079

lebhee yä yɯ bhɯä, (sese)
the work was now finished.
le travail était maintenant fini.

creation 080

-Mä ʊ wlo- ylä -plɯ nä,
But then it took a reflective look,
Mais alors elle a pris un air pensif (litt. regardé tranquillement),

creation 081

ʊ lä, “-A 'Bä (sese)

she said, “Our Father,

elle dit: « Notre Père,

creation 082

n yä yı 'bhlıı lebhee nʊ,

I have now done the work in all the countries, (lit. the work of all the countries)

j’ai maintenant fait le travail dans tous les pays, (litt. le travail de tous les pays)

creation 083

ɛ yä yı bhıä

it is now finished,

il est désormais fini,

creation 084

-mä wälıklë -bhlogbe -kʊ -lɔɔ nä,

but there is one thing,

mais il y a une seule chose

creation 085

aa' -lätee -zɔɔ -bhıɔ, (sese)

it is not finished yet.

elle n’a pas encore été faite.

creation 086

Nä n 'kä 'kwie 'gbë -gbaa (sese)

It is that I want to close the door to death

C’est que je veux fermer la porte à la mort,

creation 087

'kwie 'kä-anyı -lä -kä 'bhlä. (sese)

so that death will not hit us.”

afin que la mort ne nous frappe pas. »

creation 088

Ʊmʊ-lɔɔ' 'lʊʊ, sä wa bhlıʊ ylä naa: (sese)

That song, (here is) how you sing it:

Ce chant-là, (voici) comment on le chante:

creation 089

Atitizan! Tizan! Vumalu o![2]

(A song with the purpose of pleading with God to abolish death.)

(Un chant pour supplier Dieu d’abolir la mort.)

creation 090

Nä ʊmʊ ʊ yëku ɔ {ʊ} zɛɛ lä 'ŋnö. (sese)

So it is to herself that she dedicates the song (having been sent by God).

C’est son propre nom qu’elle cite (en chantant).

---

[2]Vumalu is a surname for Red Deer [transcriber’s note]. / *Vumalu est un surnom pour Biche Royale* [note du transcripteur].

creation 091

Sä Laagɔ -lä (ɔ){ʊ} nʊ bhɛ lä wälıı naa, (sese)
God having told her to to carry out the matter,
Comme Dieu lui avait dit qu'elle fasse les choses,

creation 092

ɔ {ʊ} yı ylä nʊ,
she had now done them,
elle les avait maintenant faites,

creation 093

-yä 'kwie 'kä ylä 'kʊ -säsänöɔ,
so that death should now decrease,
pour que la mort diminue désormais,

creation 094

-yä 'kwiee' kä -lä ylä nyıkpa 'bhlä kpänyı naa, (sese)
so that death should not hit people to such an extent,
pour que la mort ne frappe pas les gens si fort,

creation 095

ʊmʊ ɔmɔ ɔ bhlı ylä
it is that song she now sings.
c'est ce chant qu'elle chante alors.

creation 096

'Kwie ɔ {ʊ} mʊ ylä 'gbë 'yi -gbaa -kä. (sese)
It is to death that Red Deer will now go close the door.
C'est à la mort que Biche Royale s'en va maintenant fermer la porte.

creation 097

Nyıkpɔɔ' -lɔɔ -ɔ -kʊ ylä 'ylʊzɔɔ
There is someone in the world
Il y a quelqu'un dans le monde

creation 098

'nı wa la ylä -Zaagbɔ -kwlɛ naa, (sese)
and they call him Zagbo Spider,
et on l'appelle Zagbo l'Araignée, alors

creation 099

ɔmɔɔ- -yɔsɔ sloo- ylä. (sese)
he (Spider) and she (=Red Deer) now met.
les deux (Zagbo l'Araignée et Biche Royale) se sont rencontrées.

creation 100

Ɔ lä, 'Nɔɔ -lʊʊ -n bhɛɛ- lä mö nä, (sese)
He (=Spider) said, "My friend, (because of) the thing you are carrying,
Il (=Zagbo) dit: « Mon amie, à cause de ce que tu portes,

creation 101*

kä nyämʊ loo- lä 'kʊ, (sese)
*you really **are** out of breath,*
tu es vraiment essoufflée,

creation 102*

nä n 'kää- fää. (sese)
so I will accompany you."
donc je vais t'accompagner. »

creation 103

Ʊ lä, -A, 'a!
It (Red Deer) said, "Okay, if you like.
Elle (=Biche Royale)dit: « D'accord, si tu veux.

creation 104

Kä -n -nä -n 'bhlü 'kʊ -nä. (sese)
Do take it, then!"
Prends alors! »

creation 105

-Mä cɛkʊʊ ʊ bhɛɛ- lä nä,
Now the rock that it carried,
Or la pierre qu'elle portait,

creation 106

kä ʊʊ' 'bhliyee -kʊ lä nylä tobii' väna
its string (= the string attached to it for carrying it) was like the steering wheel of a car
sa corde (=corde y attachée pour la porter) était comme un volant de voiture

creation 107

wa 'tie lä nä. (sese)
that one drives,
qu'on conduit.

creation 108

'nɪ ɛɛ' -yɛ 'tɛ? (-nn) -ɛɛn'? (-nn)
and it is not hard (to handle?), *is it?*
puis il n'est pas dur (à manipuler?), *n'est-ce pas?*

creation 109

Ɛmɛ bhɛɛ- ylä (tobinö) tobii (sese)
That's what now keeps the car (in control).
C'est lui qui contrôle maintenant la voiture.

creation 110

Ɛ kä doo- nä,
If it is broken (lit. cut)
S'il est cassé (litt. cassé)

creation 111

εε' -yιε -nyimo -a?? (εε' nyimo)
is it not useless? (lit. spoiled) it is useless
n'est-il pas ruiné? il est ruiné

creation 112

-Zaagbɔ -kwlɛ 'nyigë- ylä 'nɛmυ nä, (sese)
Spider Zagbo now deceived Red Deer,
Zagbo l'Araignée a trahi Biche Royale,

creation 113

ɔ lä, -Amυ n yi 'bhliyee bhɛɛ. (sese)
he said, "It's I that will hold the string now;
il dit: « Moi, je tiendrai la corde;

creation 114

-Mä n kɛ yι bhɛɛ- nä, (sese)
But if I now hold it,
Mais si je la tiens maintenant,

creation 115

'kwie 'mö n mυ ylä 'gbë klä -kä. (sese)
it is to death that I now go to close (lit. seize) access (to the compound)."
C'est à la mort que je m'en vais maintenant fermer (litt. saisir) l'accès (à la cour). »

creation 116

'Lυnυ υmυ ɔ pä ylä -mɔɔ: (sese)
This is the song that he now sings (lit. throws):
C'est ce chant qu'elle entonne maintenant:

creation 117

Atitizan! Tizan! Bhokli[3] a lυ o! Bhokli a lυ plö o! Vumalu o!
(see line 089 above) Bhokli's song! Bokli's song! Red Deer!
(voir ligne 089 ci-dessus) chant de Bokli! chant de Bokli! Vumalu!

creation 118

Ɔɔ' zɛɛ yιε 'Nɛmυ 'ŋnö,
He (=Spider) doesn't mention Red Deer anymore.
Il ne mentionne plus le nom de Biche Royale,

creation 119

-mä ɔ yëku ɔ zɛɛ ylä 'ŋnö. ('m!)
but it is his own name that he now mentions (in the song).
mais c'est son propre nom qu'il mentionne désormais (dans le chant).

[3]If Vumalu is Red Deer's surname, Bhokli could be Spider's surname. */ Si Vumalu est le surnom de Biche Royale, Bhokli pourrait être le surnom d'Araignée.*

creation 120

'O! -A 'Bä lä, ' Ɔɔ!
Oh! Our Father (= God) says, "Oh dear!
Oh! Notre Père (= Dieu) dit: « Oh là là!

creation 121

-Ɔɔ -kä bhɛ {lä} sɔɔ! (sese)
It wasn't like that!
Ce n'était pas comme cela!

creation 122*

-Mä ɔ -kä bhlä wälıı nä,
But the one who was responsible for the matter,
Mais le responsable de l'affaire (litt. celui qui avait l'affaire),

creation 123*

ɔmɔɔ- plöö- -kä bhlä 'Nɛmʊ,
that one was Red Deer, wasn't it?
c'était Biche Royale, n'est-ce pas?

creation 124

'nı -mɔɔ 'titi -n zɛɛ ylä -pɛ -n yëku 'ŋnö nä,
And now yourself, you mention your own name!"
Et maintenant toi-même, tu mentionnes ton propre nom! »

creation 125

Ʊ lä, -Naa -lʊʊ -n bhɛɛ- ylä nä (sese)
He (= God) said to Spider, "The thing you are now carrying,
Il (= Dieu) dit (à Araignée): « La chose que tu portes maintenant,

creation 126

-lɔɔ ʊ 'kä lä too. (sese)
there it is going to stay."
c'est là qu'elle va rester. »

creation 127

-Jlibɔ 'titi -mati![4]
(Expression by which the narrator invites the audience to let him know that they want him to go on.)
(Expression par laquelle le narrateur invite l'auditoire de lui dire s'ils veulent qu'il continue.)

creation 128

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE:) Mati -a yläa-!
We have asked to hear more! (lit. it is 'mati' we have asked)
Nous avons demandé la suite! (litt. c'est 'mati' que nous avons demandé)

[4] This expression is only used by the two oldest narrators, Mr. Di Benoit and Mr. Kubeu. Its meaning is difficult to establish. It probably means something like 'A true riddle for you to hear!' / *Cette expression est seulement utilisée par les narrateurs les plus âgés, Mr. Di Benoit et Mr. Kubeu. Son sens est difficile à établir. Il veut probablement dire quelque chose comme 'Un vrai énigme pour vous!'*

creation 129

-Zaagbɔ -kwlɛ a, (sese) ɔmɔ -ɔ -lä -nöanyı lä wälını aa (nn).
Spider Zagbo, it is he that has brought this matter (=death) upon us.
Zagbo l'araignée, c'est elle qui a fait venir cette affaire (de mort).

creation 130

Ɔmɔ -ɔ -länöanyı lä 'kwienɛ aa.
It is he that has brought us death.
C'est elle qui nous a envoyé cette mort.

creation 131

Ɔmɔ -ɔ -länöanyı lä 'pʋpʋbhëa aa.
It is he that has brought us the world.
C'est elle qui nous a envoyé le monde.

creation 132

A ni lä 'pʋpʋʋ 'yi -a?
Do you see the world?
Est-ce que vous voyez le monde?

creation 133*

Jiee' -zɔɔ, -mɔɔ ʋ cie lä 'kʋ.
Down south (lit. under the ocean), that's where it begins.
Au sud, c'est là qu'il commence.

creation 134*

Kä -mɔɔ nää, -mä -aa -mänömö naa,
That place (lit. there) is good, but at this place where we are,
Cet endroit (lit. là-bas) est vraiment bon, mais chez nous ici,

creation 135

'tɛnyıı' ʋ {pʋpʋʋ} ŋëë ylä -mää nä,
as it (=the world) is now getting here,
au fur et à mesure qu'il (le monde) arrive ici,

creation 136

kʋ ŋwɛɛ- ylä 'yi 'kʋ,
it has now closed the eyes (= it has lost all its good sides)
il a maintenant fermé les yeux (= le monde a perdu ce qu'il a de bon)

creation 137*

'nı ʋ paa- lä -mää 'küküü -yä cɛkwıı 'sɔ.
and it put (lit. threw) here hills and rocks.
et il a mis (litt. jeté) ici des collines et des rochers.-

creation 138

lı' -zä -aa -mänömö -nyu lä.
That is why here where we are it is bad.
C'est pourquoi chez nous ici est mauvais.

creation 139

{-Tʊänɪ}
(Expression to inform the audience that the story has come to its end.)
(Expression informant l'auditoire que le conte est terminé.)

creation 140

Naa, 'yua ylä yɪ/wa yi yɪ -lää,
So, since the children have now come here
Donc, comme les enfants sont maintenant venus ici

creation 141

'nɪ wa ylä yɪ nä,
and they are asking now,
et qu'ils demandent

creation 142

-bhlɛ gämadä nää- nä,
and because having fun is a good thing,
et puisque l'amusement est bon,

creation 143

-naa 'klë -n -yi ylä nä,
your part that you know now,
ta part de connaissance que tu as maintenant,

creation 144

-n gä -yibhë nä, -naa 'yuë {-n soo}.
if you know, tell it to your children.
si tu as connu, c'est à tes enfants que tu parles.

creation 145*

ɭ plöö- gämalɪ.
It is fun.
C'est de l'amusement.

creation 146

ɭɪ' -zä n pä lä 'sɪɪ -lɔɔ 'nünë 'yɪ.
that's why I am telling that story, after all.
C'est pourquoi je dis ce conte-là.

3. Dacligo

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content : Why the bird Dacligo sleeps on feathers / *Contenu* : Pourquoi l'oiseau Dacligo dort sur des plumes
Speaker/Locuteur: D (70, male)
Date: 30-01–96

dacligo 001

-Ɔ plöö- lä -Dacligoo nä,
Dacligo (lit. the one who is Dacligo),
Dacligo (litt. celui qui est Dacligo),

dacligo 002

sɔɔ ɔ -kʊ lä
how it is
comment il se fait qu' il est là

dacligo 003

'nɪ ɔ pu lä zɪkä nümnünɪkpɪı 'kʊ nä,
that he sleeps nowadays on bird feathers
et (qu') il dort aujourd'hui sur les plumes d'oiseau,

dacligo 004

a -yi ɪı' -gbä -a? (AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE. 'nn)
do you know the importance of it? *no*
en connaissez-vous l'importance? (non) *non*

dacligo 005

-Dacligoonʊ, 'kläzɔnümnüü' -lefɪın -ɪ blu lä,
That Dacligo, all the birds of the bush that fly,
Ce Dacligo, tous les oiseaux de la brousse qui volent,

dacligo 006

-bluubluunümnü -ɪ -kä lä nɪkpɪı nä (nn)
the birds that fly and that have feathers
les oiseaux qui volent et qui ont des plumes

dacligo 007

ɪyä 'kläzɔmnaa 'sɔɔ- 'nii- lä tʊʊ' wälɪ 'kʊ. (nn)
and the animals of the bush were at war with each other.
et les animaux de la brousse ont été en guerre.

dacligo 008*

Tʊnʊ ɪ vë lä nä, (nn)
This war they were fighting,
Cette guerre qu'ils ont menée,

dacligo 009

sä -gbɔmnaa, kotükämnaa bhlä lä (-anʊ -dʊdʊ)
how the animals with hooves and the animals with claws were killing
comment les animaux à sabots et les animaux à griffes tuaient

dacligo 009a

-anʊ nümnüü nä, (nn)
what are they called, the birds,
comment on les appelle, les oiseaux,

dacligo 010

ɯ' {'nyɪ} -wʊ lä dä.
they (=the birds) didn't have a chance (lit. place).
ils ne leur donnent de chance (litt. place).

dacligo 011

'Mɛɛmʊ nümnüü kä wa bhlɯ sää 'titi
The very birds, they were really killing them
Les oiseaux même, ils les tuaient réellement

dacligo 012

-n nä sä wa bhlä lä zɔkpɔ nä. (nn)
as if they were killing flies.
comme s'ils tuaient des mouches.

dacligo 013

'Nɪ wa -mʊ lä tëgu -slä -kä (ao)
Then they (=the birds) went to do a war fetish (that would allow them to win the battle)
Alors ils (= les oiseaux) sont allés faire un fétiche de guerre (pour gagner la bataille).

dacligo 014

Tëgunʊ wa -mʊ lä slä -kä naa, (nn)
This war fetish that they went to do,
Ce fétiche de guerre qu'ils sont allés faire,

dacligo 015

wlä, -mä -ɔ 'gä bhä (-anʊ) toguu 'titi ʊʊ' -tëbhuu kää 'ä? (ään)
they said, "But who will be responsible for it?"
ils se sont dits: « Mais qui sera réellement volontaire pour porter la responsabilité du fétiche de guerre? »

dacligo 016*

-Mä -tëbhukänyɔɔ nä, ɔɔ' lü -kä gwi. (aa)
However, the one who is responsible for the war fetish, he must not eat palm nuts, as you know.

dacligo 017*

(mnaa') {nümnüü} -lefɪun wlä waa' {ɪ lä ɯ'} 'ylä -yɛɛ {-wʊ}. (nn)
All the (animals) {birds}, they refused (lit. they said they were not willing).

dacligo 018*

-Dacligoo lä, -Aa, n yi wälıı 'kʊ 'bhlü. (-ao)
Dacligo said, “Alright, I’ll take the matter upon me.”
Dacligo dit: « Je prendrai l'affaire sur moi. »

dacligo 019

-Dacligoonɔ, ɔmɔ -ɔ -kä lä tʊnʊ ʊʊ' -gʊgwaa. (-nn)
That Dacligo, it is he who took the responsibility of that war.
Ce Dacligo, c'est lui qui portait la responsabilité de cette guerre.

dacligo 020

-Mä tʊnʊ wa -yi ylä 'nı wa mʊ ylä vë -kä naa, (nn)
In that (phase of the) war they were now going to fight,
Mais (dans) cette (partie de la) guerre qu'ils sont venus faire ensuite,

dacligo 021

-mä nümnü bhlä lä sää -gbɔ/ɔ/mna nä. (nn)
the birds were killing the animals with hooves!
les oiseaux tuaient les animaux à sabots!

dacligo 022

'Aa! Kä a lä a slä tʊʊ 'wlu (ao)
Well, say it is better to negotiate for peace
On dit: Tenez! Il vaut mieux négocier pour la paix,

dacligo 022

'mɛmʊ 'tititi, cıcɛ 'titi, (nn-) ɛ kä 'nynigo,
if even the falcon, *if it stands upright,*
Même si l'épervier lui-même, il s'arrête *s'il se tient debout*

dacligo 023

cıcɛ bhlä ylä bholuzlä ä? (ɛɛ)
can it now kill a wild pig?
est-ce que l'épervier tue maintenant le sanglier?

dacligo 024

'Mɛɛmʊ 'gwɛ 'titi kɛ -kä 'fı
Even the chimpanzee, it is really strong,
Même le chimpanzé, il a de la force,

dacligo 025

-mä kä cıcɛ bhlɛɛ. (nn)
but the falcon kills it.
mais l'épervier le tue.

dacligo 026

ɛmɛ ɛ kä bluu, 'gblugblu!'
as for him, he jumps (beating its wings).
Lui, s’il saute, il frappe à grands coups d'ailes.

dacligo 027

Yii 'sɔ 'gba 'gba! C'est fini. (aa)
It is the two eyes that it hits (with its beak) and that's the end.
il frappe les deux yeux à coups de bec, c'est fini (=il les casse).

dacligo 028

Tʊnʊ, wa yä yı tʊnʊ vë -aaaaaaa,
That war, they fought it for a long time until
Cette guerre, ils ont alors fait cette guerre pendant longtemps.

dacligo 029

'mɛɛmʊ 'kläzɔmnaa 'titi, sä nümnüü bhlı lä nä, (nn)
even the animals of the bush themselves, the way the birds were killing them,
Même les animaux de la brousse eux-mêmes, la manière dont les oiseaux les tuent,

dacligo 030

-mä 'nı mnaa, kı bhlaä-anyı lä,
(they said), "The animals, they are really killing us
« Car les animaux, ils sont en train de nous tuer;

dacligo 031

nümnüü, kı bhlä-anyı lä. (nn)
the birds, they are really killing us."
les oiseaux, ils sont en train de nous tuer. »

dacligo 032

'Nı wa yi lä tʊnʊ 'wlu slä. (aa)
Then they negotiated for peace (lit. prick the war on the head).
Et ils ont négocié pour la paix.

dacligo 033

'Tɛnyıı' -mä wa -slä ylä tʊnʊ 'wlu nä, (nn-)
At the moment when they had now negotiated for peace,
Au moment où ils ont maintenant négocié pour la paix,

dacligo 034

wa kä yı tʊʊ 'wlu -slä
if one has negotiated (lit.pricked the war on the head)
Si on demande que la guerre finisse

dacligo 035

ʊ.. / kä ʊʊ' bhıä -wʊ -a? ('nn)
is it (=the war) not finished?
ne finit-elle pas?

dacligo 036*

Wlä -Dacligoo lä, Tʊʊ yä yı bhıä (nn)
Well, then Dacligo said, "The war is now over
Eh bien, Dacligo dit: « La guerre est finie maintenant,

dacligo 037*

nä a 'bhlü yı aa' -gʊgwaa 'kʊ! (aa)
so take back your war fetish (that you gave me to carry).”
alors reprenez votre fétiche de guerre! »

dacligo 038

Nümna -Da(cligo)…
The bird Dacligo…
L'oiseau Dacligo…

dacligo 039

Wälıı -Dacligoo ci nä, a nu -a? « ou bien » Walıı {-amʊ} Dacligoo {n} ci nä a nu -a? ('nn)
What Dacligo is saying, do you hear it?
Ce que Dacligo dit, est-ce que vous l'entendez?

dacligo 040

A bhlü yı aa' -gʊgwaa 'kʊ
Take your fetish now,
Prenez votre fétiche maintenant,

dacligo 041

n 'kä yı 'naa gwieye kpɔ. (nn-!)
I want to nibble my palm nut now!
je veux maintenant grignoter ma graine!

dacligo 042

Alee! A kä lää' nümnë nii- nä,
Come on, whenever it finds any kind of bird,
Allez! S'il trouve un oiseau quelconque,

dacligo 043

kä nümnëa 'täkänıɛ kee nä.
the bird actually turns its back on him.
l'oiseau lui tourne dos.

dacligo 044

Alee! A ka 'kʊ -bhlü
Come on! If he (=Dacligo) seizes him,
Allez! S’il (= Dacligo) le saisit,

dacligo 045*

ka sä -mɔɔ nʊkpʊ. (nn)
he takes a feather from him (lit. from there).
il lui (litt. y) enlève une plume.

dacligo 046

-N 'bhlü yı -gʊgwaa 'kʊ
(He says,) “Take now the fetish,
« Prends maintenant le fétiche,

dacligo 047

n 'kä 'naa gwieye kpɔ nä.
so that I can nibble my palm nut!"
pour que je puisse grignoter ma graine! »

dacligo 048

A kä lää' nümnë nii- nä,
Whenever it finds a bird,
S'il rencontre un oiseau quelconque,

dacligo 049

sä a nʊ lä 'kwɪɪ! 'kwɪɪ! 'kwɪɪ!
as he says, "Kwii! kwii! kwii!"
lorsqu'il fait « kwi! kwi! kwi! »

dacligo 050

nä sɔɔ ɔ sä -mɔɔ nʊkpʊ. (nn)
then at the same time it takes a feather from it,
alors en même temps il lui arrache une plume,

dacligo 051

N yi aa' nɪkpɪɪ 'kʊ pu (-ao)
(saying,) "I will sleep on your feathers."
(disant:) « Je vais dormir sur vos plumes. »

dacligo 052

Gbaa 'mnö -Dacligoo, ɔ 'slää lä nümnünɪkpɪ nä/nɪ, (aa)
The explanation why Dacligo, he tears out the animals' feathers,
L'explication pourquoi Dacligo, il arrache des plumes aux oiseaux,

dacligo 053

ɪmɪ -ɪ -kʊ lä -lää. (-ao)
that's it (lit. it is it that is here).
la voilà (c'est elle qui est là).

dacligo 054

Nümnüü ɪ 'bhlü yɪ -gʊgwaa 'kʊ (nn)
The birds, they should now come to take (back) their fetish,
Que les oiseaux viennent prendre leur fétiche,

dacligo 055

ɪyä -Dacligo 'kä -kɛ gwieye lü -mʊ nä, (nn)
so that Dacligo can also eat a palm nut,
pour que Dacligo puisse manger une graine de palme aussi,

dacligo 056

wlä nümnüü lä ɪ' 'ylä -wʊ.
it is reported that the birds say that they are not willing.
on dit que les oiseaux disent qu'ils ne veulent pas.

dacligo 057

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE /ANIMATEUR) ʅı' 'ylä -yıɔ.
They are no longer willing.
Ils ne veulent plus.

dacligo 058

-Dacligoo 'mɔ -ɔ -kä lä gwiee' 'gba.
It is Dacligo that has the palm nut as his totem.
C'est Dacligo qui a le totem de la graine.

dacligo 059

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE /ANIMATEUR) Ɔmɔ -ɔ -kä lä tʊʊ' -gʊgwaa.
It is he who has the war fetish.
C'est lui qui a le fétiche de guerre.

dacligo 060

(Conteur) Ɔmɔ -ɔ -kä lä tʊʊ' -gʊgwaa, (-ao)
It is he who has the war fetish,
C'est lui qui a le fétiche de la guerre,

dacligo 061

ʅı' -zä ɔ sä lä nümnüü nıkpıı'. (aa)
that's why he takes feathers from the birds.
c'est pourquoi il arrache les plumes des oiseaux.

dacligo 062*

N paa- 'naa 'nünë o!
There I have told (lit. shown) one of my tales!
Voilà, j'ai dit mon conte!

dacligo 063

zagbʊ -zagbʊ anyı 'wlu o![5]
zagbo, zagbo, on your head!
zagbo, zagbo, sur votre tête!

dacligo 064

-Tʊänı.
End.
Fin

dacligo 065

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE /ANIMATEUR) -Aa, Zagwä, -ayo o, -ayokä.
Well, Zagwa, thank you, thanks a lot.
Bon, Zagwa, merci, merci beaucoup.

[5]The meaning of *zagbʊ* is unknown. */ Le sens de zagbo est inconnu.*

4. Decesrad

Genre: Radio news / Nouvelles à la radio
Content: Information of a death case / *Contenu*: Annonce d'un décès
Speaker/Locuteur: E (40, female)
Date: 05-02-1993

decesrad 001

-zɪkää' -lɪɪ n nii- lä
Today's news (lit. the things of today) that I have found
Les nouvelles d'aujourd'hui que j'ai trouvé

decesrad 002

-yä n 'kanyɪ lä soo nä,
and that I am going to tell you,
et que je vais vous dire,

decesrad 003

tɛɛtɛwälɪklëa plöö- kwiee' wälɪ.
the first piece of news is about a case of death.
(est que) la première partie concerne la mort.

decesrad 004

-Aa 'bhlɪɛ 'mlö nyɪkpaa -wa -klää lä -a 'bä Fʊfʊɛ
The people from our country that have helped our father Houphouet
Les gens de notre pays qui ont aidé notre père Houphouët

decesrad 005

'nɪ ɔ -nʊ lä 'bhlɪɛ 'mlö lebhe
in his work (lit. and he worked) in this country
et il a travaillé dans le pays

decesrad 006

'nɪ 'bhlɪɛ -känöɔ lä -zɪkä 'klʊ nä,
and the development of the country (lit. the country has opened) today,
et le développement du pays (litt. le pays s'est ouvert) aujourd'hui,

decesrad 007

waa nëëdëë' lɔɔ' -bhlogbe, ɔmɔ -ɔ kuu- (wlä) bhlä.
one of them died.
l'un d'entre eux est mort.

decesrad 008

-Zëküü' 'ylʊʊ 'mʊ -lɔɔ wa -mʊɔ bhlä 'kubhutuu' -sä -kä.
On the day of yesterday, that's when they went to take him from the morgue.
C'est dans la journée d'hier qu'ils sont partis le sortir de la morgue.

decesrad 009

-Mä sä ɔ plöö- lä -a 'bä Fʊfʊɛɛ' gbʊkamänyɪkpɔ,
But as he was much appreciated by our father Houphouet,
Mais puisqu'il était homme cher à notre père Houphouët,

decesrad 010

'nı nyıkpɔɔ ɔ -gwlɛ lä 'sıı 'bhlıɛ lebhee 'mʊ nä,

and the man had also worked a long time for the country

et que cet homme aussi a duré dans le travail,

decesrad 011*

ı -ŋwa 'kʊ nylä -a 'bä Fʊfʊɛ 'titi nii- a -lɔɔ,

it is suitable that our father Houphouet himself would attend the ceremony (lit. see these things),

il est normal que notre père Houphouët lui-même assiste à la cérémonie,

decesrad 012*

ıyä wa 'kɔ -mɔɔ 'kubhutuu' -sä.

so they could take him (=the dead body) there out of the morgue.

pour qu'on l'enlève dans à la morgue.

decesrad 013*

 Lı 'ŋlöö 'mlö ɔ -yä ɔɔ lebhenʊnyʊa 'sɔ, ɔɔ 'kʊgënyʊa 'titi 'titi, ıyä ɔ 'ŋnɔ, -mɔɔ' nyıkpaa' -lefıın wa wlää- -mɔɔ 'kubhutuu 'mlö ('wlu),

Because of that he and his ministers (lit. workers), his suite, his wife, and the other people, they gathered there inside the morgue

Pour cela, lui et ses ministres (litt. travailleurs, ses protocoles, sa femme et tous les autres hommes se sont rassemblés à la morgue

decesrad 014

wa la lä Ivosɛpʊ -mää Abijä Trɛsövii nä.

called Ivosep here in Abidjan-Treichville.

qu'on appelle Ivosep ici à Abidjan-Treichville.

decesrad 015*

Wa wlää- a -mɔɔ 'wlu

They met together there

Ils se sont rassemblés là-bas

decesrad 016*

'nı wa -kʊ a -lɔɔ

and they were there

et ils étaient là

decesrad 017*

'nı wa yio -kä wä -mɔɔ -sä a.

and so they took him out of there, then.

et on l'a sorti de là.

decesrad 018

Ɔmɔ nyıkpɔɔ -mä wa yio 'sıı -zëküü' 'ylʊʊ 'mlö zizie.

That man, then, they will bury him on the day of tomorrow.

Cet homme donc, on l'enterrera dans la journée de demain.

decesrad 019

-Mɔɔ Dälʊwäbhlıɛ 'mlö, -mɔɔ' nyıkpɔ lä.
There from the Daloa area, he is a man from there.
C'est un homme de la région de Daloa.

decesrad 020*

Ɔmɔ wa la Albɛlö Bayi Taglɔ.
He is called Albert Bailly Tagro.
C'est lui qu'on appelle Alber Bailly Tagro.

5. Devinet

Genre: Riddle in folk tale form / Devinette sous forme de conte
Content: Who lost control? / *Contenu*: Qui a perdu le contrôle?
Speaker/Locuteur: D (70, male)
Date: 16-08–95

devinet 001

N nä
I would like
Je voulais

devinet 002

-a 'gä bhä 'döö 'pɛpɛlıä 'ŋʊ
us to have a little talk together
qu'on ait une petite causerie

devinet 003

ıyä -a 'gä bhä nyıä / ye.
to have fun.
pour nous amuser.

devinet 004

'Na 'ŋʊŋʊdöö wa 'kıa 'sıı wa 'bhlı fää.
My talk, they can also take it to their home country.
Ma causerie, elles pourront aussi l'emporter chez elles.

devinet 005

N na,
I say,
Je dis,

devinet 006

wlä nyıkpɔ,
once upon a time (lit. they say) there was a man.
il était une fois (litt. on dit) un homme.

devinet 007

nyıkpɔɔ -n -nä sä -mɔɔ Këklë -n -kʊ bhlä -lää nä,
The man, let's say you Kekle, you are here
L'homme, à supposer que toi Keukleu, tu sois ici

devinet 008

nyä -n 'gä bhlä Clikpëkʊ'ʊ -nönöŋnɔ bhibhie nä,
and you have courted a married woman from Trikpoko,
et que tu aies fait la cour à une femme mariée à Trikpoko,

devinet 009

nyä -n -yɔsɔ 'kä bhlä -wä nä,
and you have become lovers,
et qu'elle soit devenue ta maîtresse,

devinet 010

sɔɔ nyıkpɔɔ, sɔɔ ɔɔ' wälıı plöö- lä 'kʊ.
that's how the man, that's how his story went.
c'est comme ça que l'affaire de l'homme s'est passée.

devinet 011

Nyıkpɔɔ yi 'nı 'ŋnɔɔ mʊ,
The man goes and the woman comes,
L'homme vient et la femme va.

devinet 012

nyıkpɔɔ yi 'nı 'ŋnɔɔ mʊ.
the man goes and the woman comes,
l'homme va et la femme vient

devinet 013

'nı wa sloo.
and they meet.
et ils se rencontrent.

devinet 014

Ɔɔ' gbädöbhutuu 'mnö -mɔɔ wa sloo -klä a.
In her kitchen that is where they meet.
Dans sa cuisine à elle, c'est là qu'ils se rencontrent.

devinet 015

ı -nʊ yı 'ylʊ o!
Now one day it so happened
Il est arrivé un jour

devinet 016

ɔ nyɛɛ yı 'ŋnɔɔ ylıı.
that he gave a date to the woman.
qu'il a donné rendez-vous à la femme.

devinet 017

Ɔ lä -zɪkä'ä sɔlɪɛ -mɔnänaylʊ 'kʊ ɪ'ɪ {ʊ'ʊ} -kugbësä n yi -kä yi a!

He said, “Today Thursday evening, I’ll come.”

Il dit: « Aujourd'hui jeudi soir, je viendrai. »

devinet 018*

-Mä nyɪkpɔɔ bha 'klä'ä ɔ -kʊ 'kʊbibidä -aaa 'nɪ 'tänyɪ yi 'plö.

But as the man was leaving the field, he walked around in circles until the time (of the date) passed.

Mais l'homme revenu des champs est resté là à tourner sur lui-même jusqu'à ce que le temps (de rendez-vous) soit passé.

devinet 019

'Tänyɪɛ plöö- lä nä,

The time having passed,

Puisque le temps est passé,

devinet 020

ɪ'ɪ -zä ɔ lä n yi mʊ -mä n'n -lä 'ŋnɔɔ 'nyigë.

that’s why he said, “I’ll go, for I mustn’t dupe the woman.”

il dit donc: « Je partirai, car je ne dois pas tromper la femme. »

devinet 021

'Nɪ ɔ yi -blɔ 'kʊ bhlü o!

And he set out!

Il a pris la route!

devinet 022*

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'kʊ bha 'nɪ ɔ yi mʊ.

He got up and went.

Il s'est levé et est parti.

devinet 023

Ɔ -mʊ yɪ nä,

When he went,

Quand il est parti,

devinet 024

ɔ lä kä ɔ mʊ nä,

when he was just arriving

à son arrivée,

devinet 025

'ŋnɔɔ bhutuu wa 'su -nʊʊ sää dɪgasä -lɔɔ,

(the door of) the woman’s house had been (lit. they had) left ajar.

on avait légèrement rabattu (la porte de) la maison de la femme.

devinet 026

ʊ'ʊ (-yɛ){-wʊ} -lɔɔ mɛɛ

It wasn’t totally closed,

Elle (=maison) n'était pas totalement fermée,

devinet 027

wa 'su -nʊʊ -lɔɔ.
it had been left ajar.
elle avait été légèrement rabattue.

devinet 028*

Wa gëë -mɔɔ -bhutu'u -kadlükpɔ taa 'yi.
Three pieces of wood had been lit (lit. they had lit) there in the house.
On avait allumé, dans la maison, trois tisons.

devinet 029

'ŋnɔɔ wa -tlɔ -bhutupapʊʊ 'klʊʊ.
The woman had been turned (lit. they had turned the woman) towards the wall.
On avait tournée la femme vers le mur.

devinet 030

Ɔ 'nagɔ bhɛ,
He was her friend
Il était son ami,

devinet 031

-a, 'nı kɔ ghlü bhlä…
yes, but he was also coming like a thief (lit. he was really stealing).
oui, mais il venait aussi comme un voleur (litt. il volait vraiment).

devinet 032

Gblë! 'Nı ɔ yi -mɔɔ -bhutu'u plä.
He quickly entered the house.
Aussitôt, il est rentré.

devinet 033

Ɔ -plä ylä -bhutu'u naa,
When he had now entered the house,
Quand il est rentré dans la maison,

devinet 034

'ŋnɔɔ 'mɔ ɔ 'dıda ylä 'mʊ:
he started shaking the woman saying,
il s'est mis à secouer la femme disant:

devinet 035

Mädämʊ! -Plıı…! Mädämʊ! -Plıı..!
“Madam!” Silence! “Madam!” Silence!
« Madame! » Silence! « Madame! » Silence!

devinet 036

-A, -mä sä n'n -wʊ sisio -yi nä (Acɛlı o…)
“It is true, I haven’t come quickly,
« C’est vrai, je ne suis pas vite venu,

devinet 037

n'n -wʊ sisio -yi nä,
I haven't come quickly,
je ne suis pas vite venu,

devinet 038 *

ı'ı -zä -n -kʊ -plıı -a? /
is it because of that that you keep silent?"
est-ce à cause de cela tu es silencieuse? »

devinet 039

-Plıı…! /
Silence!
Silence!

devinet 040*

N'n -wʊ sisio -yi, ı'ı -zä -n -kʊ -plıı -a?
"I haven't come quickly, is it because of that that you keep silent?"
« Je ne suis pas vite venu, est-ce à cause de cela que tu es silencieuse? »

devinet 041

Mëu…!
Not a word!
Elle est restée bouche cousue!

devinet 042

-Jagogo -mati a!
(By this expression the narrator interrupts his story at a point of suspense, wanting to make sure the audience shows interest in what follows. Its meaning is something like, "Do you want me to continue?" or "Listen to what is coming now!")
(Par cette expression, le narrateur interrompt son histoire à un point de suspens, voulant s'assurer que l'auditoire est intéressé par la suite. Elle pourrait signifier quelque chose comme: « Voulez-vous que je continue? » ou « Écoutez la suite! »

devinet 043

'ŋnɔ nɔ, -zıglägba (kɔ),
That woman, what is surprising
Cette femme, ce qui est surprenant,

devinet 044

'ŋnɔɔ yä 'ku
she is dead
elle est morte,

devinet 045

'nı ŋwadio'o -wʊ sɔɔ -yi
and the man doesn't know
le garçon ne sait pas

devinet 046

'nɪ ɔ ylɔ lä 'kʊ.
and he is asking her questions.
et lui pose des questions.

devinet 047

Ɔ -yotobheli yi ylä
Her brother-in-law is then coming,
Son beau-frère vient alors,

devinet 048

gbüglënëa 'kʊ ɔ nyinigo ylä,
at the threshold he stops,
il s'arrête alors au seuil de la porte,

devinet 049

ɔ lä, 'Na 'ŋnɔ, -ayokä!
saying, “My wife, hello!”
Il dit: « Ma femme, salut! »

devinet 050

Kɔ bhlö.
She doesn’t react.
Elle ne réagit pas.

devinet 051

N -yoto (-yɛ){-wʊ} -lɔɔ -kʊ,
“Your husband isn’t here,
« Ton mari n'est pas là,

devinet 051a

(laughs) 'nɪ -naa nyämʊ yä bhɪä nä,
and your breath is finished
et ton souffle est fini,

*devinet 052**

bheeje -nn 'bhlää -lä -kä.
so please forgive me (lit. don’t hit me).”
pardon, ne m’en veux pas. »

devinet 053

'Nɪ -mɔɔ -bhutuu sämɪbhlügudë.
Then there in the house there are steps of someone trying to escape.
Soudainement des bruits de pas de quelqu'un en fuite…

devinet 054

Bhutu'u -lɔɔ mʊ -zɔɔ 'wlʊ kää
The one in the house came out,
celui qui était dans la maison est sorti,

devinet 055

ɔ mʊ jlu 'kʊ -lɔɔ 'yi -döö 'kä nä,
bumping into the one on the doorstep,
embrassant (heurtant) celui qui était sur le seuil,

devinet 056

'nyiniklë puu -lɔɔ.
excrements are lying there.
des déchets sont là par terre.

devinet 057

-Ɔ nyʊa 'a?
Who defecated?
Qui a déféqué?

devinet 058

Sɔɔ n ylä lä.
That's what I am asking.
C'est cela que je demande.

devinet 059

(Gbaklé, AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE ; ANIMATEUR:)
Acɛlɪ, Wli, sɔɔ ɔ ylää…
Aceli, Wli, that's what he is asking…
Aceli, Wli, c'est ce qu'il a demandé…

devinet 060

Wa'a 'nu {-wʊ}(-yɛ) nä…
They are not getting it, so …
Puisqu'elles ne comprennent pas…

devinet 061

Ɔ la, nyɪkpa 'sɔ,
He said that the two men,
Il dit que les deux hommes,

devinet 062

-nɔnɔ -kʊa -mɔɔ -bhutuu 'mnö,
one was in the house
l'un était dans la maison

devinet 063

'nɪ -nɔnɔ -kʊ jlu 'kʊ.
and the other one was outside.
et l'autre était au dehors.

devinet 064

-Mä -ɔ -kʊ lä -bhutuu 'mnö nä,
Now the one who was in the house,
Mais celui qui était dans la maison,

devinet 065

ɔ'ɔ -wʊ sä 'ŋnɔɔ yä 'ku nä -yi.
he didn’t know that the woman was dead
il ne sait pas que la femme est morte.

devinet 066

'Nɪ -nɔnɔ -ɔ -kʊ lä jlu 'kʊ {nä},
And the other one, who was outside,
Et celui qui était au dehors,

devinet 067

ɔmɔ ɔ -yi sä 'ŋnɔɔ ɔ yä 'ku.
as for him, he knew that the woman was dead.
lui, il savait que la femme était morte.

devinet 068

'Ŋnɔɔ -ɔ -kʊ lä -mɔɔ -bhutu'u nä,
The woman who was in the house,
La femme qui était dans la maison,

devinet 069

'ŋnɔɔ 'kuu -mɔɔ.
she had died there.
la femme y est décédée.

devinet 070

Ɔ -yi nä, kɔ so lä 'kukuŋnɔɔ nynä
When he (=the brother-in-law) came, he spoke to the dead woman, saying,
Quand il est venu, il (= le beau-frère) s'est mis à dire au cadavre de la femme,

devinet 071

-n -nyoto'o -wʊ -lɔɔ -kʊ,
“As your husband isn’t here,
« Puisque ton mari n'est pas là,

devinet 072*

nä 'na 'ŋnɔ nɔ, -n kʊ -kä -lɔɔ
so my dear woman, so do stay around
donc ‘ma femme’, tu dois rester là

devinet 073*

-yä n 'kä du'u 'dö fä,
so that I can take the news to the village,
pendant que je porte la nouvelle au village,

devinet 074*

-yä -n -nyoto kä -kɛ -yi nä,
so that when your husband will have come,
pour que si ton mari vient,

devinet 075*

-a 'gä -kɛ -naa wälıı bhobho.
we may deal with your problem.”
nous puissions penser à toi. »

devinet 076

-Mä 'tɛnyı'ı -mɔɔ bhutuu 'mnö nyıkpɔɔ nuu lä wälıı nä,
Now the moment the man there in the house heard the words,
Mais quand celui qui était dans la maison a entendu les paroles,

devinet 077

kɔ bhlüü sämı 'kʊ
he became afraid
il prit peur

devinet 078

'nı ɔ yi -zɔ 'wlʊ kä'ä.
and he ran out.
il courut pour sortir de vitesse.

devinet 079*

-Mä 'tɛnyıı' ɔ pa ylä -mɔɔ -gbʊgbaa
When he was now pushing the door
Mais quand il a maintenent poussé la porte

devinet 080*

'nı ɔ wlʊ ylä -zɔ nä,
and was about to go out,
et qu'il allait sortir,

devinet 081*

ɔ lä ɔ wlo jlu 'kʊ
he wanted to go outside,
il veut aller dehors,

devinet 082*

nä nyıkpɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ.
then someone was there.
alors un homme est là.

devinet 083

Wamä 'sɔ, -nɔnɔ mʊ -guu kä'ä
The two of them, one wanted to flee
Tous les deux, l 'un cherchait à fuir

devinet 084

'nı -nɔnɔ döö ɔ lünyëkpëo 'yi
and the other bumped into his fellow
et l'autre s'est retrouvé dans les bras de son semblable

devinet 085

'nı wa -bhlü -zɔ.
and they fell down
et ils sont tombés.

devinet 086

Wa -nyɔ -lɔɔ 'nyini
They defecated there,
Ils ont déféqué là,

devinet 087

nä -ɔ -nyʊı bhä?
so who did it?
donc qui l'a fait?

devinet 088

Plɛ -bha bhä kpänyı 'mnö'ö?
Who of the two was really terrified?
Qui d'entre les deux a été sincèrement effrayé par la situation?

devinet 089

(Acɛlı + Wli:) -A 'nı -wʊ -yi
We don't know.
Nous ne le savons pas.

devinet 090

(Gbaklé, AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE ; ANIMATEUR:)
A 'nı -wʊ -yii?
You don't know?
Vous ne le savez pas?

devinet 091

Ɔ -kʊ lä jlu 'kʊ nä ɔmɔ plɛ -bha lä 'mnö.
The one who was outside, he was really terrified.
C'est celui qui est au dehors qui a été {le plus}effrayé.

devinet 092

K: {Ɔmɔ -ɔ -yi nä,} ɔmɔ -nyɔ 'nyiniklëa.
The one who came, it was he who defecated
C'est lui qui est venu, c'est lui qui a déféqué.

devinet 093

G: Ɔmɔ -ɔ -nyɔ 'nyiniklëa.
It was he who defecated.
C'est lui qui a déféqué.

devinet 094

Sɔɔ wa ci lä.
So they say.
C'est ce qu'on dit.

6. Elisabet

Genre: Bible story told from the perspective of one character / Récit biblique raconté de la perspective d'un des personnages
Content: Elizabeth tells her son John (later called the Baptist) about the circumstances of his birth / *Contenu* : Elisabeth raconte à son fils Jean (plus tard appelé le Baptiste) quelles étaient les circonstances de sa naissance
Speaker/Locuteur: F (27, male)
Date: 21-02-1995

elisabet 001

'Naa 'yunɔ, -amʊ n plöö- -n 'nɔ.
My son, I am your mother;
Mon fils, je suis ta mère.

elisabet 002

-Maa 'tɛnyıɛ 'mʊ n -yä -n 'bä 'sɔ, -a nii- lä nä,
But when your father and I, we met
Mais quand ton père et moi, nous nous sommes rencontrés

elisabet 003

'nı -a -kʊʊ lä 'kʊ nä,
and we were living together,
et que nous vivions ensemble,

elisabet 004

-a -kʊʊ 'kʊ -aaa
we were together until
nous étions ensemble jusqu'à ce que

elisabet 005

'nı 'tɛnyı -tlʊmä 'mʊ.
a lot of time had passed (lit. time had become deep).
beaucoup de temps ait passé (litt. le temps était devenu profond).

elisabet 006

N -plä 'kɔgwlɛ,
I had become old (lit. I entered old age),
Je suis devenue vieille (litt. je suis entré dans la vieillesse),

elisabet 007

'nı -n 'bä -plä 'kɔgwlɛ.
and your father had become old.
et ton père est devenu vieux.

elisabet 008*

-A -bhibhie Laagɔ
We prayed to God
Nous avons prié Dieu

elisabet 009*

-a 'gä 'yu gä,
that we might have a child,
pour faire un enfant,

elisabet 010*

{-mä} -aa -wʊ 'kɔɔkɔ 'yu -gä.
but we had never had one.
mais nous n'avions jamais eu d'enfant.

elisabet 011

-Lɔɔ -tlʊmä yı 'mʊ,
A long time after that now,
Cela a pris du temps maintenant,

elisabet 012

-aa' bhobho bhɛ 'yugäwälı,
we no longer thought about having a child
nous ne pensions plus avoir d'enfant,

elisabet 013

'nı -n 'bä
then your father,
puis ton père,

elisabet 014

'tɛnyı -bhloo' -kʊ -lɔɔ
there was a time
il y eut un jour

elisabet 015

'nı ɔ -mʊ lä Zolizalɛmʊʊ'.
when he went to Jerusalem.
et ton père est parti pour Jérusalem.

elisabet 016*

Ɔ plöö- bhlä 'släkäsänyɔ
He was a priest,
Il était sacrificateur,

elisabet 017a

nä ıı 'ŋnöö 'mnö, ɔ -mʊ Zolizalɛmʊʊ'
so that's why he went to Jerusalem,
donc à cause de cela il est allé à Jérusalem,

elisabet 017b

ɔ 'kä 'släkä -sä.
in order to offer sacrifices.
pour faire des sacrifices.

elisabet 018

-Mɔɔ -bhutuu, -Laagɔbhutuu 'mlö, -mɔɔ ɔ -kʊ,
There in the house, in the house of God, there he was
Dans la maison, dans la maison de Dieu, c’est là qu'il était

elisabet 019

'nɪ Laagɔɔ' -papükänyɔ -ghläɔ lä 'yii'.
and an angel of God appeared to him.
et un ange de Dieu lui apparut.

elisabet 020

Laagɔɔ' lobholobhonyɔ -yi lä,
God’s messenger came
L'envoyé de Dieu est venu,

elisabet 021*

'nɪ ɔ cii- lä nylä
and he said that
et il a dit que

elisabet 022*

-a yi 'yu gä.
we would have a child.
nous allions faire un enfant.

elisabet 023

'Ɔɔ! N -nyoto Zakali plɛ 'kʊ 'ninio,
Well, my husband Zachariah was astonished,
Eh bien, mon mari Zacharie fut étonné,

elisabet 024

sä ɔ yä bhɛ 'kɔgwlɛ plä,
because he had become old,
parce qu’il était vieux,

elisabet 025

'nɪ -amʊ -mä n yä bhɛ 'sɪ 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä,
and as for me, I had also become old, so
et moi, j’étais aussi devenue vieille, donc

elisabet 026*

kä -a bhobho {bhɛ} nylä
we really thought
nous avons vraiment pensé que

elisabet 027*

-aa -lä bhɛ 'yu gä.
that we would not get a child.
que nous n’aurions plus d’enfant.

elisabet 028

Ɔ -soo lä sɔɔ -Laagɔzuzuu nylä,
He said to the angel of God,
Il a dit à l'ange de Dieu ceci:

elisabet 029*

-Amʊ Zakalii, n yä 'kɔgwlɛ plä,
“I, Zachariah, I have become old
« Moi, Zacharie, je suis vieux,

elisabet 030*

nä nn -lä yıɔ 'yu gä nä,
I can no longer beget a child,
je ne peux plus faire d’enfant,

elisabet 031*

'nı 'naa 'ŋlɔ yä 'sıı 'kɔgwlɛ plä nä,
and my wife has also become old, so
et ma femme aussi est vieille, alors

elisabet 032*

-aa -lä yıɔ 'yu gää nä,
we will no longer have a child.”
nous ne ferons plus d’enfant. »

elisabet 033

-Laagɔzuzuu 'mlö 'nöʊ -wʊ mɛmä,
God’ s angel wasn’t pleased,
L’ange n’était pas content,

elisabet 034

'nı ʊ -gbä
and he caused
et il a fait que

elisabet 035

'nı -n 'bä -wʊ 'mʊ -sää -aaa,
your father not to be able to speak
ton père ne pouvait pas parler

elisabet 036

'nı ı -nʊ 'tɛnyı.
for a while (lit. and it made time).
pendant un temps (et cela a fait du temps).

elisabet 037

Ɔɔ -wʊ 'mʊ -sää -aaa,
He wasn’t able to speak for a long time,
Il ne pouvait pas parler pendant longtemps

elisabet 038

'nɪ n -plä lä -naa nʊkplaa.
and I became pregant with you (lit. I entered your pregnancy).
et je suis devenu enceinte avec toi (litt. je suis entré dans ta grossesse).

elisabet 039*

Kä -Laagɔzuzuu -sonöɔ lä nylä,
God's angel said to him,
L'ange de Dieu lui a dit:

elisabet 040*

-Nn -lä yɪɔ -zɪkä 'mʊ -sää.
"As of today you will no longer be able to speak,
« A partir d'aujourd'hui tu ne pourras plus parler,

elisabet 041

sä n cii- lä 'naa wälɪɪ,
because I spoke my words
parce que j'ai dit mes paroles

elisabet 042

'nɪ -n 'nöɪ -wʊ lä -nʊawlɛ laa nä,
and you didn't believe them (lit. you didn't call them truth).
et tu ne les as pas crues (litt. tu ne les a pas appelées vérité).

elisabet 043

-Nn -lä yɪɔ 'mʊ -sää -kaa
You will no longer be able to speak until
Tu ne pourras plus parler jusqu'à ce que

elisabet 044

'nɪ 'tɛnyɪ yi 'mʊ tlʊmä.
a long time will have passed."
beaucoup de temps aura passé. »

elisabet 045

N -plä -naa nʊkplaa
I became pregnant with you (lit. I entered your pregnancy)
Je suis tombée en grossesse avec toi (litt. j'ai eu ta grossesse)

elisabet 046

'nɪ n -kaa
I was pregnant (lit. I had it (=pregnancy)),
et je l'avais (= la grossesse),

elisabet 047

a 'ghlümë yɪ,
it now increased,
elle grossissait alors,

elisabet 048*

'nı nyëbluo wa la lä Zozi nä,
then the young boy they called Jesus,
puis l'enfant qu'on appelle Jésus,

elisabet 049*

ɔ 'nɔ Mali,
his mother Mary
sa mère Marie,

elisabet 050*

ɔmɔ -mä, -Laagɔzuzu yio bhlä 'sıı -mɔɔ 'kʊ kwlii,
on her an angel of God also came down there
sur elle, l'Esprit de Dieu est aussi descendu là

elisabet 051*

'nı ʊ yio bhlä soo.
and he spoke to her.
et il lui a parlé.

elisabet 052

Ɔ plöö- a 'sä 'yuŋlʊgbɛnyı 'lɛ.
She was still practically a young girl at the time.
Elle était alors pratiquement une jeune fille encore.

elisabet 053

-Mä 'sɔ ɔ -kʊ,
But in spite of her age (lit. but that is how she was),
Mais malgré son âge (litt. mais ainsi elle était),

elisabet 054*

ɔɔ -lä bhä tee 'wlie nöö.
she hadn't married a man (lit. a husband) yet.
elle n'avait pas encore épousé un homme (litt. un mari).

elisabet 055*

'Nı -Laagɔzuzuu -sonöɔ bhä 'sıı
Then an angel from God had told her, too,
Alors l'ange de Dieu lui a parlé aussi en disant que

elisabet 056*

nylä ɔ yi bhä 'sıı 'yu gää
saying that she would also give birth to a child.
elle aussi, elle allait avoir un enfant.

elisabet 057

Ɔmɔ wa 'kä bhä Zozi la.
He would be called (lit. him they would call) Jesus.
Il sera appelé (litt. lui ils appelleraient) Jésus.

elisabet 058

ɩyä -mɔ 'Zanbadisö nä,
And you, John the Baptist,
Et toi, Jean Baptiste,

elisabet 059

-mɔ 'gɔ bhä 'yi 'kʊ 'plö tɛɛ
you will pass before him
tu seras devant lui

elisabet 060

ɩyä -n 'gä ci nylä,
and you will say that
et tu diras qu'

elisabet 061

kɔ yi -kä,
he is really coming,
il doit vraiment venir,

elisabet 062

Laagɔɔ' 'yuo, kɔ yi -kä.
God's son, he is really coming
le Fils de Dieu, il doit vraiment venir.

elisabet 063

Ɔmɔ Zoziinɔ, ɔmɔ plöö- {lä} 'ylʊ-zɔnyɪkpaa' -lɔɔ nëë-sänyɔ.
Him, that Jesus, it is he who is the saviour of mankind.
Ce Jésus, il est le sauveur de l'humanité.

elisabet 064

N -plä lä -naa 'gʊʊ nä,
I was pregnant with you, so
J'étais en grossesse de toi, alors

elisabet 065

'nɪ 'tɛnyɪ -kʊ yɪ -lɔɔ,
then a time was now there
un temps est arrivé

elisabet 066

-Laagɔgbʊʊ 'mlö 'nɪ, n yi-i lä gää.
when by God's grace, I gave birth to you.
où par la grâce de Dieu, je t'ai mis au monde.

elisabet 067

N -gänö-ö lä nä,
When I had given birth to you,
Quand je t'avais mis au monde,

elisabet 068

ɩ -nʊ yɩ 'ylɩ -ngbɔɔsɔ,
after seven days now
cela a alors fait sept jours,

elisabet 069

'sɔlɩcëa -glää lä 'klʊ nä,
at the end of the week,
à la fin de la semaine,

elisabet 070

'nɩ 'Jlusʊnyʊa yi lä yi.
then the Jews came.
puis les Juifs sont venus.

elisabet 071

-Anyɩa gbäkökʊnyɩkpaa 'fɩɩn -kʊ lä -mɔɔ,
All our neighbours were there,
Tous nos voisins étaient là,

elisabet 072*

'nɩ wa yi yi, 'ŋlɩä -yä 'yuë.
and they came, women and children.
et ils sont venus, femmes et enfants.

elisabet 074

Wlä,
They said,
Ils ont demandé:

elisabet 075

'Yuo' 'ŋnö bhä?
“What is the child’s name?”
« Quel est le nom de l'enfant? »

elisabet 076

-Lɔɔ' da 'kʊ nä,
At that time
En ce temps-là,

elisabet 077*

-n 'bä, ɔ yä'ä wɛzä -naa 'ŋlöö paa-.
your father, he had already told (lit. shown) me your name.
ton père, il m'avait déjà dit (litt. montré) ton nom.

elisabet 078

Ɔ lä -mɔ plöö- 'Zan nä,
He had said that you would be John, so
Il avait dit que tu t'appellerais Jean, donc

elisabet 079

n -yi bhɛ 'ŋlöö.
I already knew the name.
je savais déjà le nom.

elisabet 080

-Mä ɔmɔ, ɔɔ -sää bhɔɔ lä 'mʊ nä,
But as for him, since he was not speaking,
Mais lui, comme il ne parlait pas,

elisabet 081

nyıkpaa -yi lä nä,
when the people came
quand les gens étaient venus

elisabet 082*

wa ylɔɔ- lä
(and when) they asked him
et qu'ils lui demandaient

elisabet 083*

'yuoo' 'ŋlö bhä nä,
what the name of the child was,
quel était le nom de l'enfant,

elisabet 084*

ɔ lä
he wanted that (lit. said)
il voulaiit

elisabet 085*

wa -lɔ kplupä.
them to bring him a slab.
qu'on lui apporte une plaque.

elisabet 086

'Nı wa yio kplupaa -lä.
And they brought him the slab.
Et on lui a apportée la plaque.

elisabet 087

Kplupänä 'klʊ -lɔɔ ɔ -jɪjlä lä -naa 'ŋlöö
It was on this slab that he wrote your name,
C'est sur cette plaque de bois qu'il a écrit ton nom,

elisabet 088

nylä -mɔɔ plöö- Zan.
saying that you are (to be called) John.
disant que tu t'appelais Jean.

elisabet 089

'Tɛnyɪ ɔ pää- ylä sɔɔ 'ŋlöö nä,
When he gave you that name,
Au moment où il t'a donné ce nom,

elisabet 090

kä waa -lefɪn, kä plɛ 'kʊ 'niniwa.
all of them, they were really astonished.
eux tous, ils étaient étonnés.

elisabet 091*

Wlä, 'Ɔɔ! -Naa 'lɔlʊkpa 'mlö, nyɪkpɔɔ' -kä Zan plöö-,
They said, “Well, in your family no one is called John, though;
disant: « Quoi donc! il n'y a personne dans ta famille qui soit appelé Jean,

elisabet 092

'nɪ -n pä bhä Zan -a?
and you call him John?”
et tu l'appelles Jean? »

elisabet 093

'Nɪ -n 'bä yiwa soo nylä :
and your father said to them,
Et ton père leur a dit:

elisabet 094*

Laagɔ 'mɔ -ɔ cii nylä
“It was God who said that
« C'est Dieu qui m'a dit de

elisabet 095*

n 'pɔnyɪ nä,
I am to give it to him,
le lui donner,

elisabet 096

ɪ -zä n pɔɔnyɪ.
that is why I gave it to him.”
c’est pour cela que je le lui ai donné. »

elisabet 097

Nä -n ni dä n -ghlää lä nä.
So you see what happened to me (lit. where I have passed).
Maintenant tu vois ce qui m'est arrivé (litt. par où j'ai passé).

elisabet 099

Nn' gää bhɔ 'yu,
I could no longer give birth to a child,
je ne faisais plus d'enfant

elisabet 100

'nɪ nn -lä bhɔ 'kɔɔkɔ 'yu gää,
and I will no longer give birth to a child,
et je n'en ferai plus,

elisabet 101

'nɪ -n 'bä -mä ɔɔ -lä bhɔ 'yu gää.
and as for your father, he will no longer beget a child.
et ton père pour sa part, il ne fera plus d’enfant.

elisabet 102*

-Mɔ -bhlogbe 'co, -mɔ plöö- lä -anyɪa 'yu,
You alone, you are our child,
C’est toi seul, tu es notre enfant,

elisabet 103*

-lɔɔ Laagɔ nyɪ-anyɪ lä nä.
the one that God has given us.
celui que Dieu nous a donné.

elisabet 104*

lɪ -zä n mii,
That is why I seize the opportunity
C’est pourquoi je prends cette occasion

elisabet 105*

'nɪ n sonö-ö lä 'sɪɪ 'sɔɔ,
to also tell you about that,
pour te dire cela aussi,

elisabet 106

-n 'gä -kä sä Laagɔ -gbä
so you will (know) how God
pour que (tu saches) comment Dieu a fait

elisabet 107

'nɪ -a mii,
enabled us
que nous soyons en état

elisabet 108

'nɪ -a nii- lä nä,
to have you,
de t’avoir,

elisabet 109

-n 'gä -kä 'sɔɔ yibhë.
so you know that.
pour que tu le saches.

elisabet 110*

-Lɔɔ n bhloo -bhlɛ.
There I stop for now.
Là je m'arrête pour le moment.

7. Filsprod

Genre: Bible story told from memory; exhortation from line 302) / Récit biblique raconté de mémoire; exhortation à partir de la ligne 302
Content: Parable of the prodigal son, followed by an exhortation / *Contenu*: Parabole de l'enfant prodigue, suivi d'une exhortation
Speaker/Locuteur: B (40, male)
Date: August / Août 1995

filsprod 001

Nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe, ɔmɔ mii-[6] lä
A certain man, he had come (lit. been able) to
Un homme, c'est lui qui a pu

filsprod 002

'nɪ -ɔ -gää lä ɔ'ɔ 'yuë.
have children.
avoir des enfants.

filsprod 003*

-Mä ɔmɔ nyɪkpɔɔ nä,
Now that same man,
Or cet homme,

filsprod 004*

ɔ plöö- a nyɪkpa 'kädɔ.
he was an important man.
il était un grand homme.

filsprod 005*

Ɔ -kä a lɪ,
He had riches
Il avait des richesses

filsprod 006*

'nɪ ɔ -kä a -gänʊnyʊä.
and he had slaves.
et il avait des esclaves.

[6]The frequent use of this modal verb is part of the narrative style of this narrator. Its basic meaning is 'to be able to' or 'to be equal to'. In context, however, its exact meaning is mostly difficult to capture and therefore translated in different ways or left untranslated. / *L'usage fréquent de ce verbe modal fait partie du style de ce narrateur. Son sens de base est 'pouvoir, être capable' ou 'être égal'. En contexte, son sens précis est le plus souvent difficile à établir. Le mot est donc traduit de diverses manières, voire laissé non traduit.*

filsprod 007

-Mä ɔmɔ nyɪkpɔnɔ -gää lä 'yuënä 'sɔ nä,
Now that same man had these two sons
Mais cet homme avait ces deux enfants,

filsprod 008*

-ɔ plöö- lä bʊkʊ -lɔɔ nä,
the one who was the younger one
celui qui était le cadet,

filsprod 009

ɪ -nʊ 'tɛnyɪ -bhlogbe
there was a certain time
il y eut un temps

filsprod 010

'nɪ ɔ yi ɔ 'bä soo,
when (lit. then) he talked to his father
et il a parlé à son père,

filsprod 011

(nylä) ɔ lä, -A 'bä,
saying, "Our father,"
en ces termes: « Notre père, »

filsprod 012

ɔ lä:
he said,
il dit:

filsprod 013

-Naa jaa, -n dë -nöa
"Your heritage, divide it up
« Ton héritage, partage-le,

filsprod 014

ɪyä -n 'gä 'na -laa 'nyɛ,
to give me my part
pour me donner ma part,

filsprod 015

ɪyä 'na 'bhlɪ 'kʊ 'na plɛ -waa lä nä,
so that the country that I like
pour que dans le pays que j'aime,

filsprod 016

n 'kä -mɔɔ mʊ.
I can go there."
je peux allers là-bas. »

filsprod 017

-Mä ɔ 'bä mii lä nä,
Now his father,
Or son père

filsprod 018

ɔ'ɔ -wʊ -mää wälı paa-,
he didn't call for advice
il n'a consulté personne

filsprod 019

'nı ɔ yi mii
and proceeded to
et il a procédé à

filsprod 020

'nı ɔ yi lä (-n) jaanä dëë,
divide up that heritage
partager cet héritage,

filsprod 021*

'nı ɔ yi lä bʊkʊlɔ'ɔ dä 'nyɛ.
then he gave the younger one his part.
et il a donné au cadet sa part.

filsprod 022*

'Yikʊ -gä -lɔɔ, ɔmɔ, kɔ -kʊɔ a yëku
As for the elder one, he, he stayed with him,
Le premier-né, pour sa part, il restait auprès de lui (=le père),

filsprod 023

'nı ɔ -yɔ 'sɔ nʊa lebhe.
and he and he worked together.
et les deux ensemble faisaient (le) travail.

filsprod 024

-Mä ɔ'ɔ sä ɔ nyıɔ ylä ɔ'ɔ -laa nä,
Now as soon as he (=the father) had given him (=the younger one) his part,
Dès qu'il (=le père) lui (=au cadet) avait donné sa part de biens,

filsprod 025

ɔ 'nöö dä jaa nä,
à peine avait-il (=le père) partagé l'héritage,

filsprod 026

ɔ -bha lä 'kʊ nä,
he (=the younger son) got up
il (=le fils cadet) se leva

filsprod 027

'nɪ ɔ yi 'bhlɪ kätä'ä mlɔɔ.
and disappeared into an unknown country (lit. country in the back).
et il disparut dans un pays inconnu.

filsprod 028

-Mä ɔ mii lä nä,
Now he proceeded to
Alors il a pu

filsprod 029

ɔ -mʊ lä nä -mɔɔ nʊmlä -bhitii 'mlö,
go to the pubs there
aller dans les bistrots là-bas

filsprod 030

-mɔɔ ŋlʊgbɛnyua yëku,
beside the young girls there,
et auprès des filles là-bas,

filsprod 031

-mɔɔ lɪɪ'ɪ -lefɪɪ 'mlö.
into all the things there.
et dans toutes les choses là-bas.

filsprod 032

-Mɔɔ ɔ plö lä,
It is there that he passes
C'est là-bas qu'il passe

filsprod 033*

'nɪ ɔ nyima lä monie
and he is wasting the money
et il dilapide l'argent

filsprod 034*

ɔ 'bä nyɪɔ- lä nä.
his father had given him.
que son père lui avait donné.

filsprod 035*

-Mä,
Now
Or,

filsprod 036*

ɔ -nyima monie -aan,
he wasted the money until
il dilapida l'argent jusqu'à ce que

filsprod 037*

'nɪ monie, ɛ yio 'mʊ -bha
the money, it was gone,
l'argent, il soit parti,

filsprod 038*

ɛ yio wlɪ' bhɪä.
it was finished (lit. finished in his fingers).
il a fini entre ses mains.

filsprod 039

-Mä 'tɛnyɪ' moniinɛ -bhɪɔ ylä wlɪ' nä,
Now when that money was finished,
Or, quand cet argent était fini entre ses mains,

filsprod 040

sä 'yɪ 'titi ɔ 'kä yɪ nʊ
what (lit. how) is he going to do now
comment il va faire maintenant

filsprod 041

-yä ɔ 'kä yɪ lü nä…
in order to eat…
pour manger maintenant…

filsprod 042

'Tɛnyɪ' moniinɛ -bhɪɔ ylä wlɪ nä,
When that money was now finished in his hands,
Quand cet argent était fini entre ses mains,

filsprod 043

'nɪ ɔ yi lä mii 'nɪ ɔ yi mʊ.
he then proceeded to leave.
alors il est parti.

filsprod 044

Ɔ lä,
He said,
Il dit:

filsprod 045

Kä n 'kä lä nyɪkpa'a bholuzälöö ɪ'ɪ lebhe nʊ.
“I am going to work for the owners of pigs.
« Je vais faire le travail pour les propriétaires de porcs.

filsprod 046

Amʊ 'gɪ 'kʊ wloo,
I am going to look after them (=the pigs),
Je vais les (=les porcs) surveiller,

filsprod 047

n 'kı lülülıı 'nyɛ.
I am going to feed them.
je vais leur donner de la nourriture.

filsprod 048

-Lɔɔ'ɔ 'tɛnyıı nä,
At the same time
Au même moment,

filsprod 049

n kı lülülıı 'nyɛdä -kʊ nä,
while I'll be feeding them
quand je serai en train de leur donner de la nourriture,

filsprod 050

'nı n kı 'mʊ lebhe -nʊdä -kʊ nä,
and while I'll be doing that work,
et quand je serai à ce travail,

filsprod 051

lülülıı nä,
the food,
la nourriture,

filsprod 052

bholuzälö'ö lülülıı, ı yi'i 'kʊ ŋë,
the food for the pigs, there will be leftovers
la nourriture des porcs, il va en rester

filsprod 053

'nı n yi lü -mʊ.
and I will also eat."
et je pourrai en manger aussi. »

filsprod 054

Mlaanö 'mö ɔ -bɛ yı 'klʊ,
It was those animals that he looked after now,
C'était ces animaux qu'il gardait alors

filsprod 055

-mä wa kä bholuzälö lülülı 'nyɛ nä,
but when they fed the pigs,
mais quand on donnait la nourriture aux porcs,

filsprod 056

lülülı'ı -wʊ -zu,
the food wasn't much
la nourriture n'était pas beaucoup

filsprod 057

'nı ı 'kɔ yı 'kʊ ŋë,
and what would be left over for him,
et ce qui lui restait alors,

filsprod 058

ɔmɔ 'titi nä, sä ɔ 'kä lä nʊ
he himself, what should he do
lui-même, comment il va faire

filsprod 059

ɔ 'kä lä lü nä,
in order to eat,
pour manger,

filsprod 060

ɔ 'ni -wʊ sɔɔ.
he doesn’t see how (lit. that way).
il ne voit pas comment.

filsprod 061

Ɔ -kʊ -mɔɔ
He is there
Il est là

filsprod 062

'nı -gbugbe bhlɔɔ.
and he is hungry.
et il a faim.

filsprod 063

Bholuzälöö, -lıı 'titi (ɔ) {ı} lü bhlä,
The pigs, the very things they were eating
Les choses même que les porcs mangeaient,

filsprod 064

ɔ nyıı bhlä -yä (wa kä bhä lü nä,)
that he was giving them (they were giving them)
qu’il leur donnait (qu'on leur donnait)

filsprod 065

ı 'kä bhlä lü nä,
so they would eat,
pour qu'ils le mangent

filsprod 066

n -yä -ı 'gä bhä lä mii
and from which he hoped
et dont il espérait

filsprod 067

n -yä ı 'gɔ bhɛ lä 'kʊ ŋë,
that something would be left for him
qu'il en resterait pour lui,

filsprod 068

nı'ı -wʊ -zu nä,
as it (= that food) wasn't much,
comme ce n'était pas beaucoup,

filsprod 069

ı'ı ŋë nöɔ -wʊ 'kʊ.
nothing was left for him.
il ne lui en restait pas.

filsprod 070

-Gbugbe nɛ bhlɔ yı.
He was so hungry (lit. that hunger is killing him) now.
Et il a tellement faim (litt. cette faim le tuait) maintenant.

filsprod 071

Ɔ yä sıa,
He was tired,
Il était fatigué,

filsprod 072

ɔ -lefıı yä 'sää plʊ plä,
he was dirty all over.
il était devenu sale.

filsprod 073

ɔ'ɔ yıɔ 'kʊwloosä -kä.
You couldn't look at him anymore.
Il n'était plus beau à voir.

filsprod 074

Ɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ
He was there
Il était là

filsprod 075

'nı ɔ yi bhobhowlu 'ni,
and he started thinking,
et il se mit à réfléchir,

filsprod 076

ɔ lä, -Mɔɔ n 'bä yëku,
saying, "There with my father,
disant: « Là-bas chez mon père,

filsprod 077

ɔ'ɔ -käkäälı nı,
his workers there,
ses travailleurs-là,

filsprod 078

ı lü
they eat
ils mangent

filsprod 079

'nı lülülıı 'sıı,
and also the food,
et la nourriture aussi,

filsprod 080

'nı -lıı -ji 'kʊ
there are leftovers.
elle est en reste.

filsprod 081

'Nı ɔmɔ 'titi ɔ'ɔ 'gbëa 'mlö -mɔɔ'ɔ nyıkpa 'lü,
And in his own house, people eat
Et dans sa propre maison, les gens mangent

filsprod 082

'nı lülülı sıwa.
and they eat to the full (lit. the food makes them tired).
et ils mangent à satiété (litt. la nourriture les fatigue).

filsprod 083

Nä -amʊ -yi lä
Whereas I have come
Alors que moi je suis venu

filsprod 084

'nı -gbugbe 'bhlää lä -mää -a,
and hunger is killing me here,
et la faim me tue ici,

filsprod 085

'nı n nä
and I am sure (lit. I say) that
et je suis sûr (litt. je dis) que

filsprod 086

n 'kä lä -mää 'ku -a!
I am going to die here!
je vais mourir ici!

filsprod 087

Ɔ kä 'sɔɔ nä,
Since it is like that,
Comme c’est ainsi,

filsprod 088

n yi mii
I’ll proceed
je procèderai

filsprod 089

'nı n yi 'ylıbhɔ
to return home
à retourner à la maison

filsprod 090

'nı n yi -a 'bä yëku mʊ.
and I’ll go to our father.
et j’irai chez notre père.

filsprod 091

N kä -mʊ nä,
When I’ll have gone
Quand je serai allé,

filsprod 092

nı n kä -a 'bä -ŋëë nä,
and I’ll meet my father
et que je rencontrerai mon père,

filsprod 093

n yio soo nylä,
I’ll say to him,
je lui dirai:

filsprod 094

-A 'bä n yä nyenyi nʊ Laagɔ dëlü'ü yä -mɔɔ yëku nä,
“Our father, I have sinned before God and before you
« Notre père, j'ai fait du péché devant Dieu et devant toi,

filsprod 095

nn' yıɔ -naa 'yu 'plö,
(so) I’ll no longer be your child
je ne vais plus être ton enfant

filsprod 096

-mä -naa lebhenʊnyʊa 'mlö nä,
but among your workers,
mais parmi tes travailleurs,

filsprod 097

n 'kä yı -mɔɔ'ɔ nyıkpɔ 'plö.
I'll now be one there."
je voudrais y être. »

filsprod 098

-Ma 'tänyı'ı 'mʊ ɔ ciia wälıklënä nä,
But when he said those words (lit. that piece of words)
Mais lorsqu'il disait cette parole,

filsprod 099

a bhlɔ a.
they afflicted him (lit. it killed him).
elle le tourmentait (litt. elle le tuait)

filsprod 100

Sä ɔ 'kä lä mii,
How he would be able
Comment il va pouvoir faire

filsprod 101

(n -yä) {ıyä} ɔ 'kä lä nä
to walk,
pour marcher,

filsprod 102

ɔ 'kä lä yi {ıyä}
to come and
pour venir et

filsprod 103

ɔ 'kä lä ɔ 'bä yëku ŋë nä,
arrive at his father's,
arriver chez son père,

filsprod 104

wälını, ı bhlɔ bhä.
that matter, it afflicted him.
cette affaire, elle le tourmente.

filsprod 105

-Mä wälıklënä ɔ cii- lä nä,
But those words that he spoke
Mais cette parole qu'il avait dite,

filsprod 106

a nyıɔ a pɔlö 'tɛtɛ
they gave him encouragement
elle lui donna du courage

filsprod 107

'nɪ ɔ mii
and he was able
et il a pu

filsprod 108

'nɪ ɔ yi a nä,
to come
venir (litt. et il venait)

filsprod 109

'nɪ ɔ yia yi.
and he came.
et il est venu.

filsprod 110

-Mä ɔ -yia nä
Now when he came,
Or, lorsqu'il est venu

filsprod 111

ɔ -kʊ -blëlë
he was (still) far off
alors qu'il était (encore) au loin

filsprod 112

'nɪ ɔ 'bä nio lä 'gää 'yi nä,
and his father saw him,
et que son père le voyait de loin,

filsprod 113

kɔ -futo -dʊdʊ 'kʊ
he got up
il (=le père) se leva

filsprod 114

'nɪ ɔ bhlü sämɪ 'kʊ
and started running
et se mettait à courir

filsprod 115

'nɪ ɔ yi mʊ
and he went
et il est allé

filsprod 116

'nɪ ɔ yio 'yidöö.
and embraced him
et il l'a embrassé.

filsprod 117*

Ɔ woo,
He screamed
Il criait

filsprod 118*

ɔ lä,
saying,
disant:

filsprod 119

'Na 'yuo
“My child
« Mon enfant

filsprod 120

-ɔ -too bhlä nä,
who was lost
qui était perdu

filsprod 121

ɔmɔ n yä lä -zɪkä 'ni.
it is him that I have found (again) today
c'est lui que j'ai (re)trouvé aujourd'hui.

filsprod 122*

N -luë bhlä nylä
I had thought that
J’avais pensé qu’

filsprod 123*

ɔ 'kuu bhlä nä,
he had died,
il était mort,

filsprod 124

ɔmɔ ɔ yä lä -zɪkä 'kuë glɔɔ.
it is he that has woken up from the dead today.”
c'est lui qui s’est réveillé des morts aujourd'hui. »

filsprod 125

Ɔ lä,
He said,
Il dit:

filsprod 126

A -lä 'nyu
“Bring water,
« Apportez de l'eau

filsprod 127

n -yä a 'kɔ büdaa!
and wash him!”
et vous allez le laver! »

filsprod 128

-Mä 'tɛnyı 'mʊ ɔ 'bä cii ylä sɔɔ nä,
Now when his father spoke like that
Or au moment où son père parlait ainsi,

filsprod 129

ɔ 'bä -yi
his father had come
son père était venu

filsprod 130

'nı ɔ döɔ ylä 'yi nä,
and he had then embraced him,
et l'avait alors embrassé,

filsprod 131

-lɔɔ 'tɛnyı'ı nä,
at that moment
à ce moment,

filsprod 132

kɔ mii 'nı ɔ -soo ɔ 'bä nylä,
he (=the son) proceeded to speak to his father
il (=le fils) a procédé à dire à son père

filsprod 133

ɔ lä, -A 'bä,
saying, “Our father,”
disant: « Notre père, »

filsprod 134

ɔ lä,
he said
il dit:

filsprod 135

N yä nyenyi nʊ -mɔɔ wlı'ı -yä Laagɔ yëku nä.
“I have sinned against you and against God.”
« J'ai fait du péché devant toi et devant Dieu. »

filsprod 136

Nä ɔ lä, Nn' yıɔ -wa nylä
So he said, “I no longer want to
Et il dit: « Je ne veux plus

filsprod 137

n 'plö yı -naa -wawayu,
be your beloved son,
être ton fils bien-aimé,

filsprod 138

-mä n -wa nylä -naa lebhenʊnyʊa,
but I want to be like your workers
mais je veux être comme tes travailleurs,

filsprod 139

-naa -tleklenyikpaa 'mlö nä,
among your hirelings,
parmi tes journaliers,

filsprod 140

n 'kä -mɔɔ lebhe nʊʊ.
I'll work there.
je veux travailler là-bas.

filsprod 141

-Mɔɔ -n -nä 'bhlü -nö'ö yı 'kʊ,
Put me there to work for you now,
Mets-moi avec eux pour travailler pour toi,

filsprod 142

-mä n yä nyenyi'i bhlüü.
for I have fallen into sin."
car je suis tombé dans le péché. »

filsprod 143

-Mä ɔ 'bä bhɔ -nını 'mänyı
But his father didn't care about what he said
Mais son père n'a pas tenu compte des ces paroles

filsprod 144

'nı ɔ yi mii
and he proceeded
et il a procédé

filsprod 145

'nı ɔ yio a soo,
to speak to him,
à lui parler

filsprod 146

ɔ lä, A (büdë) {büda} 'na 'yuo.
saying, "Wash my child!
en disant: « Lavez mon enfant!

filsprod 147

A mʊ,
Go,
Allez,

filsprod 148

a -lä 'kwëti,
bring clothes,
apportez des habits,

filsprod 149

a -lä 'süü,
bring shoes,
apportez des chaussures,

filsprod 150

a plɔɔ 'mʊ!
dress him!
habillez-le!

filsprod 151*

A mʊ
Go,
Allez,

filsprod 152*

-yä a -lä -mɔɔ' -sikaa -kpätlʊweyee
and bring the gold ring that is there
et apportez la bague en or qui est là-bas

filsprod 153

'ɪyä a 'ŋʊɔ wlɪ'ɪ!
to put it on his finger!
pour la lui mettre au doigt!

filsprod 154

ɩyä 'naa 'bhabhlɛɛ,
And my sheep
Et mon mouton

filsprod 155

'naa bhabhlɛɛ n bhʊa bhlä
my sheep that I brought up
mon mouton que j' élevais

filsprod 156

'nɪ ɛ -kʊ bhlä -lɔɔ nä,
and that is there
et qui est là,

filsprod 157

'bhabhlö 'kädɛɛ,
the big sheep,
le gros mouton,

filsprod 158

a -lɛ
bring it
apportez-le

filsprod 159

-yä a 'bhlɛɛ
and kill it,
et tuez-le,

filsprod 160

'ıyä n 'kɔ -zıkä 'wugä 'wlu 'ŋʊ.
so that I can comfort him today.
pour que je puisse le réconforter aujourd'hui.

filsprod 161

-Mä 'na 'yuo
For my child,
Car mon enfant

filsprod 162

-ɔ kuu bhlä nä,
who was dead,
qui était mort,

filsprod 163

ɔmɔ n yä lä -zıkä 'ni.
it is him that I have found again today.
c'est lui que j'ai retrouvé aujourd'hui.

filsprod 164

N -luë bhlä 'kwie'e nä,
I had thought he was dead
J'avais pensé qu'il était mort,

filsprod 165

ɔmɔ n yä lä -zıkää 'ni.
it is him that I have found again today.
c'est lui que j'ai retrouvé aujourd'hui.

filsprod 166

Nä -zıkä'ä 'ylʊ nʊ ʊ plöö- 'na gämaylʊ.
So today is my day of celebration.
Donc aujourd'hui est mon jour de fête.

filsprod 167

-Mä ɔ yäa 'ku
For he was dead
Car il était mort

filsprod 168

'nı ɔ yä lä 'kwie -bhaa.
and he has come back from death."
et il est revenu de la mort. »

filsprod 169

-Mä 'tɛnyı'ı 'bäɔ cii ylä sɔɔ nä,
Now when the father said that
Mais quand le père a dit cela,

filsprod 170

lebhenɛ 'mö wa mii
that work, they proceeded
c'est ce travail qu'ils (=les serviteurs) ont pu

filsprod 171

'nı wa -nʊʊ 'yuo yëku.
to do do it for the son.
et ils l'ont fait pour l'enfant.

filsprod 172

Lülülını 'mö wa mii
It is that food they proceeded
C'est cette nourriture qu'ils ont procédé

filsprod 173

'nı wa -pi lä.
to cook
à préparer.

filsprod 174

Wa mii-
They proceeded to
Ils se sont mis

filsprod 175

'nı wa -kʊı lü dä.
to eat it and were eating it.
à manger et mangeaient.

filsprod 176

-Ɔ plöö- lä ɔ'ɔ 'yikʊ -gälɔɔ nä,
The one who was his older brother
Celui qui était son aîné,

filsprod 177

ɔ mii-
he could
il a pu

filsprod 178

'nı ɔ -kʋa 'klä'ä.
be in the field.
être au champ.

filsprod 179

-Mä 'tɛnyı'ı ɔ mii lä,
Now at the time when he could
Or, au moment où il a pu

filsprod 180

'nı ɔ -kʋ lä 'klä'ä nä,
be in the field,
être au champ,

filsprod 181

ɔ lä ɔ yi nä,
he wanted to come,
il voulait venir

filsprod 182

ɔ 'bä'ä 'gbëa 'mlö, -mɔɔ 'lʊ'ʊ kplü gbä,
from his father's compound, there was the sound of music there,
de cour de son père, là-bas il y avait le bruit de musique,

filsprod 183

-mɔɔ'ɔ gämalı'ı kplü gbä.
there was the sound of celebration.
là-bas (il y a) le bruit de réjouissances.

filsprod 184

Ɔ yi mii …
Then he could…
Alors il a pu…

filsprod 185

Ɔ 'bä lebhenʋnyʋa 'nı ɔ yi mii
His father's workers, he could then
Les travailleurs de son père, et il a alors pu

filsprod 186

'nı ɔ yiwa la.
call them.
les appeler.

filsprod 187

Ɔ yi wa'a 'lɔ -bhlogbe la,
He called one of them,
Il a appelé l'un d'entre eux,

filsprod 188*

ɔ lä, « -N yi -wʊ -zɪkä -wʊ. »
saying, "Come here!"
en disant: « Viens ici! *»*

filsprod 189

Nyɪkpɔnɔ -yio lä yëku nä,
When that man came up to him,
Quand cet homme est venu auprès de lui,

filsprod 190

ɔ lä -mä
he asked him (lit said)
il lui a demandé (litt. dit)

filsprod 191

-ɔ -kʊ bhä -lɔɔ?
what was going on.
ce qui se passait.

filsprod 192

Wlä nyɪkpɔɔ lä,
The man said,
L'homme dit:

filsprod 193

« 'N, -n bhelio, -naa 'bʊkʊʊ -lɔɔ,
"No, your brother, the one after you,
« *Non, ton frère, celui qui te suit,*

filsprod 194

-ɔ -mʊ bhlä
who had left
qui était parti

filsprod 195

'nɪ -ɔ -too bhlä,
and who had been lost
et qui était perdu,

filsprod 196

'nɪ -a -luë nylä
and (of whom) we thought that
et dont nous croyions que

filsprod 197

-ɔ yä bhlä 'ku nä,
he had died,
il était mort,

filsprod 198

ɔmɔ -zɪkä'ä 'ylʊnʊ,
him, this day of today,
lui, ce jour d'aujourd'hui,

filsprod 199

ɔmɔ -ɔ 'ylɪbhɔ- lä nä,
it is he who came back
c'est lui qui est revenu

filsprod 200

ɔmɔ -ɔ -yi lä ɔ 'bä yëku nä,
and who came to his father,
et qui est allé auprès de son père

filsprod 201

sɔɔ ɔ 'bä nʊ lä -pʊpɛ.
that's why his father is celebrating.
c'est pour cela que son père fait une célébration.

filsprod 202

Nä -lä'ä bhabhlɛ 'kädɛ
So the big sheep here
Alors le gros mouton d'ici,

filsprod 203

-ɛ -kʊ bhlä -lää nä,
which was here
qui était ici,

filsprod 204

ɛmɛ ɔ bhlää- lä nä,
it was that he killed
c'est lui qu'il a tué

filsprod 205

ɛmɛ -a lü lä. »
it is that we are eating."
et c'est lui que nous mangeons. »

filsprod 206

Nä 'tɛnyɪ'ɪ ɔ mii ylä
So when he had now
Donc lorsqu'il a pu

filsprod 207

'nɪ ɔ -sonöɔ ylä sɔɔ nä,
said that to him
lui dire cela,

filsprod 208

-ɔ plöö- 'yikʊgälɔɔ nä,
the elder one,
celui qui était l'aîné,

filsprod 209

ɔ 'nɪ yɪɔ -wamä.
he wasn't pleased (lit. didn't like it) anymore.
il n'était plus content (litt. ne l'aimait plus).

filsprod 210

Ɔ lä, -Aa!
He said, "Aha,
Il dit: « Ah!

filsprod 211

-mä sää -a 'bä -kʊ -a!
so that's what our father is like!
Mais notre père, c'est comme cela qu'il est!

filsprod 212

-Amʊ nɔ,
As for me here
Moi là,

filsprod 213

-ɔ mii
who
qui

filsprod 214

'nɪ -ɔ -kʊɔ yëku
am with him
suis auprès de lui

filsprod 215*

'nɪ n nʊ 'kɔɔkɔ ɔ'ɔ lebhe
and I always work for him
et qui travaille toujours pour lui

filsprod 216

'nɪ n mʊ 'klä'ä/
and I go to the field
et je vais au champ

filsprod 217

'nɪ n nʊ -lɪ'ɪ -lefɪɪn,
and I do all the work
et je fais tous les travaux (litt. toutes les choses)

filsprod 218

'nɪ -ɔ plöö- a 'naa bʊkʊʊ -lɔɔ,
and the one who is my younger brother,
et celui qui est mon cadet

filsprod 219

ɔ yä mii/
he (=the father)
il (= le père)

filsprod 220

'nɪ ɔ yä ɔ'ɔ dä jaa 'nyɛ,
had given him his part of the heritage
lui avait donné sa (=fils) part d'héritage,

filsprod 221

'nɪ ɔ yä 'kʊ 'bhlü
and he had taken it
et il l'avait pris

filsprod 222

'nɪ -ɔ -yä a 'sɔ yä mʊ/
and he had left with it
et qui était parti avec

filsprod 223

'nɪ ɔ yä ɔ'ɔ lɪɪ nyima nä,
and he had wasted his fortune
et il avait gaspillé sa fortune,

filsprod 224

ɔ 'ylɪbhɔ lä 'mʊ nä,
he is coming back
il revient

filsprod 225

'nɪ ɔ -yi lä -lä nä,
and he came here
et il est venu ici

filsprod 226

ɔmɔ ɔ bhlä lä mla 'kʊ
and it is for him that he (=the father) kills animals
et c'est pour lui qu'il (=le père) tue des animaux

filsprod 227

'nı ɔ -nʊ lä gämalı -a!
and he is celebrating
et il fait une fête!

filsprod 228

'lzä -amʊ -ɔ -kʊɔ lä yëku nä,
Whereas for me who is with him,
Alors que pour moi, qui suis auprès de lui,

filsprod 229

ɔ'ɔ -lä -zä 'ylʊ -bhlogbe 'kʊ 'bhlü
he has never yet taken a single day
il n'a jamais pris un seul jour

filsprod 230

'nı ɔ 'kä bhä ci nylä
and said,
et il aurait dit:

filsprod 231

'Na 'yunɔ, gämalı yi lä nä,
“My son, there is something to celebrate, so
« Mon fils, il y quelque chose à fêter, donc

filsprod 232

-n ni -nʊnʊ, -n 'gä lü!
take that and eat!”
prends-cela et mange! »

filsprod 233

Plɛkʊ -ʊ si'i lä.
I am angry.
Je suis fâché.

filsprod 234

Nn' -lä yı sɔɔ -za plä.
I shall never go inside because of that.”
Je n’entrerai jamais à cause de cela. »

filsprod 235

-Mä 'tänyı'ı nyıkpɔnɔ 'ylıbhɔ lä 'mʊ nä,
But as the man was going back (into the house)
Mais quand cet homme rentrait (dans la maison),

filsprod 236

kä 'yunɔ ɔ 'bä mii
that son, his father
cet enfant, son père

filsprod 237

'nɪ ɔmɔ 'titi -bha 'kʊ
himself got up
lui-même se leva

filsprod 238

'nɪ ɔ yi yi
and he came (out)
et il est venu (dehors)

filsprod 239

'nɪ ɔ yi ɔ -yowli yëku ŋë.
and he came up to his son.
et il est arrivé auprès de son fils.

filsprod 240

Ɔ lä, -A 'bä,
He (=the son) said, "Our father,"
Il (=le fils) dit: « Notre père, »

filsprod 241

ɔ lä,
he said
il dit:

filsprod 242

-Mä -amʊʊ- -kʊ -lää
"I who am here
« *Moi qui suis ici*

filsprod 243

'nɪ -ɔ nʊ -naa lebhee nä,
and who works for you,
et qui travaille pour toi,

filsprod 244

-ɔ plöö- -naa 'yuo,
who is your son
qui suis ton fils

filsprod 245

-n 'nöɔ bhɛzä ɔ'ɔ dä nyɛ,
had you not already given him his part,
ne lui as-tu pas déjà donné sa part

filsprod 246

ɔ'ɔ -wʊ -mʊ -a?
did he not leave?
n'est-il pas parti?

filsprod 247

-Mä sɯ -kʊ a
But this being so,
Mais puisque c'était comme cela

filsprod 248

'nɪ -n mi a
(how) can you
(comment) peux-tu

filsprod 249

'nɪ ɔ -yi bhä
when he came
quand il est revenu

filsprod 250

'nɪ -n bhlä bhä -lä'ä 'bhabhlö 'kädɛ nɛ'ɛ?
kill the big sheep here?
tuer le grand mouton?

filsprod 251

-Amʊ 'nö a yëku kʊ
Have I not stayed (here with you)
Et moi n'ai(-je) pas toujours été avec toi

filsprod 252

'nɪ ɔ 'nö a lebhe nʊ nä?
and have I not worked (for you)?
et n'ai-je pas travaillé?

filsprod 253

-N yä mii
Have you
As-tu pu

filsprod 254

-n yä mlɛ bhlä
killed an animal
tuer un animal

filsprod 255

-n yä'ä 'nyɛ -a?
and given it to me?
pour me le donner?

filsprod 256

-N yä'ä 'ylʊ -bhlogbe mlɛ 'nyɛ nylä
Have you ever given me an animal (telling me)
M'as-tu un seul jour donné un animal (me disant) que

filsprod 257

n yä 'na 'nagwıä 'sɔ 'kä lü -a?
I could eat with my friends?
je mange avec mes amis?

filsprod 258

'Nı ɔmɔ mö
And that one,
Et celui-là,

filsprod 259

-ɔ -mʊ
who left
qui est parti

filsprod 260

'nı -ɔ -nyimaa -naa -lıı nä,
and who wasted your fortune
et qui a dilapidé ta fortune

filsprod 261

ɔmɔ -n yi
(for) him you come
(pour) lui tu viens

filsprod 262

'nı -n bhlä mla 'kʊ -a?
and you kill an animal?"
et tu tues un animal? »

filsprod 263

(Ɔ lɔ) {Ɔ} 'bä lä, -Ayo!
His father said, "Thank you, (=calm down)
Son père dit: « Thank you! (= calme-toi)

filsprod 264

Wälıı -n ci lä,
What you have said
La parole que tu as parlée,

filsprod 265

ımı -n cii,
that's what you have said (=it is correct).
c'est cela que tu as dit (= c'est juste).

filsprod 266

-mä kä ɔ -mʊ bhlä nä,
But as he had gone
Mais comme il était parti

filsprod 267*

kä n -luë -nöɔ a 'kwie'e,
I thought he was dead
et que je pensais qu'il était mort

filsprod 268*

'nı ɔ'ɔ -wʊ lä kuu
and he wasn't dead
et il n'était pas mort

filsprod 269

'nı ɔ yä lä yi nä,
and he has come (home),
et il est venu,

filsprod 270

'na 'yu -kʊ lä -lɔɔ
my child is here
mon enfant est là,

filsprod 271

nä n yɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü.
so I took him in.
donc je l'ai accueilli.

filsprod 272

-Mä -lä gbë'ë -lı'ı -lıı
But all the things here in this house,
Mais toutes choses qui sont dans cette maison

filsprod 273

-ı plöö- lä -amʊ 'na käkälıı nä,
which are my possessions,
et qui m'appartiennent à moi (litt. qui sont mes possessions),

filsprod 274

-mɔ -naa 'lıı lä.
you, they are yours.
toi, ce sont tes choses.

filsprod 275

-Mɔ, -mɔ -kıı lä.
You, you own them.
Toi, tu les possèdes (litt. tu les as)

filsprod 276

Nä -naa 'lıı lä nä,
So since they are yours
Donc puisque ce sont tes choses,

filsprod 277

plɛ 'kʊ'ʊ sii -lä,
don't be angry,
ne te fâche pas,

filsprod 278

nä plä -bhutuu!
rather, enter the house!"
donc entre dans la maison! »

filsprod 279

-Mä 'yuo nä, kɔɔ mii a
But the child (= elder son), he
Mais l'enfant (fils aîné), il

filsprod 280

'nı ɔ -kʊ a -lɔɔ gbʊgblɛɛ 'mʊ.
stayed angry.
restait dans la colère

filsprod 281

'Nı ɔ 'bä yia (mii) {gbä}
And his father caused him
Et son père a fait qu'

filsprod 282

'nı ɔ yia -bhutu'u plä
to enter the house
il entra dans la maison

filsprod 283

'nı 'fɛtlınɛ, gämaalını/
and that feast, that rejoicing
et cette fête, cette réjouissance,

filsprod 284

'nı wa yii a nʊ
they did it
ils les faisaient

filsprod 285

'nı ı yi a 'plö.
and it passed.
et elle a pris fin.

filsprod 286

Sä 'yuo 'titi/
How the child himself,
Comment l'enfant lui-même,

filsprod 287

-ɔ plöö- bhlä bʊkʊ -lɔɔ nä,
the one who was the younger one
qui avait été le cadet,

filsprod 288

'nɪ -ɔ bhobho bhlä nylä,
and who had thought,
et qui avait pensé:

filsprod 289

n kä mʊ nä,
“If I go
« Si je pars,

filsprod 290

'nɪ n kä -a 'bä yëku -mʊ nä,
and if I go to my father’s
et si je vais aller auprès de notre père,

filsprod 291

ɔ yi'i 'kʊ yɔɔ,
he will scold me
il me grondera

filsprod 292

'nɪ ɔ yi'i 'tlü nä,
and he will chase me away,”
et il me chassera, »

filsprod 293

ɔ 'bä a mii
his father was able to,
son père a pu,

filsprod 294

'nɪ ɔ 'kɔ a 'kʊ -yɔɔ,
instead of scolding him,
et au lieu de le gronder,

filsprod 295

-mä kɔ mii
he was really able
il a pu

filsprod 296

'nɪ ɔ welio a ku'u,
to comfort him
le réconforter

filsprod 297

'nı ɔ mii
and he was able to
et il a pu

filsprod 298

'nı ɔ nyıɔ a pɔlö 'tɛtɛ,
encourage him
lui redonner courage

filsprod 299

'nı ɔ -womänöɔ a 'yɛkɛ'ɛ,
and he made him relax (lit. he widened his body)
et il lui ôtait la crispation (litt. il lui a élargi le corps)

filsprod 300

'nı ɔ yi mii/
and he (= the son) was able
et il (le fils) a pu

filsprod 301

'nı ɔ yia sä 'kʊ.
to stay (lit. he sat down).
rester (litt. il s'est assis).

filsprod 302

Nuwälı nı -ı cii lä -mää Lukö'ö 'bɔɔgʊ nʊ 'mlö 'kʊgbängbü'ü nä,
This passage in the book of Luke (lit. which speaks here in Luke's book 15)
Cette parole du livre de Luc, chapitre 15 (litt. qui parle ici dans le livre de Luc 15)

filsprod 303

'nı -ı ci lä 'yuo'o too -wälıı nä,
and which speaks about the lost child,
et qui parle de la perdition de l'enfant,

filsprod 304

-anyı 'ylʊzɔkʊnyʊa,
we, (all) mankind (lit. the people living under the sun)
nous, hommes de la terre (litt. les gens vivant sous le soleil)

filsprod 305

-anyı ı soo lä.
it is to us it speaks
c'est à nous qu'elle parle.

filsprod 306

Kı so -nö -anyı lä nylä,
It actually tells us that
Cela nous dit que

filsprod 307

dä -a mii/
as long as (lit. where)
au moment où

filsprod 308

'nɪ -a -kʊ lä -lä nä,
we are alive,
nous sommes en vie,

filsprod 309

-n kä mii/
if you
si tu

filsprod 310

'nɪ -n kä nyenyi -nʊ nä,
if you have committed a sin,
si tu a commis un péché,

filsprod 311

Laagɔ dëlü'ü nä,
before God,
devant Dieu

filsprod 312

-naa -guu -lä,
do not be afraid,
n'aie pas peur,

filsprod 313

-mä -pɛpɛ nä,
but right away,
mais aussitôt,

filsprod 314

-n kä -naa nyenyii -yibhë nä,
if you acknowledge your sin,
si tu reconnais ton péché,

filsprod 315

-n 'ylɪbhɔ
return
retourne

filsprod 316

n -yä -n -yi
in order to come
pour venir

filsprod 317

-yä -n 'pä Laagɔ wälı nylä,
and call out to God saying,
et appeler Dieu en disant :

filsprod 318

Laagɔ, n yä nyenyi nʊ -mɔɔ dëlü nä,
“God, I have sinned before you,”
« Dieu, j'ai péché devant toi, »

filsprod 319

-pɛpɛ ʊ yi -pɛpɛ mii
right away he will
au même instant

filsprod 320

'nı ʊ yii -wawayu'u 'kʊ -bhlüü.
take you in as a beloved child.
il va te reprendre comme un enfant bien-aimé.

filsprod 321

-Mä -n kä -mɔɔ zizio -kpäköö 'mlö -kʊ
But if you are there on hiding (lit. in the hiding-bushes),
Mais si tu es là à te ccher (litt. dans les buissons à cacher),

filsprod 322

'nı -n kä cii nylä
and you say
et tu dis

filsprod 323

n yä nyenyi nʊ -mɔɔ 'titi -naa 'yɛkɛ'ɛ 'mlö/
“I have truly sinned there in my flesh”
« J'ai vraiment péché là dans ma chair »

filsprod 324

'nı -n kä -n yëku -soo nylä,
and if you say to yourself,
et si tu dis à toi-même:

filsprod 325

n yä nyenyi nʊ,
“I have sinned,
« J'ai péché,

filsprod 326

mä n'n -lä Laagɔ dëlü mʊ,
but I won’t go before God
mais je n'irai pas devant Dieu

filsprod 327

n'n lä mʊ
I won't go,
je n'irai pas,

filsprod 328

'nɪ nyenyi'i n -nʊ lä
so that the sin that I have committed,
et le péché que j'ai commis,

filsprod 329

n 'kɪ 'mlö -sä,
I can confess it
que je puisse le confesser

filsprod 330

'nɪ Laagɔ 'kä'ä 'mɪɪ cie nä,
and God can forgive it to me,"
et que Dieu me le pardonne, »

filsprod 331

ɔ lä : -N -yɪ 'sɔ yi nä,
he (=God) says, "You will keep it (lit. you and it together come)
il (=Dieu) dit : « Tu marcheras avec (litt. toi et lui ensemble viennent)

filsprod 332

'nɪ ɪ 'nöö -lä 'kɔɔkɔ 'mʊ -bha.
and it (=sin) will never leave you."
et il (péché) ne te quittera plus jamais. »

filsprod 333

Nä, 'bɔɔgʊ nʊ 'mlö nʊwälɪ nɪ 'sä ɪ so -nö -anyɪ lä nylä
So, those words in that book say to us that
Ainsi donc, les paroles de ce livre nous interpellent en disant que

filsprod 334

-a kä -mʊ
if we go
si nous allons

filsprod 335

'nɪ -a kä -mää 'ylʊzɔ -kʊ
and if we are here under the sun
et que nous nous sommes sur cette terre

filsprod 336

'nɪ -a kä Laagɔ 'wlu sä glaa,
and we worship God,
et que nous adorons Dieu,

filsprod 337

'nı -a kä nyenyi nʊ nä,
and if we sin,
et si nous péchons,

filsprod 338

-a 'ylıbhɔ bʊkʊ
let's come back again
il faut que nous nous retournions

filsprod 339

-yä -a bhlü Laagɔ bhı 'kʊ
and pray to God on our knees,
et suppliions Dieu à genoux,

filsprod 340

-yä Laagɔ 'kä -mii
so that God would
pour que Dieu puisse

filsprod 341

-yä ʊ 'kä -anyı nyenyi'i -sä.
take our sin from us (lit. take us from sin).
nous enlever notre péché (litt. nous enlever dans le péché).

filsprod 342

-Mä nyıkpɔ'ɔ 'lɔ
Now whoever
Et toute personne

filsprod 343

-ɔ 'ylıbhɔ lä Laagɔ 'wlı'ı nä,
comes back to (lit. returns into the hands of) God,
qui retourne auprès de (litt. dans les mains de) Dieu,

filsprod 344

Laagɔ'ɔ 'tlü -nöɔ -wʊ nyenyi'i.
God doesn't chase them away because of sin.
Dieu ne la chasse pas à cause du péché.

filsprod 345

Sä 'yuo 'ylıbhɔɔ bhlä ɔ 'bä 'wlı'ı
Like the child came back to his father
Comme l'enfant était retourné auprès de son père,

filsprod 346

'nı ɔ 'bä bhlüo bhlä 'kʊ nä,
and his father had taken him in,
et son père l'avait repris,

filsprod 347

-n kä Laagɔ 'wlı'ı 'ylıbhɔ nä,
if you come back to God,
si tu retournes auprès de Dieu,

filsprod 348

Laagɔ yii 'kʊ 'bhlü.
God will take you in.
Dieu te reprendra.

filsprod 349

Nuwälı nı n ci lä nä,
These words that I speak,
Les paroles que je pronounce,

filsprod 350

ı 'plö -anyıa -zizi'i yamälı
may they be healing to our spirits.
qu'elles soit une guérison de nos esprits.

filsprod 351

(n yä) {iyä} ı 'nyɛ -anyıa kplɔkplɔ -wugɔɔ 'nyu pälı.
and may they give a blessing to our holy spirit.
et que cela donne à notre saint esprit de la bénédiction.

filsprod 352

Zozii 'ŋlö 'mlö,
In Jesus' name,
Dans le nom de Jésus,

filsprod 353

ı kʊ sɔɔ.
Amen (lit. may it be that way).
Amen (litt. ainsi soit-il).

8. Greve

Genre: Personal narrative / Récit personnel
Content: An obstacle on the way to work / *Contenu*: Un obstacle sur le chemin au travail
Speaker/Locuteur: F (27, male)
Date: 21-03-1995

greve 001*

N kä Kumasi'i -bha nä,
When I have left Kumasi
Quand j'ai quitté Kumasi

greve 002*

'nı n kä yi nä,
and when I come
puis quand je viens

greve 003*

Mputo'o n ghlä lä.
I pass through Mputo.
je passe par Mpouto.

greve 004

N tɔ Mputo -nyiee
I cross the waters of Mputo
Je traverse l'eau de Mpouto

greve 005

wa la lä Lagune Ebrié nä.
called Ebrié Lagoon.
dénommée Lagune Ébrié,

greve 006

N tʊɛ
I cross it
Je la traverse

greve 007*

'nɪ n ŋë lä Mputo'o.
then I arrive in Mputo.
et j'arrive à Mpouto.

greve 008*

N kä yɪ Mputo -ŋëë,
When I have arrived in Mputo,
Lorsque j'arrive à Mpouto,

greve 009*

'nɪ n bhlü lä 'wlɔwlɔ 'kʊ,
I take a pick-up taxi
je prends un Woroworo (taxi non compteur)

greve 010*

'nɪ n yi lä Ghliviɛla'a,
and I come to Riviera,
et je viens à la Riviera,

greve 011

'nɪ -a nʊ lä lebhe.
then we work.
puis nous travaillons.

greve 012a

N 'pɛɛ -lɔlɔglʊ,
I pay 100 francs (for the fare),
Je paie cent francs (pour le transport),

greve 012b

'nı n tɔ lä.
then I cross (the lagoon)
puis je traverse (la lagune).

greve 012c

N 'pɛɛ -lɔlɔglʊ
I pay 100 francs
Je paie cent francs,

greve 013

'nı n plä 'wlɔwlɔ,
and I get into a pick-up taxi
et je monte dans le Woroworo

greve 014

'nı n yi lä Ghliviɛla'a.
and I come to Riviera.
et je viens à la Riviera.

greve 015*

-Maa -zëkü'ü 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- bhlä nä,
Now on the day of yesterday (lit. the one day from now that passed),
Mais la journée d'hier,

greve 016*

ʊmʊ 'kʊ nä,
that day (lit. on it)
ce jour-là,

greve 017*

wälıklë -bhlogbe -bhlü bhä.
something happened.
quelque chose s'est passé.

greve 018*

(-Ɛɛ,) -mɔɔ nyiee 'klʊʊ, 'gokpüü -ı tʊanyı bhlä nä,
There on the lagoon, the boats that used to take us across,
Là-bas sur l'eau, les pinasses qui nous faisaient traverser,

greve 019

ımı nä, ı kä cii
as for them, when they want (lit. say)
lorsqu'elles veulent (litt. disent)

greve 020

ı 'kä -anyı tʊa nä,
to take us across,
nous faire traverser

greve 021*

kı bʋä,
they are really slow,
elles sont vraiment lentes,

greve 022

ı plüë 'tänyı -bhutukpä,
they make pass a lot of time
elles font passer beaucoup de temps

greve 023*

'nı ı mıa nyıkpa -bhutukpä 'tänyı 'kʋ.
and they are wasting a lot of people's time (lit. they make time overflow for many people)
et elles font perdre du temps à beaucoup de gens. (font déborder le temps pour beaucoup de gens)

greve 024*

Nä ı'ı 'ŋlöö 'mlö nä,
So it was because of that
C'est pour cela qu'

greve 025*

nyıkpɔ -bhlogbe (ɔ zɔɔ ɔ'ɔ) ɔ -nʋ sä'ä ɔ'ɔ gɔlʋ lɛɛ,
that a certain man, (he bought his) he took (lit. made) his small canoe
un certain monsieur s'est (acheté) fait une toute petite pirogue

greve 026*

'nı ɔ ŋʋɔ masii.
and he put a motor on it.
et il y a mis un moteur.

greve 027*

Nä, ʋmʋ gɔlʋnʋ, ʋ pio kpänyı,
So that same canoe, it was very fast
Donc, cette même pirogue allait très vite

greve 028*

'nı ʋ -zi 'gokpü
and it outstripped the boats
par rapport aux pinasses

greve 029*

-a plä bhlä -zä nä 'kʋ.
we usually took.
que nous empruntions habituellement.

greve 030*

ı'ı 'ŋlöö 'mlö nä,
It was because of that
C'est pourquoi

greve 031*

'gokpünyıkpaa 'mlö 'nʊwa -wʊ mɛmä.
that the boat people were not happy.
les conducteurs de pinasses n'ont pas été contents

greve 032*

Nä, -zıkä'ä 'ylʊʊ -ʊ plöö- lä 'sɔylʊ nʊ 'kʊ nä,
So today, which is this Tuesday,
Donc la journée d'aujourd'hui, ce mardi-ci,

greve 033*

wamä 'gokpütienyʊa, wlä
those same boatmen, they said
ces conducteurs de pinasses disent

greve 034*

wa'a nʊ -wʊ lebhe,
they are not working,
qu'ils ne travaillent pas,

greve 035

-mä kä plɛ 'kʊ siwa,
but they are really angry,
mais ils sont vraiment fâchés,

greve 036

sä -lä'ä nyıkpa -lolo nɔ,
because the new guy
parce que le nouveau-là

greve 037

-ɔ -yi lä
who came
qui est venu

greve 038

'nı -ɔ ylä lä nylä
and who wants
et qui veut

greve 039

-ɔ 'gä lebhe nʊ nä,
to work,
travailler,

greve 040

(ɔ'ɔ lʊʊ) ɔ'ɔ gɔlʊʊ, kʊ pio.
his canoe is really fast.
sa pirogue, elle file vraiment.

greve 041

'Nı ʊ'ʊ tʊa -wʊ nyıkpa -bhutukpä o!
And it doesn't even take many people across!
Et elle ne transporte même pas beaucoup de monde!

greve 042*

-Mä ʊ mʊ nä, ʊ yi,
But it comes and goes,
Cependant, elle va et vient,

greve 043*

ʊ mʊ nä, ʊ yi.
it comes and goes
elle va et vient.

greve 044*

-Bhlɛ wa'a -lʊʊ, kʊ bʊä,
However, as for theirs, it is slow,
Par contre, la leur, elle est lente,

greve 045*

'nı wa'a -lä -kä nyıkpa 'ni,
so they won't get customers
et ils ne trouveront pas de clients

greve 046*

'nı wa'a -lä -kä monii 'ni,
and they won't make any money,
et ils ne gagneront pas (assez) d'argent:

greve 047

'nı ı siwa plɛ 'kʊ.
and that made them angry.
cela les a donc fait fâcher.

greve 048

Nä ı'ı 'ŋlöö 'mlö nä,
So because of that,
Donc à cause de cela,

greve 049*

-zıkä wa'a -wʊ lebhe -nʊ.
today they did not not work.
aujourd'hui ils n'ont pas travaillé.

greve 050*

Wa'a ducifio 'titi, ɔ lä
Their village chief himself, he said
Leur Chef de village lui-même, il a dit qu'

greve 051*

ɔ 'kä 'nyie 'tɔɔ.
he wanted to cross the lagoon.
il voulait traverser l'eau.

greve 052

Ɔ 'kä 'nyiee 'tɔɔ
He wanted to cross the lagoon
Il voulait traverser la lagune

greve 053

-yä ɔ 'kä -mɔɔ Aklomiabhlä'ä mʊ,
to go to Akromiabla,
pour aller à Akromiabla,

greve 054

ɔ 'kä 'nyieklë mʊ.
he wanted to go to the other side.
il voulait aller de l'autre côté.

greve 055

Wlä wa'a nʊ -wʊ lebhe nä,
They said that as they were not working
Ils ont dit que puisqu'ils ne travaillent pas,

greve 056

wa'a -lä wa'a ducifio tʊa.
they would not take their village chief across.
ils ne feraient pas traverser leur Chef de village.

greve 057*

ɩ -kä 'ŋlöö, wa'a ducifio, ɔ -mʊ
This even meant that their village chief, he went
C'est pour cela que leur chef de village est parti

greve 058*

'nɪ ɔ -zla ɔ 'nagɔ -bhlo gɔlʊ.
to ask (lit. and he asked) one of his friends for a canoe
demander une pirogue à l'un de ses amis.

greve 059*

Gɔlʊ nʊ, ʊmʊ tʊɔ lä,
That canoe was the one that took him across
C'est cette pirogue qui l'a fait traverser

greve 060*

'nɪ ɔ yi lä mʊ.
and he went.
et il est parti.

greve 061*

Amʊ -mä, zëplü nöö n -yi lä nä,
As for me, when I arrived this morning
Quand moi, je suis arrivé ce matin,

greve 062*

n nä n 'kä 'tɔ.
I wanted to cross (the lagoon)
je voulais traverser.

greve 063

N nä n yi nä,
As I was coming,
À mon arrivée,

greve 064*

nyɪkpa'a -wʊ -lɔɔ 'nyie yëku -kʊ,
the usual people were not around on the shore of the lagoon,
il n'y avait pas les gens habituels au bord de l'eau,

greve 065*

-mä bhlooblo 'lʋä -kʊ -lɔɔ.
though a few were around.
mais il y avait quelques-uns.

greve 066*

'Nɪ nyɪkpɔ -bhlogbe yi'i lä soo nylä
Then somebody said to me,
Puis quelqu'un m'a dit:

greve 067*

'Gokpü'ü mʊ -wʊ -zɪkä.
“There are no boats going today.”
« Les pinasses ne fonctionnent pas aujourd'hui. »

greve 068

N nä,
I said,
J'ai dit:

greve 069

-Ɔ nöö -za bhä'ä?
“Why?”
« Pourquoi? »

greve 070*

Ɔ lä, Nyɪkpaa, kä plɛ 'kʊ siwa.
He said, “The people, they are really angry.”
Il a dit: « Les gens sont vraiment fâchés. »

greve 071*

N nä, -Aa.
I said, “I see.”
J'ai dit: « Ah bon! »

greve 072

Ɔ lä,
He said,
Il a dit:

greve 073

-N gä cii
“If you want
« si tu veux

greve 074

-n 'gä mʊ nä,
to go (= cross),
partir (=traverser),

greve 075*

-n ni gɔlʊ -lıɔ
there is a small canoe
voilà une petite pirogue

greve 076*

-ɔ -kʊ lä -mɔyı nä,
over there
là bas,

greve 077

ɔmɔ -n 'gä lä plä.
it is that you can take(lit. enter).”
c'est elle que tu peux emprunter. »

greve 078

'Nı -amʊ -mä n yi lä mʊ,
Then I went
J’y suis donc allé

greve 079

'nı -a yi lä gbɔlʊ pää.
and we got into a queue.
et nous nous sommes mis en rang.

greve 080

'Nı ɔmɔ nyıkpɔɔ ɔ yi lä tɛtɛ 'lʊä fä.
Then that man, he took (lit. he sent) a first group across,
Puis l'homme (=le conducteur) a fait traverser un premier groupe.

greve 081

'nı ɔ yi lä 'sɔna lʋä -gʊʊ yi.
then he came to fetch a second group.
ensuite il est venu chercher un autre groupe.

greve 082*

'Sɔna -lʋä nä wa'a 'kpaa 'mlö,
The second ones, in their group,
C'est dans le deuxième groupe

greve 084*

-mɔɔ n -kʊ -mʊ bhlä,
it was there that I was also,
que j'étais aussi

greve 085*

'nı n yi lä 'nyie 'tɔ zëplü nöö.
and I crossed the lagoon this morning.
et j'ai traversé l'eau ce matin.

greve 086

N 'pɛɛ -lɔlɔgʊlʊ.
I paid 100 francs (for the fare).
J'ai payé cent francs (pour le transport).

greve 087

N tɔɔ- lä nä,
When I had crossed
Quand j'avais traversé,

greve 088

'nı n yi lä dä wa 'bhlüü lä 'wlɔwlɔɔ 'kʊ nä yi.
I came to the place where you take the pick-up taxi,
je suis venu là où l'on prend les Woroworo,

greve 089

'nı n yi lä 'wlɔwlɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü,
and I took a pick-up taxi
et j'ai pris un Woroworo

greve 090

'nı n yi lä Ghliviɛla'a yi zëplü nöö.
and I came to Riviera this morning.
et je suis arrivé à la Riviera ce matin.

greve 091*

Nä, -n ni wälı'ı -lıı
So, these are the things (lit. the kind of things)
Donc voilà les choses (litt. le genre de choses)

greve 092*

-ɩ -ŋë nöö lä -mɔɔ -blɔ 'kʊ zëplü'ü nöö nä.
that happended to me there on my way this morning.
qui me sont arrivées there on my way this morning.

greve 093

ɩmɩ -kʊ lä -lää.
It is them that I have presented here (lit. it is them that are here).
Ce sont elles que j'ai exposé ici (litt. ce sont elles qui sont ici).

greve 094

Bhloodä.
End (lit. stopping place).
Fin (point d'arrêt).

9. Gwebhutu

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: Why the chimpanzee doesn't build houses / *Contenu*: Pourquoi le chimpanzé ne construit pas de maisons
Speaker/Locuteur: F (27, male)
Date: December / Décembre 1995

gwebhutu 001

Nyɩkpɔ kä cii- nynä 'gwɛɛ' -wʊ 'släsä -yi nä,
If anyone says that the chimpanzee doesn't know how to build,
Si quelqu'un dit que le chimpanzé ne sait pas construire,

gwebhutu 002

ɔ yä yio gë.
he has told a lie.
il a menti.

gwebhutu 003

'Gwɛ -yi 'släsä
The chimpanzee knows how to build,
Le chimpanzé sait construire,

gwebhutu 004

-mä -ŋänö -ɩ -gbä lä -zɩkä
but it is fear that causes him today
mais c'est la peur qui a fait aujourd'hui

gwebhutu 005

'nɩ ɛɛ' 'slä -wʊ nyɩkpɔ 'bhisäkʊ.
to not build like man does.
qu'il ne construit pas comme l'homme.

gwebhutu 006*

A kä lä -zıkä 'gwɛ 'yi 'ni
Whenever you see a chimpanzee today
Si vous voyez aujourd'hui le chimpanzé

gwebhutu 007

'nı ɛ kä lä -nünëë' pu nä,
sleeping in a nest,
dormir dans un nid,

gwebhutu 008

-ŋänöö- nyıɛ- lä dıgälıwlu.
it is fear that gave him that solution.
c'est la peur qui lui a donné cette solution.

gwebhutu 009

'Gwɛ 'mɛ Laagɔ Tɛpɛ paa- lä tɛɛtɛ -bhutusläl ı.
It was to the chimpanzee that God first showed how to build a house.
C'est au chimpanzé que Dieu a montré en premier comment se bâtir une maison.

gwebhutu 010

'Gwɛɛ' tɛɛtɛ -bhutuu ɛ slää- lä nä,
The first house that the chimpanzee built,
La première maison que le chimpanzé a construite,

gwebhutu 011

kä ɛ slʊʊ- -n -nä sä nyıkpɔ slä lä -zıkä nä,
he actually built it just like a human being builds today,
il l'a en fait construite à la manière dont les hommes construisent aujourd'hui,

gwebhutu 012*

sä -bhɔɔdä nä, kä ‘gwɛ -yä nyıkpɔ 'sɔ -kʊʊ bhä 'kʊ.
because in the beginning the chimpanzee and man actually lived together.
parce qu’au commencement, le chimpanzé habitait en fait avec l'homme.

gwebhutu 013

Ɛ slʊʊ- lä nä,
When he (=the chimpanzee) built,
Quand il (= le chimpanzé) a construit,

gwebhutu 014

ɛ ŋʊʊ- -cɛcɛcı,
he put up rafters
il a mis des chevrons.

gwebhutu 015

ɛ -nʊ -bhutugbäglöyi 'nänɛ,
He made a good roof framework,
Il a fait une bonne toiture,

gwebhutu 016

ɛ -kpʊʊ
he bound bamboo sticks together,
il a attaché des bambous,

gwebhutu 017

'nɪ ɛ pʊʊ- bla.
then he put clay between them.
puis il a mis du banco.

gwebhutu 018*

Ʊʊ' 'mnö -yɛɛ ylä nä,
When its (= the house) inside had now dried,
Quand l'intérieur (de la maison) avait maintenant séché,

gwebhutu 019*

'nɪ ɛ yi -mɔɔ 'plöö
then he went in (lit. he passed there),
puis il y est entré (litt. il y a passé)

gwebhutu 020*

'nɪ ɛ yi sä pu o!
and he lay down!
et il s'est couché.

gwebhutu 021*

-Maa, 'gwɛ puu- sä
However, when the chimpanzee had lain down,
Mais quand le chimpanzé s'était couché,

gwebhutu 022*

-mä plɛɛ' bhlüe- -wʊ.
his heart wasn't at peace.
son cœur n'était pas tranquille.

gwebhutu 023

Ɛ -wloo -gbäpʊʊ -aaa,
He looked at the ridge beam a long time,
Il a regardé le bois du faîte longtemps,

gwebhutu 024

'nɪ ɛɛ' 'wlu -nyimo.
then he panicked.
puis il a paniqué.

gwebhutu 025

'Gwɛ lä, 'Kpʊʊkpaa!
The chimpanzee said, "How foolhardy I was!
Le chimpanzé a dit: « Quelle imprudence de ma part!

gwebhutu 026

Wa lä bhä 'flɛ sää 'kwie -bhutuzɔ -a!
How stupid to invite death into one's home!"
Quelle bêtise d'inviter la mort jusqu'à chez soi! »

gwebhutu 027

Ɛ gblää- lä -bhutupapıı nä
He climbed up the walls of the house and
Il grimpa les murs de la maison et

gwebhutu 028

kɛ döö- -bhutugbäglöyee 'kpɔ.
he actually cut the fastening of the roofwork
il se mit vraiment à couper la toiture.

gwebhutu 029

Ɛ lä,-Gbäpʊʊ' 'kää' 'wlu 'plıtıä.
He said, "The ridge beam must not crash my head."
Il dit: « Il ne faut pas que le bois du faîte m'écrase la tête. »

gwebhutu 030

Ɛ bhıä bhä -bhlɛ sää -bhutugbäglöyee 'kpɔ -döölı,
He was just about finished to cut the roofwork
Au moment où il finissait de couper la toiture,

gwebhutu 031

'nı -cɛcɛcʊ -bhlo 'kɔtɔ-
when one of the rafters broke
une des poutres de la toiture se cassa

gwebhutu 032

'nı 'gwɛ -bhlü lä -zɔɔ.
and the chimpanzee fell down.
et le chimpanzé tomba par terre.

gwebhutu 033*

Ɛ cie -bhlɛ sää -dʊdʊ ŋëlı,
He was about to reach the ground,
Il allait arriver par terre

gwebhutu 034*

'nı -gbäpʊʊ 'kpɔtɔ- lä -mɔɔ ŋɔkʊ
when the ridge beam broke there above (him)
lorsque le bois du faîte se détacha en haut,

gwebhutu 035

'nı ɛɛ' 'mnëa 'titiclö 'kʊ 'zi!
and it landed exactly on his nose.
et s'abattit juste sur son nez.

gwebhutu 036

Gwɛɛ' 'kʊtakpää' 'fɪɪn, ka -nyimo-!
The chimpanzee's whole face, it was a mess!
Toute la figure du chimpanzé, elle fut sérieusement endommagée!

gwebhutu 037

'Mnëa -yä nimnii 'sɔ yä zamä- gblätätä! Dolu -bhlobhlo!
The nose and the lips become (lit. have become) all red, full of blood!
Le nez et les lèvres sont (litt. ont été) rouges de sang.

gwebhutu 038*

-Bhutupapɪɪ -yä papoo -ya, -vlu!
The walls and the roof crash to the ground!
Les murs et le toit dégringolent ensemble!

gwebhutu 039*

ɩ yä ‘gwɛ 'wlu bhlüü-.
They fall (lit. have fallen) on the chimpanzee.
Ils tombent (litt. sont tombés) sur le chimpanzé.

gwebhutu 040*

Wlä ‘gwɛ lä, ɩmɪ n yä bhɛ lä -zä ci.
The chimpanzee said, "That's what I had already said.
Alors le chimpanzé dit: « C'est ce que j'avais bien dit.

gwebhutu 041

-Ɔ gä yɪ 'sɔɔ nä,
Since the situation is now such that
Puisque c'est ainsi,

gwebhutu 042

-nɪnɪ 'fɪɪn yä ylä bhlü nä,
all that (=walls and roof) has fallen down,
et que tout ceci (murs et toiture) est tombé,

gwebhutu 043

ɪɪ' ŋazɪɪ 'mnö, -mɔɔ n 'kä ylä sä pu.
it is in their ruins that I will sleep now."
c'est dans leurs décombres que je dormirai maintenant. »

gwebhutu 044*

Papoo -yä -cɛcɛcɪɪ -ya -gbäpɪɪ -ya, ɪmɪ 'kʊ ‘gwɛ -goo
It was on straw and rafters and ridge beams that the chimpanzee spent the night
C'est sur la paille, les poutres et les bois du faîte que le chimpanzé a passé la nuit

gwebhutu 044a

'nɪ zeli yi ze.
until daybreak.
jusqu'au lendemain matin.

gwebhutu 045

Ɔ lä, ɩmɪ 'fɪɔ -ɔɔ -wʊ -lää -kʊ -a!
He said, “Isn’t that what I wanted in the first place?
Il dit: « N'est-ce pas ce que je recherchais dès le départ?

gwebhutu 046

Sëpudä nn' tää- bhɔɔ nä, nn' yɪɔ -lɔɔ nii- -a!
The place to sleep that I was looking for, haven’t I found it?”
La couchette que je cherchais, ne l'ai-je pas trouvé! »

gwebhutu 047*

Wlä -n gä lä -zɪkä 'gwɛ 'yi 'ni,
Now whenever you see the chimpanzee nowadays
Si vous voyez aujourd’hui le chimpanzé

gwebhutu 048

'nɪ ɛ kä lä -nünëë' pu nä,
sleeping in a nest,
se coucher dans un nid,

gwebhutu 049

ɛɛ' -bhutuu -ʊ -bhlünöɛ lä 'wlu nä,
his house that fell on him,
sa maison qui est tombée sur lui,

gwebhutu 050

ʊʊ' ŋazɪı 'kʊ ɛ pu lä.
it is in its ruins that he sleeps.
c'est dans ses décombres qu'il dort.

gwebhutu 051

'Mnüpɪɔ -ɔ yä lä -zɪkä 'gwɛ slä nä,
The little nose that is on his face today,
Le menu nez qui est sur son visage aujourd'hui,

gwebhutu 052

-bhutugbäglöyee' 'bhlʊlɛ ɛ bhɛɛ- lä.
it is the infirmity caused by the roofwork (having fallen on him) that he has.
n'est autre qu'une infirmité causée par la toiture (tombée sur lui).

gwebhutu 053*

A kä lä 'sɪı 'gwɛ 'ni,
Whenever you see the chimpanzee
Chaque fois que vous voyez le chimpanzé

gwebhutu 054*

'nɪ ɛ kä lä ɛɛ' numnuu 'plöplönyʊä tlaa nä,
showing its lip to all who pass,
montrant sa lèvre à tout passant,

gwebhutu 055

-cɛcɛcʊʊ -ʊ -wlɛ lä në nä,
it is the rafter that hit his mouth,
c'est la poutre qui lui a tapé la bouche,

gwebhutu 056

ɯ' 'jëa, amä ɛ tla lä -glɔnyʊä.
its wound, that is what it shows to everyone.
la plaie de cela, c'est elle qu'il montre à tous.

gwebhutu 057

A ni dä 'gwɛ 'bhää lä -zɪkä
That is where the chimpanzee takes his lesson
Voici d'où le chimpanzé tire sa leçon

gwebhutu 058

'nɪ ɛ ‘kä slää
for building
pour construire

gwebhutu 059

'nɪ ɛɛ' 'ŋʊ -wʊ lä -bhutugbäglöye -yä -cɛcɛcɪ 'sɔ nä.
without putting a ridge beam and rafters.
sans mettre une toiture et des poutres.

gwebhutu 060

ɩmɪ -a ci lä -a 'bhlɪ nynä: 'Gwɛ -yi 'släsä
That’s why we say in our country, “The chimpanzee knows how to build,
C'est ce qu'on dit chez nous: « L*e chimpanzé sait construire,*

gwebhutu 061

'nɪ -bhutugbäglöye sɪɛ 'slälɪɯ'.
but the building of a roofwork is too much for him.
mais il n'arrive pas à construire avec une toiture. »

10. Kazo

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: How a young man kills a water spirit / *Contenu*: Comment un jeune homme tue un génie de l’eau
Speaker/Locuteur: C (75, male)
Date: 16-08-1994

kazo 001*

Wlaa,
It is reported (lit. they say) that
On raconte que

kazo 002*

nyɪkpa 'mä slää- lä waa 'du.
people had built a village for themselves.
des gens s'étaient construit un village.

kazo 003

-N -nä sä Bhluukwë -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ nä,
It's as if Blukwo was here
C'est comme si Bloukweu est ici,

kazo 004

'nɪ -a -kʊ lä -lä Bhluukwë yëku nä,
and we lived close to Blukwo,
que nous habitions tout près de Blukweu,

kazo 005

gwälɪ -a plä lä nä.
and we use (lit. enter) canoes.
et que nous traversions par pirogues.

kazo 006*

'Nyibhlë -kʊ -lɔɔ.
There was a river.
Il y avait une rivière.

kazo 007*

'Nyibhlëa- -kʊ lä -lɔɔ nä,
That river (lit. the river that was there),
Dans cette rivière là (litt. la rivière qui était là),

kazo 008*

'kuŋlʊklä -kʊ -mɔɔ.
an old woman's ghost was in there.
il y avait une vieille revenante.

kazo 009*

Amä plöö- lä 'nyibhlëa 'mlö -zlëë.
She (lit. it was her who) was the river spirit.
Elle (litt. c'est elle qui) était le génie de l'eau.

kazo 010

Gɔlʊ kä ylä -lɔɔ 'plö nä,
Now if a canoe passes there,
Quand une pirogue passe par là maintenant,

kazo 011

gɔlʊʊ kä bhuo nä,
if the boat turns over,
et que la pirogue se renverse,

kazo 012*

nyɪkpa 'sɔ a kä bhä -bhlü nä,
in case you were two people,
si vous étiez deux personnes,

kazo 013

(ɔ){a} yä -bhlogbe 'bhlä,
she kills (lit. has killed) one of you,
elle tue (litt. a tué) l'un d'entre vous,

kazo 014

-bhlogbe -lä 'gä ylä ɖuu' yi.
one will now come (back) to to the village.
et c'est un seul qui viendra maintenant au village.

kazo 015*

-Zɪkää' 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ nä,
Now one day (lit. on the day of today)
Un beau jour (litt. le jour d'aujourd'hui)

kazo 016*

ŋwadi mʊ ylä,
a lad was coming along,
un jeune homme partait,

kazo 017*

ɔ bhɛɛ ɔɔ 'kazɔ.
he had with him (lit. was holding) his raffia washcloth.
ayant avec lui (litt. portant) sa serviette en raphia.

kazo 018*

Tɛɛtɛɛ, -a 'bäsɪ -yä -a tɪtɪä,
In former times, our fathers and forefathers,
Avant, nos pères et nos grands-pères,

kazo 019*

'kazɪɪ' wa budo wä.
it was with raffia washcloths that they used to wash themselves.
c'est avec des serviettes en raphia qu'ils se lavaient.

kazo 020*

Waa budo (wɔ) bhɔɔ 'tobhoo'.
They didn't use a towel to wash themselves.
Ils ne se lavaient pas avec des serviettes (en coton).

kazo 021*

'Ëbhii' wɛ -kʊ.
Towels didn't exist back then.
Les serviettes (en coton) n'avaient jamais existé.

kazo 022*

Ɔ mʊ yı 'nyibhlëa 'kʊ ŋëë -kä nä,
As he was now arriving on the river,
Dès son arrivée sur la rivière,

kazo 023*

ɔ bhɛɛ 'boo,
he was carrying a wash basin.
il portait une cuvette

kazo 024*

'Gblikisi!
(Ideophone)
Patratras!

kazo 025*

Gɔlʊ yä bhuo.
The canoe overturns (lit. has overturned).
La pirogue se renverse (litt.s'est renversé).

kazo 026*

Ɔmɔ -mä ɔ plöö- ylä ŋwadi,
Now he, he was a man,
Or lui, c'était un brave garçon,

kazo 027*

'nı ɔ -yi ylä 'ŋie nä,
and he knew how to swim,
et il savait aussi nager,

kazo 028*

'kazɔɔ yä mʊ.
the raffia washcloth is gone.
la serviette en raphia est partie.

kazo 029*

'Kuŋlʊkla -a -kʊ ylä -mɔɔ 'nyibhlëa 'mʊ,
The old woman's ghost that was there in the river
La vieille revenante qui était dans l'eau

kazo 030*

'nı -a plöö- ylä -mɔɔ' -zlëa nä,
and that was its spirit (lit. the spirit of there),
et qui était le génie de cette eau,

kazo 031*

(ɔ) a yä 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü.
(she) it has taken the raffia washcloth.
elle a pris la serviette en raphia.

kazo 032*

Gɔlʊʊ, 'nɪ ɔ yiu yɪ pɪa,
The canoe, he now pulled it ashore,
La pirogue, il l'a alors tiré sur la rive,

kazo 033

'nɪ ɔ yi yɪ 'boo 'kʊ 'bhlü.
then he took the wash basin.
puis il a pris la cuvette.

kazo 034

'Nyibhlënä 'mä ɔ wa ylä.
That river, that is what he was now setting about emptying.
Cette rivière, c'est ce qu'il a alors commencé à vider.

kazo 035*

Ɔ lä, 'Naa 'kazɔɔ, ʊmʊ n budoo 'mʊ,
He said, "My raffia washcloth, that's what I wash with.
Il se dit: « C'est avec ma serviette en raphia que je me lave,

kazo 036

nä, -lʊʊ -ʊ -kʊ lä 'nyibhlënää' nä,
so, the thing that is in this river
donc la chose qui est dans cette rivière

kazo 037

'nɪ -ʊ yä lä 'naa 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü nä,
and that has taken my raffia washcloth,
et qui a pris ma serviette en raphia,

kazo 038

ɪ kä yɪ 'naa 'kwie plöö- nä,
if it now means that I pass through my death
si c'est pour passer par ma mort,

kazo 039

kä n kuu- lä,
I'll die,
je mourrai,

kazo 040

-mä n yiu -zɪkä 'ni.
but I shall find it today."
mais le trouverai aujourd'hui. »

kazo 041

'Ci 'sɔ 'kʊ wa bhlɪnöa -kaa!.
It is twice that one sings (in the course of that story),
C'est deux fois qu'on chante (au cours de ce conte),

kazo 042

'ci 'sɔ wa ŋonöa -kä 'kʊ aa! …
it is twice that one answers! (song[7] follows)
c'est à deux reprises qu'on répond…(chant)

kazo 043

A ŋo dɪgasä 'kʊ,
Answer softly,
Repondez doucement,

kazo 044

wälɪɪ a mɛmä-nɪ 'nägäsä -tɛɛ!
your voices, make them soft and nice!
vos voix, rendez-les bien belles!

kazo 045

-Amʊ, kä n mɛɛ nëë' 'ɛɛ!….
As for me, I really have a nice voice! (song follows)
Quant à moi, j'ai une belle voix!…(chant)

kazo 046

Nä -ɔ -kä lä 'boo,
So the one who had the wash basin,
Donc celui qui avait la cuvette,

kazo 047

ŋwadio -ɔ -kä lä 'boo
the lad who had the wash basin
le garçon qui avait la cuvette,

kazo 048

'nɪ -ɔ wa lä 'nyie nä,
and who was emptying the river,
et qui vidait la rivière,

kazo 049

ɔmɔ ɔ bhlɪ lä nylä: …
as for him, his song goes like this: … (song follows)
lui, il chante comme ceci:…(chant)

kazo 050*

Wlä nyɪkpɔ -kʊ wä sɔɔ -aaa,
They say that the chap (lit. someone) had stayed like that until
On dit que cet homme avait continué ainsi jusqu'à ce que

[7] For this story the songs have unfortunately not been transcribed.

kazo 051*

'nɪ 'nyibhlëa' -lefɪɪn,
the whole river,
toute la rivière,

kazo 052*

ɔ yia waa 'fɪɪn,
he had completely emptied it out
il en avait enlevé l'eau

kazo 053*

'nɪ a yi -mɔɔ bhɪä.
and it was empty (lit. finished there).
et elle fût vidé entièrement.

kazo 054*

Kokloko! ŋlʊklä yi 'kʊ ji.
The old woman appeared!
Et soudainement, la vieille est apparu!

kazo 055*

(Ɔ) {A} -kä a ɔɔ 'kazɔɔ.
She had his raffia washcloth.
Elle avait sa serviette en raffia.

kazo 056*

'Nɪ wlä ɔ yi 'kazɔɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü.
Then it is said that he took the raffia washcloth.
Alors on dit qu'il a pris la serviette en raphia.

kazo 058*

-Zlëa -a -kʊ bhɛ lä -lɔɔ nä,
The spirit that had been there,
Le génie qui avait été en ce lieu,

kazo 059*

ɔ yä yɪ -lɔɔ (ɔ yä -lɔɔ) -zlëa -sä.
he has now taken the spirit away from there..
il a maintenant enlevé le génie de là.

kazo 060

-N ni ɪɪ' -zä
You see, that is why
Tu vois, c'est pour cela que

kazo 061

a kä lä duu' -kʊ,
if you live in a village
si vous êtes dans un village,

kazo 062

'nɪ 'nyie kä -lɔɔ -kʊ,
and there is a river
s'il y a une rivière

kazo 063

'nɪ wa kä (-gbä) cii -mä
and they say that
et que l'on dit que

kazo 064

-zlëë -kʊ -lɔɔ nä,
there is a spirit there
il y a un génie par là,

kazo 065

nyɪkpɔ -sɔ lä yɔlʊ nä,
the one who is inclined
celui qui est disponible

kazo 066

ɔmɔ -sä lä -zlëa -lɔɔ.
it is him who takes the spirit away from there.
c'est lui qui enlève le génie de là.

kazo 067

Ɔ ka yɪ bhlä nä,
If he now kills it,
S'il le tue maintenant,

kazo 068

-zlë -kʊ yɪ -pɛ -lɔɔ -a?
is there still a spirit now?
est-ce qu'il y a encore un génie?

kazo 069

(audience) aa -wʊ -lɔɔ -kʊ.
It is not there.

kazo 070

lɪ' -zä n pä lä 'naa 'nünë o!
That is why I was telling my story!

11. Kokoleko

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: How the cunning of a loser has triumphed over the winner / *Contenu*: Comment la ruse d'un perdant a triomphé sur le gagnant
Speaker/Locuteur: G (55, male)
Date: 11-02–94

kokoleko 001

'Nünëa n nä n 'kä lä bʊkʊ 'pä nä (-kpazebhleku)
The story I am going to tell
Le conte que je vais raconter,

kokoleko 002

amää- plöö- nynä- (-kpazebhleku)
it (lit. it is it that) goes like this:
c'est (litt. c'est lui qui est) le suivant:

kokoleko 003

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ (-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ) -ıyä -Sʊmabolu (-Sʊmabolu)
Rooster and Worm,
Coq et Ver de Terre,

kokoleko 003a

ɯmɯ- mʊ lä 'lʊ (-kpazebhleku)
they (lit. it is them that) are going for a dance competition (lit. going to a song)
ils (litt. ce sont eux qui) partent pour un concours de danse.

kokoleko 004

-Sʊmabolu ʊ -lü leylü. (ʊ -lü leylü)
Worm, he is rich.
Ver de Terre, il est riche.

kokoleko 005

Ʊʊ' -blɯ' -leeyenɛ, -n gä -Sʊmaboluu' -blɯ' -wlo,
That thing on his neck, if you look at Worm's neck,
Cette chose qui est à son cou, si tu as regardes le cou de Ver de Terre,

kokoleko 006

-mɔɔ 'lele 'mʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
it (lit. there) is shining.
ça (lit. là) brille.

kokoleko 007

-Sikaaye ʊ ŋʊʊ- lä -blɯ'. (-kpazebhleku)
It is something golden that he has put around his neck.
C'est quelque chose en or qu'il a mis autour de son cou.

kokoleko 008*

-Sikaacɯ ʊ ŋʊʊ- lä -blɯ', (-kpazebhleku)
It is a gold chain that he has put round his neck,
C'est une chaîne en or qu'il a mise au cou,

kokoleko 009*

ɯ' -zä -mɔɔ lele lä 'mʊ. (-aao)
that's why it (lit. there) is shining. *okay*
c'est pourqoui cela (litt. là) brille. *d'accord*

kokoleko 010

-Sʊmabolu lä, ʊmʊʊ- ye,
Worm says that it is him who dances well,
Ver de Terre dit que c'est lui qui danse bien,

kokoleko 011

ʊmʊʊ- bhlı. (-kpazebhleku)
it is him who sings well.
que c'est lui qui chante bien.

kokoleko 012

Wlä -kɔkwɛɛ lä (ʊmʊʊ-) {ɔmɔɔ-} ye
The fowl says that it is him who dances well
Le poulet dit que c'est lui qui danse bien

kokoleko 013

(ʊmʊʊ-) {ɔmɔɔ-} bhlı. (-kpazebhleku)
it is him who sings well
c'est lui qui chante (bien).

kokoleko 014

Nä wamä 'sɔ, 'lʊ wa mʊ lä bie -kää. (-kpazebhleku)
So the two of them, it is on a dance competition that they went.
Alors les deux sont allés en tournée de concours de danse.

kokoleko 015

Sä 'Clikpëkʊ -kʊ lä -lää,
As if Trikpoko was here
Comme si Trikpoko était ici,

kokoleko 016

Gwëjibëë -kʊ lä -lää 'zukaa Aadebee' nä, (-kpazebhleku)
or Godjiboué was here, until Adebem,
ou Godjiboué était ici, jusqu'à Adébem,

kokoleko 017

sɔɔ {-blɔ wa bhlü lä 'nı} wa mʊ lä o! (-kpazebhleku)
it's that kind of a distance (lit. way) that they went.
c'est (un chemin de ce genre) qu'ils parcourent.

kokoleko 018

Wa (yä) mʊ {ylä} nä,
As they were going
Pendant qu'ils partaient,

kokoleko 019*

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ 'mʊʊ- pio lä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
It was Rooster that hurried
C'était Coq qui était rapide

kokoleko 020*

'nɪ ʊ yi 'Clikpëkʊ ŋë (-kpazebhleku)
and he arrived at Trikpoko
et il est arrivé à Trikpoko

kokoleko 021*

'nɪ wa yiu 'dö 'ylä. (-kpazebhleku)
and they asked him the news.
et on lui a demandé les nouvelles.

kokoleko 022

(ʟɪ' -zä ɔ) {Ʊ} lä, 'Lʊ -a -lä lä (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "We have brought a dance,
Il dit: « Nous avons apporté une danse,

kokoleko 022

n -yä -Sʊmabolu 'sɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
Worm and me.
Ver de Terre et moi.

kokoleko 023*

Nä -a 'gä ye
We'll dance, then,
Nous allons donc danser,

kokoleko 024*

{-yä} -lɔɔ -ɔ -yi lä yesä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and the one who knows how to dance, (= who dances better)
puis celui qui sait danser, (=qui danse mieux)

kokoleko 025*

-a 'gɔ 'ni. (aao)
we are going to find him." *(okay)*
nous allons le trouver. » *(d'accord)*

kokoleko 026*

'Nɪ -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ yi -jlëë' slo. (-kpazebhleku)
And Rooster came out before the crowd.
Et Coq s'est mis sur la scène.

kokoleko 027*

'nɪ wa yi -mɔɔ plüü 'ŋʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
and they started beating the drums there.
et ils ont engagé les tam-tams.

kokoleko 028

Ʊ lä, -Ji -bhɛlʊ -kokolekole -ji -bhɛlʊ -kokoleko
He sings: Ji (=panther?) 'bhɛlʊ (=male?) -kokoleko (= cock-a-doodle-do?)
Il dit (en chantant): Ji (=panthère? 'bhɛlʊ =mâle? -kokoleko = cocorico?)

kokoleko 028a

(THE WHOLE AUDIENCE REPEATS (TOUT L'AUDITOIRE RÉPÈTE) -Ji -bhɛlʊ

kokoleko 029

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!

Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!

Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 030

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE:) -Mati -a ylää-!

We have asked to hear more!

Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 031

'Nı wa yiu 'lʊ -sää. (-kpazebhleku)

And they congratulated him (=gave him money).

Et on l'a félicité (=donné de l'argent).

kokoleko 032

Wa mʊʊ 'lʊ -sää -kä -aaa nä,

When they had congratulated him a long time,

Après qu'on l'ait félicité longuement,

kokoleko 033

ʊ nii- -luëyi taa.

he had gotten 15 francs.

il a eu quinze francs.

kokoleko 034

'Nı -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ yi gbogo. (-kpazebhleku)

Then Rooster made room (for Worm to take his turn)

Puis Coq a laissé le passage (à Ver de Terre)

kokoleko 035*

'nı -Sʊmabolu yi yi. (-kpazebhleku)

and Worm came.

et Ver de Terre est venu.

kokoleko 036*

Ʊmʊ -mä ʊʊ' pio lä nä,

As for him, he wasn't fast,

Lui, comme il n'est pas rapide,

kokoleko 037*

dıgasä 'nı ʊ yi ŋë. (-kpazebhleku)

it was slowly that he arrived.

c'est lentement qu'il est arrivé.

kokoleko 038

Alee[8]! 'Nı wa yi -mɔɔ plüü 'ŋʊ (-kpazebhleku)

There you go! Then they beat the drums

Aussitôt, ils ont mis les tam-tams (ils se sont engagés dans les battements des tam-tams).

kokoleko 039

'nı -tʊgblaa yi në -sä. (-kpazebhleku)

and the long drum crackled (lit. opened its mouth)

et le long tamtam a crépité (lit. il a ouvert la bouche).

kokoleko 040 (first song)

Ɔ {Ʊ} lä, -Anımı -anımı! Gbëkëzlëji 'anımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)

He (= Worm) said (= sang), (words are unananlyzable) (Audience /Auditoire: …)

Il (= Ver de Terre) dit (en chantant): (mots inanalysables) (Public: …)

'Nımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)

'Nımıa nımıko! (Audience and narrator together: -Anımı -anımıa anımı anımı!)

kokoleko 041

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!

Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!

Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 042

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE:) -Mati -a ylää-!

We have asked to hear more!

Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 043

-Mä -Sʊmabolu -ʊ ylö 'sıı

Now (you watch) Worm, who turned round and round

Mais (il fallait voir) Ver de Terre qui tournoyait

kokoleko 044

'nı -ʊ -kä -blıı 'nı ʊ dodo 'mʊ nä! (-kpazebhleku)

and who wriggled with his neck!

et qui, avec son cou se tortillait!

kokoleko 045

Wa mʊʊ 'lʊ -sää -kää nä, (-kpazebhleku)

When they went to congratulate him,

Quand ils sont allés le féliciter,

kokoleko 046

ʊ nii- -lɔlɔbhɛgö 'sɔ. (-kpazebhleku) (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: 'Aa-)

he got 2000 francs (a much higher sum than the 15 francs Rooster had gotten)

il a eu deux mille francs. (largement supérieur aux quinze francs reçus par le coq)

[8]This is the French interjection « Allez », which literally means “Go!”. */ Il s’agit ici de l’interjection française « Allez! ».*

kokoleko 047

(Bon!) 'Ɔɔ!
Well, there's something going wrong here!
ça a l'air de clocher quelque part!

kokoleko 048

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ ʊ yi lä -Sʊmabolu 'yii' wloo,
Rooster looked at Worm
Coq a regardé Ver de Terre,

kokoleko 049

ʊʊ' 'mnö yıɛ mɛɛ-. (-kpazebhleku)
he wasn't happy any more.
il n'était plus content.

kokoleko 050

Bon, ale! 'Nı wa yi bʊkʊ -blɔ 'kʊ 'bhlü. (-kpazebhleku)
Well, there you go! Then they went back to the road.
Aussitôt, ils ont encore pris la route.

kokoleko 051

Kä wa mʊ ylä. (-kpazebhleku)
They were now going
Ils partaient maintenant

kokoleko 052

{'Nı} wa yi Gwëjibëë ŋë. (-kpazebhleku)
and arrived in Godjibouhé.
et ils sont arrivés à Godjiboué.

kokoleko 053

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ ʊmʊʊ- -gää 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
It is Rooster that is ahead.
C'est le coq qui est devant.

kokoleko 054

Nä ʊʊ' -bu! -bu! -bu!
So by beating his wings
A grands coups d'ailes s'est précipité

kokoleko 055

'Nı ʊ yi ŋë. (-kpazebhleku)
he arrived.
et il est arrivé.

kokoleko 056

Wlä : -Mɔɔ' 'dö yıı'? (-kpazebhleku)
They asked him, "What are the news now?"
On lui a demandé: « Quelles sont les nouvelles, alors? »

kokoleko 057

Ɔ {ʊ} lä, N -yä -Sʊmabolu 'sɔ,
He said, “Me and Worm,
Il dit: « Moi et Ver de Terre

kokoleko 058

'lʊ -a bie lä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
We are giving a dance competition (lit. it is a song we are taking around),
nous faisons une tournée de danse;

kokoleko 059

sɔɔ -amʊ -gää lä 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
that’s why it is me that is up in front.
c'est pourquoi c’est moi qui suis devant.

kokoleko 060

-Mä ʊmʊ ʊ -kʊ -mɔɔ klë,
As for Worm, he is back there
Quant à Ver de Terre, il est derrière,

kokoleko 061

kʊ yi. (-kpazebhleku)
he is coming.
il arrive.

kokoleko 062

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 063

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE:) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!”
Nous avons demandé la suite! »

kokoleko 064

Wlä : -Aa,
They said, “Okay,”
Ils ont dit: « Entendu! »

kokoleko 065

'nɪ (wa yi -lɔɔ plüü) wa yi nyɪkpa wälɪ 'pä. (-kpazebhleku)
and (they … the drums) they called the people,
et (ils ont …les tamtam) ils ont appelé les gens.

kokoleko 066

Wlä : A 'ŋʊ -lɔɔ plüü! (-kpazebhleku)
saying, “Get the drums there ready!”
disant: « Mettez les tamtams en place! »

kokoleko 067

-Lelüü, 'nı ı yi 'tää-. (-kpazebhleku)

And the drums, they resounded (lit. they touched each other)

Et les tambours, ils les ont fait retentir (lit. ils se sont touchés)

kokoleko 068 (same song as in line 040 above)

Ɔ {ʊ} lä, -Anımı -anımı! Gbëkëzlëji 'anımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)

He (= Worm) said (= sang), (words are unananlyzable) (Audience /Auditoire: …)

Il (= Ver de Terre) dit (en chantant): (mots inanalysables) (Audience /Auditoire: …)

'Nımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)

'Nımıa nımıko!

(NARRATOR AND AUDIENCE TOGETHER /NARRATEUR ET AUDITOIRE ENSEMBLE:)

-Anımı -anımıa anımı anımı!)

kokoleko 069

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!

Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!

Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 070

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!

We have asked to hear more!

Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 071

'Nı wa yio {yiu} 'lʊ -sää.

And they congratulated him.

Et ils l'ont félicité.

kokoleko 072

'Duu 'ghlü ylä nä, (-kpazebhleku)

The village is fairly big,

Puisque le village est assez grand,

kokoleko 073

wa mʊɔ {mʊʊ} 'lʊ -sä -kää nä

so when they went to congratulate him

quand ils sont allés le féliciter,

kokoleko 074

ɔ {ʊ} nii- -luëyi -ngbü. (-kpazebhleku)

he got 25 francs.

il a eu vingt cinq francs.

kokoleko 075

Bon! -Aa, 'nı ʊ yi gbogo. (-kpazebhleku)

Well, okay, then he made room (for Worm to take his turn).

Bon, d'accord, puis il a laissé le passage (à Ver de Terre).

kokoleko 076

-Sʊmabolu -mä ʊ yi -lɔɔ ŋë. (-kpazebhleku)
Now, Worm he arrived there.
Ver de Terre est arrivé là maintenant.

kokoleko 077

Ale! Nä, wlä, A 'ŋʊ -mɔɔ plüü! (-kpazebhleku)
There you go! So they said, "Beat the drums there!"
Aussitôt le signal a été donné: « Engagez les tamtams! »

kokoleko 078

'Nı wa yii -mɔɔ 'ŋʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
And they beat the drums there.
Et ils ont engagé les tamtams.

kokoleko 079 (third song)

Ɔ {Ʊ} lä, -Anımı -anımı! Gbëkëzlëji 'anımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)
He (= Worm) said (= sang), (words are unananlyzable) (AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE: …)
Il (= Ver de Terre) dit (en chantant): (mots inanalysables) (AUDITOIRE: …)
'Nımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)
'Nımıa nımıko! (Audience and narrator together: -Anımı -anımıa anımı anımı!)

kokoleko 080

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 081

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 082

-Sʊmabolu nii- -lɔlɔbhɛgö -ngbü. (-kpazebhleku)
Worm got 5000 francs.
Ver de Terre a eu cinq mille francs.

kokoleko 083

Ɔ lä, Ale, -ɔɔ -wʊ gbʊʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "There you go, it's not a big deal."
Il dit: « OK! Ce n'est pas grave. »

kokoleko 084

-Mä -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊʊ' 'mnö -yɛ mɛɛ-. (-kpazebhleku)
But Rooster wasn't happy any more.
Mais Coq n'était plus content.

kokoleko 085

Aadebee' wa mʊ ylä (-kpazebhleku)
It is to Adebem they are now going.
Ils sont en train d'aller à Adébem

kokoleko 086

'nɪ wa yi Aadebee' ŋë. (-kpazebhleku)
and they arrived in Adebem.
et ils sont arrivés à Adébem.

kokoleko 087*

Ʊmʊ -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ, ʊmʊʊ- -gää lä 'kɔɔkɔ 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
That same Rooster, it was him who always walked ahead.
C'est lui Coq qui est toujours devant.

kokoleko 088

Ʊ -ŋë lä gää 'nɪ ʊ yi -mɔɔ 'pä. (-kpazebhleku)
As soon as he had arrived, he began to sing.
Quand il est arrivé, il a en même temps entonné

kokoleko 089

Wlä, Saa yɪ?
They said, “What’s the matter now?”
On demanda: « Qu’est-ce qui se passe donc? »

kokoleko 090

Ɔ lä, 'Döö' -wʊ -mɔɔ -kʊ, (-kpazebhleku)
He said, “There’s nothing serious,
Il dit: « Il n'y a rien de grave.

kokoleko 091

-mä 'lʊ -a bie lä nä,
but we are doing a dance competition,
mais nous sommes en tournée de danse,

kokoleko 092

sɔɔ -a -yi lä, sɔɔ n -yi lä (-kpazebhleku)
That’s why I have come.
c'est pourquoi je suis venu.

kokoleko 093

-Mä n -yä -Sʊmabolu 'sɔɔ- bie lä 'lʊ
I and Worm together are doing the dance competition;
Moi avec Ver de Terre nous faisons la tournée de danse ensemble ;

kokoleko 094*

-mä ɔ -kʊ klë (-kpazebhleku)
he is behind,
il est derrière,

kokoleko 095*

-mä kɔ yi -kä, (-kpazebhleku)
but he is coming,
mais il arrive,

kokoleko 096

nä ale, a 'kä -mɔɔ plüü 'ŋʊ
so go and get the drums ready!
donc allez et mettez les tamtams au point!

kokoleko 097

-Amʊ, n 'kä 'naa däkʊ ye. (-kpazebhleku)
As for me, I shall dance my part."
Quant à moi, je vais danser ma part. »

kokoleko 098

'Nı wa yi -plüüklänyʊa wälı 'pä. (-kpazebhleku)
And they called the drummers.
Et on a appelé les batteurs de tamtam.

kokoleko 099

Wlä : A 'ŋʊ yı -mɔɔ! (-kpazebhleku)
They said, "Beat the drums now!"
On leur a dit: « Engagez les tamtams! »

kokoleko 100

'Nı wa yii -mɔɔ 'ŋʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
And they started to beat them.
et ils ont commencé à les battre.

kokoleko 101 (fourth song)

Ɔ {Ʊ} lä, -Anımı -anımı! Gbëkëzlëji 'anımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)
He (= Worm) said (= sang), (words are unananlyzable) (AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE: …)
Il (= Ver de Terre) dit (en chantant): (mots inanalysables) (AUDITOIRE: …)
'Nımı anımıko (-Anımı -anımı)
'Nımıa nımıko! (AUDIENCE AND NARRATOR TOGETHER: -Anımı -anımıa anımı anımı!)

kokoleko 102

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 103

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 104

Ʊ nii- -luëyi 'kʊgbä (ASTONISHED AUDIENCE: Ouais)
He (Rooster) got 50 francs. *(yeah)*
Il (le coq) a eu cinquante francs. *(ouais)*

kokoleko 105

'nɪ ɔ {ʊ} yi gbogo. (-kpazebhleku)
and he made room (for Worm to take his turn)
et il a laissé le passage (à Ver de Terre).

kokoleko 106

'Nɪ -Sʊmabolu yi 'kʊ bhɪä (-kpazebhleku)
And Worm was last
Ver de Terre était en dernière position

kokoleko 107

'nɪ ʊ yi 'kʊ ghlä. (-kpazebhleku)
and he appeared.
et il est apparu.

kokoleko 108

Wlä, A 'ŋʊ yɪ -mɔɔ! (-kpazebhleku)
They said (to the drummers), "Go for it!"
On dit (aux batters de tamtam): « Entamez! »

kokoleko 109

-Mä dä plüü -su -lätee nä..! (-kpazebhleku)
But when the drums were still hot,
Mais au moment où les tamtams étaient encore chauds,

kokoleko 110

-tʊʊgbälöö yi në -sä. (-kpazebhleku)
the long drums resounded.
les longs tambours ont retenti.

kokoleko 111 (fifth song)

Ɔ lä, -Anɪmɪ -anɪmɪ! Gbëkëzlëji 'anɪmɪ anɪmɪko (-Anɪmɪ -anɪmɪ)
He (= Worm) said (= sang), (words are unananlyzable) (Audience: …)
Il (= Ver de Terre) dit (en chantant): (mots inanalysables)
'Nɪmɪ anɪmɪko (-Anɪmɪ -anɪmɪ)
'Nɪmɪa nɪmɪko! (AUDIENCE AND NARRATOR TOGETHER: -Anɪmɪ -anɪmɪa anɪmɪ anɪmɪ!)

kokoleko 112

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

kokoleko 113

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

kokoleko 114

-Sʊmabolu mʊ nʊ-kää nä, (-kpazebhleku)
When Worm had done his part,
Quand Ver de Terre a fait sa part,

kokoleko 115

ʊ nii- -lɔlɔbhɛgö 'kʊgbä. (-kpazebhleku) (AUDIENCE: shouts of surprise)
he got ten thousand francs.
il a eu dix mille.

kokoleko 116

Monie (ɔ) {ʊ} yɛ yı 'bhlä. (-kpazebhleku)
The money, he now had more than enough. (lit. he has now killed it)
L'argent, il en a eu plus qu'assez.(litt.: il l'a maintenant tué)

kokoleko 117

-Bon, wlä -zıkää nä, kä -a mʊ ylä -a 'bhlı. (-kpazebhleku)
"Well, we'll now (lit. today) go back home.
« Bon, nous allons maintenant (litt. aujourd'hui) chez nous.

kokoleko 118

-A yä yı 'dii 'wlu koo-, (-kpazebhleku)
We have come through the villages (lit. we have touched the head of the villages),
Nous avons parcouru tous les villages (litt.: nous avons touché la tête des villages),

kokoleko 119

nä kä -a mʊ ylä -a 'bhlı. (-kpazebhleku)
so we'll now go back home."
donc nous allons maintenant chez nous. »

kokoleko 120

ɩmı 'sɔ ı (-gää 'yi) {gëgë- yı} 'kʊ -aaa.
The two of them followed each other for a long time.
Les deux se suivaient pendant un long moment.

kokoleko 121

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ -gää 'yi 'kʊ, (-kpazebhleku)
Rooster was in front
Coq était devant

kokoleko 122

-Sʊmabolu guu 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
and Worm was following him.
et le Ver de Terre le suivait.

kokoleko 123*

Kä wa mʊ ylä. (-kpazebhleku)
They were now leaving.
Ils étaient en train de partir.

kokoleko 124*

Wa yä -blɔɔ bhlü -aaa, (-kpazebhleku)
They go (lit. have gone) on the road until
Ils parcourent (lit. ont parcouru) le chemin jusqu'à

kokoleko 125*

wa yä -blɔɔ 'mʊ mimi-. (-kpazebhleku)
they reach (lit. have reached) half way.
faire la moitié du chemin.

kokoleko 126*

Wlä kä wa wlo yı nä (-kpazebhleku)
Then all of a sudden (lit. as they are now looking)
Alors tout d'un coup (litt. au moment où ils regardent)

kokoleko 127*

-n ni 'nyikpotütë. (-kpazebhleku)
there is a swarm of black ants!
voici un essaim de fourmis magnan!

kokoleko 128

'Nyıkpotütë wa -ŋë ylä nä,
The swarm of black ants upon which they arrived
L'essaim de magnans qu'ils ont rencontré

kokoleko 129

aa' yıɛ bhlobhlodä -kä. (-kpazebhleku)
it had no end.
il n'avait pas de fin.

kokoleko 130

-Sʊmabolu lä, N 'kä 'ylıbhɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
Worm said, "I'll go back."
Ver de Terre dit: « Je vais retourner. »

kokoleko 131

Wlä kɔkwɛɛ lä, 'Nn, -n yi -n plää' kätää' (-kpazebhleku)
The fowl said, "No, come and get on my back,
Le poulet dit: « Viens et monte sur mon dos,

kokoleko 132

-yä n kää- plüa (-kpazebhleku)
so I can take you across,
pour que je te fasse traverser;

kokoleko 133

-mä -anyı 'sɔɔ- -yi bhlä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
the two of us had come together,
car c'est nous deux qui étions venus

kokoleko 134

n 'nöö- -lä të. (-kpazebhleku)
so I mustn't abandon you.
je ne dois pas t'abandonner.

kokoleko 135

'Nyɛɛ' monie. (-kpazebhleku)
Give me the money!" (to carry it)
Donne-moi l'argent! » (pour le porter)

kokoleko 136

'Nι ɔ yi (gbä) {ci nynä} -n plää' kätää' (-kpazebhleku)
And he said, "Get on my back,
Puis il a dit: « Monte sur mon dos,

kokoleko 137

ιyä n 'kää- plüa. (-kpazebhleku)
so that I can take you across."
pour que je te fasse traverser. »

kokoleko 138

-Sυmaboluu' moniinɛ υ nii- lä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
That money that Worm had gotten
Cet argent que Ver de Terre a eu,

kokoleko 139

υ nii- -lɔlɔbhɛgöö' gwlι 'sɔ 'nι 'kυgbä. (AUDIENCE: 'Aa) (-kpazebhleku)
he had gotten fifty thousand francs.
il a eu cinquante mille francs.

kokoleko 140

-Anυυ, -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlυυ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
what's he called, Rooster,
- comment il s'appelle?- Coq

kokoleko 140a

υ nii- -lɔlɔglυ -luëyi 'kυgbä. (AUDIENCE: 'Aa). (-kpazebhleku)
he had gotten one hundred and fifty francs.
il a eu cent cinquante francs.

kokoleko 141

Moniinɛ, ɔ {υ} lä : Nä nn' -lä -zɔɔ bhlü -a?
That money, he (= Worm) said, "Will I not fall down?"
Cet argent, il (Ver de Terre) dit: « Est-ce que je vais pas tomber? »

kokoleko 142*

Ɔ (-kɔkwɛɛ) lä, -N kυ -mää 'naa kätänää'! (-kpazebhleku)
He (Rooster) said, "Sit (lit. be) right here on my back!
Il (Coq) dit: « Mets-toi (litt. sois) ici sur mon dos!

kokoleko 143

Kʊ -mää 'naa -papüü 'sɔ pää',
Sit here between my two wings,
Mets-toi ici entre mes deux ailes,

kokoleko 144

känöö' -kä sä, (-kpazebhleku)
hold on fast to me,
tiens-moi bien,

kokoleko 145

-mä kä n mʊ lä (-kpazebhleku)
because I am leaving
car je suis en train de partir

kokoleko 146

n 'kää- plüa! (-kpazebhleku)
to take you across!"
pour te faire traverser! »

kokoleko 147

Ɔ lä, -Aa.
He (= Worm) said, "Alright."
Il (= Ver de Terre) dit: « Entendu. »

kokoleko 148

'Nɪ ɔ yi -lɔɔ 'plöö-. (-kpazebhleku)
Then he (= Rooster) passed there.
Puis il (= Coq) est passé là,

kokoleko 149

{'Nɪ} Ɔ yio kätää' 'plöö-, (-kpazebhleku)
and he (= Worm) passed on his (= Rooster's) back
et il (= Ver de Terre) est passé sur son dos

kokoleko 150

'nɪ ɔ yio -mɔɔ 'ŋʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
and he (= Rooster) put him (= Worm) there,
et il (= Coq) l'a mis là-bas

kokoleko 151

Ale! en route! (-kpazebhleku) Kä wa paa {y}lä.
There you go, go ahead! *They were now running.*
Aussitôt fait, *ils se sont mis à courir.*

kokoleko 152

'Nyikpotütënä 'mä ɔ bhlü -kɛ lä. (-kpazebhleku)
It is that swarm of ants that he (= Rooster) is going through now
C'est l'essaim de fourmis magnans qu'il (= Coq) est en train de parcourir à présent

kokoleko 153

-Judu! -judu! -judu!
with huge steps!
à grands pas!

kokoleko 154*

Ɔ -kʊ paadä -aaa,
He was running until
Il courait jusqu'à ce qu'

kokoleko 155

ɔ mʊ 'nyikpotütëa' {nëëdë} ŋë -kää nä, (-kpazebhleku)
he arrived in the middle of the swarm of black ants,
à arriver au milieu de l'essaim de magnans,

kokoleko 156

'nɪ ɔ yii gbɔtɔ.
then he shook them (=his wings)
puis il a les a secoué (les ailes)

kokoleko 157*

Wuë! -Sʊmabolu yä -zɔɔ bhlü. (-kpazebhleku)
(ideophone) Worm falls (lit. has fallen) down!
Hélas! Ver de Terre tombe (litt. est tombé)!

kokoleko 158*

-Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ yä -bluu
Rooster flies (lit. has flewn),
Coq s'envole (litt. s'est envolé),

kokoleko 159*

ʊ yä mʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
he is gone.
il est parti.

kokoleko 160

'Nyikponʊ -mä,
So these black ants…,
Ces magnans donc…,

kokoleko 161

-Sʊmabolu -mä, (-kpazebhleku)
Now Worm,
Or Ver de Terre,

kokoleko 161a

ʊ -glö wä 'pʊpʊnʊʊ' 'mnönyunɔnyɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
he was a very wicked person.
il était un homme très méchant.

kokoleko 162

-N gä -Sʊmaboluu' gbʊ nii- nä, (-kpazebhleku)
If you got a problem with Worm,
Si tu as eu affaire à Ver de Terre,

kokoleko 163

-nn goo- -wʊ duu',
you don't sleep in the village
tu ne dors pas au village.

kokoleko 164

kʊ tlüü- lä. (-kpazebhleku)
he chases you away (from the village).
Il te chasse (du village).

kokoleko 165

Nä sɔɔ 'pʊpʊʊ 'mnö mnümnülɛlıaa' -lefɪn kä wa tänʊ bhä 'kɔɔkɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
That's why all the little beasts in the world that bite look for him all the time.
C'est pour cela que toutes les petites bêtes du monde qui mordent le cherchent toujours.

kokoleko 166

Ʊ -bhlüü lä -lɔɔ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
When he fell down there,
Quand il est tombé là,

kokoleko 167

-lää' 'nyikpoyee- gä (ɔɔ') {ɛɛ'} 'klë 'kʊ bhlüü,
each black ant will take its piece (of Worm)
chaque fourmi magnant va prendre son morceau (de Ver de Terre)

kokoleko 168

'kpäkplää! kä (ɔ){ɛ} döa 'mʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
with rapid mouvements, she cuts him up.
d'un geste rapide, elle le découpe (aussitôt).

kokoleko 169

-Sʊmabolunʊ ʊmʊ (wa yi) -lɔɔ -blɔklänëdë,
Ver de Terre, lui, là au milieu du chemin,

kokoleko 170

'nɪ wa yiu (lü) {'mʊ -döödö} 'fɪn,
they cut him up completely
ils l'ont découpé entièrement

kokoleko 171

'nɪ wa yiu -lɔɔ të. (-kpazebhleku)
and they abandoned him there.
et ils l'ont abandonné là.

kokoleko 172

Wa yiu -zɔ bhıä. (-kpazebhleku)
They finished him.
Ils l'ont fini.

kokoleko 173*

-Kɔkwɛɛnɔ, -ɔɔ bhɛ lä monii nii- nä, (-kpazebhleku)
That rooster, who had not gained any money,
Ce coq qui n'avait pas eu d'argent,

kokoleko 174*

'nı ɔ yi monie 'kʊ 'bhlü (-kpazebhleku)
he then took the money (Worm had gotten)
il a alors pris l'argent (que Ver de Terre a eu)

kokoleko 175*

'nı ɔ -nyɛsɔ yi bhä yi aa! (-kpazebhleku)
and went away (lit. came) with it
et il est parti (litt. venu) avec.

kokoleko 176

Leylü 'kʊ ɔ -kʊ lä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
It's on a fortune that he now sits.
C'est sur la richesse qu'il est assis.

kokoleko 177

lı' -zä zeli kä lä -ze
That is why at daybreak
C'est pourquoi quand il fait jour,

kokoleko 178

'nı ɔmɔɔ- pä lä 'bhlıɛ 'mʊ (bhlıɛ 'kʊ) wälı. (-kpazebhleku)
it is him who starts shouting in the land.
c'est lui qui se met à crier dans la région.

kokoleko 179

Dä nyıkpɔ kä -kʊ,
Wherever someone is
Où que quelqu'un soit,

kokoleko 180

ɔ 'kä ɔɔ' wälıı 'nu. (-kpazebhleku)
he will hear his words (of boasting) (=his cock-a-doodle-doo).
il va entendre ses paroles (orgueilleuses) (=son cocorico).

kokoleko 181

lı' -zä -Kɔkɔɔbhɛlʊ pä lä wälı aa! (-kpazebhleku)
That is why Rooster shouts, then!
Voici pourquoi il crie, comme il fait aujourd'hui!

kokoleko 182

N paa- 'naa 'nünë o! (-kpazebhleku)
I have told (lit. shown) my story!
J'ai raconté (litt. montré) mon conte!

kokoleko 183

Zagbʊ -zagbʊ o!
(Expression in order to pass to the next story?)
Expression de transition au conte suivant?)

kokoleko 184

SEPI GƆVA 'wlu o!
On Sepi Gova's head
Sur la tête de Sepy Gova.

kokoleko 185

(Everyone) -Tʋänı.
End
Fin

12. Lueuzi

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: How a co-wife is punished for her greed and cruelty / *Contenu*: Comment une coépouse est puni pour sa jalousie et cruauté
Speaker/Locuteur: C (75, male)
Date: 16-08–94

lueuzi 001

ɩmı n cii- bhlä tɛɛ
That's what I said before
C'est ce que j'avais dit,

lueuzi 002

nynä gämadä nää-.
that having fun is good.
que s'amuser est bon.

lueuzi 003

-Mä a 'nö gäma nä,
But if you are not having fun,
Mais si vous ne vous amusez pas,

lueuzi 004

a yi nyıkpa 'kʊgbä 'plö,
you could be ten people,
vous pouvez être dix personnes,

lueuzi 005

(c'est zero!) 'Nn!
(it is nothing) No!
c'est zéro! Non!

lueuzi 006*

-Kpläkplödö lä,
It's a lie (=it is good for nothing).
C'est mensonge (= c'est peine perdue).

lueuzi 007

-mä nn' kı -lä 'mʊ 'bhläbhlä.
but I mustn't mix them (=my words) up.
mais il ne faut pas que je les (=mes paroles) mélange.

lueuzi 008*

A yi nyıkpaa' gwlıtaa bhlü,
You could be sixty people,
Que vous soyez soixante,

lueuzi 009

'nı a 'nö gäma nä,
and if you are not having fun,
et si vous ne vous amusez pas,

lueuzi 010

ıı' yıɛ (-wʊ) nää-.
it's no good.
ce n'est pas bien.

lueuzi 011

Ɩı' -zä 'naa plɛyii' -kʊ lä 'kɔɔkɔ gämalı
That is why in my heart, there is always fun,
C'est pour cela que dans mon cœur, il y a toujours amusement,

lueuzi 012

'nı 'naa plɛyii' yi 'kɔɔkɔ gämalı kʊ -kaa
and in my heart there will always be fun until
et dans mon cœur, il y aura toujours amusement jusqu'à

lueuzi 013

'nı -amʊ 'titi 'naa nyämʊ yi bhıä.
my own breath will end.
à ce que moi-même mon souffle va finir.

lueuzi 014 (Song/Chant)

Libhia Libhiaaaa!
wlä -maa -naa lü bhä -go leee
wlä -naa 'yu lü bhä ple ple lü o 'naa 'yu
-ɔ waa 'naa 'yu -cɔpɔ nı

(Song to announce the story. The audience is invited to sing what the storyteller tells it to sing.)

(Chant entonné pour annoncer le conte. L'auditoire est appelé à chanter ce que le conteur lui dit de chanter.)

lueuzi 015

Sɔɔ a ŋo -klää 'kʊ a!

This is how you answer!

Voici comment vous répondez!

lueuzi 016

Libhia Libhia!…

(The audience sings together as instructed when the storyteller gives the signal)

(L'auditoire chante en chœur au signal du conteur).

lueuzi 017

-Jlibɔ 'titi -mati!

A true riddle for you to hear!

Un vrai énigme pour votre écoute!

lueuzi 018

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää- lä.

We want to hear it. (lit. it is 'mati' we have asked)

Nous voulons l'entendre. (litt. c'est 'mati' que nous avons demandé)

lueuzi 019

Wlaa … (sese) 'nɪ 'ylʊbää' -a -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ? (sese)

They say … *is it in the season of clearing the bush that we are in?*

On dit que … *est-ce en période de débroussaillage que nous sommes?*

lueuzi 020*

Wlä (sɔɔ) nyɪkpɔ {ɔmɔɔ-} nöö- lä ɔɔ' 'ŋwnɪä 'sɔ. (sese)

They say there was a man who had two wives.

On dit qu'il y avait un homme qui avait deux femmes.

lueuzi 021*

-Kaflɪnɪɛ! Ɔɔ' 'ŋwnɪa 'sɔ -kä 'yuë 'sɔ. (sese)

Excuse me! (=I'll talk to you about a calamity) His two wives had two children.

Que cela ne vous déplaise! (=Je vais parler d'un malheur) Ses deux femmes avaient deux enfants.

lueuzi 022*

Kä wa këpë lä, (sese)

They were at the age of crawling

ils marchaient à quatre pattes

lueuzi 023*

'nɪ ɔ -loo lä 'säkäzize, (sese)

when he had cleared land for a rice field

quand il avait nettoyé un champ de riz

lueuzi 024*

'nɪ 'ŋwnɪa yi 'säkaa go. (sese)
and the women planted the rice.
et les femmes ont planté le riz.

lueuzi 025*

'Säkänä futo ylä nä, (sese)
When that rice was now bearing fruit,
Quand ce riz fleurissait,

lueuzi 026

'säkaa, kä mna lüa. (sese)
the rice, the animals were eating it.
le riz, les animaux le mangeaient.

lueuzi 027

Bholuzälö lüa lä {nä}, ('nn)
As the pigs were eating it,
Comme les sangliers le mangeaient,

lueuzi 028*

ɔɔ' 'slënɔɔ (sese) ɔ laa:
his first wife, *she said,*
sa première épouse, *elle dit:*

lueuzi 029*

N 'kä -zɪkä -mɔɔ' 'klää' mʊ. (sese)
“I am going to go to the field there today.”
« Je vais aller au champ aujourd'hui. »

lueuzi 030*

'Nɪ ɔ yi ylä 'yuo 'kʊ bhlü
Then she took the child
Puis elle a pris l'enfant

lueuzi 031*

'nɪ ɔ yi ylä -mɔɔ mʊ. (sese)
and she now went there.
et elle y est allée.

lueuzi 032

Ɔ -mʊ ylä (-gɔgblö -bhutuu) 'säkä -papa -zɔɔ {nä}, (sese)
When she had now gone under the shelter by the rice field,
Quand elle est allée sous l'apatam du champ,

lueuzi 033

ɔ yä yɪ -kosu zlaa-. (sese)
she makes (lit. has made) a fire.
elle fait (lit. a fait) du feu.

lueuzi 034*

Ɔ -nyoto -nʊ -gbɔtʊ nä,
Her husband had built a bed out of bamboo,
Son mari ayant fait un lit en bambou,

lueuzi 035*

-gbɔtʊʊ 'kʊ wa pu sä. (sese)
so it was on the bamboo bed that they were lying down.
c'est sur le lit en bambou qu'ils se couchent.

lueuzi 036*

{-Mä -lɔɔ 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ,} ɔ -nyoto -goo duu' (sese)
But that day her husband spent the night in the village
Mais ce jour-là, son mari a dormi au village,

lueuzi 037

{'nɪ} ɔ luëzüŋnɔ -goo duu'. (sese)
and her co-wife slept in the village.
et sa rivale a dormi au village.

lueuzi 038

'Yuo yä yɪ ŋɔɔ. (sese)
The child is now asleep (lit. has now slept).
L'enfant dort alors (litt. a alors dormi).

lueuzi 039

Tɛɛtɛɛ, 'näpöö' wɛ -kʊ ʊ? (sese)
In former times there were no lamps, right?
Avant, il n'y avait pas de lampes, n'est-ce pas?

lueuzi 040*

Ylɪɪ wa nʊ wä. (sese)
It was torches people used to make.
C'est des flambeaux qu'on utilisait.

lueuzi 041

'Nɪ ɔ yi ylʊ 'kʊ 'bhlü, (sese)
Then she took a torch
Et elle a pris un flambeau

lueuzi 042

'nɪ ɔ yiu 'yi -döö. (sese)
and she lit it.
et elle l'a allumée.

lueuzi 043*

'Yuo puu- yɪ -gbɔtʊʊ 'kʊ,
Now the child lay on the bamboo bed,
L'enfant est maintenant couché sur le lit en bambou

lueuzi 044*

ɔ yä ŋɔ. (sese)
he is asleep (lit. has slept)
il dort. (litt. a dormi)

lueuzi 045*

'Klaa 'mnö ɔ mʊ ylä bi -kä. (sese)
She then goes for a stroll into the (rice) field.
C'est dans le champ qu'elle est alors partie se promener.

lueuzi 046*

'Yuo -glɔ ylä nä, (sese)
Now when the child has woken up,
Quand l'enfant s'est réveillé,

lueuzi 047*

kɔ mʊ ylä -mɔɔ 'klaa 'mnö. (sese)
he then goes into the field.
il a commencé à partir dans le champ.

lueuzi 048*

'Säkaa -bɔlɪı wa saa wä. (sese)
Formerly they used to make paths in the rice fields.
Avant on avait l'habitude de faire des sentiers dans les champs de riz

lueuzi 049*

Ʊmʊ ɔ bhlü ylä. (sese)
It was such a path that he (=the child) then took.
C'est un tel sentier (litt. sur lui) que l'enfant (litt. il) prit.

lueuzi 050*

Laagɔ nʊ ylä wälɪ nä, (sese)
Now as God does things,
Comme Dieu fait les choses

lueuzi 051*

'ŋnɔɔ mʊ yɪ 'wluylɪbha -kä nä, (sese)
as the woman was now turning her head,
au moment où la femme allait tourner la tête,

lueuzi 052*

ɔɔ' plɛ nynä mnɛ -ɛ yi. (sese)
she thought it was an animal that was coming
elle croyait que c'était un animal qui venait.

lueuzi 053*

Du! Ɔ yä 'yuo 'bhlä. (sese)
With a blow (ideophone) she kills (lit. has killed) her child.
D'un coup de machette, elle tue (litt. a tué) l'enfant.

lueuzi 054*

Ɔ lä kɔ wlo yı,
As she was now looking,
Au moment où elle regarde,

lueuzi 055*

-n ni yı ɔɔ' 'yu mɔ. (sese)
there's now her child(s body)!
voici (le corps de) son enfant!

lueuzi 056

O! lı' -wʊ (yɛ) wälı -kä. (sese)
Oh dear! It's not a big deal.
Quelle horreur! (c'est mon enfant que j'ai tué), ça ne fait rien.

lueuzi 057

'Yu nɔ 'mɔ ɔ paa- ylä kätää', (sese) ɔɔ' 'kukulɔɔ. (sese)
That child, it is him she put on her back, *his dead body.*
Cet enfant, c'est lui qu'elle a alors mis sur son dos, *son cadavre.*

lueuzi 058

Duu' ɔ mʊ ylä (sese)
She now started out for the village,
Elle partait au village maintenant,

lueuzi 059 (Song)

ɔ lä, Libhia! Libhiaaaa! (Audience: Libhia! Libhiaaaa!)
she was singing (lit. said): (words unanlyzable)
elle a entonné ce chant: (paroles inanalysables)
wlä -maa -naa lü bhä -go leee
wlä -naa 'yu lü bhä ple ple lü o 'naa 'yu
-ɔ waa 'naa 'yu -cɔpɔ nı

lueuzi 060

O! 'Ylʊ yä yı bhlü (sese)
Oh dear, it is night (litt. day has fallen),
Oh, il fait nuit (litt. le jour est tombé),

lueuzi 061

-mä nyıkpaa' -läte sä puu. (sese)
but people are not asleep yet.
mais les gens ne dorment pas encore.

lueuzi 062

Kɔ bhlı ylä,
She is singing
Elle est en train de chanter

lueuzi 063

kɔ mʊ ylä. (sese)
and she is going (to the village).
et elle est en train de partir (au village).

lueuzi 064*

Dunyʊa lä, Ɔ! A po -wʊ 'nyukwli! (sese)
The villagers said, “Oh! (What’s that sound?) Listen!
Les villageois disent: « Oh!(Qu'est donc ce bruit?) Écoutez! Prêtez l'oreille!

lueuzi 065*

-Mä -aawlii' 'klaa' -blɔɔ 'kʊ, (sese)
The path to our friend’s field,
Du chemin au champ de notre ami,

lueuzi 065a*

'nʊgbʊwälı ghlä -kä -mɔɔ. (sese) (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE:) Libhia! Libhiaaaa!…
wailing is coming from there (lit. wailing passes there).”
des plaintes proviennent de là (lit. passent là). »

lueuzi 066

Wlä, -Aawli,
They (=the villagers) said,
Ils (les villageois) disent: « Notre ami,

lueuzi 067

-naa 'klaa -blɔɔ 'kʊ -mɔɔ 'nʊgbʊwälıı ghlä lä. (sese)
The path to your field, it is from there the wailing is coming.”
Du chemin de ton champ, c’est de là que proviennent les plaintes. »

lueuzi 068*

'Nı wlä 'ŋnɔnɔ yi wä a (sese)
And that woman was coming (to the village)
Et cette femme venait (au village).

lueuzi 069*

'nı ɔ ŋʊ wä 'yu nɔ sä a. (sese)
and she was putting that (dead) child down.
et déposait cet enfant (mort).

lueuzi 070*

Zeli yä yı ze, (sese)
The next morning
Le lendemain matin,

lueuzi 071*

wlä, -Aa, -mɔɔ 'titi -naa 'yu bhɛ, (sese)
they (the villagers) said to the woman, Well, it was your own child,
ils (les villageois) dirent à la femme: « C'était ton propre enfant,

lueuzi 072*

nä sä -n 'gä lä nʊ
so the way you are going to proceed
donc la manière dont tu vas procéder

lueuzi 073*

('nɪ) -yä -n 'gɔ lä büda nä, (sese)
in order to wash him (is that)
pour que tu le laves (est que)

lueuzi 074

-nn -lä 'nyu 'titi 'plü (sese)
you will not draw real water
tu ne puiseras pas de la vraie eau

lueuzi 075

'nɪ -n 'gɔ büda.
in order to wash him.
pour le laver,

lueuzi 076

-n gä cii- 'kpokposä -n 'nöɔ -wʊ bhlää- nä.
since you say that you didn't do it on purpose."
puisque tu dis que tu ne l'as pas fait exprès. »

lueuzi 077

Nä 'bii, ɪmɪ wa -tla lä, (sese)
It is wash bowls they held out (to her)
Donc ce sont des cuvettes qu'ils (lui) ont tendues.

lueuzi 078

wlä, -N 'tu 'mɪɔɔ, (sese)
saying, "Weep bitterly!",
disant: « Pleure à chaudes larmes!, »

lueuzi 079

-n 'tu 'mɪɔɔ! (sese)
Weep bitterly!
Pleure à chaudes larmes!

lueuzi 080

-Naa 'mɪɔɔ 'mʊ -n -nä -n 'gä lä 'kʊ bhlü
It is your tears that you will take
Ce sont tes larmes que tu vas prendre

lueuzi 081

{-yä} -n 'gä lä 'yuo büda. (sese)
in order to wash the child."
pour laver l'enfant. »

lueuzi 082

'Nı wlä wa yio 'bii -zɔɔ 'suu-. (sese)
Then they pushed wash basins before her
Puis ils ont poussé les cuvettes en bas d'elle.

lueuzi 083 (Song, see line 14)

Ɔ lä, Libhia! Libhiaaa! (AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE: Libhia Libhia!)
She said singing: (unanalyzable words)
Elle dit en chantant: (mots inanalysables)
wlä -maa -naa lü bhä -go leee
wlä -naa 'yu lü bhä ple ple lü o 'naa 'yu
-ɔ waa 'naa 'yu -cɔpɔ nı

lueuzi 084

Wlä 'bii -lefıın, gää ı yie- gää ɔɔ' 'mıɔɔ 'kʊ. (sese)
All the wash basins, they got filled with her tears.
On dit que toutes les cuvettes ont été remplies de ses larmes

lueuzi 085*

Wlä, -N büdüo yı! (sese)
They said (to her), “Wash him now!”
Ils (lui) dirent: « Lave-le maintenant! »

lueuzi 086*

'nı ɔ yio 'kʊ 'bhlü
Then she took him
Alors elle l’a pris

lueuzi 087*

'nı ɔ yio büda 'fıın. (sese)
and washed him completely.
et elle l’a lavé complètement.

lueuzi 088*

'Nı wa yio lıılılı 'kʊ 'ŋʊ. (sese)
Then they put ornaments on him.
Puis on a mis des parures sur lui.

lueuzi 089

Wlä, -N mʊ -n 'gɔ yı zizie! (sese)
They said (to the woman), “Go bury him!”
On dit (à la femme): « Vas l'enterrer! »

lueuzi 090*

'Nı ɔ yio zizie. (sese)
And she buried him.
Alors elle l’a enterré.

lueuzi 091*

-Mä ɔ -zizio- ylä naa, (sese)
When she had now buried him,

lueuzi 092

duu' 'kɔgwlɛnyʊa (sese) (ɔ) -wa -kʊ ylä duu' nää, (sese)
the village elders who were now in the village,
les anciens qui étaient alors dans le village

lueuzi 093*

(ɔ) wlä, A yi -wʊ -zıkä, (sese)
they said, “Let’s get together shortly,
ils dirent, « Venez (et concertons-nous),

lueuzi 094

-mä 'ŋnɔɔ 'wugä -bhɔɔ lä 'wlu. (sese)
as the woman has had a rough time. (lit. the woman’s soul left from her head)
car la femme a été terriblement éprouvé. (litt. l'âme de la femme lui a quitté la tête)

lueuzi 095

Nä 'wugä yɔ 'wlu -bha nä, (sese)
Since she has had such a rough time,
Puisqu'elle a été éprouvée de la sorte,

lueuzi 096

a yi -a 'gɔ 'nyu büda, (sese)
come, let’s offer her gifts (lit. let’s wash her with water)
Venez et offrons-lui des présents (litt. lavons-la avec de l'eau)

lueuzi 097

-yä -a 'gɔ 'wugɔ 'wlu 'ŋʊ. (sese)
in order to comfort her. (lit. put soul on head)
afin de la réconforter. (litt. mettre âme sur tête)

lueuzi 098

Ɔ luëzüŋnɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ, (sese)
Her co-wife was there,
Sa rivale était là,

lueuzi 099

ɔ -fä wälıı plɛ 'kʊ. (sese)
she watched what was going on.
elle observait toute l'affaire.

lueuzi 100

'Ŋnɔɔ 'nı wlä wa yio yı 'nyu büda. (sese)
The woman, so they offered her gifts.
La femme, on lui a alors offert des présents.

lueuzi 101

'Nı wa yi lıı -sä
And they gave (her) riches,
Et ils (lui) ont offert des biens,

lueuzi 102

'nı wa yio 'wugä 'wlu 'ŋɔ. (sese)
and they comforted her.
et ils l'ont réconforté.

lueuzi 103

Ɔ luëzüŋnɔ lä, -Aa, (sese)
Her co-wife said, "I see,
Sa rivale dit: « Ah, bon!

lueuzi 104

-mä 'nı -a luëzüŋnɔ, sää ɔ -nʊ lä (sese)
so my co-wife, that's how she acted
ma rivale, c'est ce qu'elle a fait

lueuzi 105

'nı wa yɔ lı 'nyɛ! (sese)
and they have given her riches."
et ils lui ont donné des biens. »

lueuzi 106*

Ɔɔ' sä ɔ -yä ɔɔ' -lɔɔ 'sɔ -mʊ ylä 'klä nä,
When she and her child (lit. hers) went to the field,
Lorsqu'elle est partie au champ avec son enfant (litt. le sien),

lueuzi 107*

'Gboo-! (AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE / ANIMATEUR: ɔ yɔ 'bhlä)
with a blow (ideophone)
d'un coup de machette

lueuzi 107a*

'nı ɔ yio 'bhlä.
she kills (lit. has killed) him
elle le tue (litt. l'a tué)

lueuzi 108 (Song)

'Sabo (sese) ɔɔ' bhlıwälı {gbä}, Libhia! Libhiaaaa! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: Libhia! Libhia!
In the night she sang a song (the same as her co-wife had sung): unanalyzable words
La nuit elle s'est mise à chanter (le même chant que sa rivale avait chanté)
wlä -maa -naa lü bhä -go leee
wlä -naa 'yu lü bhä ple ple lü o 'naa 'yu
-ɔ waa 'naa 'yu -cɔpɔ nı

lueuzi 109*

Wlä, 'O! A po -kä 'nyukwli -mä,
They (= the villagers) said, “Oh listen again, because
Ils (les villageois) dirent: « Prêtez encore l'oreille, car

lueuzi 110*

-aawlii' 'klä nä 'mnö, gbʊ -bhlobhlo ghlä lä -mɔɔ.
in that field of our friend’s there are a few problems!
au champ de notre ami, il y a quelques problèmes!

lueuzi 111

'Nɪ 'ŋnɔɔ -yä 'yuo 'sɔ yi yi,
So the woman came (to the village) with her (dead) child
Alors la femme rentra (au village) avec l'enfant (mort)

lueuzi 112

'nɪ ɔ yio sä 'ŋʊ. (sese)
and she put him on the ground.
et elle l'a déposé.

lueuzi 113

Wlä, -Aa! lɪ' -yɪɛ wälɪ -kä. (sese)
They (the villagers) said, “Well, that’s no big deal.
Ils (les villageois) dirent: « Bon, on verra ça. (Trêve de commentaire!)

lueuzi 114

-N 'nii- bhɛ zëkü -n luëzüŋnɔɔ' daa.
“You had attended your co-wife’s ceremony yesterday, hadn’t you?
« Tu avais assisté à la cérémonie de ta rivale hier, n'est-ce pas?

lueuzi 115

-N 'nii- bhɛ -lɔɔ. (sese)
You had attended that, hadn’t you?”
Tu y avais assisté, n'est-ce pas? »

lueuzi 116

Zeli -ze lä nä,
The next morning
Le lendemain matin,,

lueuzi 117

'bii 'nɪ 'mɪ wa -lä ylä. (sese)
wash basins, that’s what they brought (to her).
des cuvettes, c’est ce qu'ils ont apportés (auprès d'elle).

lueuzi 118

Wlä, -N 'tu yɪ
They said (to her), “Weep now,
Ils lui dirent: « Pleure maintenant,

lueuzi 119

-yä -n 'gɔ yı büda!
in order to wash him!”
afin de le laver! »

lueuzi 120

{'Nı} wlä nyıkpɔ -dlɛɛ kʋɔ -kä nëë',
Now it is common knowledge (lit they say) that someone has at least spittle in his mouth,
Alors une personne a normalement au moins du crachat dans la bouche

lueuzi 121

'nı ɔ lɔ sä {mʋ -kä -dlɛɛlıä} nëë'
but she couldn’t even get a drop of spittle from her mouth
mais elle ne réussit à faire sortir même une goutte de crachat de sa bouche,

lueuzi 122

'nı wa pɔ -kä -dʋdʋ 'kʋ. 'Bii-!
that could have fallen down. Nothing!
qui pût tomber à terre. Rien!

lueuzi 123

'Nı zeli yi 'mʋ kplɔɔ. (sese)
(This went on) until daylight.
(Cela a duré) jusqu'à ce que le jour parût.

lueuzi 124

-Aa, wlä, -Aa, -ayokä, (sese)
“Alright,” they said, “Alright, thank you.”
« Bon, » dirent-ils. « Bon merci. »

lueuzi 125

-mä -n luëzüŋnɔ, wälıı ɔ -nʋ bhlä mö naa, (sese)
Now your co-wife, what she had done
Sache que ce que ta rivale avait fait

lueuzi 126

'nı -a büdüo- bhlä 'nyuu naa, (sese)
and we had comforted her
et que nous l'avions réconforté,

lueuzi 127*

'kpokposä ɔ 'nı bhɛ -nʋ. (sese)
she hadn’t done it on purpose.
elle ne l'avait pas fait exprès.

lueuzi 128

-Mä -naa -lɔɔ, 'kpokposä -n bhlɔɔ- lä nä, (sese)
But your child (lit. yours), it is on purpose that you killed him, so
Mais ton enfant (litt. le tien), c'est exprès que tu l'as tué, ainsi

lueuzi 129

'kpokposä -n -yɔ 'sɔ yi plä. (sese)
it is on purpose that you will go into the grave (lit. enter) with him.
c'est exprès que tu iras en terre (litt.entrer) avec lui.

lueuzi 130

'Nɪ wlä wa yi lesie 'bhlü. (sese)
So they dug the grave.
Alors ils ont creusé le tombeau.

lueuzi 131

Ɔmɔ {'yuo}, ɔ 'nɔ, -tɛtɛ wa ŋʊʊ- -mɔɔ, (sese)
Him, his mother, it was first that they put her there,
Lui (=l'enfant), sa mère, c'est premièrement qu'on l'a mis dedans

lueuzi 132

'nɪ wa yi -lɔɔ 'yuo 'klʊ 'ŋʊ
then they put the child on top of her
puis ils ont mis l'enfant sur elle

lueuzi 133

'nɪ wa yi -dʊdʊ 'su.
and they closed the grave. (lit. they pushed the soil)
et ils ont fermé le tombeau (litt. poussé la terre).

lueuzi 134

ʟɪ' -zä wlä -n -lie, a kä lä dä -kʊ,
That's why they say that if your neighbour, you live together somewhere
C'est pourquoi on dit que si ton prochain, si vous habitez ensemble quelque part

lueuzi 135

'nɪ -n lie wälɪ kɔ lä 'kʊ -bhlü,
and your neighbour, if he has had (lit. taken) a problem
et que ton camarade a eu un problème(litt. pris une affaire)

lueuzi 136

'nɪ dunyʊä kä lä (gbä) cii- -mä,
and if the villagers say,
et que les villageois disent:

lueuzi 137

Nyɪkpɔnɔ, wälɪnɪ ɔ -nʊ lä -ää nä,
"That person, what they have done,
« Cette personne, ce qu'elle a fait là,

lueuzi 138

'wugä -bhɔɔ {lä} 'wlu nä,
they have had a rough time,
elle a été terriblement éprouvée,

lueuzi 139

a yi -a ˈŋʊɔ ˈwugä ˈwlu!
so let's comfort her,"
donc venez et réconfortons-la!, »

lueuzi 140

ˈnɪ -nn (gbä) {ci -wʊ} nynä
then you mustn't say,
alors tu ne dois pas dire:

lueuzi 141

sää -nɔnɔ -nʊ a -zëkü,
"The way she acted yesterday,
« Comme celle-là a fait hier,

lueuzi 142

-amʊ -mä n yi sɔɔ nʊ {-mʊ}.
me too, I'll act the same way (so I'll also get gifts like they did).
moi aussi, je vais faire ainsi (pour qu'on me donne aussi des biens comme à elle).

lueuzi 143

Kä -n -yɪ plä.
You'll die as a result."
Tu vas en mourir. »

lueuzi 144

N pä -kä ˈnaa ˈnünë o!
I have told (lit. shown) my story!
J'ai fait (litt. montré) mon conte!

lueuzi 145

Zagbʊ -zagbʊ o! -Tʋänɪ.
The story has ended. Next one!
Le conte est terminé. Le suivant!

NB: Ces deux expressions sont dites toujours à la fin des contes pour dire que le conte est terminé On peut dire l'un ou l'autre ou les deux ensemble. Si on les dit successivement comme c'est le cas ici, c'est parce que le conteur ne veut pas passer le relai à quelqu'un d'autre. Soit qu'il continue lui-même ou on ne conte plus. *-Tvänɪ* est précédé du nom d'une personne présente lorsque le conteur veut donner la parole à cette personne.

13. Medic

Genre: Procedural / Description d'activité
Content: How to make "medecine" to chase birds from the rice field / *Contenu*: Comment faire un "médicament" pour chasser les oiseaux de son champ de riz
Speaker/Locuteur: B (40, male)
Date:16-05-1995

medic 001

'Naa 'klaa 'mlö gwäzöö, nümlügwäzöö,
The medicines for my field, the medicines against birds
Les médicaments pour mon champ, les médicaments d'oiseaux

medic 002

gwäzöö n nä,
the medicines I am talking about
ces médicaments don't je parle

medic 003

n fä bhlä 'naa 'klaa 'mlö nä,
that I took to my field
que j'amenais dans mon champ,

medic 004

nümlügwäzö lä.
they are medicines against birds.
ce sont des médicaments d'oiseaux.

medic 005

-Mä n kɪ -mɔɔ -fä nä,
When I take them there,
Lorsque je les y amène,

medic 006

zëplüü' 'pii n kä mʊ nä,
very early in the morning when I am going,
très tôt le matin en allant,

medic 007

nn slä -wʊ nyɪkpɔ në.
I don't talk to anybody.
je ne parle à personne.

medic 008

'Nɪ n mʊ,
Then I go
Puis je vais,

medic 009

'nɪ n ŋë lä 'klaa 'mlö.
and I arrive in the field.
et j'arrive dans le champ

medic 010

N kä 'klaa 'mlö -ŋë nä,
When I have arrived in the field,
Lorsque je suis arrivé dans le champ,

medic 011*

'nɪ n bhlü lä -kosu 'kʊ,
then I take fire,
alors je prends du feu,

medic 012

'nɪ n bhlü gwäzöö 'kʊ,
then I take the medicines
puis je prends les médicaments

medic 013

'nɪ n bhlü -nyakpɪ 'kʊ,
and I take leaves,
et je prends des feuilles,

medic 014

'nɪ n mʊ,
then I go
puis je vais

medic 015

'nɪ n dɪɪ lä 'klaa nëëdë 'yi,
and I kindle them in the middle of the field,
et je les enflamme au milieu du champ,

medic 016

'nɪ n ŋunɪɪ lä -mɔɔ.
and I burn them there.
et je les brûle là.

medic 017

N kɪ -mɔɔ -ŋuu nä,
When I have burnt them there,
Quand je les y ai brûlés,

medic 018

'nɪ n bha -mɔɔ
then I leave there
alors je quitte là

medic 019

'nɪ n yi yɪ duu'.
and I come to the village.
et je viens au village.

medic 020*

Dä n yi lä duu'
When I come to the village,
Lorsque je suis en train de venir au village,

medic 021

-lɔɔ n 'kä lä nyıkpɔ në slä.
then I will speak to someone.
alors je vais parler à quelqu'un.

medic 022

N kä nyıkpɔ në -slä nä,
When I have spoken to someone
Quand j'ai parlé à quelqu'un

medic 023

'nı zeli kä -ze,
and the next morning comes
et que le lendemain arrive,

medic 024

'nı n kä bʊkʊ -mʊ nä,
and I go again,
et que je repars,

medic 025

'nı n mʊ,
then I go
alors je vais

medic 026

'nı n bhlü -kosu 'kʊ,
and I take fire,
et je prends du feu

medic 027

'nı (n döö) n -zla bʊkʊ gwäzöö -kosu,
and (I kindle) I burn the medicine again,
et (j'enflamme) je brûle à nouveau le médicament,

medic 028*

'nı n ŋʊ -mɔɔ -nyakpı,
then I put leaves there
puis je mets des feuilles

medic 029

'nı gboyloo bhlü 'klaa 'kʊ,
and the smoke takes over the field
et la fumée envahit tout le champ,

medic 030

'nı nümlü -bha 'klaa 'mlö.
and the birds leave from (lit. inside) the field.
et les oiseaux quittent du (litt. dans le) champ.

14. Neyo

Genre: Personal narrative / Récit personnel
Content: How a quarrel between fishermen escalated into an ethnic conflict / *Contenu*: Comment une dispute entre pécheurs est devenu un conflit entre ethnies
Speaker/Locuteur: H (28, male)
Date: January / Janvier 1997

neyo 1*

'Döö' -wʊ -mɔɔ Gbɔglɛ -kʊ.
There are no news there in Sassandra.
Il n'y a pas de nouvelles là-bas à Sassandra.

neyo 2*

-Glɪsɪsɪɛɛ' -zä -a -mö bhlä.
It was because of Christmas that we had gone.
C'est à cause de la fête de Noël que nous étions allés.

neyo 3.1*

-A -mö lä nä,
When we had gone,
Quand nous étions allés,

neyo 3.2

-Glɪsɪsɪɛ, -a nie- 'nää
Christmas, we celebrated (lit. found) it fine.
la (fête de) Noël, nous l'avons bien fêtée (lit. trouvée).

neyo 4.1

-Mä dä ɛ 'kä lä yi nä,
Now when it was going to come
Or avant qu'elle n'arrive, (litt. quand elle voulait venir)

neyo 4.2

ɛɛ -lɛɛ -ɛ plöö- lä Nʊwɛlɪɛ nä,
the feast that is Christmas,
la fête qui est la Noël,

neyo 4.3

dä wa gää- lä Zozii nä,
when Jesus was born, (lit. when they gave birth to Jesus)
quand Jésus est né, (litt. quand ils ont mis au monde Jésus)

neyo 4.4

lɔɔ 'cʊʊ ylɪ glʊ -yä 'taa' 'sabo,
in the night of the twenty-third of that month,
la nuit du vingt-troisième jour de ce mois-là,

neyo 4.5

'nɪ -n -yi sɔɔ nynä
then know that
alors sache que

neyo 4.7

glʊ -yä 'sɔ 'kʊ Bedie 'ŋnɔ -mö bhlä Gbɔglɛɛ'
on the twenty-second Bédié's (the Predisdent's) wife had come to Sassandra.
le vingt-deuxième, la femme de Bédié était allée à Sassandra.

neyo 5.1*

Nä glʊ -yä taa 'sabo Jübëyëkpü 'sɔɔ- -mö lä jie 'klʊʊ
So in the night of the twenty-third two young Neyo men went out on the ocean,
Donc dans la nuit du vingt-troisième, deux jeunes Néyo sont partis sur mer,

neyo 5.2

-yä wa 'kä -dädö 'pä
in order to throw their nets,
afin de jeter leurs filets,

neyo 5.3*

-yä wa 'kä zlü tää -Glɪsɪɛɛ' -za.
in order to look for fish because of Christmas.
afin de chercher du poisson à cause de Noël.

neyo 6.1*

Wlä wa -mö lä nä
It is reported that as they went,
On dit que lorsqu'ils sont allés,

neyo 6.3*

Fädɪnyʊä pää- waa 'pilo jiee'.
Fanti people had thrown their net into the ocean.
des Fanti avaient jeté leur filet dans la mer.

neyo 6.4*

Wa niu lä 'yi nä, kwa -sʊʊ 'nyie'
When they saw it, they took it out of the water
Quand ils l'ont vu, ils l'ont enlevé de l'eau

neyo 6.5*

'nɪ wa yiu waa gɔlʊʊ 'mö 'ŋʊ.
and they put it into their canoe.
et ils l'ont mis dans leur pirogue.

neyo 7.1*

lɪ' yɪɔ 'mö -tlʊmä
Before long
Cela n'a plus duré

neyo 7.2*

'nɪ Fädɪnyʊa yi yi.
the Fanti came.
et les Fanti sont venus.

neyo 8.1

Wa -yi lä nä,
When they had come,
Quand ils étaient venus,

neyo 8.2

wlä,
they said,
ils ont dit:

neyo 8.3

-Ɔ bhlüü- bhä -anyıa 'piloo 'kʊ?
“Who took our net?”
« Qui a pris notre filet? »

neyo 9.1

Jübua 'a -wʊ guu-,
The Neyo were not afraid,
Les Néyo n’avaient pas peur,

neyo 9.2

wlä,
they said,
ils ont dit:

neyo 9.3

-Anyıı- bhlüü- lä anyıa 'piloo 'kʊ.
“It is us who took your net.”
« C’est nous qui avons pris votre filet. »

neyo 10.1

Wlä Fädınyʊa lä,
It is reported that the Fanti said,
Les Fanti auraient dit: (litt. On dit que les Fanti ont dit:)

neyo 10.2

'Nı -ɔnözä a bhluu- bhä 'kʊ?
“And why did you take it?”
« Et pourquoi l’avez-vous pris? »

neyo 11.1

Wlä Jübua lä,
It is reported that the Neyo said,
Les Neyo auraient dit:

neyo 11.2

Wälıı -ınözä -a bhluu- lä 'kʊ nä,
“The reason why we have taken it (literally: the problem because of which we have taken it)
« La raison pour laquelle nous l’avons pris,

neyo 11.3

a 'nɪ -wʊ -yi -a?
don't you know it?
vous ne la savez pas?

neyo 12.1

-A yä 'anyɪ bhɛ soo
We had already told you
Nous vous avions déjà dit

neyo 12.2.*

nynä anyɪɪ- -kä 'jekpi gwɔlɪ nä,
that you, who have boats like the white people (i.e. with a motor),
que vous, qui avez des pirogues des Blancs (c'est-à-dire avec un moteur),

neyo 12.3

a 'kä ci
if you say
si vous dites

neyo 12.4

nynä a 'kä fɪɛ nä
that you want to go fishing
que vous voulez faire la pêche

neyo 12.5

a mö jiee' yikʊ
you are to go out on the ocean,
vous n'avez qu'à aller au large,

neyo 12.6*

-yä -anyɪɪ- -kä lä gwɔlɪ tɪkɪlɪa nä,
so that we, who have small canoes,
de sorte que nous, qui avons de petites pirogues,

neyo 12.7

-a 'gä ɛɛ kpɪkpɪɪ 'kʊ tüto
we might navigate close to the shore
nous puissions longer la côte

neyo 12.8

-yä -a 'gä fɪɛ.
in order to fish.
pour faire la pêche.

neyo 13.1*

-A yä bhɛ anyɪ soo
We had told you
Nous vous avions dit

neyo 13.2*

nynä a 'nö pää -lä 'sıı 'piloo 'kʊ.
that you were not to throw a net either,
que vous ne devez pas non plus jeter le filet,

neyo 13.3*

'ızä -a bhlüü- lä anyıa 'piloo 'kʊ.
that is why we took your net.
c'est pourquoi nous avons pris votre filet.

neyo 14.1

Ʊʊ -wʊ zlüye bhlää-,
It hasn't caught any fish,
Il n'a pas pris de poisson,

neyo 14.2*

aa -wʊ cii-
we did not say
nous n'avons pas dit

neyo 14.3*

nynä -mä -a 'gʊ nyima
that we would destroy it,
que nous voulions le détruire,

neyo 14.4*

-mä -a 'gʊ anyıa 'cifio yëkʊ fä.
rather, we are going to send it to your chief.
nous allons plutôt l'envoyer auprès votre chef.

neyo 15.1

-Mä -a gä ci
Because if we say
Parce que si nous disons

neyo 15.2

nynä -mä ka fiɛ -anyıa 'nyiklëa 'kʊ nä,
that you are actually fishing in our part of the water,
que vous faites la pêche dans notre partie de l'eau,

neyo 15.3

a 'bäsı lä
your elders (will) say
vos aînés disent

neyo 15.4

wälıı -a ci lä nä
that what we are saying
que ce que nous disons

neyo 15.5

ɯ -wʊ -nʊawlɛ plöö-.
that is not the truth.”
ce n’est pas la vérité. »

neyo 16

-N ni wälɯ wa 'nii- lä 'kʊ nä.
Here is the issue that was between them.
Voilà le problème entre eux.

neyo 17.1*

Fädɯnyʊa -mä wa 'nɯ yɯ 'mö -nuu
Now as for the Fanti, they didn’t want to listen to reason anymore,
Or les Fanti, ils ne voulaient plus entendre raison,

neyo 17.2*

-mä 'yizlɛ wa -kʊ ylä.
rather, they were now angry.
mais ils se sont mis en colère maintenant.

neyo 18.1

Wa -kʊ 'yizlɛnɛ 'mö -aaa,
They stayed angry until
Ils étaient dans cette colère jusqu’à ce que

neyo 18.2

yiosä 'gbaa' -säsänöwa.
the matter turned into a conflict.
cela soit devenu un conflit.

neyo 19.1*

Dä Jübëyua 'ylɯbhä ylä waa gɔlʊʊ nä,
When the Neyo were turning round their canoe,
Lorsque les Neyo étaient maintenant en train de faire demi-tour avec leur pirogue,

neyo 19.2*

kʊ bhuo-.
it turned over.
elle s’est renversée.

neyo 20.1

Waa gɔlʊʊ bhuo- ylä nä,
When their canoe had now turned over,
Lorsque leur pirogue s’était maintenant renversée,

neyo 20.2

wlä Fädɯnyʊa lä,
it is reported that the Fanti said,
les Fanti auraient dit:

neyo 20.3

'Nı -a yä 'anyı 'ni.
“So now (lit. and) we have got (lit. found) you.”
« Alors maintenant (litt. et) nous vous avons attrapés (lit. trouvés). »

neyo 21.1

Nyëblu -bhlo, ɔ 'tlänyı
One of the young men, he was trying
L’un des jeunes hommes, il essayait

neyo 21.2

-yä ɔ 'kä 'kʊ bha
to come up to the surface,
de remonter à la surface,

neyo 21.3

'nı Fädıyu -bhlo yio waa blı 'kädıı ıı lʊʊ -bhlo 'wlu 'wlää
then a Fanti hit him on his head with one of the big oar blades
alors un Fanti l’a frappé sur la tête avec un des grandes rames

neyo 21.4

'nı ɔ yi 'kʊ mnɔ.
and he sank under the water.
et il a disparu sous l’eau.

neyo 22.1

ı -nʊ 'tänyı
After a while
Cela a fait un temps

neyo 22.2

'nı ɔ -ghlä bʊkʊ 'kʊ
he reappeared
puis il a resurgi de l’eau

neyo 22.3

'nı wa yi o bʊkʊ -blʊʊ 'wlu 'wlää.
then they again hit him on his head with the oar blade.
alors ils l‘ont de nouveau frappé sur la tête avec la rame.

neyo 23.1

Dä wa -wlänöɔ ylä bʊkʊ -blʊʊ 'wlu nä,
When they had now again hit him on his head with the oar blade,
Lorsqu’ils l’avaient maintenant de nouveau frappé sur la tête avec la rame,

neyo 23.2

kɔ kuu- yı
he then died
il est mort maintenant,

neyo 23.3

'nɪ ɔ yi sä slɔɔ.
and he went under.
puis il a coulé.

neyo 24.1*

-Lɔɔ 'sɔnä lɔɔ -mä, dä ɔ nii- lä nʊnʊgbɪnɪ 'yi nä,
That second one, when he saw what was going on,
Quant au deuxième, lorsqu'il a vu ce qui se passait,

neyo 24.2*

kɔ 'fike
he really acted smartly,
il a bien réagi,

neyo 24.3*

-mä 'nɪ ɔ mɛɛ- gɔlʊʊ -zɔɔ.
because he then dived under the canoe.
Car il a alors plongé sous la pirogue.

neyo 25.1

Fädɪnyʊa wa tänöɔ yɪ -aaa
The Fanti were now looking for him until
Les Fanti le cherchaient alors jusqu'à ce

neyo 25.2

'nɪ wa -sɪä.
they got tired of it.
qu'ils en soient las.

neyo 26.1

Waa' 'nio yɪɔ lä nä,
As they didn't see him anymore,
Comme ils ne l'ont plus vu,

neyo 26.2

kwa -sä gwë
they drew back.
ils ont reculé.

neyo 27.1

Ɔmɔ -mä 'sɪɪ kɔ pa 'nyisɪ
Now as for him, he was really swimming hard
Or lui aussi, il nageait vraiment

neyo 27.2

'nɪ ɔ yi 'yikʊ mö.
and he advanced.
et il est allé devant.

neyo 28.1*

Fädɪnyʊa, wlä wa wlo klë nä,
The Fanti, it is said as they were looking behind
Les Fanti, on dit quand ils ont regardé en arrière,

neyo 28.2*

ɔ yä kpänyɪ 'yikʊ mö.
he has advanced a lot.
il avait bien avancé.

neyo 29.1

Waa -gwɛɛ wa -kä lä
The fish-hook that they had
Leur hameçon qu'ils avaient

neyo 29.2

'nɪ wa fɪä lä zlüü 'mö nä,
and with which they catch the fish,
et avec lequel ils attrapent les poissons,

neyo 29.3

wa bhlüe- 'kʊ
they took it
ils l'ont pris

neyo 29.4

'nɪ wa yie 'pä
and they threw it
et ils l'ont lancé

neyo 29.5

'nɪ ɛ yio kpɔ.
and it caught him.
et il s'est accroché à lui.

neyo 30.1

Dä wa jlie ylä nä,
As they were now pulling it,
Quand ils l'ont tiré maintenant,

neyo 30.2*

'nɪ ɔ yie 'yi 'kpɔtɔ.
he tore it out.
alors il l'a arraché.

neyo 31.1*

Nyëblüo 'tlänyɪ- -aaa
The young man succceeded (lit. tried until)
Le jeune homme a réussi (litt. il a essayé jusqu'à ce que)

neyo 31.2*

'nɪ ɔ yi 'nyügbë 'kʊ ŋë
in reaching the beach.
à regagner le bord de l'eau.

neyo 32.1

Ɔɔ -lɔ -ɔ zäpʊ ylä nä
As he was now bleeding
Comme il saignait maintenant,

neyo 32.2*

ɔɔ -wʊ -bʊä
he wasn't slow to act
il n'a pas tardé,

neyo 32.3*

-mä kɔ -mö komisäliaa'
but he went to the police station
mais il est allé au commissariat de police

neyo 32.4*

'nɪ ɔ yi 'sʊjaa soo
and told the police
et il a dit aux policiers

neyo 32.5

sä ɪ plöö- lä -mɔɔ jiee' 'kʊ nä
how things had happened out there on the ocean.
comment cela s'est passé là-bas sur la mer.

neyo 33.1*

Wlä 'ylʊbä kä cii-
It is reported that when New Year is going to (lit. says it will)
On dit que lorsque la Nouvelle Année va (litt. dit qu'elle va)

neyo 33.2*

a 'kä yi nä
come up,
venir,

neyo 33.3*

kä Fädönyʊa bhlä nyɪkpɔ
the Fanti kill someone
les Fanti tuent quelqu'un

neyo 33.4*

'nɪ wa bʊbɔ jiee
and they make a sacrifice to the ocean.
et ils font un sacrifice à la mer.

neyo 33.5*

Nä Jübua kä jie 'klʊ -mö nä,
So when Neyo people go out on the ocean,
Alors quand les Néyo partent sur mer,

neyo 33.6*

kä wa too -mɔɔ.
they don't come back (lit. stay there).
ils sont perdus (litt. ils restent là-bas).

neyo 34.1

Wamä Jübëyua 'sɔ, Fädönyʊa kwa bhä bhlää- nä
These two young Neyo, if the Fanti had killed them (both),
Ces deux jeunes Néyo, si les Fanti les avaient tués (tous les deux),

neyo 34.2

nyɪkpɔɔ' -lä bhɔɔ duu' 'dö -lä
no one would have sent news to the village.
personne n'aurait envoyé des nouvelles au village.

neyo 35.1

'Tänyɪ 'fɪn waa nyɪkpɔ too lä jiee' nä
Each time that one of theirs stays on the ocean
Chaque fois que quelqu'un des leurs reste en mer,

neyo 35.2

sɔɔ wa lä 'sʊjaa 'dö
they inform (lit. send news to) the police,
ils informent les policiers (litt. envoient des nouvelles aux policiers),

neyo 35.3

-mä kä wa pʊwa wälɪ 'yi.
they really appeal to them.
ils font vraiment appel à eux.

neyo 35.4

Wlä 'sʊjaa lä
It is reported that the police say
On dit que les policiers disent

neyo 35.5

wa yʊwa 'kʊ sɪä
that they (=the Neyo) annoy them (=the police),
qu'ils (= les Néyo) les embêtent,

neyo 35.6

-mä ylɪ 'fɪn 'kʊ waa nyɪkpa too.
because their people are lost all the time.
parce que tous les jours leurs gens sont perdus.

neyo 36.1

-N ni wälıı -ı 'gä lä tʊʊ -lä nä
Here is the issue that will bring war,
Voilà l'affaire qui va amener la guerre,

neyo 36.2

ımı -ı -kʊ lä -länömö
that is what is the matter here.
c'est cela qui est là.

neyo 37.1*

Jübënyëbluoo- -bha lä -lɔɔ nëë' nä
The Neyo lad who had escaped,
Le jeune homme néyo qui a échappé,

neyo 37.2*

kɔ -mö ɔ 'bäsı soo -kä
he went to tell his elders,
il est allé parler à ses aînés,

neyo 37.3*

-mä wa 'nı ı -wʊ -nʊawlɛ laa-.
but they did not believe it. (lit. they did not call it truth)
mais ils ne l'ont pas cru. (litt. ils ne l'ont pas appelé vérité)

neyo 38.1

Gbʊgblɛɛ 'mö ɔ bhlüü- lä -dɔnʊ 'kʊ nä
In his anger he took a matchette,
Dans la colère, il a pris une machette,

neyo 38.2

kɔ blüë- Fädıny waa lo.
he actually passed through the compounds of the Fanti.
il est vraiment passé entre les lots des Fanti.

neyo 39.1

Ɔ -mö lä nä,
When he went,
Quand il est allé,

neyo 39.2

waa -lıı, ımı ɔ nyima ylä.
their possessions, that is what he now destroyed.
leurs biens, c'est eux qu'il détruisait maintenant.

neyo 39.3

Wlä -nänʊä lä,
Some are said to have said,
Certains auraient dit:

neyo 39.4

Plɛɛ- bhlä nyɪkpɔɔ -a?
“Is the man crazy?”
« Est-ce que l’homme est fou? »

neyo 40.1

-Nänʊä lä,
Others said,
D’autres disaient:

neyo 40.2

Plɛɛ' 'bhlɔ -wʊ,
“He isn’t crazy,
« Il n’est pas fou,

neyo 40.3

-mä -a -yio.
but we know him.”
mais nous le connaissons. »

neyo 41.1

Wlä, -Mɔɔ klëë' 'ylʊbaa -a plöö- lä nä,
They said, “Last year,
Ils ont dit: « L’année passée,

neyo 41.2

ɔ -yi a -abhlɪ Kagbë nyɪkpa zɛɛ -kää nä,
as he came to count the people in our Kagbo region,
comme il est venu compter les gens de notre canton de Kagbeu,

neyo 41.3

nyɪkpa -bhutukpä -yio -mɔɔ Kagbë.
many people know him there in the Kagbo region.”
beaucoup de gens le connaissent là-bas dans le canton de Kagbeu. »

neyo 42.1

Nä ɔmɔ nyëblunɔ nä, dä ɔ nyima ylä Fandɪnyʊa' -lɪɪ nä,
So then, that young man, when he had destroyed the possessions of the Fanti
Donc, lui, ce jeune homme, quand il avait détruit les biens des Fanti,

neyo 42.2

kwa -ŋënöɔ 'gba.
they accused him.
ils l’ont accusé.

neyo 43.1

Ɔ guu-
He became afraid
Il a pris peur

neyo 43.2

'nɪ ɔ yi -bidikii' plä.
and he enterd into a shop.
et il est entré dans une boutique.

neyo 43.3

Ɔ -plä ylä -bidikie' nä,
When he had now entered the shop,
Quand il était entré dans la boutique maintenant,

neyo 43.4

kɛɛ käänyɔ gbaa- ɛɛ kpluu
its owner locked the door.
son propriétaire a fermé la porte.

neyo 44.1

'Kɛsɛnɛ ɛmɛ wa sä ylä.
Then there was a big tumult.
Alors il y avait un grand tumulte.

neyo 44.2

Dä nyëbluo wlʊʊ- ylä -zɔɔ nä,
When the young man now went outside,
Lorsque le jeune homme est maintenant sorti

neyo 44.3*

kɔ -mö
he went
il est parti

neyo 44.4*

'nɪ ɔ -soo ɔ 'bäsɪ
and he spoke to his elders.
parler à ses aînés.

neyo 45.1*

Wamä -mä waa' -wʊ -bʊä,
Now as for them, they didn't waste any time (lit. they were not slow),
Quant à eux, ils n'ont pas tardé,

neyo 45.2*

kwa bhlüü- tëvëlɪı 'kʊ
they actually took weapons
ils ont pris des armes

neyo 45.3

'nɪ wa -mö Fädɪnyʊa tʊ 'kʊ
and went to fight against the Fanti.
et ils sont allés combattre les Fanti.

neyo 46.1

Nyëbluo, Blojee' nyëblu lä

The young man, he is from Blodje.

Le jeune homme, c'est un jeune de Blodjé.

neyo 46.2

Bloje -glö 'duu -ʊ -kʊ lä 'nyıma -yä jie 'sɔ pää nä

Blodje is the village that is between the lagoon and the ocean.

Blodjé est le village qui est entre la lagune et la mer.

neyo 47

Wamä Blojee' nyıkpaa nä, kwa -kʊ kpänyı Gbɔglɛɛ'

Those people from Blodje, many of them live in Sassandra.

Ces gens de Blodje, beaucoup d'entre eux habitent à Sassandra.

neyo 48.1

-N gä Gbɔglɛɛ' liseedä -yi nä

When you come from the highschool in Sassandra,

Quand tu viens du lycée de Sassandra,

neyo 48.2

ɛ -yä Katoliköbhutuu -yä UEESO -bhutuu 'sɔɔ' 'sɔkʊgbaa 'mnö, -mɔɔ Fädıny ʊa slää- lä waa 'du 'kädʊ.

in the ravine between the Catholic house and the house of the l'UESSO, it is there that the Fanti have built a big village.

dans le ravin entre la maison catholique et la maison UESSO, c'est là que les Fanti ont construit leur grand village.

neyo 48.3

'Dunʊ 'mö Jübua -mö

It is in that village that the Neyo went

C'est dans ce village que les Néyo sont allés

neyo 48.4

'nı wa döö- lä 'yi

and they set it on fire.

et ils y ont mis le feu.

neyo 49.1

-Lɔɔ 'tänyıɛɛ' nä, ı plöö- bhä 'cʊʊ ylıı glʊ -yä -mɔɔnä.

By that time, it was the twenty-fourth of the month.

A ce moment-là, c'était le vingt-quatre du mois.

neyo 49.2

Zëlü 'kä ze

Morning would came

Il allait faire jour

neyo 49.3

-yä -a 'gä Nʊwɛlɪ 'ni

and we would celebrate Christmas.

et nous allions voir la fête de Noël.

neyo 50.1

'Saboo' 'cɔcɪɛ -ɛ 'gä lä nʊɔ nä

The night mass that would take place,

La messe de nuit qui allait avoir lieu,

neyo 50.2

ɛɛ za 'ŋwnɪä -yi Katolikökɔcɪgbëa 'mnö göglä -kä.

it was because of that that women had come to the Catholic compound to make preparations.

c'est à cause d'elle que des femmes étaient venues préparer la cour de l'église catholique.

neyo 51*

Pɛlɪɔ -mä, ɔ -kʊ bhä 'sɪɪ -lɔɔ.

Now the priest, he was also there.

Quant au curé, il était aussi là.

neyo 52*

Ɔmɔ Pɛlɪɔ nä, ɔ -glö Guduyu.

That priest, he is a member of the Gudu clan (lit. a Gudu child).

Ce prêtre-là, il fait partie du clan des Gudu (litt. un enfant gudu).

neyo 53.1*

Nä dä 'ŋwnɪa nii- lä gboyloo 'yi nä

So, when the women saw the smoke,

Donc, quand les femmes ont vu la fumée,

neyo 53.2*

kä waa nëëdëë' lɔɔ -bhlo -mö ɔ soo -kä

one from among them went to tell him

une d'entre elles est allée lui parler

neyo 53.3*

nynä, Mɔ Pɛlɪ, Fädönyʊaa' 'duu 'mnö gboylo bha -mɔɔ nä

saying, "My Father, from the village of the Fanti there is smoke coming,

en disant: « Mon Père, du sein du village des Fanti il y a de la fumée qui monte,

neyo 53.4

-aa yibhë- -wʊ wälɪɪ

we don't know what the problem is."

nous ne savons pas quel est le problème. »

neyo 54.1

Pɛlɪɔ -mä 'sɪɪ, kɔ -bha ɔɔ lebhee yëku

The priest, too, he left his work

Le curé aussi, il a quitté son travail

neyo 54.2

'nɪ ɔ -yä 'ŋwnɪa 'sɔ -mö -mɔɔ 'duu 'mnö
and he and the women went over there into the village.
et lui et les femmes sont allés là-bas dans le village.

neyo 55.1

Ghladioo 'mö sä Pɛlɪɔ cii- lä nä
On the radio, what the priest said,
A la radio, comme le curé a parlé,

neyo 55.2

sɔɔ n ci klä aa!
that's exactly what I am saying.
c'est ainsi que je parle exactement.

neyo 56.1

Wlä Pɛlɪɔ lä,
The priest said that
Le curé a dit que

neyo 56.2

dä ɔ nii- lä 'duu {-ʊ si lä nä } 'yi nä
when he saw the burning village
lorsqu'il a vu le village qui brûlait,

neyo 56.3

kä ŋäzö -plɔ
he felt sad
il a eu pitié

neyo 56.4

'nɪ ɔ tuu-
and he wept.
et il a pleuré.

neyo 57.1

Ɔ lä,
He said
Il a dit

neyo 57.2

ɔ -mö Jübua yëku
that he went to the Neyo
qu'il est allé auprès des Néyo

neyo 57.3

-yä ɔ 'kwa bhibhie
in order to beg them
pour les supplier

neyo 57.4

nynä wa -taa wälıı 'yi.
to drop the matter.
qu'ils laissent tomber l'affaire.

neyo 58.1

-Mä 'fıa ɔ 'kwa lä bhibhie nä
But before he could beg them,
Or avant qu'il puisse les supplier,

neyo 58.2

wa yɔ bhɛzä soo
they had already spoken to him
ils lui avaient déjà parlé

neyo 58.3

nynä Jübuaa' wälı mɛɛ-
saying that the Neyo were right,
en disant les Néyo avaient raison,

neyo 59.1

-ɔnözä ɔ -mʊwa bhä bhibhie -kä?
why was he coming to beg them (to let go)?
pourquoi il était venu les supplier.

neyo 60.1

Ɔ lä -mä
He said that
Il a dit que

neyo 60.2

sä ɔ plöö- -Laagɔwälıcinyɔ
since he was the preacher
comme il était le prédicateur

neyo 60.3

'nı ɔ plöö- 'sıı waa mɛnönyɔ nä.
and he was also their ally.
et qu'il était aussi leur allié.

neyo 61.1

Mɛnönyɔ kä ɔ lümɛnönyɔ bhibhie- nä,
If an ally begs his fellow ally,
Si un allié supplie son autre allié,

neyo 61.2

ɔɔ' cɛɛ -wʊ.
he doesn't refuse.
il (=ce dernier) ne refuse pas.

neyo 62.1

Nä wälıklönö 'sɔɔ -zä ɔ -mö
So it was for those two reasons that he had gone
Donc c'est à cause de ces deux raisons qu'il était parti

neyo 62.2

-yä ɔ 'kwa lä bhibhie.
to beg them.
pour les supplier.

neyo 62.3

-Mä Jübuaa' -wʊ 'kʊ ŋoo-
But the Neyo hadn't accepted.
Mais les Néyo n'ont pas accepté.

neyo 63.1

ɩ -kamänöɔ yëkuu'
That had been very hard on him
Cela lui avait fait mal

neyo 63.2*

'nı ɔ tuu-
and he had cried.
et il avait pleuré.

neyo 64.1*

Pɛlıɔ lä
The priest said
Le curé a dit

neyo 64.2*

ɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ -aaa cie zëplü 'gliyi -pɛnää' 'kʊ -yä mö -kügbëgliyi 'sɔ 'nı 'klë 'kʊ.
he was around a long time, from nine in the morning until twelve thirty.
qu'il était resté là longtemps, de 9 h du matin jusqu'à midi et demi.

neyo 64.3 *

-Lɔɔ 'ylʊʊ 'kʊ ɔɔ -wʊ dëdü -lü.
That day he hadn't eaten lunch.
Ce jour-là, il n'avait pas mangé de repas de midi.

neyo 65.1

Ɔ -wloo nʊnʊgbıı,
He had watched what was happening,
Il avait regardé ce qui se passait,

neyo 65.2

ɔ -bhibhie- nyikpaa
he had begged the people
il avait supplié les gens,

neyo 65.3

-mä waaʻ ŋoo -wʊ.
but they had not accepted.
mais ils n'avaient pas accepté.

neyo 66.1

-N -yi sɔɔ
Do you know
Sais-tu

neyo 66.2

nynä Gananyʊa kwa mö 'cɔcɪ' -a?
that the Ghanaians, they go to church?
que les Ghanéens, ils vont à l'église?

neyo 67.3

Nyɪkpaa nii- lä Pɛlɪɔ 'yi nä
When the people saw the priest,
Quand les gens ont vu le curé,

neyo 67.4

kwa -yio yëku
they came up to him
ils sont venus auprès de lui

neyo 67.5

'nɪ ɔ -yʊwa 'sɔ yi -mɔɔ 'cɔcɪgbëë' mö.
and he and they went to the church compound together.
et lui et eux sont allés là-bas dans la cour de l'église.

neyo 68.1

Ɔ -soo 'cocinyʊa
He told the people of the church
Il a dit aux gens de l'église

neyo 68.2

nynä wa -tää Fädönyʊa tʊʊ tlü lä nä 'yi
to let the Fanti that the war is chasing away
qu'ils laissent les Fanti que la guerre chasse

neyo 68.3

-yä wa plä -mɔɔ 'cocigbëë'
enter there into the church compound.
pour qu'ils entrent là-bas dans la cour de l'église.

neyo 69.1

Ɔ lä,
He said that
Il a dit que

neyo 69.2

nykpaa ɔ -yʊwa 'sɔ -plä lä dä -bhlogbe -mɔɔ nä
the people who entered the place together with him
les personnes qui y sont entrés avec lui,

neyo 69.3

wa -bhlü nyɪkpaa' gwlɪ -ngboplo 'nɪ nyɪkpa -ngbɔɔsɔ
they numbered one hundred and twenty-seven people.
ils étaient cent vingt-sept personnes.

neyo 70.1

Cie -lɔɔ' ylʊʊ 'kʊ -yä ŋëë zavie ɛɛ ylɪɪ 'sɔ 'kʊ.
From that day until the second of January
De ce jour-là jusqu'au deux janvier,

neyo 70.2

wlä Pɛlɪɔ lä,
it is reported that the priest said that
le curé aurait dit que

neyo 70.3

nyɪkpaa' gwlɪ -ngbü -ngbü ɪɪ 'ci 'kʊgbä ta(a) a- -plɔɔ lä 'kʊ.
thirteen hundred people had found refuge with him.
c'étaient mille trois cents personnes qui étaient hébergés chez lui.

neyo 71.1*

Minislöɔ wa laa lä Bonbe nä,
The minister called Bombet,
Le ministre nommé Bombet,

neyo 71.2*

ɔ -yi -mɔɔ
he came there
il est venu là-bas

neyo 71.3*

'nɪ Ganaa' abasadɛlɪɔ -yi 'sɪɪ.
and the ambassador of Ghana came, too.
et l'ambassadeur du Ghana est venu aussi.

neyo 71.4

Kä abasadɛlɪɔ -sa ɔ bhelia 'gë
The ambassador actually said to his brothers that they were wrong.
L'ambassadeur a vraiment donné tort à ses frères,

neyo 72.1

ɔ lä
he said
il a dit

neyo 72.2

Kodivalöö' nyıkpɔɔ' -lä Gana mö
that someone from Côte d'Ivoire would not go to Ghana
qu'une personne de Côte d'Ivoire n'irait pas au Ghana

neyo 72.3

'nı ɔ 'kä sää wälı nʊ
and do something like that
et faire une chose pareille

neyo 72.4

'nı Ganayu 'kä -plıı kʊ.
and the Ghanaian would stay quiet.
et le Ghanéen resterait tranquille.

neyo 72.5

Nä kä Jübuaa' wälı mɛɛ-
Therefore the Neyo were right.
Donc les Néyo avaient vraiment raison.

neyo 73.1

-Mä 'fıa -yä ɔ 'kä lä yi nä
But before coming
Or avant de venir,

neyo 73.2

ɔ -soo Ganabhlıɛɛ' käänyɔ wälını.
he had talked to the President of Ghana about this matter.
il avait parlé au président du Ghana de cette affaire.

neyo 74.1

Kä waa 'bhlıɛ ɛ 'bä -sonöɔ
The father of their country had actually told him
Le père de leur pays lui avait dit

neyo 74.2

nynä ɔ fä -mɔɔ tomobüü
that he would send busses there
qu'il enverrait des cars là-bas

neyo 74.3

-yä ı 'kwa Gana fä.
and they would take them to Ghana.
pour les amener au Ghana.

neyo 75.1

-A ci lä -pɛpɛɛ' nä
We said a little while ago
Nous avons dit tout à l'heure

neyo 75.2

wlä tomobüü -kʊ -mɔɔ Gbɔglɛɛ'
that there would be busses there in Sassandra
qu'il y aurait des cars là-bas à Sassandra

neyo 75.3

ı gwliwa.
for their transport.
pour les transporter.

neyo 76.1

Nʊnʊgbını 'fıın 'mnö nä, wlä Fädınyʊa bhlää- Jübëyu -bhlo
In all these happenings, the Fanti killed one Neyo
Dans tous ces événements, les Fanti ont tué un Néyo,

neyo 76.2

'nı Jübua bhlää- Fädınyʊä -ngboplo
but (lit. and) the Neyo killed six Fanti.
mais (litt. et) les Néyo ont tué six Fanti.

neyo 77

-N ni wälı -ı plöö- lä -mɔɔ Gbɔglɛɛ' 'kʊ nä.
That's what happened there in Sassandra.
Voilà l'affaire qui s'est passée là-bas à Sassandra.

neyo 78.1.

Wa ŋʊʊ- 'dö
People discuss
On discute

neyo 78.2

'nı wa cii-
and they say
et on dit

neyo 78.3

nynä Fädınyʊa -yä Jübua 'sɔ -tɛɛ -vë lä
that the Fanti and the Neyo fought with each other once before,
que les Fanti et les Néyo se sont combattus auparavant,

neyo 78.4

-mä -mɔɔ lowiaa' -wʊ tʊʊ 'mö -plämö
but their country did not get involved into the conflict.
mais l'étranger ne s'est impliqué dans le conflit.

neyo 79.1

N -yi sɔɔ
I know
Je sais

neyo 79.2

nynä ghladio tlevizıɔ cii-
that television said so,
que la radiotélévision l'a dit,

neyo 79.3

-mä -amö 'titi bha ylä -mɔɔ nä,
but as I am coming back from there myself,
mais comme je viens de là-bas moi-même,

neyo 79.4

ı -ŋwa 'kʊ
it was necessary
il fallait

neyo 79.5*

nynä n sonö-ö (*sg.*),
that I talk to you
que je te parle,

neyo 79.6*

-yä -n 'gä sɔɔ yibhë
so that you know about it.
pour que tu le saches.

neyo 80

-Lɔɔ n bhloo-
Here I end (my report).
C'est ici que je m'arrête.

15. Radio

Genre: Radio news bulletin / Bulletin de nouvelles à la radio
Content: Information about decisions from the last Council of Ministers / *Contenu*: Communication de décisions par le dernier Conseil des Ministres
Speaker/Locuteur: E (40, female)
Date: 17-02-1995

radio 001

-A 'bäsı -yä -a -nɔɔsınyı, bhɛŋwnıä -yä bhelienyı, aa' -lefıın- -poo lä 'nyukwli nä,
Our fathers and our mothers, sisters and brothers, you all who listen,
Nos pères et nos mères, sœurs et frères, vous tous qui écoutez,

radio 002

Yubhu Nyadlo Gäwänɔ lä aa' -kügbë namä-!
Yubu Nyadro Gawanon bids you good evening!
Youbou Gnadro Gawanon vous dit bon soir!

radio 003

-A -kʊ -zɪkä 'sɔlɪɪ' -ngbüylʊʊ 'kʊ,
We are today Friday,
On est aujourd'hui vendredi,

radio 004

lioo' sɔnacʊʊ ʊʊ' ylɪɪ 'kʊgbä -ngbɔɔsɔ lä -zɪkä.
the second month of the year, its seventeenth day is today.
c'est le dix-sept du deuxième mois aujourd'hui.

radio 005

-Ɔ -too yɪ -lɔɔ 'pɛpɛlɪä
It now remains a little
Il reste maintenant un peu

radio 006

-yä -kugbëgliyi -ngboplo 'kä yɪ klä.
and six o'clock in the evening will strike.
et six heures du soir sonnera.

radio 007

Nä ʊmʊ ylʊʊ 'mnö döö n 'kanyɪ lä -sää nä,
So the news of the day that I shall give you,
Donc les nouvelles du jour que je vais vous dire,

radio 008

ɪɪ' -lefɪɪn, yiosä bhelio Ali Kɔna Bedie -yä ɔɔ' 'govlänyɪkpaa 'sɔ -jlëa 'mnö, -mɔɔ ɪ bha lä.
they are almost all coming from our brother Henri Konan Bédié and his Cabinet council.
elles viennent presque toutes du frère Henri Konan Bédie et de son Conseil des ministres.

radio 009

-Pʊpɛdö lä.
It is good news (lit. news of joy).
Ce sont de bonnes nouvelles (litt. nouvelles de joie).

radio 010

Anyɪ 'titi a -yi sɔɔ -mä amä -jlëa nä,
You know yourselves that the Council (of ministers),
Vous-mêmes, vous savez que le Conseil (de ministres),

radio 011

'sɔlöö' -lefɪɪn 'mnö, 'ci -bhlogbe a kʊʊ lä sä,
every week, it meets once,
toutes les semaines il siège une fois.

radio 012

'nɪ -aa 'bhlɪɛ 'mnö lebhee' -lɛɛ -ɛ 'gä lä -mɔɔ nʊɔ-,
and the work that is going to be done in our country
et le travail qui va être fait dans notre pays

radio 013

ıyä wälıı' -lefıın -ı 'gä lä -mɔɔ sä ŋʊɔ nä,
and all the decisions that are going to be taken,
et toutes les décisions qui vont être prises

radio 014

'nı amä -jlëa 'mnö nyıkpaa 'ŋʊnı lä dä -bhlogbe.
it is in that meeting that people agree on that.
c'est dans cette assemblée que les gens s'entendent sur cela.

radio 015

Nä 'bhää- -mɔɔ klëë' 'sɔlıɛ 'kʊ,
So since last week
Donc depuis de la semaine dernière

radio 016

-yä -n ŋëë yı -lää 'sɔlınɛɛ',
until this week,
jusque la semaine d'aujourd'hui,

radio 017

'sɔlınɛ -a -kʊ lä -lää 'mʊ nä 'mʊ,
the week that we are in,
la semaine dans laquelle nous sommes,

radio 018

amä -jlëa 'mnö 'klüü -lıı -ı -ghlää lä -mɔɔ nä,
the topics that were treated in the Council,
les sujets qui ont été traités dans le Conseil,

radio 019*

a po yı 'nyukwli -yä n 'kanyımı yı soo.
listen now and I shall speak to you about them.
écoutez et je vais vous les dire maintenant.

radio 020

Tɛɛtɛɛklëa -a -ghlää lä -mɔɔ -jlëa 'mʊ nä,
The first topic that was dealt with there in the Council,
Le premier sujet qui a été traité dans le Conseil là-bas,

radio 021

wlä […]
it is reported that […]
on dit que […]

[…]

radio 041

'Sɔnaklëa -a -ghläa -mɔɔ -jlëa 'mʊ nä,
The second topic dealt with there in the Council,
Le deuxième sujet traité dans le Conseil là-bas,

radio 042

wlä […]
it is reported that […]
on dit que […]

[…]

radio 053

Taanaklëa -a -ghlää lä -mɔɔ -jlëa 'mö naa,
The third topic dealt with there in the Council,
Le troisième sujet traité dans le Conseil là-bas,

radio 054

wlä […]
it is reported that […]
on dit que […]

[…]

radio 081

-Mɔɔnänaklëa -a -ghlää lä -mɔɔ -jlëa 'mʊ nä,
The fourth topic dealt with there in the Council,
Le quatrième sujet traité dans le Conseil là-bas,

radio 082

wlä 'jekpinʊʊ wa la lä -biee nä,
it is reported that the beverage of the white people called beer
on dit que la boisson des Blancs qu'on appelle bière

radio 083

'nɪ -a mnä lä -mää -aa 'bhlɪnɛɛ' nä,
and that we drink here in our country,
et que nous buvons ici dans notre pays,

radio 084

wlä kä wa 'kä ylä ɛɛ' 'kpä 'kʊ -sää
it is reported that they will diminish its price,
on dit qu'on va diminuer son prix,

radio 085*

-mä ɛmɛ -biee nä, kpänyɪ ɛɛ' 'kpä 'tɛ yɪ -pɛɛ.
because, that same beer, its price is very high at present.
parce que cette bière, son prix est très élevé à présent.

radio 086

Nä ɛɛ' 'kpänä 'tɛ lä nä,
So, as its price is high,
Donc comme son prix est élevé,

radio 087

ı gbä 'nı nyıkpaa -bhutukpää' zɔmıɛ {zɔmʊɛ} yıɔ.
this is the reason why many people do not buy it anymore.
cela fait que beaucoup de personnes ne l'achètent plus.

radio 088

Nä wa 'kä yı ɛɛ' 'kpaa 'kʊ -sää
So they will diminsh its price,
On va donc diminuer son prix,

radio 089

-yä nyıkpa -bhutukpä 'kɛ yı bʊkʊ zɔɔ.
pour que beaucoup de personnes l'achètent encore.
so that many people will buy it again.

radio 090

-Mänı ɛmɛ -biee dä wa nʊnɛ {nʊnıɛ} lä nä,
Because that beer, the place where they produce it,
Car cette bière, l'endroit où on la fabrique

radio 091

nyıkpaa- nʊ lä 'sıı -mɔɔ lebhe.
there are people working there.
ce sont des gens qui y travaillent.

radio 092

-Aa, nä wa 'nıɛ lä zɔɔ
Well, so if people don’t buy it,
Eh bien alors, si donc on ne l'achète pas

radio 093

nä wamä -lɔɔ nyıkpaa kä waa' lebhe -ɛ nyimo lä 'sıı.
then those other people, their work is spoiled.
alors ces hommes-là, c'est leur travail qui se gâte aussi.

radio 094

Nä wa 'kä ɛɛ' 'kpaa 'kʊ -sää
So they will diminish its price,
On va donc diminuer son prix,

radio 095

-yä waa' lebhee 'kä 'sıı 'yikʊ mʊ.
so that their work can also go ahead.
pour que leur travail avance aussi.

radio 096

-Ngbüna -klëa a -ghlää lä -mɔɔ nä,
La cinquième nouvelle qui est venue de là-bas,

radio 097

wlä […]
it is reported that […]
on dit que […]

[…]

radio 110

'Kʋbhıädöklëaa- -ghlää lä -mɔɔ -jlëa 'mö nä,
La dernière nouvelle qui vient de l'assemblée,

radio 111

wlä […]
it is reported that […]
on dit que […]

[…]

radio 153

ɩmuˌ plöö- lä -jlëa 'mnö 'döö -lefɩn uˌ' bhloodä.
This is the end of all the news from the
C'est cela qui est la fin de toutes les nouvelles provenant de l'assemblée.

16. Siamoi

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: The death of Siamese twins / *Contenu*: La mort de jumelles siamoises
Speaker/Locuteur: C (75, male)
Date: 11-02-1994

siamoi 001

Siamwa.
Siamese twins.
Des Siamois.

siamoi 002

-Jlibɔ 'titi -mati!
A true riddle for you to hear!
Un vrai énigme pour votre écoute!

siamoi 003

(AUDIENCE /AUDITOIRE :) -Mati -a ylä.
We are asking to hear more (lit. it is 'mati' we are asking).
Nous demandons d'écouter plus! (litt. c'est 'mati' que nous demandons).

siamoi 003a

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE / ANIMATEUR :) A -kʊ -plɪ!
Taisez-vou!

siamoi 004

Wlaa, (sese) 'ylʊ -zɔ -a -kʊ lä naa, (sese)
They say that in this world where we are,
On dit que dans ce monde où nous sommes,

siamoi 005

nyɪkpa kä wa gää lä 'kɔɔkɔ. (sese)
human beings, they procreate offspring all the time.
les êtres humains, ils font toujours des enfants.

siamoi 006*

-N kä -gää, (sese)
If you have children (lit. if you procreate)
Quand tu fais des enfants

siamoi 007

'nɪ -n kä 'ŋlɪä 'sɔ -gää, (sese)
and if you get two girls
et que tu fais deux filles,

siamoi 008

'ŋlɪä taa -n gä -gää,
or if you get three of them,
ou si tu en fais trois,

siamoi 009

-n yi 'kʊgbä gää, (sese)
(even) you will get ten,
(même) tu en feras dix,

siamoi 010

-n gä ŋwadië -gää, (sese)
if you get boys,
si tu mets des garçons au monde,

siamoi 011*

'ŋlɔɔ 'mɔ wa 'kä lä wlie 'nyɛ, (sese)
it is the girl that they will marry off (lit. give a husband)
c'est la fille qu'on va donner en mariage,

siamoi 012*

ɪyä -n 'gä lä ŋwadio 'kʊ 'bhlü. (sese)
and you will keep (lit. take) the boy.
et on va garder (litt. prendre) le garçon.

siamoi 013*

Nyıkpɔ bhlogbe, ɔmɔ wa la lä 'Lulu.
There was a certain man called Lulu.
Il y'avait un certain homme nommé Lulu.

siamoi 014*

Ɔmɔ -ɔ -gää lä ɔ'ɔ ŋlʊgbɛnyʊä 'sɔ. (ɔmɔ -ɔ -gää lä ɔ'ɔ ŋlʊgbɛnyʊä 'sɔ).
He had two girls (lit. it was him who procreated his two girls)
Il a eu deux filles (litt. c'est lui qui a engendré ses deux filles).

siamoi 015*

-Mä ŋlʊgbɛnyʊä nä 'sɔ ɔ -gää lä naa, (sese)
Now these two girls that he had,
Or ces deux filles qu'il a eues,

siamoi 016*

kä wa 'mɛmɛ. (kä wa 'mɛmɛ)
they were stuck to each other.
elles étaient collées l'une à l'autre.

siamoi 017

Wa'a -yɛ nëa 'kʊ 'wlää, (wa'a -yɛ nëa 'kʊ 'wlää)
They don't have the mouth in common
Elles n'ont pas la bouche en commun,

siamoi 018

wa'a -yɛ sıı 'kʊ 'wlää. (wa'a -yɛ sıı 'kʊ 'wlää)
they don't have the arms in common.
elles n'ont pas les bras en commun.

siamoi 019

Wa 'wlää- bhıı 'kʊ, (wa 'wlää- bhıı 'kʊ)
They have the legs in common,
Elles ont les jambes en commun,

siamoi 020

'nı wa 'wlää 'gʊʊ 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
and they have the stomach in common.
et elles ont le ventre en commun.

siamoi 021

'Yuë nä 'sɔ ɔ -gänʊwa ylä naa, (sese)
These two children, when he had now got them,
Ces deux enfants là, quand il les a mis au monde,

siamoi 022

ɔ 'nʊwa yıɔ 'wlie nyɛɛ. (ɔ 'nʊwa yıɔ 'wlie nyɛɛ)
he did not marry them off anymore.
il ne les a plus donnés en mariage.

siamoi 023

Wa -kʊ yɪ sä -kaaa, (sese)
They now stayed (in the family) a long time,
Elles restaient maintenant longtemps (en famille) ;

siamoi 024

-mɔˈɔ ˈsɔna -nɔnɔ, (sese)
then the second one of them,
alors celle la deuxième d'entre elles,

siamoi 025

ˈnɪ ɔ yi ˈku. ('nɪ ɔ yi 'ku)
it so happened that she died.
elle vient à décéder.

siamoi 026*

Nɔnɔ -yä, (nɔnɔ -yä) ˈnɪ -nɔnɔ kuu. ('nɪ -nɔnɔ kuu)
One *and one died.*
L'une est vivante *et l'autre est morte.*

siamoi 027*

Ɔ ˈbä -yä ɔ ˈnɔ ˈsɔ, (sese)
Her father and her mother,
Son père et sa mère,

siamoi 028*

dunyʊa {-ya},
together with the village people,

siamoi 029*

wa tu yɪ. (sese)
they now wept.
ils ont pleuré maintenant.

siamoi 030

ˈNɪ sä -a ˈgwa bhä nʊˈʊ? (sese)
"What shall we do with them?"
« Comment allons-nous faire avec elles? »

siamoi 031

-A, ˈnɪ kä -mä waˈa -lä -kä -bakä ˈkʊbhlü,
Well, they can surely not take a knife
Eh bien, on ne peut quand même pas prendre un couteau

siamoi 032

ˈnɪ wa ˈkwa ˈmʊ ˈŋätö ˈgblan! (sese)
and cut them apart!
and pour les fendre!

siamoi 033

Wa 'kwa 'mʊ 'ŋätö,
If they cut them apart,
Si on les fend,

siamoi 034

-mä'ä -nɔnɔ -ɔ -yä lä nä,
the one that is alive,
celle qui est vivante

siamoi 035

ɔ'ɔ -lä {'sɪɪ} 'ku -mʊ -a? (ɔ yi 'ku)
will she not also die? *she will die*
ne va-t-elle pas mourir aussi? *elle mourra*

siamoi 036

Sä ɪ 'kä yɪ -kʊ nä,
How ever it will be decided,
Quoiqui sera décidé,

siamoi 037

ɪmɪ -kʊ ylä -lɔɔ. (-aa')
it will be followed.
on s'y tiendra.

siamoi 038

'Nɪ wa yi -mɔɔ wamä 'sɔ 'ŋʊ. (sese)
Then they put both of them there (in the tomb).
Alors ils y (= dans la tombe) ont mis les deux.

siamoi 039

-Ɔ -yä ylä naa, (-ɔ -yä ylä naa)
The one who was alive,
Celle qui est vivante,

siamoi 040

ɔ lä, 'Nyɪä, ('nyɪä)
she said, "Mother,
elle dit: « Mère,

siamoi 041*

'kɔɔn, ('kɔɔn) -n nylipë lesie 'kʊ, (-kpazebhleku)
always *sweep the tomb on top*
toujours *balaies sur la tombe*

siamoi 042*

ɪyä 'ŋʊ -lɔɔ 'tɪtɔ, (-kpazebhleku)
and put ashes there,
et mets-y de la cendre,

siamoi 043*

ɪyä 'ŋʊ -lɔɔ -bhʊbhlä,
and put there bubla leaves (=leaves used in the worship ritual for the spirits of the deceased),
mets-y du boubhleu (=feuilles à caractère rituel servant à l'adoration des esprits de mort),

siamoi 044*

-ya wätɪä! (-kpazebhleku)
and wateea leaves! (another kind of leaves used for the same purposes).
du watéa (une autre espèce de feuilles pour les mêmes cérémonies).

siamoi 045*

-N pi -läbʊ (-kpazebhleku)
Cook mashed banana
Prépare de la purée de banane (plantain)

siamoi 046*

ɪyä -n 'ŋʊ -lɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
and put it there.
et dépose-la!

siamoi 047

'Ylʊ 'kʊ -n gä ylä bʊkʊ -yi, (-kpazebhleku)
On the day that you will come back
Le jour où tu reviendras

siamoi 048

nylipë -kä -yi, (-kpazebhleku)
for sweeping
pour balayer,

siamoi 049

'nɪ -n gä ylä 'nyikpo -zälʊ 'yi nii nä, (sese)
and you see black ants
et que tu vois des fourmis magnans,

siamoi 050

yibhë sɔɔ -mä -amʊ 'titi yä yi. (sese)
know that it is me who has come."
sache que c'est moi même qui suis venue. »

siamoi 051

Ɔ 'nɔ lä, -Aa. (sese)
Her mother said, "Okay."
Sa maman dit : « D'accord. »

siamoi 052*

'Kɔɔkɔ sɔɔ ɔ nʊ ylä. (sese)
All the time, that's how she now acted.
Tout le temps, c'est ainsi qu'elle fait maintenant.

siamoi 053*

ˈŋlɔɔ -mʊ ylä -zɪkä nä, (sese)
When the woman now went one day,
Quand la femme est maintenant allée un jour,

siamoi 054*

ˈnyikpo -tütë yä ˈkʊ ghlä. (sese)
a swarm of black ants appear (lit. have appeared).
une légion de magnans apparaît (litt. est apparu).

siamoi 055

Sä wa bhlɪ bhä -lɔɔ’ ˈlʊ ˈyɪ ˈna?
How does that song go again?
Comment est-ce qu'on chante ce chant encore?

siamoi 055

(AUDIENCE REPRESENTATIVE / ANIMATEUR :) N ˈnʊ (bhɔɔ) -yi o!
I don’t know it!
Je ne le connais pas!

siamoi 056

SONG (narrator begins to sing and audience joins in)
CHANT (le narrateur commence à chanter et l’auditoire répond)

siamoi 057

N naa (-kpazebhleku)
I say
Je dis

siamoi 058

(ˈnzä) {ɪˈɪ -zä} wa gä ylä poyua a! [wa gä ylä poyua a]
that is why people (lit. they) now get twins!
c'est pourquoi les gens font des jumeaux maintenant!

siamoi 060

ˈnɪ -nɔnɔ -kʊ ylä ɔˈɔ dä, ˈnɪ -nɔnɔ -kʊ ylä ɔˈɔ dä. (sese)
and one is now separated from the other (lit. is now in its place).
et désormais l'un se trouve séparé de l'autre (litt. est désormais à sa place).

siamoi 061

-Kaflɪnyɪɛ! -Mä -nɔnɔ ɔmɔ ɔ kä -mʊ nä, (sese)
Excuse me! But then, if one dies,
Ne vous en déplaise! Mais si l'un meurt,

siamoi 062

-nɔnɔ yi lä too. (-aa’)
the other will stay (alive).
l'autre restera (en vie).

siamoi 063

N pä -kä 'na 'nünë o!
So I have told my story!
J'ai donc donné si mon conte!

siamoi 064

Lusyɛn (sese) -mɔ n pa lä 'wlu'u. (-aa')
Lucien, it is you I appoint to continue.
Lucien, c'est sur toi que je pose la tâche de continuer.

siamoi 065

Paseke a kä sä -kʊ,
Because if you are together
Parce que si vous êtes demeurez ensemble

siamoi 066

'nɪ a 'nö 'pɛpɛlɪä sää nʊ naa, (-kpazebhleku)
and you don't do that (=tell stories)
et que vous ne faites pas un tout petit peu comme ça (= raconter des contes),

siamoi 067

'nɪ a kä säpu -kä mʊ naa, (-kpazebhleku)
and you go to sleep,
et que vous allez vous coucher,

siamoi 068

-n 'kä wälɪ në'ë -sä naa, (-kpazebhleku)
if you want to say something,
quand tu veux dire quelque chose,

siamoi 069

-n 'ŋlɔ mɔ 'titi -n nöö bhɛlä -bhutu -zɔɔ naa, (-kpazebhleku)
your own wife that you have at home,
ta propre femme que tu as à la maison,

siamoi 070

-n yä ɔ'ɔ wälɪ në'ë pä. (-kpazebhleku)
you haven't got nice words for her.
tu lui parles mal.

siamoi 071

-Mɔɔ, ŋwadi -n plöö- ylä, (-kpazebhleku)
You, you are a man now,
Toi, tu es garçon,

siamoi 072

-naa nügloätäta -n 'gä ylä 'kʊ 'bhlü. (-kpazebhleku)
it is harsh words that you will now use (to impose yourself).
c'est à force de paroles menaçantes que tu t'imposeras.

siamoi 073*

-Mä a kä 'pɛpɛlıä -gäma,
But if you have a little fun,
Or si vous vous amusez un petit peu,

siamoi 074*

'nı a kä sä pu -kä -mʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and then you go to lie down,
et si vous allez vous coucher ensuite,

siamoi 075*

-n yä ŋɔɔ, (-kpazebhleku)
you sleep right away (lit. you have slept).
tu dors aussitôt (litt. tu as dormi).

siamoi 076

'Ylää plöö- 'kwie. (-kpazebhleku)
Sleep is (a kind of) death
Le sommeil est une (sorte de) mort.

17. Sigo

Genre: Folk tale / Conte traditionnel
Content: What happens when you are disloyal to the one who helped you out / *Contenu*: Ce qui arrive quand on est déloyal envers son bienfaiteur
Speaker/Locuteur: G (55, male)
Date: 16-08-1994

sigo 001

Sigo.
Sigo.

sigo 001

'Nünëa n 'kä -kä lä 'pä naa,
The story that I am going to tell you,
Le conte que je vais raconter,

sigo 002

amä, aa' bhıädaa -lɔɔ a 'kä lä 'kʊ ŋo
at its end you will respond.
à sa fin vous allez répondre.

sigo 003

Sigo. Laagɔ kwlie- lä nyıkpɔ.
Sigo. God made a man.
Sigo. Dieu a fait un homme.

sigo 004

Jinëdë, -mɔɔ ɔ ŋʊɔ- lä
In the middle of the ocean, that's where he put him.
Au milieu de la mer, c'est là qu'il l'a mis.

sigo 005

-Mɔɔ, -mɔɔ zëkpë 'ninienöɔ- lä.
There, it is out there that life did amazing things to him.
Là-bas, c'est là-bas que la vie lui a fait des choses étonnantes.

sigo 006

Nä kä a 'kä lä bhlı.
So you will sing.
Donc vous allez chanter.

sigo 007

n 'kä lä bhlı nynä
I am going to sing that
Je vais chanter que

sigo 008

n nä Sigo ye lu o,
I say Sigo was disloyal.
je dis que Sigo m'a trahi.

sigo 008a

FIRST SONG / PREMIER CHANT
Sigo ye lu o!
Sigo was disloyal!
Sigo a été déloyal!
A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo! (= Why have you done this to me, Sigo?)
Demandez à Sigo! (=Pourquoi m'as-tu fait ça, Sigo?)

A 'ylä Sigo! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: ye lu a!)
Ask Sigo! *he was disloyal!*
Demandez à Sigo! *il a été déloyal!*

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o! A 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o! A 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nı 'bä kä a! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o! A 'ylä Sigo!)
I haven't got a father! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de père! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

n 'nɪ 'nɔ kä a! (AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
I haven't got a mother! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
je n'ai pas de mère! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

sigo 009

Ʊ 'nöanyɪ -lä plɛ 'yi 'mʊmlɔ?
Will you not forget it (lit. will it not disappear from your hearts)?
Est-ce que vous n'allez pas l'oublier?(litt. ne disparaîtra-t-il de vos coeurs)?

sigo 010

A yiu yibhë -a?
Will you know it?
Est-ce que vous allez le connaître?

sigo 011

bɔn, kä n 'kä ylä 'nünëa 'pä
Alright, I'll now tell the story.
Bon, je vais maintenant raconter le conte

sigo 012

(Audience representative / Animateur:) -Ɛɛ, -a yi mii- -a yi yɪ 'kʊ cie -pɛɛ
Yes, we can now start,
Oui, nous allons pouvoir commencer maintenant,

sigo 013

(Audience representative / Animateur:) -n 'pä 'kɔɔkɔ!
Go ahead!
Conte toujours!

sigo 014

'Nünëa 'mä n 'kä ylä 'pä
The story, it is what I will tell you now.
Le conte, c'est ce que je vais raconter maintenant,

sigo 015

-Lää duu' -a -kʊ lä.
We are here in the village.
Nous sommes ici au village,

sigo 016

Nyoglubë duu' -a -kʊ lä (Voilà!)
We are in the village of Niégrouboué, *That's it!*
Nous sommes au village de Niégrouboué, *Voilà!*

sigo 017

'nɪ -a yä lä -kugbë -gwlɛ. (sese)
and we are together this evening.
et nous sommes ensemble ce soir.

sigo 018

'Jekpiŋnıä -yi lä -kugbë nä, (sese)
White women who have come this evening,
Des femmes blanches qui sont venues ce soir,

sigo 019

wamää- -yii' lä -kugbë -gwlɛ -kää (sese) -amʊ -Jigo Kwëci. (sese)
they have come to my house, me Jigo Kotchi's this evening.
ce sont elles qui sont venues chez moi ce soir, moi Djigo Kotchi.

sigo 020

Wa yi ylä -gwlɛ -kä nä,
As they are coming to stay
Comme elles viennent pour rester,

sigo 021*

ı -ŋwa 'kʊ nynä n 'pä yı -a 'bhunünü (sese)
it is a good thing that I now tell our own stories,
il convient que je donne des contes de chez nous,

sigo 022*

-yä wa 'kı 'sıı 'nu -mʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
so that they may also hear them,
pour qu'elles les entendent aussi,

sigo 023*

(-mä) ıyä wa 'kı 'sıı wa 'bhlı fä. (-kpazebhleku)
and so that they can even take them to their home country.
et qu'elles les emportent dans leur pays.

sigo 024

lı' -zä n ci lä sɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
That is why I am saying it.
C'est pour quoi je dis cela.

sigo 025

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

sigo 026

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

sigo 027

N naa, (-N naa)
I say, *You say*
Je dis, *Tu dis*

sigo 028

Laagɔ 'mʊʊ- kwlie- lä nyɪkpɔ. (sese)
God created a man. (lit. God, it was him who brought down a man)
Dieu qui a créé un homme. (litt. c'est Dieu qui a descendu un homme)

sigo 029

-Mɔɔ jinëëdë cɛkʊ -kʊ {bhä} -mɔɔ, (sese)
There was a rock in the middle of the ocean,
Il y avait un rocher au milieu de la mer,

sigo 030

'nɪ ʊ yi lä -mɔɔ nyɪkpɔɔ kwlie, (sese)
and he put the man down there.
et il y a descendu l'homme.

sigo 031

Ɔmɔ wa la Sigo. (sese)
he was called Sigo.
Il s'appelait Sigo

sigo 032

-Mä Sigo nɔ ʊ kwlie- lä -mɔɔ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
However, that Sigo that he put down there,
Or ce Sigo que Dieu a descendu là-bas,

sigo 033

Sigo, ɔɔ' 'ni -yɪɛ {-wʊ} sä, (-kpazebhleku)
Sigo, he cannot see.
Sigo, il ne voit pas.

sigo 034

kɔ -kʊ lä 'cucukpää'.
he is in the dark.
il est dans les ténèbres.

sigo 035

Kä ɔɔ' 'yii gbɔɔ- lä 'klʊ,
His eyes are shut
Ses yeux sont fermés.

sigo 036

ɔɔ' 'ni -yɪɛ {-wʊ} sä, (-kpazebhleku)
he cannot see,
il ne voit pas,

sigo 037

'nɪ ɔɔ' Laagɔɔ ŋʊɔ- lä -mɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
and his God put him there.
et son Dieu l'a mis là-bas.

sigo 038*

{Ʊ} nyıɔ gwieyi taa. (-kpazebhleku)
He gave him three palm nuts.
Il lui a donné trois graines de palme.

sigo 039

Gwieyi nı taa 'mı ɔ lü lä 'kɔɔkɔ
These three palm nuts, that's what he ate all the time
Ces trois graines de palme, c'est ça qu'il mangeait toujours

sigo 040

'nı ɔɔ' 'pʋpʋʋ 'mnö 'nı ɔ -kʋ lä -mɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
all his life. (litt. and in his life, and he was there)
toute sa vie. (litt. et dans son monde, et il y était)

sigo 041

Gwieyi nı taa 'mı ɔ lü lä, (-kpazebhleku)
It is these three palm nuts that he was eating
Ce sont ces trois graines de palmes qu'il mangeait

sigo 042

'nı ɔ -kʋ ylä 'kɔɔkɔ -mɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
and he was all the time there.
et il était toujours là-bas.

sigo 043*

-Zıkä, Goplë plö -aaa, (-kpazebhleku)
One day (lit. today) Gopleu was flying until
Un jour l'oiseau Gopleu s'envolait jusqu'à ce qu'

sigo 044*

'nı a yi -mɔɔ jinëëdë mʋ. (-kpazebhleku)
he (lit. it) came (lit. went) to the middle of the ocean.
il arrive (litt. aille) au milieu de la mer.

sigo 045

A lä a mʋ nä,
When he went,
Quand il y est allé,

sigo 046

cɛkʋʋ 'klʋ nyıkpɔ -kʋ -mɔɔ.
on the rock there was a man.
sur le rocher, il y avait un homme.

sigo 047

Sigo -kʋ -mɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
Sigo was there.
Sigo était là-bas.

sigo 048

'Nı -ja! 'Nı a yi cɛkʊʊ 'klʊ gɔɔ-. (-kpazebhleku)
Then he alighted on the rock.
Et aussitôt l'oiseau s'est posé sur le rocher.

sigo 049

Ɔ {A} laa, 'Nɔɔ, -ayio o! (sese)
He said, "Hello, my friend!"
Il a dit: « Bonjour, mon ami! »

sigo 050

'Nı Goplë, -anʊ Sigo yi 'kʊ gbäglö. (sese)
And Gopleu, rather Sigo was startled.
Et Gopleu, ou plutôt Sigo, a sursauté

sigo 051

-Ɔ bhänöö' bhä? (sese)
"Who is greeting me?"
« Qui me salue? »

sigo 052*

Ɔ {A} lä, -Amʊ, Goplë. (sese)
He said, "It's me, Gopleu."
Il a dit: « C'est moi, Gopleu. »

sigo 053*

Ɔ lä, -A, 'nɔɔ, -ayiokä! (sese)
He said, "Oh my friend, hello!"
Il a dit: « Oh mon ami, bonjour! »

sigo 054*

A lä, 'Nɔɔ, (sese) 'bhlı 'kʊ n bha nä, (sese)
He said, "My friend, I have come a long way,
Il dit: « Mon ami, je viens de très loin,

sigo 055*

n yä sıä. (sese)
I am tired.
je suis fatigué.

sigo 056

-Gbugbe bhlää' lä nä,
I am hungry,
J'ai faim,

sigo 057

-n 'nyɛ 'naa dä gwieye
give me some of your palm nut (lit. my share of palm nut)
donne ma part de graine de palme,

sigo 058

n 'kä lü. (sese)
to eat (lit. I will eat).”
je vais manger. »

sigo 059

Ɔ lä: 'Ɔɔ!
He exclaimed, “Oh!
Il s'exclame: « Oh!

sigo 060

-Amʊ -ɔɔ lü -wʊ lʊʊ
I who have nothing to eat (lit. who eats nothing)
Moi, qui n’ai rien à manger (litt. qui ne mange rien)

sigo 061

'nɪ 'naa gwieyi nɪ taä,
and my three palm nuts here
et mes trois graines-ci

sigo 062

ɯmɪ n -kä,
are all that I have (lit. it is them I have)
sont tout ce que j’ai, (litt. ce sont elles que j'ai)

sigo 063

'nɪ n lü 'pʊpʊ nʊ 'mʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and that I eat all my life,
et que je mange dans toute ma vie,

sigo 064

ɯmɪ -n nä n 'nyɛɛ-
it is them you tell me to give you
ce sont elles que tu me dis de te donner

sigo 065

-yä -n 'gä lü -a? (-kpazebhleku)
to eat?”
pour que tu les manges? »

sigo 066

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, 'nɪ sä -gbugbe bhlää' ylä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
He said, “My friend, but since I am hungry, …
Il dit: « Mon ami, mais comme j'ai faim,

sigo 067

-n nyɛɛ' gwieye.
give me a palm nut!
donne-moi une graine de palme!

sigo 068

-N 'nyɛ 'naa dä gwieye! (-kpazebhleku)
Give me some of your palm nut!”
Donne-moi ma part de graine! »

sigo 069

Ɔ lä, -Aa,
He said, “Alright.
Il dit: « D’accord.

sigo 070

(bon) n yä 'nu. (sese)
Okay, I have understood.
Bon, j'ai compris.

sigo 071*

'Bhlü gwieyee 'kʊ. (sese)
Take the palm nut!”
Prends la graine de palme! »

sigo 072*

'Nɪ ɔ yio gwieyee 'nyɛ (sese)
and he gave him the palm nut,
et il lui adonné la graine,

sigo 073*

'nɪ Goplë yie lü. (sese)
and Gopleu ate it.
et Gopleu l’a mangé.

sigo 074*

Ɔ {a} -lü ylä gwieyee nä,
When he had now eaten the palm nut,
Quand il avait maintenant fini de manger la graine de palme

sigo 075

ɔ {a} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -ayäyio, -mä kä n mʊ yɪ o! (sese)
he said, “My friend, good bye, I am leaving.”
il a dit: « Mon ami, au revoir, je m'en vais. »

sigo 076

'Nɪ a yi 'kʊ -bha
And he got up
Et il s'est levé

sigo 077

'nɪ a yi mʊ. (sese)
and he left.
et il est parti.

sigo 078

A -mʊ, a -kʊ -mɔɔ -aaa, ylıı 'sɔ.
He went, he stayed away a while, two days.
Il est parti, il est resté là-bas jusqu'à deux jours.

sigo 079

Taaylʊʊ {tana 'ylʊʊ} 'kʊ, 'vukuvuku -gu!
On the third day, he came flying
Le troisième jour, à coup d'ailes il arrive,

sigo 080

'nı a yi bʊkʊ -lɔɔ cɛkʊʊ 'klʊ gɔɔ-. (-kpazebhleku)
and he alighted again on the rock.
et s'est de nouveau posé sur le rocher.

sigo 081

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -ayio o! (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "Hello, my friend!"
Il dit: « Bonjour, mon ami! »

sigo 082

Ɔ lä, -Aa, 'nɔɔ, -ayiokä. (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "Oh, hello, my friend!"
Il dit: « Oh, bonjour, mon ami! »

sigo 083

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -gbugbe bhlää' lä nä, (sese)
He said, "My friend, I am hungry, so
Il dit: « Mon ami, j'ai faim, donc

sigo 084

bheeje -n nyɛɛ' gwieye,
please, give me a palm nut
je t'en prie, donne-moi une graine de palme

sigo 085

n 'kä lü! (sese)
to eat!"
pour que je mange! »

sigo 086

Ɔ lä, 'Ɔɔ!
He exclaims, "Oh my,
Sigo s'écrie avec indignation:

sigo 087

-Mɔɔ' bhɛ -zımakʊ -lää -yi -a? (-kpazebhleku)
wasn't it you who came here the other day?"
« N'est-ce pas toi qui es venu l'autre jour ici? »

sigo 088

Ɔ {A} lä, -Amʊ lä. (sese)
He said, “It is me,
Il dit: « C'est moi,

sigo 089

-mä -gbugbe bhlää' lä nä,
but since I am hungry
mais comme j'ai faim

sigo 090

sɔɔ n -yi lä bʊkʊ
that is why I have come again,
c'est pourquoi je suis revenu encore

sigo 091

-yä -n gää' gwieye 'nyɛ. (sese)
so you would give me a palm nut.”
pour que tu me donnes une graine. »

sigo 092

Ɔ lä, 'Nı gwieyii -bhlü a taa,
He said, “The palm nuts numbered three,
Il dit: « (Tu sais bien que) les graines étaient au nombre de trois,

sigo 093

'nı n yää- -bhlogbe 'nyɛ nä,
and since I gave you one
et comme je t'en ai donné une,

sigo 094

lıı 'sɔɔ- -kʊ ylä -lɔɔ nä,
there are two that are there now.
ce sont deux qui sont maintenant là.

sigo 095

N kää- nyɛɛ- nä,
If I give you,
Si je te donne,

sigo 096

zio n lü bhä -pɛɛ? (sese)
how many do I eat now?”
combien est-ce que je mange désormais? »

sigo 097

Ɔ {A} lä, ('nı) 'nɔɔ,
He said, “My friend,
Il dit: « Mon ami,

sigo 098

'nı sä -gbugbe bhlää' ylä nä… (sese)
but since I am hungry…"
mais comme j'ai faim maintenant… »

sigo 099

Bhlie 'kʊ. (sese)
"Take it!"
(Sigo cède pour la seconde fois disant: « Prends-la! »

sigo 100

'Nı ɔ yio {yia} gwieyee 'nyɛ (sese)
And he gave him the palm nut
Et il lui a donné la graine

sigo 101

'nı ɔ {a} yie lü. (sese)
and he ate it.
et il l'a mangé.

sigo 102

'Nı a yi 'kʊ -bha,
Then he got up
Alors il s'est levé,

sigo 103

a lä, 'Nɔɔ, -ayoyio! (sese)
saying, "Good bye, my friend!"
disant: « Au revoir, mon ami! »

sigo 104

Bɛɛ! 'Nı Goplë yi mʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
Then he left.
Alors il est parti.

sigo 105

A kʊ -mɔɔ -aaa, ylıı 'sɔ,
He stayed away a while, two days,
Il est resté là-bas jusqu'à deux jours,

sigo 106

'Vuku 'vuku -gu! A yi bʊkʊ -lɔɔ gɔɔ-. (-kpazebhleku)
then he came beating his wings and alighted again there (=on the rock),
A grands coup d'ailes, s'est posé une fois encore là (sur le rocher).

sigo 107

Ɔ {A} lä, Sigo, (sese)
He said, "Sigo."
Il dit: « Sigo. »

sigo 108

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -ayio! (sese)
He said, “My friend, hello!”
Il dit: « Bonjour, mon ami! »

sigo 109

Ɔ lä, -Aa, 'nɔɔ, -ayiokä! (-kpazebhleku)
He said, “Oh, my friend, hello!”
Il (=Sigo) répond disant: « Mon ami, bonjour! »

sigo 110

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -gbugbe bhlää' lä nä,
He said, “My friend, I am hungry, so
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, j'ai faim, donc,

sigo 111

-n nyɛɛ' {-naa gwieyee}! (-kpazebhleku)
give me (of your palm nut)!”
donne-moi (de ta graine)! »

sigo 112

Ɔ lä, 'Ɔɔ, 'Nɔɔ! (-kpazebhleku)
He exclaimed, “Oh my, my friend!”
Sigo s'est écrié (avec indignation disant): « Mon ami! »

sigo 113

Ɔ lä, -Aa, -n gä cii- -n gää' yı 'bhlä nä,
He said,“Well, if you want to kill me,
Il dit: « Bon, si tu veux me tuer,

sigo 114

kä -n -nä -n 'bhlä yı (-kpazebhleku)
then kill me!
tue-moi alors!

sigo 115

-Mä n 'nöö- -lä 'naa gwieyee 'nyɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
But I won’t give you of my palm nut.
Mais je ne te donnerai pas ma graine.

sigo 116

Ɛmɛ -bhlo 'nı n -kɛ ylä -pɛɛ,
It is all I have now
Elle est tout ce que j’ai désormais,

sigo 117

'nı n lie nä,
and it is my food (litt. I eat it),
et je m’en nourris (litt. je la mange),

sigo 118

'nɪ -n -nä n 'nyɛɛ- mɛ ylä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and you tell me to give it to you now, so
et tu me dis de te la donner, alors

sigo 119

-amʊ n nä n lü yɪ? (-kpazebhleku)
myself, what are you saying I should now eat?"
moi, qu'est-ce que tu me dis de manger désormais? »

sigo 120

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, bheeje,
He said,"Please, my friend,
Il dit: « Pardon, mon ami,

sigo 121

-n nyɛɛ' gwieye
give me a palm nut
donne-moi une graine

sigo 122

n 'kä lü, (-kpazebhleku)
to eat (litt. I will eat),
pour que je mange,

sigo 123

-mä -gbugbe bhlää' lä.
because I am hungry!"
car j'ai faim. »

sigo 124

Ɔ lä, -Aa,
He said, "Okay,
Il dit: « D'accord,

sigo 125

-n 'bhlüe 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
take it!
prends-la!

sigo 126

-Amʊʊ- 'nä kuu- yɪ -o,
If it is me that will now die (of hunger)
Si c'est moi qui dois mourir (de faim)

sigo 127

n 'ku yɪ! (-kpazebhleku)
may I die now!"
que je meure alors! »

sigo 128

'Nı ɔ yio gwieye 'nyɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
And he gave him a palm nut.
Et il lui a donné une graine de palme.

sigo 129

Gbʊgblɛ -saa, (-kpazebhleku) 'nı ɔ yionyɛ 'nyɛ
With discontent *he then gave it to him.*
Dans le mécontentement, *il la lui a alors donnée.*

sigo 130

'nı -anʊ yie 'kʊ 'bhlü, (-kpazebhleku)
And what's his name took it,
Et comment on l'appelle l'a prise,

sigo 131

Goplë yie 'kʊ 'bhlü
Gopleu l'a prise

sigo 132

'nı ɔ yie lü. (-kpazebhleku)
and he ate it.
et il l'a mangé.

sigo 133

Ɔ {A} -kʊ -lɔɔ 'föö, (-kpazebhleku)
He stayed there a moment
Il est resté là un instant après

sigo 134

ɔ {a} lä, 'Nɔɔ, (-kpazebhleku) ɔ {a} lä, 'Nɔɔ, (-kpazebhleku)
and said, "My friend," *he said, "My friend,*
et dit: « Mon ami, » *il dit: « Mon ami,*

sigo 134a

n yä -naa gwieyee lü (-kpazebhleku)
I have eaten your palm nut,
j'ai mangé ta graine,

sigo 135

-mä -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
but close your eyes now!
mais ferme les yeux maintenant!

sigo 136

Ɔ lä, -Mä kä -n 'luglu 'nöö -a? (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "But are you offending me?
Il (= Sigo) dit: « Encore, tu me parles mal?

sigo 137*

-Amʊ, 'naa 'yii ŋwɛɛ- -kä 'kʊ,
As for me, (you know that) my eyes are shut
Moi, mes yeux sont fermés,

sigo 138*

'nɪ nn' 'ni -kä sä, (-kpazebhleku)
and I cannot see,
et je ne vois pas,

sigo 139*

'nɪ -n sonöö',
and you are saying to me,
et tu me dis:

sigo 140*

-Mä -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
'Close your eyes!' "
'Mais ferme les yeux!' »

sigo 141

Ɔ {A} lä, (-kpazebhleku) Ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ,
He said, *"Close your eyes,*
Il dit: *« Ferme les yeux,*

sigo 142

pɪänɪ 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
Press on them!"
Presse dessus! »

sigo 143

Ɔ lä, -Aa.
He said, "Okay."
Il dit: « Compris. »

sigo 144

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ, (-kpazebhleku)
And he closed his eyes
Et il a fermé les yeux

sigo 145

{'nɪ} ɔ yii 'kʊ pɪä-. (-kpazebhleku)
and he pressed on them.
et il a appuyé dessus.

sigo 146

Ɔ pɪänɪ- 'kʊ -aaa, föö -aaa, (-kpazebhleku)
He pressed on them a while until
Il les a pressés pendant un moment jusqu'à ce que

sigo 147

ɔ {a} lä, 'Nɔɔ, (-kpazebhleku)
he (=Gopleu) said, “My friend,
et il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami,

sigo 148

-n welie 'yi. (-kpazebhleku)
open your eyes!”
ouvre les yeux! »

sigo 149

-Mä ɔ mʊ 'yi welie -kää nä,
Now when he opened his eyes
Or au moment où il a ouvert les yeux,

sigo 150

ɔ -kʊ (jibɔ) jizägbä 'kʊ. (sese)
he was on the beach.
il était à la plage.

sigo 151

Cɛkʊʊ nëëdë ɔ -kʊ a nä,
In the middle of the rock where he had been,
Au milieu du rocher où il avait été,

sigo 152

ɔ yä -mɔɔ -bha,
he has left there,
il a quitté là-bas,

sigo 153

ɔ yä 'klä yëku,
he has come to the shore,
et il est venu sur la rive,

sigo 154

ɔ yä -mää jie yëku yi. (-kpazebhleku)
he has now come beside the ocean.
Il était (maintenant) venu au bord de la mer.

sigo 155

(Ɔ lä) (-kpazebhleku) Ɔ yä 'yi welie
He said *He opens (lit. has opened) his eyes,*
Il a ouvert les yeux

sigo 156

ɔ ni yı sä. (-kpazebhleku)
he can now see.
il voit maintenant.

sigo 157

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
He (= Gopleu) said, “My friend, close your eyes!”
Il (= Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, ferme les yeux! »

sigo 158

'Nɪ ɔ yi bʊkʊ 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
And he closed his eyes again.
Et il a fermé les yeux de nouveau.

sigo 159

Ɔ ŋwɛɛ- 'yi 'kʊ -aaa,
He kept them shut for a while,
Il a fermé les yeux pendant un moment,

sigo 160

-mä ɔ lä kɔ welie 'yi nä (-kpazebhleku)
but when he opened his eyes,
mais lorsqu'il a ouvert les yeux,

sigo 161

-lɔɔ' 'bhlɪ -klëaa' -lefɪn fɪn fɪn fɪn, a yä -luo. (-kpazebhleku)
all of the ground there, all, all, all, it was cleared
tout le territoire qui était là, tout, tout, il a été nettoyé.

sigo 162

-Lɔɔ -lefɪn plöö- yɪ ('tazɪ){'tasɪbhiti}. (-kpazebhleku)
Everywhere there were now houses with several floors
Partout il y avait maintenant des immeubles.

sigo 163

(-Lɪɪ) {Daa'}-lefɪn plöö- yɪ nyɪkpa -bhlobhlo (-kpazebhleku)
The whole place was now inhabited by people.
Tout le lieu était habité par des hommes.

sigo 164

-Lɔɔ' (-lɪɪ'){daa'} -lefɪn 'bhlüü (-kpazebhleku), -kɔkwɪä, (-kpazebhleku)
Everywhere there were cattle, fowl,
Partout, des bœufs, des poulets,

sigo 164a

-ää, wlü -yä 'bhabhlö -ya 'fɪn, (-kpazebhleku)
em, goats, and also sheep and everything,
euh, des cabris, avec des moutons et tout,

sigo 165

-yä geyuë waa' -bhitigbälɪ. (sese)
and also rows of houses for slaves
puis aussi des rangées de maisons pour des esclaves.

sigo 166

'Nɪ ɔ {a} yi (etazɪ) 'slä. (sese)
And he built houses with several floors.
Et il a construit aussi des immeubles.

sigo 167

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, (sese)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami,

sigo 168*

-n yää' puë, (sese)
You have saved me,
Tu m'as sauvé,

sigo 169*

-amʊ -mä kä n puë(ë)- lä 'sɪɪ. (sese)
now I am saving you, too."
moi aussi je te sauve maintenant. »

sigo 170

Ɔ {A} lä, -Naa -bhiti -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ. (sese)
He said, "These are your houses here."
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Ce sont tes maisons qui sont ici. »

sigo 171

Ɔ {A} lä, -Nɪnɪ 'fɪɪn -ɪ -kʊ lä -ää {-naa lɪɪ lä} (sese)
He said, "Everything that is here is yours.
Il dit (encore): « Tout ce qui est ici est à toi.

sigo 172

-Naa geyuë -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ, (sese)
There are your slaves here,
Ce sont tes esclaves qui sont ici,

sigo 173

-naa 'ŋnɪää- -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ. (sese)
there are your wives here.
ce sont tes femmes qui sont ici.

sigo 174*

-Naa dää- -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ. (sese)
It is your home (lit. place) that is here.
C'est ton chez-toi qui est ici.

sigo 175

N yää- 'sɪɪ 'nää nʊ. (sese)
I have also been good to you.
Je te fais aussi du bien.

sigo 176

'Nɪ ɔ {a} yi -zɔɔ bhɪä. (sese)
And he (=Gopleu) finished (his work).
Et il (=Gopleu) a fini (son œuvre).

sigo 177

'Nɪ ɔ {a} yi -zɔɔ bhɪä. (sese)
And he (=Gopleu) finished (his work).
Et il (=Gopleu) a fini (son œuvre).

sigo 178

Ɔ {A} lä, -Naa dää- -kʊ -kɛ lä -lää a! (sese)
He said, “So this is your home here!”
Il dit: « C'est ton chez-toi qui est donc ici! »

sigo 179

-Mä ɔɔ' -bhiti -gbɔlʊʊ' bhloodaa, (sese)
However, at the end of the row of houses
Or à la fin de la rangée de ses maisons,

sigo 179a

sää gwädö 'kädä -kʊ -lɔɔ. (sese)
there is a big kapok tree.
il y a un grand fromager.

sigo 180

Gwädö 'kädaa, amä ɔ {a} ŋʊʊ- -lɔɔ,
The big kapok tree, that’s what he (=Gopleu) put there,
Le gros fromager, c’est lui qu'il (=Gopleu) a mis là

sigo 181

amä -zɔ wa gwlɛɛ. (sese)
(and) under which people get together.
(et) sous lequel les gens se rassemblent.

sigo 182

-Lɔɔ wa -kʊ ylä. (sese)
It is there that they live now.
C'est là qu'ils habitaient désormais.

sigo 183

-Mä Sigo, leylü ɔ -lü ylä nä, (sese)
So Sigo has now become a very rich man
Sigo est devenu un richard

sigo 184

ɔmɔ 'bhisäkʊ nyɪkpɔɔ' yɪɛ 'pʊpʊʊ' -kʊ,
there is no one like him in the world,
il n’y a personne comme lui dans le monde,

sigo 185*

'nɪ ɔ -kʊ ylä -lɔɔ, ɔ -yä ɔ 'ŋnɪä 'sɔ. (sese)
and he was there, he and his wives.
et il était là, lui et ses femmes.

sigo 186

-Mä ɔ yä 'yuë gää -aaa,
Now he has had children until
Or il a fait des d'enfants jusqu'à ce que

sigo 187

'yua ɔ -gää lä nä,
the children that he had
les enfants qu'il avaient faits,

sigo 188

waa' -yɪɛ {-wʊ} -zunɔɔ' 'bɛ. (sese)
they couldn't be counted anymore.
ils ne pouvaient plus être comptés.

sigo 189

Ɔ -gää ylä sää 'yua naa, (sese)
When he had had that many children
Quand il a mis les enfants au monde de la sorte,

sigo 190

amä Goplë mä -mä (sese), gwädö 'kädaa 'wlu (sese)
that Gopleu *on top of the big kapok tree*
ce Gopleu, lui aussi, *sur le grand fromager,*

sigo 190a

a yä -mɔɔ, a yä -mɔɔ, a yä -mɔɔ pänö-. (sese)
he has, he has, he has brooded there.
il y a, il y a, il y a pondu.

sigo 191

A pänö- ylä -mɔɔ nä, (sese)
When he had brooded there,
Quand il a pondu là-bas,

sigo 192

{'nɪ} aa' yuo -kɔtɔ yɪ {ylä} nä,
and his child had now come out of the egg.
et que son enfant a été couvé,

sigo 193*

-mɔɔ gwäda 'wlu ɔ -kʊ
it was there on top of the kapok tree that he (= the baby bird) was
c'est là sur le fromager, qu'il (=le bébé oiseau) était

sigo 194*

'nɪ ɔ tu {ylä}. (sese)
crying. (lit. and he was crying).
et il pleurait.

sigo 195

'Yuo tu lä naa, (sese)
When the child was crying,
Quand l'enfant pleure,

sigo 196

-anʊ, ɔmɔ Sigo 'yua, (sese)
em, Sigo's children,
euh,les enfants de Sigo,

sigo 197

ɔɔ' -wawaŋnɔɔ' 'yuo, (seese)
his favorite wife's child,
l'enfant de la femme préférée de Sigo,

sigo 198

wlä 'yuo lä, -anʊ, Goplëa' 'yuoo- tu -mɔɔ {gwäda 'wlu} nä, (sese)
it is said that the child said that -em - Gopleu's child who is crying on top of the kapok tree
l'enfant aurait dit - euh - l'enfant de Gopleu qui pleure en haut du fromager

sigo 199

ɔmɔ, wa 'nyɪɔnyɔ
it (lit. him), they should give it to him
lui, qu'on le lui donne

sigo 200

{-yä} ɔ -yɔ 'sɔ 'kä gäma. (sese)
so that he could play with it.
pour qu'il s'amuse avec.

sigo 201

'Aa! Sigo (sese) 'ŋnɔ yä yi. (sese)
Well, Sigo's wife comes (lit. has come).
Eh bien, la femme de Sigo est venue.

sigo 202

Ɔ lä, Sigo, (sese) wlä 'naa 'yuo lä
She said, "Sigo, they say my child says
Elle dit: « Sigo, mon enfant dit

sigo 203

ɔ yä Goplëa' 'yuo 'sɔ 'kä gäma, (seese)
he wants to play with Gopleu's child,
qu'il veut s'amuser avec l'enfant de Gopleu, donc,

sigo 204

nä -n 'gä gbä
so see to it that
donc tu vas faire

sigo 205

-yä wa 'kɔ -mɔɔ -sä. (sese)
they take him from there (on the tree).”
qu'on l’enlève de là (sur l’arbre). »

sigo 206

Wlä Sigo lä, Nn' 'ylä -yıɛ {-wʊ}. (sese)
It is said that Sigo said, “I am not willing.”
Sigo aurait dit: « Je ne veux pas. »

sigo 207

Ɔ lä, 'Naa nyıkpɔɔ -ɔ puëë' lä, ɔmɔ -ɔ -kʊ lä -lɔɔ, (sese)
He said, “My chap who saved me, it’s because of him (lit. it is him who is there),
Il dit (encore): « Mon type qui m'a sauvé, c'est à cause de lui (litt. c’est lui qui est là),

sigo 208

'nı ɔɔ' 'yuo 'mɔɔ- -kʊ -mɔɔ {gwäda 'wlu},
and it is his child that is there on the kapok tree
et c'est son enfant qui est sur le fromager

sigo 209

'nı -n nä n nyɛɛ- mɔ, (sese)
and you are telling me to give it to you,
et tu me dis de te le donner

sigo 210

'nı ɔ kɔ yı bhlä -ä? (sese)
and if he (=my child) now kills it?”
et s'il (mon enfant) le tue? »

sigo 211

Ɔ 'ŋnɔ laa,
His wife said,
Sa femme dit:

sigo 212

Gbʊʊ- nöö- 'wlu -n nöö' yıɛ -wa nä, (sese)
“It is because you don’t love me anymore
« Parce que tu ne m'aimes plus,

sigo 213

ıı' -zä 'naa 'yuo lä
that is why my child says
à cause de cela mon enfant demande

sigo 214

wa 'nyıɔ Goplëa 'yuo
to give him (lit. they give him) Gopleu's child
qu'on lui donne l'enfant de Gopleu

sigo 215

'nı -n nä -tɛɛ -mä
and you are only saying that
et tu dis seulement que

sigo 216

-nn 'ylä -wʊ. (sese)
you do not want
tu ne veux pas.

sigo 217

Ɔ lä, 'Aa!
He exclaimed, "Oh my!
Il s'est écrié d'indignation.

sigo 218

N nä nn' 'ylä -yıɛ {-wʊ}! (sese)
I am saying that I am not willing!"
Je dis que je ne veux pas! »

sigo 219

Ɔ lä nä, 'ŋnɔɔ lä
She said, the wife said,
Elle dit, la femme dit:

sigo 220

Nn' ŋoo -yıɛ {-wʊ} {'sıı}. (sese)
"Me, too, I am no longer willing."
« Moi aussi je ne veux plus. »

sigo 221

Ɔ lä, -Aa, n yä 'nu o. (sese)
He said, "Okay, I have understood."
Il dit: « D'accord, j'ai compris. »

sigo 222*

Ɔ lä, Geyuënyı, (sese)
He says (giving an order): "Hey, slaves,
Il dit (donnant un ordre): « Vous, les esclaves

sigo 223*

-lɔɔ' gwädä 'yı {-a}-kʊ lä -lɔyı nä,
the kapok tree over there, which is way over there,
le fromager qui est là-bas,

sigo 224*

a bhla! (sese)
cut it down!”
Abattez-le! »

sigo 225

'Gu! -Gu! 'Gu!
With mighty blows
A grands coups de hache

sigo 226*

Suu 'mʊ wa bhlä ylä (sese)
They now went about felling the tree
Ils se mirent à abattre l'arbre,

sigo 227*

ıyä ʊ 'kä -zɔɔ bhlü
so that it would actually fall
pour qu’il tombe

sigo 228*

-yä wa 'kä 'yuo 'kʊ 'bhlü. (sese)
and they could take the child (= the baby bird).
et qu’ils puissent prendre l'enfant (de l’oiseau).

sigo 229

Suu nʊ 'mʊ wa bhlä ylä, (sese)
They were now felling that tree,
Ils abattaient alors cet arbre,

sigo 230

suu nʊ 'mʊ wa bhlä ylä. (sese)
they were now felling that tree.
ils abattaient alors cet arbre.

sigo 231

-Mä Goplë, 'bhlı 'kʊ a -mʊ lä lü -kää nä, (sese)
But Gopleu, the region where he had gone to eat
Mais Gopleu, le territoire ou il est parti manger,

sigo 232

-mɔɔ' -wʊ 'bɛ. (sese)
it was very far away (lit. there was not comparable).
il était très éloigné (litt. là-bas n’était pas comparbale).

sigo 233

A -kʊ -mɔɔ -aaa…
Il y est resté jusqu’à
He stayed there until

sigo 234

a -yi 'sɔɔ {nynä}
he knew that
ce qu'il sache que

sigo 235

suu kʊ lʊ 'kä lä bhlü. (sese)
the tree was about to fall down.
l'arbre allait tomber.

sigo 236

A -pa 'gu! 'gu! 'gu! 'gu!
He flew fast (lit. ran) ran, beating his wings
Il a volé (litt. couru) à grands coups d'ailes

sigo 237

'nı a yi yi.
and he came.
et il est venu.

sigo 238

Suu 'kä -bhlɛ sää bhlü
When the tree was just about to fall down,
Au moment même où l'arbre allait tomber,

sigo 239

'nı a yiu 'wlu gɔɔ- (sese)
he alighted on its top,
il est venu s'y poser,

sigo 240

'nı suu yi 'kplä. (sese)
and the stem of the tree shut itself (lit. was sown)
et le tronc de l'arbre s'est refermé (litt. s'est cousu)

sigo 241

'nı a yi kwli. (sese)
and Gopleu came down.
et Gopleu est descendu.

sigo 242

A lä Sigo, (sese)
He said, "Sigo,
Il dit: « Sigo,

sigo 243

-n 'gä bhä nʊʊ?
what do you want to do?
qu'est-ce que tu veux faire?

sigo 244

-N nä saa bhä? (sese)
What are you intending (lit. saying)?"
Qu'est-ce que tu veux (litt. dis)? »

sigo 245

Ɔ lä, (Non!) -Ɔɔ!
He said, "No! Don't worry!"
Sigo dit: « Non! Ne t'en fais pas! »

sigo 246

'Nɔɔ, -ɔɔ -wʊ 'yigädawälı,
My friend, there is nothing (lit. nothing else),
Mon ami, il n'y a rien de particulier (litt. rien d'autre).

sigo 247

-mä wlä 'naa 'yuo lä
but they say that my child says
c'est mon enfant qui dit que

sigo 248

ɔ -yä -naa 'yuo 'sɔ 'kä gäma, (sese)
he wants to play with your child
il veut s'amuser avec ton enfant,

sigo 249

nä ʋ' -zä wa bhlä bhlä suu. (sese)
so that is why they are were felling the tree."
c'est pour quoi ils abattent l'arbre. »

sigo 250

Ɔ lä, 'Ɔɔ!
He (=Gopleu) said, "Oh?
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Ah bon?

sigo 251

'Yuë 'sɔ kä gäma nä,
When two children play together,
Quand deux enfants s'amusent,

sigo 252

kä wa 'bhläbhlä -kä nä, (sese)
since they hit each other,"
comme ils se tapent, »

sigo 253

ɔ lä, -naa 'yuo, ɔɔ' kä 'naa 'yuo 'bhlä nä, (sese)
he said, "your child, he should not hit my child, so
il dit: « ton enfant, qu'il ne frappe pas mon enfant, donc

sigo 254

-nn bhlä -lä bʊkʊ 'sɔ,
don’t fell (the tree) a second time,
n'abats pas (l’arbre) une deuxième fois,

sigo 255

-nn bhlä -lä suu! (sese)
don’t fell (the tree)!”
n'abats pas l'arbre! »

sigo 256

Ɔ lä, -Aa, n yä 'nu o!
He said, “Okay, I have understood!”
Sigo dit: « D’accord, j'ai compris! »

sigo 257

'Nı Goplë yi bʊkʊ bi -kä mʊ o! (sese)
Then Gopleu went again away for a stroll.
Et Gopleu est parti encore se promener.

sigo 258

'Ŋnɔ nɔ, ɔɔ' ŋo yıɔ,
That woman, she wouldn’t accept,
Cette femme, elle ne voulait plus rien savoir,

sigo 259

'yuo tu yı bʊkʊ, (sese)
the child (=Sigo’s child) was crying again,
l'enfant (de de Sigo) pleure de nouveau,

sigo 260

ŋnɔɔ' ŋo bhɛ. (sese)
the woman had not accepted.
la femme n’avait pas accepté.

sigo 261

Ɔ lä, Sigo, (sese)
She said, “Sigo
Elle dit: « Sigo,

sigo 262

-anʊʊ 'yuo, wa 'kɔ -mɔɔ -sä -yä,
what’s his name’s child, they will take it from there,
l'enfant du type-là, on va l'enlever de là,

sigo 263

ɔ -yä 'naa 'yuo 'sɔ 'kä gäma!
so that it and my child can play together!
pour qu'il s'amuse avec mon enfant!

sigo 264

Wloo- sä 'naa 'yuo tu lä nä! (sese)
Look how my child is crying!
Regarde comment mon enfant pleure!

sigo 265

-Ɔ gä {-kä} bhɛ lä -naa -wawaŋnıa nä, (sese)
If it was your favorite wives,
Si c'était tes femmes préférées,

sigo 266

-n yä -kä bhɛ wamä 'yuo 'nyɛ. (sese)
you would have given them the child (=Gopleu's child).
tu leur aurais déjà donné l'enfant (=enfant de Gopleu).

sigo 267

-Mä -amʊ ylä nä, (sese) ıı' -zä -n -nä
But since it is me, *that is why*
Mais comme c'est moi, *c'est à cause de cela*

sigo 268

-nn -lä lä 'naa 'yuo nümnüyuo 'nyɛ
you will not give my child the bird child
tu ne vas pas donner à mon enfant le bébé oiseau

sigo 269

'nı ɔ (wa) -yɔ 'sɔ kä lä gäma. (sese)
so he can play with it."
pour qu'il s'amuse avec. »

sigo 270

Ɔɔ! Sigo, wälıı yɔ yëkuu' kamä- (sese)
Well then, Sigo, those words hit him hard,
Alors là, Sigo, ces paroles l'ont touché,

sigo 271

'nı ɔ yi geyua 'kʊ gaa-. (sese)
and he yelled at the slaves,
et il a crié sur les esclaves,

sigo 272

{Ɔ lä,} A bhlä gwäda! (sese)
saying, "Cut the kapok tree down!"
disant: « Abattez le fromager! »

sigo 273

'Gu! -Gu! 'Gu! -Gu!' 'Gu! Gwädä nä 'mä wa bhlä lä. (sese)
Blow by blow, that kapok tree, it is what they cut down.
Coup sur coup, ce fromager, c'est lui qu'ils abattent.

sigo 274*

A 'kä -bhlɛ bhlü
It was about to fall,
Il était sur le point de tomber,

sigo 275*

'nı Goplëa yi yi (sese)
then Gopleu came
alors Gopleu est venu

sigo 276

'nı -gu! 'nı (Goplëa) {a} yi gwäda 'wlu gɔɔ-.
and alighted on top of the kapok tree.
et s'est posé sur le fromager.

sigo 277

'Nı gwäda yi 'kplä (sese)
and the kapok tree shut itself (lit. was sown).
et le fromager s'est refermé (litt. s'est cousu).

sigo 278

'nı ɔ {a} yi kwli.
and he came down.
puis il est descendu.

sigo 279

Ɔ {A} lä Sigo, (sese) -n -nä sa bhä? (sese)
He said, "Sigo, what are you intending (lit. saying)?"
Il dit: « Sigo, qu'est-ce que tu veux (litt. dis)? »

sigo 280

Ɔ lä, 'Nɔɔ, 'flɛ nn' bhlä -wʊ gwäda
He said, "My friend, it is not without a reason that I am felling the kapok tree
Il dit: « Mon ami, ce n'est pas pour rien que j'abats le fromager

sigo 281

-mä 'yuo 'kä gäma.
but the child wants to play.
mais l'enfant veut s'amuser.

sigo 282

'Yuo, kɔ bhıä' lä 'kwlı,
The child, he exasperates me,
L'enfant, il m'embête),

sigo 283

ɔɔ' ŋoo -wʊ. (sese)
he doesn't accept (to calm down).
il n'accepte pas (de se taire).

sigo 284

Sɔɔ n nä wa bhlä gwäda,
So I said to cut the kapok tree down,
C'est pour cela que j'ai dit d'abattre le fromager,

sigo 285

-yä n 'kä -naa 'yuo 'kʊ 'bhlü
so that I can take your child
pour que je prenne ton enfant

sigo 286

-yä wa 'kä gäma. (sese)
and they can play together."
et qu'ils s'amusent. »

sigo 287

Ɔ lä, -Aa,
He (=Gopleu) said, "Okay,
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « D'accord,

sigo 288

-n yä sɔɔ ci nä, n yä 'nu. (sese)
since you say so, I have understood.
comme tu le dis, j'ai compris.

sigo 289*

-Mä 'yua 'sɔ kä -kä gäma nä, (sese)
But when the two children will play together,
Mais quand les deux enfants s'amusent

sigo 290*

waa' 'bhläbhlä -lä -kää! (sese)
they must not hit each other!
qu'ils ne se frappent pas!

sigo 291

-Mä -amʊ n yä -kɛ mʊ a! (sese)
As for me, I am gone, then!
Quant à moi, je suis donc parti!

sigo 292

Ɔ lä, -Aa.
He (=Sigo) said, "Okay."
Il (=Sigo) a dit: « D'accord. »

sigo 293

'nɪ anʊ yi mʊ,
and what's his name? left
et comment il s'appelle? est parti,

sigo 294

Goplë yi mö {mʊ}. (sese)
Gopleu left.
Gopleu est parti.

sigo 295

'Yuo 'mɔ -ɔ tu lä bʊkʊ… (sese)
The child, it is him that is crying again…
L'enfant, c'est lui qui pleure de nouveau…

sigo 296

Ɔ lä, A bhlä gwädaa! (sese)
He (=Sigo) said, "Cut the kapok tree down!"
Il (=Sigo) dit: « Abattez le fromager! »

sigo 297

Gwädä nä 'mä wa bhlä lä. (sese)
That kapok tree, that's what they cut down.
C'est ce fromager qu'ils abattaient,

sigo 298

amä wa bhlä ylä, (sese)
that's what they now cut down,
c'est lui qu'ils abattaient maintenant,

sigo 299

'nɪ -vlu! 'Nɪ gwäda yi (-dʊdʊ) 'kʊ bhlü. (sese)
and with a big bang the kapok tree fell on the ground.
et le fromager est tombé par terre avec fracas.

sigo 300

(Allez) Goplëa 'yuo 'nɪ wa yio -mɔɔ -sä, (sese)
Gopleu's child, they then took it from there
L'enfant de Gopleu, ils l'y ont alors enlevé

sigo 301

'nɪ wa yio 'yuo 'nyɛ. (sese)
and they gave him to the child (=Sigo's child).
et ils l'ont donné à l'enfant (de Sigo).

sigo 302

Kä wa gäma ylä, (sese)
They were now playing together
Ils sont en train de s'amuser

sigo 303

'nɪ Goplë yi yi, (sese)
when (lit. then) Gopleu came.
quand (litt. puis) Gopleu est venu

sigo 304

-Gu! 'Nɪ a yi gɔɔ-. (sese)
and alighted (on the tree).
et il s'est alors posé (sur l'arbre).

sigo 305

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -n yä gwäda bhlä -a?
He said, "My friend, have you cut the kapok tree down?"
Il dit: « Mon ami, as-tu abattu le fromager? »

sigo 306

Ɔ lä, -Nn.
He (=Sigo) said, "Yes."
Il (=Sigo) dit: « Oui. »

sigo 307

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Yua 'sɔ kä -kɛ gäma nä, (sese)
He (=Gopleu) said, "When the children play together,
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Quand les enfants s'amusent,

sigo 308

waa' 'bhläbhlä -lä -kaa! (sese)
they must not hit each other!"
qu'ils ne se fassent pas de mal! » (avertissement)

sigo 309

Ɔ lä, -Aa.
He said, "Okay."
Il dit: « Compris. »

sigo 31

Goplë, 'nɪ a yi bi -kä mʊ o! (sese)
Gopleu then went for a stroll.
Gopleu est alors allé se promener.

sigo 311

-Mɔɔ a -kʊ lä -aaa, (sese)
He stayed away until
C'est là-bas qu'il est resté jusqu'à ce qu'

sigo 312

'nɪ a yi -mɔɔ -bha
he left from there
il y quitte

sigo 313

'nɪ a yi yi. (sese)
and (he) came back.
et (re)vienne.

sigo 314

(A lä ka yi) A -yi
(He was coming,) He came
(Il allait venir) Il est venu

sigo 315

'nı a yi kwli. (sese)
and he came down.
et il est descendu

sigo 316

A lä, 'Nɔɔ, 'nı 'naa 'yuo? (sese)
He said, “My friend, what about my child?”
Il dit: « Mon ami, et mon enfant? »

sigo 317*

Ɔ lä, 'Nɔɔ, 'yua 'sɔ -kʊ gämadä nä, (sese)
He said, “My friend, as the two children were playing together,
Il dit: « Mon ami, les deux enfants étaient en train de s'amuser,

sigo 318*

'naa -lɔɔ yä -naa 'yuo 'bhlä. (sese)
my child (lit. mine) hit your child.”
mon enfant a frappé ton enfant. »

sigo 319

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Ɔɔ! 'Nɔɔ! (sese)
He exclaimed, “Oh dear! My friend!
Il s'est écrié avec émoi: « Mon ami!

sigo 320

'nı n -sonöö- bhɛ nynä
And I had told you that
Et je t'avais dit que

sigo 321

'yua 'sɔ wa kä gäma
the two children, when they play together,
les deux enfants, quand ils jouent ensemble

sigo 322

waa' 'bhläbhlä -lä -kä nä, (sese)
they mustn’t hit each other.
qu'ils ne se fassent pas de mal;

sigo 323

-n -nä waa' -lä bhɔɔ 'bhläbhlä. (sese)
(then) you had said that they wouldn’t hit each other.
(alors) tu as dit qu'ils n'allaient pas se faire de mal.

sigo 324

'Nı sı -kʊ yı
So how come
Alors comment se fait-il

sigo 325

'nı wa bhlää- bhä 'naa -lɔɔ? (sese)
that mine was hit?”
que le mien a été frappé? »

sigo 326

Ɔ lä, -A! 'Naa bhelinɔ,
Well, my brother,
Eh bien, mon frère,

sigo 327

'naa 'yuo yä -naa 'yuo 'bhlä. (sese)
my child has hit your child.
mon enfant a frappé ton enfant.

sigo 328

Ɔ {A} lä, -Aa,
He (=Gopleu) said: “Okay,
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Bon,

sigo 329

ıı' -wʊ lebhe -kä o! (sese)
it doesn’t matter,
ça ne fait rien!

sigo 330

ɪı' -wʊ lebhe -kä,
It doesn’t matter!
Ça ne fait rien,

sigo 331

-mä 'yuë 'sɔɔ- gäma bhä nä, (sese)
because it was two two children who were playing together,
parce que c'était deux enfants qui s'amusaient,

sigo 332

'yuë 'sɔ kä 'bhläbhlä nä, (sese)
if they hit each other,
s'ils se sont blessés,

sigo 333

ıı' -wʊ lebhe -kä,
it doesn’t matter,
ça ne fait rien,

sigo 334

-mä waa' wla -wʊ -nɔnɔ gbʊ 'kʊ. (sese)
so this won't be turned into a big issue (to take revenge).
donc on ne va pas en faire une grande affaire (pour se venger).

sigo 335

Nä -n yä sɔɔ ci nä,
Therefore after what you have said,
Puisque tu as dit cela,

sigo 336

n yɪ 'yi -tää {-taa} o! (sese)
I let (lit. have let) it go at that!"
je laisse (litt. j'ai laissé) tomber! »

sigo 337

'Nɪ amä -mä, 'nɪ a yi -plɪ kʊ o! (sese)
And he, he (=Gopleu) was silent.
Et lui, il (=Gopleu), il s'est tu.

sigo 338

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, n 'kä 'lʊ -döö. (sese)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, I want to compose a song."
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, je vais composer (litt. couper) un chant. »

sigo 339

'Nɪ ɔ yi -mɔɔ 'lʊ 'pä. (sese)
And he started (lit. showed) a song.
Puis il a entonné (litt. montré) un chant.

sigo 340

Sä ɔ kʊ -mɔɔ paa-?
(Lucien, a younger narrator, asks:) *How did he show it (=the song?)*
(Lucien, un narrateur plus jeune, demande :) *Comment l'a t-il montré?*

sigo 341

Ɔ {A} lä,
(Kotchi, the narrator, answers:) *He sings (lit. says):*
(Kotchi, the narrator, répond:) *Il chante ceci (litt. dit):*

sigo 342

SECOND SONG / DEUXIEME CHANT
Sigo ye lu o!
Sigo was disloyal!
Sigo a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

A 'ylä Sigo, ye lu a!
Ask Sigo he was disloyal!
Demandez à Sigo, il a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE : Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ a bhlää- lä o! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE : Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
It is me that you have killed! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
C'est moi que vous avez tué! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

A 'ylä Sigo! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE : Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
Ask Sigo! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
Demandez à Sigo! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nö nɔ -kaa (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
I have no mother *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de mère *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

A 'ylä Sigo! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
Ask Sigo! *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
Demandez à Sigo! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nö bä -kaa (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
I have no father *Sigo was disloyal, ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de père *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ -n bhlää- bhä -a? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o!)
Is it me that you killed/hit? *Sigo was disloyal!*
Est-ce moi que tu tuais? *Sigo a été déloyal!*

(NARRATOR AND AUDIENCE TOGETHER/ CONTEUR ET AUDITOIRE ENSEMBLE :)

A 'ylä Sigo!

Ask Sigo why!

Demandez à Sigo pourquoi!

sigo 343

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!

Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!

Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

sigo 344

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE) -Mati -a ylää-!

We have asked to hear more!

Nous avons demandé la suite!

sigo 345

Ɔ lä, Sigo, -amʊ -n bhlä bhä -a? (-kpazebhleku)

He (=Gopleu) said, "Is it me that you kill?" (=Is that how you reciprocate the good I have done you?)

Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Sigo, est-ce moi que tu tues? » (=Est-ce ainsi que tu me rends le bien que je t'ai fait?)

sigo 346

-Amʊʊ- yää- nʊ nä,

Me who made you (into someone)

Moi qui t'ai fait,

sigo 347

-amʊ -n bhlä bhä -a? (-kpazebhleku)

is it me that you kill?

est-ce moi que tu tues?

sigo 348

-Ɔɔ -wʊ gbʊʊ o! (-kpazebhleku)

It's not an issue."

Ce n'est pas grave. »

sigo 349

'Nɪ goplë yi bi -kä mʊ, (-kpazebhleku)

And Gopleu went for a stroll,

Et Gopleu est allé se promener,

sigo 350

'nɪ a yi yi o! (-kpazebhleku)

and he came.

puis il est venu.

sigo 351

A -kʊ -mɔɔ -aaa,

He stayed away a while,

Il est resté là-bas pendant un moment,

sigo 352

'nɪ a yi yi
then he came
puis il est venu

sigo 353

'nɪ a yi gɔɔ-. (-kpazebhleku)
and he alighted.
et il s'est posé.

sigo 354

A gɔɔ- ylä bʊkʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
When he had alighted again,
Quand il s'est posé encore,

sigo 355

a lä, 'Nɔɔ, -n -kʊ -lɔɔ -a?
he said, "My friend, are you there?"
il a dit: « Mon ami, tu es là? »

sigo 356*

Ɔ lä, -Ɛɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
He said "Yes."
Il dit: « Oui. »

sigo 357*

Ɔ lä, 'Nɪ 'yuo {'yua} -wa gäma bhlä nä
He (=Gopleu) said, "And the children who used to play together,
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Puis les enfants qui jouaient ensemble,

sigo 358

-naa - lɔɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ -a? (-kpazebhleku)
is yours there?"
le tien, est-il là? »

sigo 359

Ɔ lä, -Ɛɛ, 'naa -lɔɔ -kʊ -lɔɔ. (-kpazebhleku)
He said, "Yes, mine is there."
Il (Sigo) dit : « Oui, le mien est là. »

sigo 359a

THIRD SONG /TROISIÈME CHANT
Sigo ye lu o!
Sigo was disloyal!
Sigo a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo! Ɔ too!
Ask Sigo! He is lost!
Demandez à Sigo! Il est perdu!

A ylä Sigo, ye lu a!
Ask Sigo, he was disloyal.
Demandez à Sigo, il a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ -n bhlää- o? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
Is it me you have killed? (After all I did for you?) *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Est-ce moi que tu as tué? (Après tout ce que je t'ai fait?) *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ -n bhlää- o? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
Is it me you have killed? *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Est-ce moi que tu as tué? *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nö nɔ -kaa! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
I have no mother! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de mère! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nö bä -ka o! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo)
I have no father! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de père! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ -n bhlää- bhä -a? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o)
Is it me you have killed? *Sigo was disloyal!*
Est-ce moi que tu as tué? *Sigo a été déloyal!*

(CONTEUR ET AUDITOIRE ENSEMBLE:) A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

sigo 343

-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

sigo 344

(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE :) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

sigo 362

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, ɔ lä, 'Nɔɔ, ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu) said, “My friend,” he said, “My friend, close your eyes!”
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, ferme les yeux! »

sigo 363

Ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ!
Close your eyes!
Ferme les yeux!

sigo 364

-mää n 'kää- n 'kää- n'kää- 'nägädä 'ŋʊ,
so I will put you in a good place.
pour que je te mette dans un bon endroit,

sigo 365*

-Mä -nɪnɪ -ɪ -kʊ lä -länʊmʊ nä,
Since these things that are in this place,
Comme les choses qui sont ici,

sigo 366*

ɪ yä 'zɛ nä,
they are rotten,
elles sont pourries,

sigo 367*

nä n 'kää- 'yigäda dä 'ŋʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
therefore I shall put you in a better place.
C’est pourquoi je te mettrai dans un meilleur endroit.

sigo 368

Ɔ lä, Nn' 'ylä -wʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Sigo) said, “I don’t want to.”
Il (=Sigo) dit: « Je ne veux pas. »

sigo 369

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ!
He said, “My friend, close your eyes!”
Il dit: « Mon ami ferme les yeux! »

sigo 370

-Amʊʊ- -nʊ a -lɪɪ,
I who made the things
Moi qui ai fait les choses,

sigo 371

'nɪ n cii- nynä -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ
and who is telling you to close your eyes
et qui te dis de fermer les yeux

sigo 372

-yä n 'kää- 'nägädä 'ŋʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
so I can put you in a better place,
pour que je te mette dans un meilleur endroit,

sigo 373

-nn 'nu -wʊ -a? (-kpazebhleku)
you are not hearing?
tu n'écoutes pas?

sigo 374

-N ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
Close your eyes!"
« Ferme les yeux! »

sigo 375

Ɔ lä, 'Nɔɔ nn' 'ylä yıɔ.
He (= Sigo) said, "My friend, I don't want to anymore.
Il (=Sigo) dit: « Mon ami, je ne veux plus.

sigo 376

Nn' ŋwɛ -wʊ 'yi 'kʊ, (-kpazebhleku)
I am not closing my eyes.
Je ne ferme pas les yeux,

sigo 377

-mä dä n -kʊ lä nä, -lɔɔ nää. (-kpazebhleku)
because the place where I am is good."
car le lieu où je suis est bien. »

sigo 378

Ɔ{A} lä, ' Sʊɛ!
He (=Gopleu) said, "Nonsense!
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Quelle sottise!

sigo 379

-Aa, -mä kä -n -bä -a? (-kpazebhleku)
Okay, are you as stupid as that?
Bon, es-tu bête à ce point-là?

sigo 380

-Amʊ n ci nynä
Me, I am saying,
Moi, je dis:

sigo 381

-n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
"Close your eyes!"
« Ferme les yeux! »

sigo 382

kä -n nä -n 'gä 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ nä! (-kpazebhleku)
you actually want to close your eyes!
alors tu n'as qu'à fermer les yeux!

sigo 383

N nä -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ
I am saying to you to close your eyes,
Je te dis de fermer les yeux,

sigo 384

-yä n 'kää- 'nägädä 'ŋʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
so I can put you in a better place
pour que je te mette dans un meilleur endroit!

sigo 385

Dä n nä n 'kää- ylä -pɛ 'ŋʊ nä, (-kpazebhleku)
The place where I want to put you from now on,
Le lieu où je veux désormais te mettre,

sigo 386

daa, -n yi -lɔɔ yibhë. (-kpazebhleku)
the place, you will know it.
la place, tu la connaîtras.

sigo386a

FOURTH SONG /QUATRIEME CHANT
Sigo ye lu o!
Sigo was disloyal!
Sigo a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo! ye to wɛ!
Ask Sigo, he is lost!
Demandez à Sigo, il est perdu!

A ylä Sigo ye lu a!
Ask Sigo, he was disloyal!
Demandez à Sigo, il a été déloyal!

A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ -n bhlää- o? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE:) Sigo ye lu o! A 'ylä Sigo!)
Is it me you have killed? *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Est-ce moi que tu as tué? *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Amʊ -n bhlää- o? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
Is it me you have killed? *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Est-ce moi que tu as tué? *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

N 'nö nɔ -kaa! (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
I have no mother! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de mère! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Nn' -wʊ nɔ -kä, n 'nö bä -ka o (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o, a 'ylä Sigo!)
I have no mother, I have no father! *Sigo was disloyal! Ask Sigo!*
Je n'ai pas de mère, je n'ai pas de père! *Sigo a été déloyal! Demandez à Sigo!*

Nn' -wʊ 'bä -kä, a 'ylä Sigo!
I have no father, ask Sigo!
Je n'ai pas de père, demandez à Sigo!

Amʊ -n bhlää- bhä -a? (AUDIENCE/AUDITOIRE: Sigo ye lu o!)
Is it me you have killed? *Sigo was disloyal!*
Est-ce moi que tu tues? *Sigo a été déloyal!*

(NARRATOR AND AUDIENCE TOGETHER/ CONTEUR ET AUDITOIRE ENSEMBLE:)
A 'ylä Sigo!
Ask Sigo!
Demandez à Sigo!

sigo 387
-Ja! -Ja! A go -mati o!
Silence! Silence! Say that you want to hear more!
Silence! Silence! Demandez à entendre la suite!

sigo 388
(AUDIENCE / AUDITOIRE :) -Mati -a ylää-!
We have asked to hear more!
Nous avons demandé la suite!

sigo 389
Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -n ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, close your eyes!"
Il (Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, ferme les yeux! »

sigo 390
'Nı Sigo yi 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
So Sigo closed his eyes.
Alors Sigo a fermé les yeux.

sigo 391
Ɔ {A} lä, Sigo, -n welie 'yi yıɛ.
He (=Gopleu) said, "Sigo, open your eyes now!"
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Ouvre les yeux maintenant! »

sigo 392

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'yi welie. (-kpazebhleku)
So he opened his eyes.
Alors il a ouvert les yeux.

sigo 393

Ɔ mʊ 'yi welie -kää nä, (-kpazebhleku)
When he was opening his eyes
Au moment où il a ouvert les yeux,

sigo 394

-lɔɔ' 'bhlɪɛ -lefɪɪn (-kpazebhleku)
the whole place,
tout l'espace,

sigo 395

nyɪkpɔɔ' -lä yɪɔ -lɔɔ 'plö.
nobody will pass through there anymore
personne ne pourra plus passer par là.

sigo 396

-Nn 'plö yɪɔ -lɔɔ
You don't pass through there anymore
Tu ne passes plus là

sigo 397

'nɪ -n 'gä yɪ nyɪkpɔ 'ni. (-kpazebhleku)
to go see anybody.
pour voir quelqu'ɪn.

sigo 398

-Lɔɔ -lefɪɪn, ɔ{a} yä -lɔɔ wlä. (-kpazebhleku)
The whole place, he (=Gopleu) had ruined it.
Tout l'endroit, il (=Gopleu) l'a cassé.

sigo 399*

Ɔ {A} lä, -N ni sä n sonöö- bhlä
He said, "You see, I had said to you
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Voilà, comme je t'avais dit

sigo 400*

nynä kä n 'kää- lä göglä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
that I would really give you a good situation, so
que j'allais t'arranger,

sigo 401

n yä -lää wlä,
I have ruined this place (lit. here),
j'ai cassé ici,

sigo 402

kä n nä n 'kä lä -lɔɔ nʊ bʊkʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
but I am going to rebuild the place.
mais je vais refaire l'endroit.

sigo 403

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu)said, "My friend, close your eyes!"
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, ferme les yeux! »

sigo 404

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
And he closed his eyes.
Alors il a fermé les yeux.

sigo 405

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, welie 'yi. (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, open your eyes!"
Il dit: « Mon ami, ouvre les yeux! »

sigo 406

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'yi welie.
And he opened his eyes.
Alors il a ouvert les yeux.

sigo 407

Ɔ lä kɔ welie 'yi nä,
When he was opening his eyes,
Quand il ouvrait les yeux,

sigo 408

-lɔɔ 'klaa' -lefɪɪn, a -kʊ yɪ aa' saa,
the whole forest, it was now there as before.
toute la forêt était à son état initial.

sigo 409

'nɪ ɔ -kʊ yɪ 'nyiee yëku.
and he was now sitting by the water.
et il était assis au bord de l'eau.

sigo 410

Ɔ -kʊ yɪ ('nyiga) 'nyikpʊkpʊʊ 'kʊ. (-kpazebhleku)
He was now on the shore.
Il était maintenant sur la rive.

sigo 411

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, ŋwɛ 'yi 'kʊ! (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, close your eyes!
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Mon ami, ferme les yeux!

sigo 412

-Mä -n ni lä 'yi -a,
Because you see,
Parce que vois-tu,

sigo 413

n yä yɪ nʊ nä,
I have now made this
j'ai maintenant fait ceci,

sigo 414

'yigäda dä -a 'gä ylä 'plöö-. (-kpazebhleku)
we will now pass to another place."
nous allons maintenant passer à un autre endroit. »

sigo 415

'Nɪ ɔ yi 'yi 'kʊ ŋwɛ. (-kpazebhleku)
So he closed his eyes.
Alors il a fermé les yeux.

sigo 416

(Ɔ mʊ ɔ ye) Ɔ mʊ nʊ -kää nä,
When he was doing so
Au moment où il le faisait,

sigo 417*

ɔ -kʊ yɪ -mɔɔ ɔɔ' cɔkʊʊ 'wlu. (-kpazebhleku)
he was now there on top of his rock.
il se trouvait maintenant là sur son rocher.

sigo 418

Cɔkʊ 'wlu, jinëdëë' cɛkʊʊ 'wlu ɔ {a} -sɔ bhlä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
On the rock, on the rock in the middle of the ocean from which he (=Gopleu) had taken him,
Sur le rocher, sur le rocher au milieu de la mer d'où il (=Gopleu) l'avait enlevé,

sigo 419

ɔ -kʊ yɪ -lɔɔ{-mɔɔ}, (-kpazebhleku)
he (=Sigo) was now there.
il (=Sigo) était maintenant là-bas.

sigo 420

Ɔɔ' gwieyii taa -kʊɔ yɪ wlɪı'. (-kpazebhleku)
His three palm nuts were now in his hands
Ses trois graines sont dans sa main.

sigo 421

Ɔ 'na welie yɪ 'yi,
He tried in vain to open his eyes,
Il avait beau ouvrir les yeux,

sigo 422

ɔɔ' 'yii ɪ -kʊ yɪ ɪ' sa.
his eyes, they were now as they had been before
ses yeux, ils sont redevenus comme à l'état initial,

sigo 423

ɭ yä ŋomo. (-kpazebhleku)
They had gotten dim.
Ils étaient éteints.

sigo 424

Ɔ {A} lä, 'Nɔɔ, -ayoyɪ, -mä kä n mʊ ylä! (-kpazebhleku)
He (=Gopleu) said, "My friend, good bye, I am now leaving.
Il (=Gopleu) dit: « Ami, au revoir, je m'en vais.

sigo 425

-AmʊʊA- -nʊʊ-
I, who made you
Moi qui t'ai fait

sigo 426

'nɪ -ɔ puë- nä,
and who saved you,
et qui t'ai sauvé,

sigo 427

-amʊ -n bhlä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
it is me that you are killing,
c'est moi que tu tues,

sigo 428

-naa dä -n -kʊ bhlä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
your place where you were before
ton endroit où tu étais

sigo 429

'nɪ -n lü bhlä -naa gwieyii nä, (-nn)
and where you ate your palnuts
et où tu mangeais tes trois graines,

sigo 430

(ɪ' -blɔɔ…) ɪ' 'nää n -nʊʊ- lä nä,
(their path..) the good that I did to you
(leur chemin…) le bien que je t'ai fait

sigo 431

'nɪ -mɔɔ -n bhlää' lä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and you are killing me in spite of it
et pourtant tu me tues,

sigo 432

-n ni -naa daa!
here is your home!
voici chez toi.

sigo 433

-Lɔɔ -kʊ yɪ bʊkʊ -zɪkä -lää. (-kpazebhleku)
This is again your place here.
C'est encore chez-toi ici.

sigo 434

-Kʊ yɪ -naa dä,
Stay now at your place,
Reste maintenant chez toi,

sigo 435

-mä -amʊ n yä mʊ a! (-kpazebhleku)
but I, I am gone!"
mais moi je suis parti! »

sigo 436*

'Nɪ wlä Goplë yi bhä 'kʊ -bha, (-kpazebhleku)
Then Gopleu got up

sigo 437*

'nɪ {a}ɔ yi bhä mʊ a! (-kpazebhleku)
and he went away.
et il est parti.

sigo 438*

'Nünëa, sä Sigo -nʊ wä nä,
The story (about) how Sigo had acted
Le conte comment Sigo s'était comporté

sigo 439*

ɔ -nʊ Goplë, (-kpazebhleku)
towards Gopleu
envers Gopleu

sigo 440*

'nɪ Goplë, -mä a -nʊɔ wä nä, (-kpazebhleku)
and Gopleu, (how) he had dealt with him,
et comment Gopleu, il avait agi envers lui,

sigo 441

ɪu' -dɔɔ 'pɛpɛlɪɔ 'mɔ n ŋʊʊ- {lä} sä, (-kpazebhleku)
that little piece of advice, that is what I have given (lit. put down) through it
ce petit conseil, c'est ce que j'ai donné (litt. déposé) au travers de lui,

sigo 442

-yä a 'kɔ -kä yibhë a! (-kpazebhleku)
so that you may know it (=the advice).
pour que vous le connaissiez (= le conseil).

sigo 443

-Lɔɔ n bhloo-. (-aao)
It is here I stopped.
C'est là que je me suis arrêté.

sigo 444

(LUCIEN:) Nyänyä[9], (nn) lɔɔ ɔ bhloo- laa.
Nyanya, *it is here he has stopped.*
Nyanya, *c'est ici qu'il s'est arrêté.*

sigo 445

(NYÄNYÄ:) -A mʊ! Sɔɔ lä, 'pɪɛpɪɛ -a pä lä.
Let's go! That's it, little by little we give (lit. we throw) stories.
Allons! C'est ça, on conte (litt. jette) peu à peu.

sigo 446

(KOCI:) Voilàà!
Thaat's it!
Voilàà!

18. Soutien

Genre: Hortatory / Exhortation
Content: The problem of the Godie language and culture disappearing and what should be done to preserve them / *Contenu*: Ce qu'il faut faire pour préserver la langue et la culture godié, qui sont menacées de disparition
Speaker/Locuteur: F (27, male)
Date: April / Avril 1996

soutien 001

Bhɛŋwnɪä -yä bhelienyɪ, anyɪaa' -kaflɪnɪɛ -kä!
Sisters and brothers, please excuse me (for what I am going to talk about)!
Sœurs et frères et, veuillez m'excuser (pour ce dont je vais vous parler)!

soutien 002

Kä -n bhʊtʊ nä,
I am truly concerned, but
Ce sont des inquiétudes qui me traversent, mais

soutien 003

bhʊtʊbhʊtʊnyɔ -glö -kä nüwätä nä,
the person expressing concern is a cold mouth (= has a peaceful intention),
le lamentateur est une bouche froide (= a une intention pacifique),

[9] The younger narrator Lucien turns to the audience representative Nyanya. */ Le narrateur plus jeune, nommé Lucien, s'adresse à Nyanya, l'animateur.*

soutien 004

nüwätä waa' 'paa -kä 'kpeye.
and you don’t slap a cold mouth.
et on ne gifle pas une bouche froide.

soutien 005

-Aa 'bhlıɛ -a 'bäsıbäsı -tüanyı lä nä, ɛmɛ -ɛ -kʊ lä -lää.
Our inheritance that our forefathers have left us, that is the issue. (lit. it’s that that is here)
Notre patrimoine que nos ancêtres nous ont laissé, c'est de cela qu'il s'agit. (litt.: c'est cela qui est ici)

soutien 006

Nuwälıı wa -tüanyı lä nä,
The language that they have left us,
La langue qu'ils nous ont laissée

soutien 007

dı -kʊ bhä?
where is it?
où est-elle?

soutien 008

Kı too lä.
It is actually disappearing.
Elle en train de se perdre.

soutien 009

Kı büo lä 'kʊ.
It is about to be forgotten.
Elle est en voie d'être oubliée.

soutien 010

-Anyıaa nuwälıı ı yä 'kʊ cɛnölıı' 'plö.
Our language, it has become a subject of discussion.
Notre langue est devenue sujette à discussion.

soutien 011

Waa' -dɔɔ, waa' 'nünüü -yä waa' -jlibɔɔ, dä sä ı -kʊ bhä?
Their (= our ancestors’) wisdom, their stories, their riddles, where are they?
Leur sagesse, leurs contes et leurs devinettes, où sont-ils?

soutien 012

Nyıkpɔ nyıkpɔ, ɔɔ' sää- -tonöɔ ylä 'wluu' nä,
Everyone, whatever has stayed in his head,
Chacun, ce qui est resté dans sa tête,

soutien 013

sɔɔ ɔ ŋʊ ylä sä.
that is what he shares (lit. puts down).
c'est ce qu'il partage (litt. dépose).

soutien 014

Kɔ kä yı yio gëë-
If he tells in fact wrong things,
S'il raconte en fait des faussetés

soutien 015

ɔɔ' 'yuë -yä ɔɔ' natokloyuë kä wa bhɛnöö- ylä 'wluu.
his children and grandchildren, they now carry that in their heads.
ses enfants et ses petits enfants garderont cela dans la tête.

soutien 016

-Abhuwälıı -ı plöö- lä -aa ciciwälıı nä,
Our language, which is our way of speaking,
Notre langue, qui est notre parler,

soutien 017

kı büo lä 'kʊ.
it is really about to be forgotten.
elle est vraiment en voie d'être oubliée.

soutien 018

'Kɔgwlɛwnyʊa -wa -yi lä bhlägɔgɔbhlänuwälıı' 'pɛpɛlıä nä,
The old people who know a little bit the old way of speaking,
Les vieux qui connaissent un peu de l'ancien parler,

soutien 019

wliiye 'yi wa zɛnönʊa yı,
you can now tick them off on your fingers,
on ne les compte maintenant qu'au bout des doigts,

soutien 020

'nı waa' laa yıɔ nyeblii
and they don’t call the young people anymore
et ils n'appellent plus les jeunes

soutien 021

'nı wa 'kʊa soo-.
and talk to them.
et leur parlent.

soutien 022

Nyeblii -mä 'fläsıwälı yʊwa plüë nä,
As for the young people, the French language has changed them, so
Quant aux jeunes, puisque la langue française les a transformés,

soutien 023

waa' 'jloo- -wʊ 'kɔgwlɛnyʊa yëku
they don’t approach the elders
ils ne s'approchent pas des anciens

soutien 024

'nı wa 'kä 'ylä nynä:
in order to ask them questions saying,
pour leur demander en ces termes:

soutien 025

'Bäsınyı, 'ylʊ yä 'wlu 'tɔɔ nä,
“Dear fathers, the sun is going down (=you are coming to the end of your days), so
« Chers pères, le soleil s'incline (= vous approchez la fin de vos jours), alors

soutien 026

bhlägɔgɔbhlänuwälıklë- gä 'mnö -kʊ nä
if you have knowledge of our old way of speaking,
s'il y a en vous une connaissance de l'ancien parler,

soutien 027

a cio-
let it be said,
que cela soit dit,

soutien 028

-yä -anyıa 'nyukwli 'kaa klä.
so that our ears may seize it.”
pour que nos oreilles le saisissent. »

soutien 029

-Wa bha lä nyeblii nëëdë,
Those who leave from among the young people
Ceux qui quittent le milieu des jeunes

soutien 030

'nı -wa yi lä 'bäsıı yëku
and who come next to the elders
et qui viennent vers les parents

soutien 031

nynä wa 'kʊwa cıa nä,
so that they can teach them,
pour qu'on les enseigne,

soutien 032

wa kä -lää' lɔɔ wälıklë -soo,
if they (=the elders) give information to one of them,
si on donne des renseignements à l'un,

soutien 033

kɔ zizienöa ɔ -liesı 'yii.
he hides it from the others
il le cache devant les autres

soutien 034

kɔ klaa 'nää ɔmɔ -bhlogbe 'coo -za.
and he keeps it only for him alone.
et il garde cela pour lui seul.

soutien 035

-Aa, 'nı bɔɔgʊ 'klʊ -mä ıı' -kʊ
Well, and it is not (written) on paper
Eh bien, ce n'est pas (écrit) sur papier

soutien 036

'nı ɔ klı lä 'nää ɔ yëkuu' -bhlogbee' -zaa nä,
and he keeps it to himself, so
et il garde cela pour lui seul, alors

soutien 037

kɔ -bë lä ɔɔ' 'wuklëë' -lʋa, waa' dä 'kʊ.
he really forgets those coming after him (lit. those behind him).
il a vraiment oublié ceux qui viennent après lui (litt. ceux qui sont derrière lui).

soutien 038

Kɔ -bë lä ɔɔ' 'yuaa' dä 'kʊ.
He really forgets about his children in the future. (lit. the place of his children)
Il a vraiment oublié ses enfants dans l'avenir. (litt. la place de ses enfants)

soutien 039

-A 'bhuwälıı, -a 'nıı yıɔ -yi,
Our language, we don't know it anymore,
Notre langue, on ne la connaît plus,

soutien 040

'nı 'bäsıı' yıɔ 'tɛnyı -kä
and our elders don't have the time anymore
et nos parents n'ont plus du temps

soutien 041

-yä wa 'kanyımı yı cıa!
to teach it to us.
pour nous l'enseigner!

soutien 042

Nä -a 'nö dıgälı -plä
Thus if we are not wise
Si donc nous ne faisons pas preuve de sagesse,

soutien 043

'nı -a 'nö 'pɛpɛlıɔ -ɔ -tonö-anyı lä 'nyukwli nä,
and if the little bit that has stayed in our ears,
et si le peu qui nous est resté dans les oreilles,

soutien 044

-a 'nöɔ 'bɔɔgʊʊ' ŋʊʊ- nä,
if we don't put it on paper
si nous ne le mettons pas par écrit (litt. sur papier),

soutien 045

nuwälıı' 'cë -sä -aa 'yuë ci -kä bhä zeküü?
what kind of language will our children speak tomorrow?
quel genre de parler est-ce que nos enfants parleront demain?

soutien 046

Säsä -a cıa -kä bhä -aa 'yuë
How will we then teach our children
Comment allons-nous donc enseigner nos enfants

soutien 047

'nı -aa 'yuë soo -kä bhä waa' 'yuë?
and how will our children talk to their children?
et comment nos enfants parleront-ils à leurs enfants?

soutien 048

Bhɛŋwnıä -yä bhelienyı,
Brothers and sisters, (lit. sisters and brothers)
Frères et sœurs, (litt. sœurs et frères)

soutien 049*

säsä -a 'gä bhä nʊ
what can we do
comment allons-nous faire

soutien 050*

-yä 'pɛpɛlıɔ -a -yi lä -bhlɛ nä,
so that the little that we know at this point,
pour que le peu que nous savons pour le moment

soutien 051*

ɔɔ' kä -kä bhä 'kʊ büoo?
it will not be forgotten?
il ne sera pas oublié?

soutien 052

Säsä -a 'gä bhä nʊ -yä 'pɛpɛlıɔ
What can we do so that the little bit
Comment allons-nous faire pour que le peu

soutien 053

-a 'bäsı ya-anyı lä soo- nä,
that our elders have told us,
que nos pères nous ont dit,

soutien 054

ɔ 'kä bhä 'ylʊzɔɔ too?
it will stay in this world?
qu'il puisse rester au monde?

soutien 055

Säsä -a 'gä bhä nʊ
What can we do
Comment allons-nous faire

soutien 056

-yä 'pɛpɛlıɔ -a -yi lä nä,
so that the little bit that we know,
pour que le peu que nous connaissons,

soutien 057

-aa natokloyuë 'kɔ bhä kätää' ŋëmʊ?
our grand-children will find it?
nos petits-enfants puissent le trouver?

soutien 058

ı -ŋwa 'kʊ nynä -a jɻjlä- -nını 'fıın 'bɔɔgʊʊ'.
It is necessary that we write all of that on paper.
Il faut que nous mettions tout cela par écrit (litt. que nous écrivions tout cela sur du papier).

soutien 059

-Mä 'fıa -yä ı 'kä 'bɔɔgʊʊ' jɻjlɔ- nä,
But before it will be written on paper,
Mais avant que cela ne soit mis par écrit,

soutien 060

ı -ŋwa 'kʊ nynä -anyı Gwëjee -a wamä- -abhuwälıı.
it is necessary that we the Godié, we love our language.
il faut que nous, le peuple godié, nous aimions notre langue.

soutien 061

ı nää- 'sıı 'kʊ nynä
It is also good that
Il est aussi bien que

soutien 062

-a 'ciä ıı' jɻjlälı
we learn how to write it
nous apprenions à l'écrire

soutien 063

ıyä -a yibhë ıı' zɛsä.
and that we know how to read it.
et que nous sachions la lire.

soutien 064

Bhɛŋwnıä -yä bhelienyı,
Brothers and sisters,
Frères et sœurs,

soutien 065

sä nyıkpɔnyıkpɔ kä mii- nä,
whatever each and every one of us is able to do,
la manière dont chacun d'entre nous peut,

soutien 066

ɔ nʊ sɔɔ,
he should do,
qu'il le fasse,

soutien 067

ıyä -a ˈbhuwälıı, ı ˈkä yibhënöɔ.
so that our own language, it will be known.
pour que notre parler soit connu.

soutien 068

-Mä wlä -a ˈbäsı lä,
Because our elders have this saying:
Car nos parents ont cet adage:

soutien 068

-Kɔfʊ kä -kä takplä ˈkʊ -kʊ nä,
“If the wasp is still in its nest,
« Si la guêpe est encore sur sa ruche

soutien 069

-lɔɔ ʊ kää -kä.
that’s when its sting hurts.”
c'est là que sa piqûre fait mal. »

References

Andrews, Avery. 1985. The major functions of the noun phrase. In Shopen, 62–154.
Blakemore, Diane. 1992. *Understanding utterances: An introduction to pragmatics*. Oxford: Blackwell.
Blass, Regina. 1990. *Relevance relations in discourse*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
Brown, Gillian, and George Yule. 1983. *Discourse analysis.* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
Carozzi, Stefano. 2010. *Expect the unexpected: Aspects of pragmatic foregrounding in Old Testament narratives.* London: T. & T. Clark.
Chafe, Wallace L. 1976. Givenness, contrastiveness, definiteness, subjects, topics and point of view. In Charles N. Li (ed.), *Subject and topic*, 25–56. New York: Academic Press.
Chafe, Wallace L. 1987. Cognitive constraints on information flow. In Tomlin, 21–51.
Comrie, Bernard. 1989. *Language universals and linguistic typology.* 2nd edition. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
Dooley, Robert A., and Stephen H. Levinsohn. 2001. *Analyzing discourse: A manual of basic concepts.* Dallas: SIL International and University of North Dakota.
Dingemanse, Mark. 2010. Folk definitions of ideophones. In Elisabeth Norcliffe and N. J. Enfield (eds.), *Field Manual* Volume 13, 24–29. Nijmegen: Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics. http://fieldmanuals.mpi.nl/volumes/2010/folk-definitions-of-ideophones/.
Ducrot, Oswald. 1983. Puisque, essai de description polyphonique. *Revue Romane* 24:166–185.
Egner, Inge. 1989. *Précis de grammaire Wobé*. Abidjan: Annales de l'Université d'Abidjan. Linguistique. Tome XV.
Egner, Inge. 2005. Applicative marking in Kru. *Afrika und Übersee* 86:199–222.
Givón, Talmy. 1984. *Syntax. Vol. 1. A Functional-typological introduction.* Amsterdam: Benjamins.
Givón, Talmy ed. 1983. *Topic continuity in discourse*. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
Gratrix, Carol. 1975. *Morphotonologie du godié.* Annales de l'Université d'Abidjan. Série H, no.8, 99–114.
Gratrix, Carol. 1978. Godié narrative. In Grimes, 311–323.
Grimes, Joseph E. 1975. *The thread of discourse.* Janua Linguarum, Series Minor No. 207. The Hague: Mouton.
Grimes, Joseph E. ed. 1978. *Papers on discourse.* Dallas: Summer Institute of Linguistics.
Keenan, Edward L. 1985. Passive in the world's languages. In Shopen, 243–281.
Lambrecht, Knud. 1994. Information structure and sentence form: Topic, focus and the mental representations of discourse referents. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
Levinsohn, Stephen H. 1997. A report on research into the functions of relative clauses in languages of Cameroon. *Notes on Translation* 11(3):38–40.
Levinsohn, Stephen H. 2000. *Discourse features of New Testament Greek: A coursebook on the information structure of New Testament Greek*. Dallas: SIL International.
Levinsohn, Stephen H. 2007. *Self-instruction materials on narrative discourse analysis*. Dallas: SIL International. http://www-01.sil.org/~levinsohns/narr.pdf (accessed May 8, 2014).
Lewis, M. Paul (ed.), 2009. Ethnologue: Languages of the World, Sixteenth edition. Dallas, Texas: SIL International. Online version: http://archive.ethnologue.com/16.
Marchese, Lynell. 1976. Subordination in Godié. M.A. thesis. University of California at Los Angeles.
Marchese, Lynell. 1978. Time reference in Godié. In Grimes, 63–75.
Marchese, Lynell. 1986a. *Tense/aspect and the development of auxiliaries in Kru languages*. SIL Publications in Linguistics 78. Dallas: SIL International.
Marchese, Lynell. 1986b. Grammaire pratique de la langue Godié. Unpublished ms.
Marchese, Lynell. 1986c. The pronominal system of Godié. In Wiesemann, Ursula (ed.), *Pronominal systems*, 217–255. Tübingen: Gunter Narr.
Marchese, Lynell. 1987. On the role of conditionals in Godié procedural discourse. In Tomlin, 263–280.
Marchese, Lynell. 1989. Kru. In John Bendor-Samel (ed.), *The Niger-Congo languages,* 119–139. New York: University Press of America.
Pope, Kathrin. 1993. The use of subordinate clauses in Waama and how this affects translation. *Notes on Translation* 7(2):1–11.

Roulet, Eddy. 1996. Polyphony. In Verschueren, Jef, Jan-Ola Östman, Jan Blommaert, and Chris Bulcaen (eds.), *Handbook of pragmatics*, 1–18. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
Roulet, Eddy, Laurent Filliettaz, Anne Grobet, with Marcel Burger. 2001. *Un modèle et un instrument d'analyse de l'organisation du discours.* Bern: Peter Lang.
Runge, Steven E. 2010. *Discourse grammar of the Greek New Testament: A practical introduction for teaching and exegesis*. Peabody: Hendrickson.
Schachter, Paul. 1985. Parts-of-speech systems. In Shopen, 3–61.
Shopen, Timothy (ed.). 2007. *Language typology and syntactic description. Vol 1: Clause structure.* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
Sperber, Dan, and Deirdre Wilson. 1995. *Relevance: Communication and cognition*. Oxford: Blackwell.
Tomlin, Russell S. (ed.). *Coherence and grounding in discourse*. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
Tufvesson, Sylvia. 2007. Expressives. In Asifa Majid (ed.), *Field Manual,* Volume 10, 53–58. Nijmegen: Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics. http://fieldmanuals.mpi.nl/volumes/2007/expressives/.
Welmers, William E. 1973. *African language structures.* Berkeley: University Press.
Weydt, Harald, Th. Harden, E. Hentschel, and D. Rosler. 1983. *Kleine deutsche Partikellehre: Lehr- Und Übungsbuch.* Stuttgart: Klett.